drop dead, gorgeous

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Character:	Bakugou Katsuki, Midoriya Izuku, Shinsou Hitoshi, Kirishima Eijirou, Kaminari Denki, Sero Hanta, Ashido Mina, Uraraka Ochako, Iida Tenya, Todoroki Shouto, Eri (My Hero Academia), Izumi Kouta
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Collections:	Katya’s Korner Fic Recs, BkDk Greats, Social Media Fics that I LOVE, Unfinished_best_bnha, Cloudy with a Chance of great fics, Dekunerd, the perfect fic doesn't exi-, My hero academia, All-time BNHA Favourites, call 911 for I have died at the sheer perfection that are these fics, Unfinished Masterpieces, Kylo's BNHA Recommendation Stories :D, Boku No Hero Academia, ☆ Little Red's BNHA Library ☆, The Abyss Records, Deku x Kacchan, Lady's collection of PERFECT fics., ☆My Hero Stories Worth Your Time☆, Creative Chaos Discord Recs, Fav BKDK Fics, _____My Hero Smut Life_____, _____My Hero Stories That Made Me Cry_____, bkdk favs :), Deku and Kacchan feel good fics, BakuDekuStories, Se eu perde-las, God Tier BNHA, For Re-reading Great Bakudeku, misc favourite fic, Honestly every fanfic of Izuku I have ever read., BKDK, these fics are why i’m sleep deprived, Absolute Treasures That Hit Harder Than They Should Have, GBFOAT: Greatest BakuDeku Fics Of All Time_____ me life, Curated bakudeku, BNHA fanfics that I liked and cried and definitely in my top 50, Magnolia's Favourite Fics, bkdk birthed and raised the person i am today, Best shit ever, Behold the Sacred Texts, fuckin' mint, isabella9792_readinglist, pretty sure i can't feel love but i can also lie to myself, BNHA BEST CHAPTER FICS TO EVER GRACE THE INTERNET, the holy grail of fanfiction, Stellar Fics: A Wonder Duo Collection ☆★, Soft Top Mido x Sassy Bottom Kats, Favorites_bb, Legitimately The Best Works I've Ever Read, emus top fics, masterlist of bnha fics i’ve read and would read again, Adored Fics, My Hero Academia, BKDK Fics that Just Hit Different, Bakudeku books That leave you squealing, Worth It BNHA Fanfics Reading List - Completed, Мои_любимые_работы☺, Favs mesmo, ¨˚ə(´◡`)ɜ˚¨ kat, ùwú oh worm? then squirm., Bakudeku is my whole soul and being, under penalty of death, my hero academia: a medley, bnha fanfics that caught

my attention, hixpatch's all time favorites, bkdk the world, Phoenix's Re-read List, MHA Fics I Haven't Read Yet, Too BakuDeku fics, BNHA Top Tier, fics for my BakuDeku addiction, bakudeku love :) <3, Keep Coming Back 2, Literal perfection in every way, bnha fics that I would die to read for the first time again, My Favourite Fanfics, I don't have a personal life, Characters Explores Social Media, Comfort fics, lil' bkdk box of skittles (+others), BakuDeku Goldmine, BakuDeku Things, Dad Look! It's the Good Kush!, Bakudeku gems, my top bkdk/dkbk faves, blasphemi's bnha fics, Social Media AUs, my personal stash of good bnha shit, Recs for Friends, my BNHA favs, BakuDeku AO3 Collection (Shin), All Time Fave BakuDeku Fics I've Read (Shin), Favourite BkDk <3, bkdk euphoria :)., MHA favs, Subscribed books I've finished, late night reads, unfinished and marked as complete / open ending, The best BAKUDEKU fics i finished reading, fics that cured my depression, Favorite reads!, Keep Your Eyes On Me, Finished Reading, longfics that butter my bread, My Absolute Favorites, MHA746, Every_fic_I_want_to_read, Already Read - MsPato, DazzlingGreenBean MHA, BKDK Brainrot (Tia Lee), hear me out. what if we… communicated?, SakurAlpha's Fic Rec of Pure how did you create this you amazing bean, FFs I find lovely, I don't even WATCH this show but this fic hits HARD, My Favourite Bnha stories to read, [finished] bnha ٩(ヽ°～°ヽ)9, ❀ㄹ|아❀'s library

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drop dead, gorgeous

by thewunderkind

Summary

It's been eight years since Izuku last logged in. When he gets the chance to do so, he discovers that he's married to a user named Ground Zero. Apparently, the husband he's had eight years ago 「 *King Explosion Murder* 」 patiently waited and has somehow not divorced him. Also, for some reason said husband is now a professional player.

Or the one wherein Izuku learns about the horrors of online — *not really* — *dating*.

- Inspired by Waiting For You Online by Xi And Qing

your husband is online

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Izuku blinks, fingers rapidly tapping on the keyboard, mouse gliding against the desk.

It's seven am on a Saturday morning and here he is sitting in front of the computer, his companion cursing at him loudly, headphones blaring at his ears. It's so loud he slightly flinches, panicking as he tries to chain his moves and overthrow the monster rampaging in front of his avatar. He doesn't have a lot of mana left, not much HP either. It also doesn't help how they've ran out of potions due to the dungeon mission they did previously.

"YOU'RE SUCH A FUCK UP FUCKING DEKU USE YOUR ULT YOU FUCKING NERD —"

Usually, other players would join parties to defeat this particular boss. It was *that* strong.

Izuku might be able to find one but his partner… well, due to his colorful language and a rather extreme personality; he doesn't get along with others. Groups most especially, it wasn't his forte. He's extremely strong and skilled but he isn't really cooperative. Izuku as well— he is too much of a pushover to refuse the duo invites so before he knew it he had been favored and couldn't leave.

"I'm so sorry, Kacchan!"

"USE YOUR FUCKING ULT WHEN I STUN YOU DUMBASS!"

"When…When's your CC up?"

"IN EIGHT FUCKING SECONDS LOOK AT THE FUCKING SCREEN AND YOU'LL SEE—"

Izuku sweatdrops as he observes the other charge, waiting for the countdown to proceed before running towards the enemy. His final attack was ready and his partner was about to execute. If they do this well then they might win the game.

Wait for the right timing, wait for the right timing, wait for the right timing—

"NOW!"

"Full Cowling!" his avatar, a hero named *Deku* shouts, green electricity running through his entire body. His partner's explosion has the monster stunned for approximately four seconds, enough to chain fourteen combos one after the other. "Delaware Smash!"

"Stun Grenade!"

"Graaaaaaaaaaaaaahhh!" the enemy lets out one last cry before it goes down.

Izuku's eyes widen and he gets up from his seat, his chair clattering and moving back.

Did… Did they just win!? They really won! Just the two of them against the ultimate boss and —

"THIS IS WHAT I'M TALKING ABOUT! HELL YEAH—"

Ping!

New Record Set by
King Explosion Murder and Deku.
Time: 00:16:24:06

“Good job, Kacchan!”

Izuku beams, sitting down and leaning back his seat before they loot the treasure box that appears as a reward right after. It only takes a few minutes before their names appear on the game forums and other players start to congratulate them. A job well done indeed.

World Execute.

It is the most sensational and long-awaited game of the decade.

A 3D online fantasy MMORPG that features action-oriented combat in an alternate universe modeled after modern society. There are country servers and upon avatar automation, each and every player is granted a quirk: Emitter, Transformation, or Mutant; either of the three in random.

You can choose to become a *civilian* — there are many missions to play and you can build your own career like a Slice of Life game. Or you can be someone *important* — enter a prestigious school and become a doctor or the next Prime Minister by boosting your intelligence. There are monsters all over the place, to raise levels, provide materials, and serve as bosses. Dungeons also exist for players to discover rare items and explore.

You can get married, divorce and have children as well! It’s the very reason why female consumers are attracted. Marriage gives the players a 10% loot bonus additional and many in-game benefits like clothing and weapons that are only limited for couples.

Upon its initial release, World Execute garnered about 2 million downloads worldwide.

Ping!

Your husband *King Explosion Murder* is online.

Izuku doesn't notice the chatbox that shows up at the edge of his screen, too busy grinding and raising his level on a solo intermediate mission. He has to defeat a monster called *Gorgon Snake*. A sly enemy with high agility and accuracy stats thus quite difficult to land hits on. The chatbox continues to resound, messages flooding at a rapid pace. He doesn't even need to see the name to realize who that player is. There could only be one person.

Victory!

When the mission finally ends, he clicks on the box and is welcomed by a dozen messages.

King Explosion Murder:

>> it’s 11 PM why are you still up?
>> are you grinding again shitty deku?
>> what a nerd.
>> let’s go on to musutafu field together.
>> i want a slime to make my raincoat.

Izuku scrolls down, in the middle of typing before another ping is heard.

>> open mic rn!!
>> come here! I wanna dungeon.

Your husband *King Explosion Murder* is requesting a call.

It takes a moment for him to activate his mic, the sign lighting up blue when he's allowed the access. There's a muffled sound on the other side of the line and some sort of mumbling saying *shitty headset keeps getting tangled.* It’s been about a year and a half since Izuku started to play the game. It’s also been more than a year since he met the other, the two of them teaming up as a duo and getting married for extra EXP and probability rates.

“WHY ARE YOU STILL AWAKE YOU NERD!?” came the voice from the other side of the line. Thankfully, Izuku had already lowered the volume settings expecting this to happen. *“Come with me. We’re going slime hunting since you don’t seem to be doing anything useful.”*

“Hi, Kacchan,” the fifteen-year-old awkwardly laughs, glancing at the map on the right-hand edge of his screen. He clicks on the red dot that indicates the other's position, the screen loading as he warps to where his partner is. “I’ll accompany you but I don’t think I can play for long. I have to go to sleep soon.”

When the screen finishes loading he's standing next to King Explosion Murder’s peculiar avatar.

“What the hell? You’re confusing… dammit,”

“Nn,” at times like these he had learned that it was better to just agree. “We’ll be moving houses tomorrow so I might not be online for a while.”

“How long’s a while?”

“About three days? I have to help mom and she’s the only one who knows how to set up the pc,”

There's silence on the other side of the line before their avatars start to run around, Izuku following suit.

“Whatever. Just make sure to return for the next event. I have four gacha tickets,”

Izuku blinks before a smile appears on his face, “Yes, Kacchan.”

“We… We can’t bring the pc with us mom?”

Behind them, the moving company is packing their furniture into boxes and loading them onto the back of their truck. Their apartment isn’t that big so it’ll only take a few hours, or so they said.

Their things are expected to arrive at their new house by tomorrow morning. Both of them on the other hand have a train to catch after this. Inko just needs to supervise the workers a bit to make sure that everything goes well before they leave.

“I’m sorry, Izuku. I’ll buy you a new one when we get to Fukuoka okay?” she knows that it's necessary for school and all. Her son most especially; spends quite a lot of time in front of the screen. "Please be patient for a bit."

Unfortunately, the reason why they couldn’t bring the pc this time was because it was getting sold. It was a dinosaur anyway, an old model Inko bought for her work five years ago. It operates well and had up-to-date software but the monitor quality is extremely bad and the keyboard is stiff hard. Since they're going to move and had the budget, she figured that it would be better to just buy a new one.

“Midoriya-san, can you please tell us which ones you don’t want us to pack?”

“Ah, yes! Coming!”

Inko turns towards the worker who is holding a box while Izuku watches her back retreat.

Just like that, eight years had passed.

“You used to play World Execute?”

Shinsou narrows his eyes at his friend who is awkwardly laughing and scratching a finger against a freckled cheek.

“I used to eight years ago,” he started when he was fourteen and played for about a year and a half. It wasn’t a long time compared to others but he almost managed to max out his level and set a few records here and there. “We moved to Fukuoka so we couldn’t bring my pc. Mom brought me a laptop but I can’t really play it there,” true, it was an MMORPG type of game so it needed a big screen and a separate keyboard. A laptop simply won’t do.

“Hmm…” Shinsou remains silent for a while before continuing. “Were you good at it?”

“I was average at it…”

Shinsou scoffs, not believing that statement for even a bit. This guy was a hard worker, a diligent and resolute one on top of that. At the age of fifteen, he's sure that Midoriya Izuku was most likely grinding away for items and levels. He just seems like *that* type of person. Then again he’s not really that shocked anymore. His classmate is good at *everything* — studying, practical tests, talking to other people, and getting on their good side… Izuku being good at games is just a no-brainer. He also got to experience his prowess at a Mario Cart tournament so...

Tsk.

“That somehow pisses me off,”

Good guys trying to be humble that is. Sorry, he isn’t like that.

If their other classmates knew about this they’d most likely use it as a reason so get closer. Izuku

might continue to deny but he was quite popular at their campus. He even made it to the secret list of *Top 10 Hot Guys You'd Want To Date*; a poll available for only females. He had good muscles and an attractive face, quite tall as well. Personality-wise Izuku was a gentleman, kind, and very sweet.

He was also at Criminology. Who wouldn't want a hot police officer as a boyfriend?

Shinsou feels angry at the fact that he can't get jealous. It's one of those *ohh yeah, these people are lucky* kind of situation. Izuku was *perfect.* He was so perfect that Shinsou couldn't even bitch about it.

Anyway.

"Sorry. Didn't mean to make you upset,"

See? What did he say?

"Do you still remember your account?"

"I have the same username and password everywhere so…"

A yes, definitely a yes, "Great, you'll be coming with me to the computer café later."

It was Izuku's first time at a computer café.

Contrary to what he had expected, the place is well-kept and very clean. There are expensive-looking computers with glowing neon CPUs under the table. The mouse and keyboards look very costly as well — the type he'd seen gamers use online. He should've expected this much at least.

"Twenty-four and twenty-three where — *ah,"*

Their seats are next to each other and Shinsou is glad to see that nobody else is around.

"Hurry up! Hurry up!" he looks excited. He's never had a friend to play the game with before. World Execute was very popular but Shinsou wasn't friendly. "Wow, you even type slow," after seeing how the other took at least three seconds with each key, the mouse slowly hovering around the screen.

By the time Izuku had finished signing in; Shinsou's screen had already completed loading sending him to Hosu City which was the JP Server's main respawning point. His avatar is an assassin type, purple hair but with cat accessories and all. Yes, that was the account he spent countless sleepless nights on.

"Umm… That's quite cute,"

"Shut up, Midoriya,"

Him liking cute things and cats was still taboo. Please do not mention it casually.

"Shinsou-kun," Izuku calls out, eyes focused on the screen as he clicks *accept, accept, accept,* and more update requests. It looks like the username and password are correct but the account is quite

outdated and old. “It says to update.”

“You really haven’t played in eight years,” Shinsou sighs after seeing the number of patches that need to be installed in Izuku’s account. There are at least twenty. Usually one wouldn’t even take a minute but with that much… “You have to wait an hour and a half for everything to finish,” it wasn’t a calculation; it was clearly written on the screen.

“Ghnn… I’ll just watch you for now,”

“Sure, why not,” Shinsou says, avatar moving around the city. “Which server do you play on anyway?”

“AP Shot!”

Ground Zero shouts; the ULT cut scene showing up before the attack full blasts at the enemy.

Victory!

“Nice team!”

“Nice! Nice!”

“Easy win —“

“Don’t say that!”

Bakugo Katsuki, age twenty-three is a professional World Execute player under UA. He has been playing for almost ten years now, his account maxed out and his avatar decked with epic custom items. He isn’t really a team player – more of a *soloist* – but they had to recruit him since the guy was freaking strong. The competition earlier was fierce, the other top team: *Shiketsu*, losing with 3-4.

“Nice Kill, bro!” Kaminari grins at Katsuki, giving him a thumbs-up before he takes off his headphones. “I died during the last minute. It’s a good thing you played as Dealer.”

“It wasn’t just during the last minute, Kami. You have 8 deaths!” Mina laughs with her arms around her stomach, leaning back her seat from too much laughter. “I only have 2 deaths. I won our bet! How’s that!?” against Shiketsu that is a rather good feat. Her character, Alien Queen, is a fighter with low defense stats after all.

“You gotta admit that we won the clash because of my epic CC though,”

“Worked because I didn’t let their assassin come close,” Sero points out, arms crossed above his chest and nodding his head.

He was the one who trapped the other team’s dealer, immobilizing him so that he couldn’t join the crowd for a few seconds to deal damage. It was a good decision on his part since that battle made them catch up 3-3. It was nerve-wracking, really.

“Good job team!” Kirishima, red-headed and tank player exclaims. He doesn't have a lot to boast since his avatar doesn't have strong attack stats nor did he have a lot of kills. Instead, he's the one

who goes at the front and ganks all the damage for his teammates. “I can’t believe we won the finals. It was a close one.”

“— IT WAS SUCH A GOOD MATCH WASN’T IT!? THIS YEAR, UA WINS! EVERYONE CLAPCLAPCLAPCLAP.”

Present Mic is on the stage speaking as an MC for the audience and for those who watched the online stream. The tournament is held in a very big hall, both teams sitting on two different booths. The game is displayed on an enormous screen from two different perspectives. It wasn’t like the players had time to look up and watch anyway. They needed to focus on the game.

Live Stream Chat:

>> Congrats UA! Clap! Clap! Clap!
>> Kaminari’s stun was soooo late during the first match LOL
>> CAMIEEEEEE-CHAN NOOOOO DON’T CRYY
>> UA’s lucky that Inasa wasn’t around this time HAHAHA
>> Nice Kill Alien Queen! Stan Pinky!
>> Team leader Bakugo tho wwwwwwwww
>>REMATCH WITH INASA! REMATCH! POLL

“Geez, can’t you be a bit happier?” Kaminari tells their teammate Katsuki, leaning over his chair since they sat next to each other. “It’s ten million yen, bro. We get two million individually.” It's good that they won but if they lost then he would’ve surely been bitter. They lost last year so this in a way was good redemption. It was also the final tournament of the season.

“Shut up. Let’s just get out of here already,” Katsuki says, taking off his headphones. “They’re so fucking loud,” the crowd which was cheering and Present Mic, that is.

“We still need to get our award—”

“THE TROPHY AND THE CHECK!”

“Take pictures as a team you know—“

“As the leader, you need to give the speech after—“

Ping!

Your husband *Deku* is online.

The system’s announcement prompts on Katsuki’s screen.

Chapter End Notes

edited: 02/08/21

world execute explained.
(1) it's a pc game, not a vr one. it's the most popular open-world game.
(2) people can communicate by letting the game have access to their mic.

(3) players can get married but the requirements eight years ago were much more lenient.

katsuki and izuku's relationship.
(1) both started to play at around thirteen or fourteen.
(2) played together for about two years. got married for the game benefits.
(3) izuku disappeared when they were both fifteen.
(4) they are both currently twenty-three years old.

inspired by a novel named *waiting for you online* by *xi he qing ling*.

pk is not allowed

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Izuku has been observing his friend play World Execute, unaware that his monitor had already finished loading and that he was receiving heaps of notifications. He didn't have his headset on to hear the chimes, too focused on Shinsou's screen, amazed by the graphics and quality. It looked like an entirely different game! More complex and complicated than what he remembered. There were more people, servers and the map was ten times bigger than it was eight years ago.

Ping!

The twenty-three-year-old blinks, glancing to check if the updates had finally finished.

You have received 999 messages.
You have 999 friend requests.

Huh? "Umm… Shinsou-kun?"

"What's up?"

He was in the middle of a quest, silently cursing his teammates inside his head because *who on earth thought it was a good idea to use three tank-type builds? Are they stupid or something?* Even though he was an assassin he had no choice but to carry with his mediocre defense. He wasn't a long-ranged fighter, dammit! At this point, they were going to lose when the loot rate was good.

GG team.

"Did it finish updating — *what* — stop clicking on things!" glancing back and forth between his and Izuku's screen.

"How do I make it stop? It keeps ringing,"

"Go to your settings and turn your friend requests and public message off,"

"Okay, uhh…"

Ping!

Your husband *Ground Zero* is requesting a call.

Izuku narrows his eyes at the notification. There's a blonde player circling his avatar, pushing him around ever so often. Above the player's name is the title *Loving Husband* in gold epic borders instead of a username. Said user is also using angry emotes, avatar huffing, and puffing every ten seconds or so.

What's wrong with this guy? Decline.

Ping!

Your husband *Ground Zero* is requesting a call.

Decline.

Ping!

“Whoa, what’s this!? The server chat is going insane,” while Izuku is in the middle of ignoring the strange player, his friend is reading through the chat boxes after losing, mostly unreadable due to how fast people were typing and sending messages. “Ah, the Hero League Tournament is today,” too lazy to read the long ones that supplied the explanation.

Your husband *Ground Zero* has sent you x100 angry emotes.

“I think it didn’t update properly, Shinsou-kun,”

“Hmm?” another clueless individual asks, naively turning towards Izuku. “Why not?”

Another barrage of pings is heard.

The convention hall is in *chaos*.

It's an understatement, really. The audience from the stands are cheering and screaming, managers on their phones, the E-Press taking photos and the internet viewers basking on online drama. It looks like streamers and game outlets are out covering the news already. News Flash: *Ground Zero Has A Husband!? True Identity Revealed In Hero League Tournament 2021!* Present Mic isn’t helping either. He's describing everything that is on the big screen above their heads.

“Maybe his account crashed?” Kirishima suggests, wondering why *Sweet Caring Husband* hasn’t replied these last ten minutes.

“His username’s been leaked, Bakugo. I think you should stop now,”

“Ack! No good! Aizawa-sensei’s glaring at us!” Mina worriedly points out, tugging on the blonde’s arm only to be shrugged away.

“You meanie! You're always like that that's why your husband doesn't like you!”

Their team leader wasn’t really listening.

“Come on, come on, come on!” Katsuki impatiently clicks away with the mouse, requesting to call every few seconds or so. He knows that there's no way the other’s account crashed. This guy is actively declining him and not even reading his messages. “Reply you fucking Deku!”

“Uhh… Team UA what about the awarding ceremony—“

“Fuck off!”

Shinsou and Izuku’s seats are basically sharing one computer booth at this point.

“Why is a ranker calling you!?”

“I don’t know!”

“He’s one of the top 50 players in Japan!” on the verge of hyperventilating, the bags under his eyes darkening even more. He takes over his friend’s mouse, deleting all the friend requests and spam with one click, hands shaking every time he sees the blonde avatar round the green-haired bunny-like character his friend had. “See what he has to say!”

Your husband *Ground Zero* gifted you *5 gold.*

What's the purpose of five gold!? Izuku has plenty of gold.

Ground Zero pauses for a second before he purchases a universal bubble and exclaims *TALK TO ME!!!*

“You know him!?”

“I’m addicted to the game and I play all night, Midoriya! He’s popular!”

Ping!

“Ack! Don’t click on it, Shinsou-kun!”

Ground Zero:

>> ??
>> !!!!!????
>> WHAT ARE YOU DOING DEKU!?
>> OPEN MIC RIGHT NOW
>> ANSWER THE FUCKING CALL

50+ messages from Ground Zero.

Izuku looks *horrified*, struggling to snatch the device from his friend, “Why did you click on it!? Now he knows we’ve read it— Shinsou-kun, don’t reply, please *no* —“

<< *Whoasd asr youuu??*
>> !????
>> ARE YOU FOR REAL!?

“Stop it!” Izuku exclaims, covering his mouth when he realizes that he raised his voice inside the computer café. Thankfully, the attention on him doesn't last long and everyone returns to their own business a few moments later. He presses his lips into a thin line, worriedly grabbing Shinsou’s arm while the other typed away on his account. “What… What if it’s a scam? We don’t know him.”

“No, this account is legit,” Shinsou replies, clicking unto Ground Zero and carefully inspecting his profile. “I know it is,” He didn’t have 1000+ hours on his account for nothing. Also, if this was a scam… What on earth were they being scammed for!?

“But… But… It’s weird that he keeps calling!”

“I can’t believe you have a ranker in your list….”

>> I’M YOUR FUCKING HUSBAND YOU DUMBASS!!!!!
>> NOW ANSWER THE FUCKING CALL!!!!!!

Shinsou narrows his eyes at the screen before sending Izuku a dirty look, “You...”

“What? What is it?” came the confused, frantic reply.

Ping!

Your husband *Ground Zero* is requesting a call.

“Anyway, you’re right. Even if he is legit, requesting a call is kind of weird,” he sighs as he clicks decline. Shinsou drags the mouse around making Deku run the other way, Ground Zero following in tow with an angry stomp. Wow, this guy is very persistent huh. “He keeps following you.”

Ping!

>> DON’T LEAVE ME FUCKING DAMMIT!!!!!

“Can’t we just log out?” Izuku asks when he finally gets the mouse back; scrolling up on the dozens of angry messages he received from Ground Zero today. “Yeah… Nn… I should log out. How do I log out?”

“Nah, we should try talking to him for a sec. He seems pretty pissed off at you,” Shinsou encourages, grabbing the keyboard to type.

<< *I think you got the wrong person, sir?*
>> NO I DID NOT. LOOK AT THE SIGN ABOVE MY HEAD.

Loving Husband indeed.

“What’s wrong with this person!?” Izuku asks; horrified at what was happening. It felt like they were dealing with a lunatic; a strange, peculiar mythical creature on the internet.

The next thing Shinsou types seems to blow the last fuse.

>> *Pls stop trolling omo*

“Let’s just block him,” Izuku suggests, figuring that it was the best solution at this point. This conversation isn’t really going anywhere. Back then he learned that it was better not to get involved with these kinds of things. “Where’s the block button, Shinsou-kun.”

“Whoa, this is kind of fun Midoriya—“

You were attacked by *Ground Zero.*
You have suffered *7800 damage* from *Ground Zero.*

“AHHHHHH — GROUND ZERO YOU —“ Shinsou stands up, fingers gripping his hair. “Midoriya, your equipment!”

You have died.

Ping!

Hosu Server Chat:

>> LOVER’S QUARREL LOL
>> WWWWWWWWWWWWWWW
>> Check the main forum news guys wahahahaha

>> PK! PK! PK! PK! PK! PK!
>> Gonna go get himself banned with PK LOL

You have used a *revival root* on *Deku.*

“Bakugo you can’t just PK anyone! That’s against the rules!”

“He was fucking pissing me off…” Katsuki clicks his tongue, a vein appearing on his forehead with how irked he currently was. Irked didn’t even cut it — he was mad, angry, annoyed, irritated, vexed. He was fucking *fuming*. Beside him Kaminari was clutching his stomach, almost falling off his chair due to too much laughter. “And I revived him so it’s fine. I’m returning his equipment when he decides to talk.”

Your husband *Deku* has been resurrected.

Deku:

<< *What’s wrong with you bitch!?*
>> DON’T YOU HAVE SOMETHING YOU WANT TO SAY TO ME????

“Ohhhh, so there’s drama after all,” someone from the other team whispers, most likely Camie.

“We should’ve expected this. It’s Bakugo after all,”

"AN UNEXPECTED PREDICAMENT! LIKE A SUDDEN DEVELOPMENT IN AN AFTERNOON DRAMA, ‘DON’T YOU HAVE SOMETHING YOU WANT TO SAY TO ME!?’ I CAN TELL THAT BAKUGO KATSUKI IS GETTING MAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAD. NOW, FROM HERE ON WE CAN ONLY —“

“They seem more interested in this than the game earlier,” Sero points out, helping Kaminari who was wheezing on the floor. “And why is Present Mic narrating this!?”

<< *Why did you kill me then resurrect me after!?*
>> I’LL DO WHAT I WANT YOU FUCKING LOSER.
<< *Who are you!?!?!?*

“You look like you’re going to explode, calm down bro,” Kirishima awkwardly laughs, patting his teammate’s shoulder. The blonde has always had an explosive personality. He’s had issues with other pro-players before but never something like this. Also, the redhead doubts that the other was thinking about this properly. He was most likely too angry to process things.

“Just give ‘em a call personally later. We’re still live you know,”

Katsuki clicks his tongue, hands continuing to type and send messages.

>> YOU DON’T RECOGNIZE ME!?
>> TRY TO FUCKING REMEMBER DEKU.
>> STUPID DEKU!!
>> WHAT DOES IT SAY ABOVE MY HEAD.

Loving Husband that's what.

“Ghh — It’s Aizawa-sensei,” Mina who was laughing a few seconds ago seems to have settled down quietly. Kaminari, Sero, and Kirishima as well; they silently observed their instructor who was walking towards their group, glancing warily at each other.

“Bakugo,” Aizawa calls out, his shadow looming from behind the team leader’s seat. “Stop for now. You’re still on the screen.”

“I don’t fucking care,”

As expected.

Team UA sweatdrops, sinking unto their seats for what was about to go down.

“You know how it works,” the man starts, sighing and rubbing the bridge of his nose. “The viewers might see private information,” not regarding Katsuki but on the player he is talking to. The internet is a very scary place. If there are enough clues, many would be able to figure out private details regarding a person’s identity. Personal conversations should be kept private, not streamed live on the Hero League Tournament Finals.

“Hurry up before I unplug this entire set-up,”

A rather terrifying threat. Aizawa is clearly telling Katsuki not to cause any more trouble.

The blonde remains silent for a while before he grits his teeth, typing one last time.

>> YOU BETTER BE ONLINE ON SAME TIME TOMORROW OR ELSE!!

Your husband *Ground Zero* is offline.

“He’s gone,” Shinsou blinks, hands hovering above the keyboard ready for war. “That… That was something.”

“I can’t believe you cursed at him, Shinsou-kun,” a shivering Izuku says, completely shaken up by what just happened. Was this really his account? He’s never met that player before. No matter how much he thought about it, the name just wasn’t familiar. It didn't ring a bell. “I don’t think I’ll be able to play games again. That was too eventful.”

“Leave it to me. I’m a loser in real life but I won’t lose online,”

“Ah, your hobby, yes,”

Shinsou grins, moving the mouse so that Deku could run around the field. It was also then he noticed something peculiar about his friend’s account.

“Your level is already maxed out even though you haven’t played in 8 years?” LVL. 300 with insane stats on top of that. It was impossible to reach that level without being an extreme nerd that dedicated all their time to gaming. Professionals were understandable since it was their jobs but… “What the fuck…” truth to be told he couldn’t really blame the other. He himself saw the patch updates earlier. If it was a recently used account it wouldn’t have that much downloads.

“I don’t know as well!” Izuku reasons out, knowing that he hasn’t lied to Shinsou throughout this entire ordeal once. “I really haven’t played in a long time! Maybe I got hacked or something…”

“You’re telling me that World Execute who was made by renowned programmers like Aizawa Shouta-san and Mirai Sasaki-san would allow hackers — Your reason is hackers…”

“Wha — What else could it have been?”

Shinsou remains silent, clicking on Deku to examine his profile. Aside from the maximized level, the other peculiar thing was the old outdated collector’s item equipment in his inventory. Many try to get their hands on those, serving more as a collection rather than gear. He scrolls through the friends list — Deku only has 17 which is not a lot. Above the skills which the avatar possessed, the status *Married* is visibly displayed and *Spouse: Ground Zero* directly next to it.

He glances at Izuku who looks worried and confused, silently mumbling as if he realized something, “He’s not the one I married though…”

“If you haven’t played in eight years then you haven’t deleted anything, right?”

“Nn…”

He clicks on the chatbox that closed, maximizing it so that it covered half of the screen.

Ground Zero - offline -

>> YOU BETTER BE ONLINE SAME TIME TOMORROW OR ELSE!!
>> *9,999+ messages*

“You’re telling me that you’ve maxed out the chat with someone you don’t know?”

Quite suspicious, actually.

“Try scrolling up,” Shinsou advises before he gives the mouse back.

Chapter End Notes

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terminology explained.
(1) PK - stands for *player kill.*
(2) it's considered bad to PK because killed players drop the equipment and items they have.
(3) it's basically a form of looting.

bakubro, pls don't pk even if you're mad.

what's your phone number?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“You look troubled, Midoriya,”

Shinsou points out, the both of them sitting on a bench inside the campus. Perhaps it's a side effect of the caffeine Izuku had been drinking since yesterday. He looks tired and hyper at the same time. Or maybe he didn’t get enough sleep? It's almost as if he’d been up all night studying and it wasn’t even exam week yet. Ah, if it wasn’t those two then it was definitely due to what they discovered yesterday.

“Still concerned about Ground Zero?”

Izuku presses his lips into a thin line, fingers weaving flustered.

“Understandable,” the purple-haired male nods, eyes focused somewhere else. “I mean… it’s kind of a dick move.”

Yes, they’ve already established that yesterday. Apparently, almost 10,000 messages had been accumulated from *Loving Husband* over the past eight years he had been offline. They’ve read through most of them and it was easy to figure out what was the problem.

“Do you…” hasn’t really seen or known *Ground Zero* slash *King Explosion Murder* in real life but for some reason, he feels kind of… *nervous?* After he remembered what happened years ago, Izuku had been struck with the worst existential crisis he’s ever had in his entire life. “Do you think that he’ll understand if I apologize now?”

“Well, he continued sending you messages for the last eight years…”

“I have work at four…” another problem he has and at this point, he's ready to rip his hair out.

Midoriya Izuku is known amongst his circle of friends for being kind, caring, and considerate. He has always been the type to help others in need. The type you’d gladly introduce to other people; not really a social butterfly but not very introverted either. He was reliable, responsible, and a friend who you’d want to be around for long term.

But the thing is… although virtual. Leaving your husband isn’t really caring or considerate, is it?

Has… Has he always been this kind of asshole!? He didn’t mean to ignore those messages, really!

Doomed. He was definitely *doomed*. Even Shinsou who wasn’t knowledgeable in human relationships said that it was a dick move. It was safe to say that the guilt was eating him inside out.

“That’s kinda sad then,” the other just had to say. “I bet he’ll get angrier…”

It’s fine if he got angry actually…

“Or wait you out,”

Please no. He should’ve sent a message yesterday but they’ve already left before he remembered.

“That… That joke does not make me feel any better,” it made him feel anxious and *scared,* made him feel like he was the worst person in the entire world. He knew that this was nothing because apparently Ground Zero’s been waiting for him for eight whole years — he’s read the messages so he knew – but alas, it was still just as bad.

It was so bad he could feel a headache coming. Oh, maybe a fever as well. Add a stomach ache on top of that. He was *that* anxious.

“It wasn’t a joke,” because apparently, Shinsou feels kind of guilty for playing around with the keyboard yesterday. He's partly to blame for the bad reunion. It should’ve been more dramatic and emotional now that he knew the back story. “What time do you get out?”

“Nine,”

“You’re dead, good luck,” he sends his friend the most pitiful look he could muster and slowly shook his head. “Poor Loving Husband.”

“Shinsou-kun!” Izuku all but groans, the birds at his feet flying away due to his volume.

“Stop making me more guilty, please…”

Team UA lives in one place, a share house provided by the company.

Everyone agreed and had no problems with it. Their job is to play games and stream so most of the time they spend is inside their rooms. Also, practice is easier when their teammates are around. Content-wise, there’s never a dull moment. They could get up whenever they want and it's always a fun time with other people around. The house is huge and the company is pretty generous with their salary as well. It's paradise on land for gamers, really.

“Bakugo’s still stuck in his room playing?” Mina pouts, hugging a pillow close to her chest as she skims through the channels on TV trying to find E-Sports. She knows that there's one but she forgot which it was. “He's not even streaming. He hasn’t even come down for breakfast or lunch either.”

“Isn’t that bad?” Sero asks, remembering how food-conscious the blonde was. “Wasn’t he working out and stuff?”

You know, carbs, protein, and all. Katsuki is *very* strict with his diet.

Kirishima awkwardly laughs, “Right? I think it’s better to leave him be though. You know how he is.”

“Scary…”

“Yep, really scary,”

“Must be nice... having someone,” Kaminari complains, peeking at the fridge to see if they have something to eat. As usual, there's none. It's all healthy stuff since Bakugo is the one in charge of groceries and most of the cooking. Actually, Mina might have some junk food in her room. He’d have to ask her later. “Isn’t it kind of difficult to get married? You have to find rare items for

wedding rings and stuff."

"Almost impossible, yeah," Mina nods; remembering what players have to go through to achieve the status. Marriage sounds nice, shared EXP and all but the items needed for it was stupidly rare. "Would you rather use diamond ore for an accessory or equipment?"

"Screw marriage, we craft!" Kaminari declares, not even bitter now that he's realized the circumstances.

The marriage function has always been part of World Execute ever since it has been established as a game.

Although it gave benefits like loot bonuses, limited equipment, and shared EXP; the items and missions in order to get married are extremely difficult.

First of all, you need to be at least LVL. 50 – a rather high baseline eight years ago since the LVL. MAX was 100. Currently, LVL. 120 was the requirement, LVL. MAX 300 due to the developments and progress made over time. The level restriction, in a way, was the main problem.

Second, the items are *extremely* rare. In order to create a wedding ring, one needs Mythril Ore, the rarest kind of ore in World Execute. It sold for an extremely high price and if successfully forged, could create high level mythic or epic grade weapons. A wedding ring wasn't the only thing needed as well. The pair needs to create their own ceremony; have at least 30 players attend the one-minute event and drink Hephaestus' Wine afterward, an S-Class rare ingredient that would have players with the cook occupation rolling on their graves.

They also have to gather 20-star fragments in order to get the Goddess' blessing and have her officiate the wedding. For the missions, the couple needs to find the great sage and priest, prove their love and fervor by defeating quests as a duo, and double-team weekly quiz events. Izuku and Katsuki found themselves up till two am just to find a Gorgon Snake to kill.

Anyway, with the amped-up difficulty and more NPCs, nowadays getting married was very rare.

"Would you mind checking these, Midoriya?"

"Ah yes, of course, Torino-sensei,"

A stack of papers is placed on top of the desk, the elderly man grabbing his jacket and bag before heading towards the door. Izuku had been working as Torino Sorahiko's assistant ever since he entered college. He happened to see the post on the bulletin board and landed on a lucky spot. It was a coincidence how the man was also one of his subject teachers during the day.

"Just finish what you can. It's already gotten so late,"

"Hai…" Izuku softly replies, skimming through the stack. It would definitely take quite a long

time. It's worth four sections and everything was written in essay form, a report.

“You know where the keys are,” Torino says, his assistant nodding in reply. “Don’t stay up working so much.”

“See you tomorrow, sensei,”

9:47 P.M.

“Stupid Deku…” Katsuki mumbles under his breath, glaring at the screen in front of him. His avatar had been running around doing quests and all. It’s almost been five hours as well. Was he getting stood up again? Was that what was happening? For some reason, he could feel the heat—*anger*, pool in the pit of his stomach. “ARGHHHHHHHHHHHHHH!!!!!!!!”

“AP Shot!” Ground Zero exclaims, soloing an A-ranked Quest.

Ping!

Victory!

Blue Lagoon Quest Ranks

1. Ground Zero and Deku
2. Ground Zero
3. Bellax, SnowFairy0, Ulmioo, Sann…

Ranks were based on time records, the fastest on top. Even though Katsuki’s avatar was strong, no matter how much he tried he still couldn’t beat their score from eight years ago. Were they *that* good? He could remember staying up all night with Deku but he couldn’t remember them actually pressuring themselves for the numbers. All they wanted was the loot and satisfaction. Back then he played World Execute for fun but now…

“Who the fuck does he think he is?” a snarl through gritted teeth, clicking away on the keyboard.

“Fucking Deku —“

Number 17. Where’s number 17?

“Ah, there it is,”

Izuku slowly walks towards the booth, glad that there wasn’t anyone next to him or on the same row. It was pretty late so there weren’t a lot of customers but the good thing about the city is that almost everything is open 24/7, whether it is convenience stores or computer cafes. He places his bag on the seat next to him, mouse gliding on top of the desk as he searched for the familiar game shortcut. Almost all of the pcs have World Execute installed on them — it was *that* popular of a game.

The screen changed, loading after he logged in on his account.

It was currently a few minutes past ten and he knew that he was extremely late but he still wanted to check, maybe leave a message or two.

Ping!

You have received *14* messages.
Your husband *Ground Zero* is online.

Oh no. This was literally his worst nightmare becoming true. He doesn't want to get ahead of himself though. This guy's a professional player, this was his job. Of course, he'd be playing the game. He wasn't waiting for Izuku or anything. How entitled of him to assume that… right? He'd hope so at least. His heart almost dropped when a few seconds later, a blonde avatar with the title *Loving Husband* warped to where he was.

For other players, they'd usually see the username but he was the only exception of course. Izuku really should've been calm and stopped Shinsou from turning into a keyboard warrior yesterday. How should he even explain himself?

Click. Click. Click.

"I'm so sorry for being late, Kacchan —"

You were attacked by *Ground Zero.*
You have suffered *9200 damage* from *Ground Zero.*
You have died.

Again!? The same thing happened to him yesterday.

Izuku awkwardly laughs.

Ground Zero:

>> !!
<< *I'm so sorry for being late, Kacchan.*
<< *I was at work.*

***Ground Zero* used *revival root* on you.**

>> i wanna talk.
>> open mic right now. don't fucking run away.

Izuku's hand nervously clicks on the keyboard wondering what he should reply. Truth be told, he doesn't want to open mic, there's a headset in front of him but he doubts that'd be sufficient. Also, that meant he'd be talking out loud in here. There were only a handful of customers so he'd definitely stand out. Then again, the other can only adjust so much for him. He already made him wait.

Maybe he'll try talking about it once and if he insists then he'll agree.

<< *I'm sorry. I won't run away, Kacchan.*
<< *I don't think we can call, I'm at an internet café.*
<< *Were you waiting for me?*

At least Katsuki's not typing in all caps now.

>> I WASN'T!!
>> WE'LL JUST FUCKING TYPE THEN.

He takes that back.

Kacchan…

Your husband *Deku* has sent you x100 crying emotes.
Your husband *Deku* has sent you x20 dogeza emotes.

Kacchan…

"Shitty nerd…" Katsuki mumbles, tightly gripping the mouse. Izuku *remembers.* Now this seems more like the person he knew. At first he wondered if the other changed over the past eight years since yesterday it seemed like he was talking to a war freak but apparently not. It made him ponder and remain silent for a bit, watching the chat box toggle the other's typing.

Ping!

Deku:

>> I'm so sorry I didn't recognize you last time.
>> Your username changed.
<< *you finally remember me?*

True, he did change his username from *King Explosion Murder* to *Ground Zero*. It was getting embarrassing to use that kind of name, or so his management said. It was something he thought of when he was fourteen, a childish title. They said that he needed something more professional if he wanted to be on online streams and participate in tournaments. He had an image to uphold and a username was part of that.

>> Yes. You're Kacchan right? Katsuki?

"And you're Deku because you mistyped your name Izuku,"

The blonde scoffs, leaning back his seat, watching the other's avatar run around and do emotes near his. He doesn't know what surname the other has. Izuku has always been quite guarded and cautious online, careful not to share anything too personal — like his phone number, surname, address, and stuff.

Katsuki's hands hovered above the keyboard before he slowly started to type.

Ping!

Ground Zero:

>> you didn’t even say goodbye.

A statement that made Izuku freeze.

It made him guilty and sorry at the same time but he wasn’t really sure what kind of attitude he should show to his — *haven’t seen in eight years* — in-game husband. What kind of answer should he give? Was Katsuki feeling mad? Sad? It was most likely the former, or so he assumed. Then again, the message he got was kind of solemn. He also read the past messages the other sent while he was offline.

>> we were supposed to attend the summer event together.

The thing they’ve been preparing for two weeks. They went to dungeons to train, gathered items and potions so that they had enough supply during the hunt. They even registered during the first day of March, too excited since the reward was *Mirror Glass,* a 30% buff item that could only be obtained by married couples.

<< Kacchan! I’m so sorry!
<< I know I promised but a lot has happened.
<< Yesterday was the first time I logged in after such a long time. I was accompanying a friend.

Shinsou, to be more exact —

The cause of the reunion and also the cause of why said reunion flopped.

>> you said you’ll get back after a few days.
<< Mom didn’t bring the pc when we moved.
<< She brought me a laptop as a replacement but I can’t play pc games there.

Yes, reason your way out Izuku. It almost felt like they were arguing with how fast they replied to each other, avatars completely still to focus on typing.

>> but I also gave you my cellphone number.
>> you didn't use it.

Ah, that’s right. Katsuki did give his personal number to him. Was he waiting for a call?

<< Sorry!!!
<< I’m so sorry!!!

You sent x20 dogeza emotes to *Ground Zero.*

<< Have you been playing these last eight years?
<< Why didn’t you divorce me?? I wasn’t active…

Katsuki’s typing stopped all of a sudden before it returned a few seconds later and stopped again.

It almost felt like something was going to happen and indeed, for the second time of the day —

You were attacked by *Ground Zero.*
You have suffered *9200 damage* from *Ground Zero.*

“Ahh—no!” he already lost his armor, at this rate he’d be left with just his avatar’s underwear on.

You have died.

“I can’t believe this guy…” Katsuki complains with a scowl on his face, a bit out of character even for him. It wasn’t an angry scowl; it was one that screamed *I’m upset.* Inside the darkroom the screen reflected off his eyes, frowning at the dead avatar of his husband. He wasn’t even going to help him at this point. There was a thirty-second countdown so for now he ought to use that to gather his thoughts.

Ping!

Deku:

>> I’m so sorry!!! Sorry!

Your husband *Deku* has respawned.

<< will you be active from now on?

His fingers tap on the desk, waiting for a reply. Unexpectedly, the one he got was quite disappointing and pathetic.

<< I don’t know. I have school and work.

This again… He was tired of it all dammit!

>> GIVE ME YOUR NUMBER THEN SHITTY DEKU.
>> SO FUCKING USELESS.

“Did something come up?” Kaminari asks, noticing how their leader frequently checked his phone these past few days. “He’s never paid attention before.”

“Maybe he’s looking at our schedule,”

“Maybe he got scolded by management again,”

“Maybe…” Mina smiles, girl senses tingling. “Maybe it’s his husband.”

Chapter End Notes

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oh no, izuku's not done repenting of course.
katsuki will take advantage of that phone number.

a whole lot of pining up next.

i'll show you around

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

At nine-thirty pm, Izuku finds himself at the computer café again. He's been going daily for almost a week now, black frame glasses sitting on the bridge of his nose. It made the girls who passed by glance and giggle from time to time so he must have looked like a nerd, or so he assumed. He doesn't have time to think about that for now though. He's on a quest, *they're* on a quest. Both he and Kacchan are on their way to their village to reset his spawn point – a patch they did a few years ago.

He drags his mouse around, Deku running around town, following Ground Zero towards the gate so that they could go to another place. It was either they walked – *and slay monsters while they were at it* – or buy a teleportation gem. They had enough money so surely…

Cling! Cling!

"What's that!?" Izuku stares at the animal that was summoned by the other's *Clear Bell.*

"A horse!?"

Your husband *Ground Zero* invites you to ride together.

Ground Zero:

> << *Where'd you get that, Kacchan?*
> >> they give them out during daily rewards.
> >> 7 day login reward.

"Things like these can happen in-game now!?" he asks himself while accepting the request, Deku sitting right in front of Ground Zero who was holding the reins. The sight almost made him laugh, their two avatars on one horse that is. "*Maybe I haven't claimed mine. I've logged in for seven days now… I think."*

Musutafu wasn't that far off but the road was full of bandits and monsters. Having an animal summon made it so that those things could be avoided and repelled. Although it was slower than a teleportation gem, the map and scenery made the journey interesting. From time to time they'd stop to kill slimes – low-level monsters but with useful drops for things like raincoats and potions. Other people were on the side of the road as well, camping and grinding for buffs.

A few villains would try to PK but Ground Zero was way too strong for them.

Please choose your enemies wisely next time.

> << *Kacchan, I also want a horse.*
> >> i said log in for 7 days.

Izuku had already logged in for seven days though.

Scroll. Scroll. Scroll. "But it's not here!?"

Izuku groans at the sight of apple, apple, apple, *golden apple,* apple, apple, *big apple,* apple, apple.

Maybe he should just wait it out? He oo-hed in realization when he saw it at the bottom of the pile, his avatar happily rejoicing when he received the Clear Bell. Animal companions were selected *randomly* it seemed. Katsuki got a horse today but next week he might get a bird or something.

You have acquired *Clear Bell!*

>> i'll show you around.

Katsuki said when they arrived at Musutafu, the two of them still on top of the horse. As odd as the scenery looked, there were also a few players who were in the same state – with different animals that is. One was riding on top of a very big hamster actually. Also, the other players didn't look like they cared. The universal bubbles they saw were all unrelated and random.

You sent x10 blush emotes to *Ground Zero.*

<< *It's like a date www*

Izuku blinks when the horse all of a sudden stops and –

Ping!

***Ground Zero* sent you x100 angry emotes.**

"Ehh? Why is he mad?" after seeing how the other's avatar growl and fume red.

<< *Kacchan! That guy has red wings!*
>> it's his quirk.
<< *Does that mean he can fly with his settings?*
>> yeah.
<< That's so cool!
>> *he ain't that strong. that's all he can do.*

You have arrived at *Musutafu Subdivision.*
You and *Ground Zero* have dismounted.

"It's a subdivision now!?" completely taken aback. Their village looked like his hometown actually. It looked quite modern and accurate to life. "Wasn't this supposed to be a *town!?*" filled with nothing but weeds and grass? They brought their lot here since it was cheap. Izuku remembered how much trouble they went through with the weeding and building, how they ground for wood and straw, going to blacksmiths for metal wires and equipment.

What happened to the paddy fields… those were his favorite actually.

It was a good source for frogs which sold for 2000 g.

There were buildings, parks, apartment complexes and –

<< *That's the training ground!? IT LOOKS LIKE A SCHOOL.*
>> can't go in. only beginners allowed.

"That's kinda nostalgic," Aldera Training Ground which was currently *Aldera Training School.*

Newcomers would spawn in that area as a tutorial before the actual game. Izuku remembers being trash-talked badly at that place since he didn't have a quirk at first. He trained a lot though and

triggered a legendary event that made him receive the NPC All Might's quirk, *One for All.* It was rare back in the day so he wondered if it was still the same now.

Mutusafu Live Chat:

>> Ground Zero's here OMG!
>> @*Ground Zero, @Deku* SPOTTED!!!
>> Wifey @*Deku* www wwwww
>> Send proof pls @*softserve @22_jado*
>> FREE GIFTS LINK IN BIO —> VISIT PAGE

"Ah, Kacchan where are you going?" as he tries to follow Ground Zero down the street, rounding a corner before stopping right in front of a really big house.

Hmm? This place is?

>> it's our house.
<< *!?*

Deku makes a rather shocked, pseudo-adorable reaction.

"This mansion!? Didn't we live in a hut!?"

Their house used to be mediocre to boot!

Their levels were rather high back then but they certainly weren't artistic fifteen-year-olds. Also, with their settings, a hut was the most luxurious thing normal players who didn't spend money in-game could build. Times have changed it seemed. Was it his imagination or was theirs the biggest he's seen in this subdivision so far? They were *rich?* And he was married to a *celebrity!?*

Izuku stares at the infrastructure in front of him, *dumbfounded.* Indeed, written on the nameplate is *Ground Zero & Deku*, the rightful owners of said house.

It felt like he was living off his husband's money, to be honest…

Izuku wasn't a gold digger!

He really wasn't!

<< *But we're poor????*
<< *We used to live on a field, Kacchan??*
>> it's the same one. i just fixed it.

"That... That's so cool…" because a stable income and a house impress *everyone.*

And by *everyone,* Izuku is included in that.

You sent *Ground Zero* x100 grateful emojis.

Katsuki's lips slightly curl up at the screen right in front of him, watching Deku run around the house.

It's more so a grin than a smile but oh well...

Ping!

Deku:

>> WE HAVE A KITCHEN!?

Ping!

>> AND A POOL!?

You received x10 loving emojis from *Deku.*

"You…" Shinsou starts off, narrowing his eyes at his friend in a judging manner. They met up for lunch and very rarely – *as broke college students* – did they go out of school to eat. "You've been on your phone an awful lot lately," sometimes even during class. From time to time he'd also see the other look at it while they're walking down the street. It had never been that frequent before. It almost seemed like the person he was talking to was kind of *clingy.*

"I feel left out," quite a sad admission before adding, "Did you get a girlfriend?"

"Wha— It's not a girlfriend, Shinsou-kun!" Izuku exclaims, trying to defend his virtue which in this case is a bit unclear. The guy had never dated anyone before so being suspected that he was – *although flattering* – made him flustered to the core. "He's just a friend…" fingers shyly fiddling with each other, Shinsou looking bored as ever. Despite being a big guy, Izuku acted like a school girl sometimes.

"So it's not a woman but a man," said friend nods, trying to process the thought. "Hmm…"

"W-What?" he squirms under the other's inspecting gaze.

"Suspicious…" Shinsou declares, taking a bite of his sandwich, chewing for a few seconds before, "Midoriya Izuku, you're suspicious."

"Kacchan and I just started talking again, that's all,"

"Ahh, Loving Husband. Bakugo Katsuki?"

"You know him!?" a rather loud declaration that made a few people glance towards their direction. Izuku opened his mouth to speak but no words came out. More than feeling shocked, he felt oddly *betrayed*. "H-How? But he's – You know Kacchan's real name!?" wasn't that supposed to be something *private!?* How would Shinsou know?

"I was the one who told you he's a ranker, stupid," referring to the last time he interfered at the computer café. He's been playing World Execute for almost four years now, quite regularly as well so he'd say he knew quite a lot of things. "Ground Zero's not just a professional. He streams and does game plays so of course, I know his name. He's *everywhere* online."

"Wha — I knew he was a ranker and a professional since you told me but – "

Shinsou nods in response, not letting Izuku finish, “You didn’t know that he streamed, is that it?”

“This…” Shinsou places his phone right in front of his friend.

“This is what your husband looks like.”

Izuku’s eyes glistened in excitement as he stared at the photo.

“He used to scold me for being on my phone way too much,”

Kaminari grumbles to Mina, remembering those days his phone got confiscated. Apparently, he was using Twitter excessively, or so that’s what their team leader said. Mina would’ve retorted that Katsuki wasn’t leaking unreleased work information in his account unlike Kaminari but then again, she was also kind of intrigued. If this guy out of all people said that you were on your phone a lot, something was up.

“Look where he is right now,”

“I know,” she nods, eyes focused on the blonde sitting across the room. “Hella sus.”

Deku:

> <<*what are you doing right now?*
> >> I’m in class, Kacchan!
> *<< are you playing later?*
> >> Hehehe ofc. see you later!

Unbeknownst to him, two of his teammates had already approached and surrounded the chair he was sitting on; looking over his shoulder to see what he was he was typing. He immediately clicked his tongue and hid the device close to his chest, glaring at the pair for trying to invade his privacy. They both don’t look discouraged, already too used to their team leader’s antics. This in a way was more important.

The suspense was *killing* them alright.

“We wanna know! It’s *Sweet Caring Husband,* right!? What do you guys talk about!?”

“Deku! Isn’t that his username!? We already know who he is so show us!”

“It’s none of your business!”

Because apparently, Katsuki’s love life was more intriguing than any other drama there was.

“How much wood do you fucking need!?”

Katsuki complains out loud, tapping away with the space bar of his keyboard.

Ground Zero looks angry on screen all the while chopping wood with his axe, horned rabbits intimidated and fleeing. He knew that Izuku couldn’t hear him. There’s no way he could, they both had their mics off since the other played World Execute in a computer café. Communication would’ve been easier if Izuku had his own pc at home but that wasn’t the case.

“How many more fucking trees do we need to – “

Ping!

Deku:

>> Is Chargebolt is your teammate? He sent me a friend request and a PM.

And it was quite easy to spot among his notifications since his name had a verified badge next to it.

Katsuki grits his teeth because uck those teammates of his. He already told them to mind their own business! He should really give them a thorough *lecture* later, Kaminari most especially. He was getting very nosy nowadays.

<< *ignore that! don’t accept random people’s requests without telling me.*
>> Ehhhhhhhhhh?????
>> no fair!!

“Come here,”

Ground Zero runs around the map waving his axe in default. Deku sends a shocked emote before he retreats, seemingly having the wrong idea. A few seconds later Katsuki receives a stream of messages from the other saying *NO PK! NO PK! REPORT PK!* Why does he think that he was going to kill him, dammit! Ground Zero pauses in his place, Deku turning and pausing out of curiosity as well.

You sent *Deku* x445 *wood.*

>> KACCHAN!!!!!!!!!
>> !!

***Deku* has sent you x100 grateful emotes.**
You sent *Deku* x100 angry emotes.

>> Thank you!
>> All I need is a Wind Orb now! Recruit party!

Katsuki’s lips press into a thin line before it turned into a frown.

It's no secret that Katsuki absolutely *hates* parties.

His group was an exception since that was something related to work and even then – *in the beginning* – they had so much trouble getting along and cooperating. He was more of a *solo* player; it's always been that way ever since he started playing World Execute at the age of thirteen, ten years ago. Coincidentally, a few months after he started, he met Deku who later on became his partner – *since then and until now* – and together they formed a duo.

As to why he hated parties there was only one reason – they fucking *talk* too much.

And it wasn't just talking either. The extras are brave enough to *talk back.*

In summary, he hated getting bossed around. He also hated people who were full of themselves.

Although some would argue that *he* was the problem. Katsuki has a pretty dirty mouth during gameplay. He also demanded *impossible* requests during fights – do *this,* do *that,* why are you so fucking slow, and *WHERE'S YOUR FUCKING ULT, YOU PATHETIC DUMBASS.* Not a lot of people could stand him, really. His current group was just getting used to him actually. They were a complete *disaster* at first.

At that time, Deku who was both patient and kind proved to be the perfect companion.

"You hate partying during casual mode! Why are you partying during casual mode!?"

Kaminari asks with a shaking voice over the mic, his avatar *Chargebolt* warping over to Musutafu where Ground Zero and Deku were. Unfortunately, this guy was the only one in his professional team who was currently online. He'd rather party with someone he knew than someone completely unknown. They needed four people for a Difficult Quest – the only way for Izuku to find a Wind Bell.

Since they were married, the drop would definitely be higher so it was most likely that they'd find it during their first or second try.

Ground Zero didn't reply, muting his teammate's shrieks.

Ping!

Party Chat:

> **Deku:**
> >> My friend will be arriving soon!
> >> He's just trying to find a teleportation crystal since he's in Hosu right now.
> **Chargebolt:**
> >> AASDASLDKASSDKASJDALSDJKALS
> >> SWEET CARING HUSBAND
> >> DUDE HI
> >> Can I send you a friend request O///O??
> >> I THINK I ALREADY SENT YOU A FRIEND REQUEST???

Ping!

***Yummycat* has joined your party.**

The guy who arrived looked like an assassin of some sort, a scarf wrapped around his neck equipped with an epic rank purple house cat apron. It was a very rare item but it sure did not look like it. Contrary to how flimsy it looked, it actually had legendary DEF stats.

Yummycat:

>> Where is my summoner?

Deku's avatar started to dance around.

Chapter End Notes

edited: 02/11/21

kaminari and shinsou, the two meme lords meet.
it's going to be a party chaos all for the sake of a mere wind bell.

sweet caring husband

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Katsuki is really not good with parties.

He'll say it a second time for emphasis, okay?

He's really *not* good with parties.

The noise has always been his main problem. Many say that what's lacking is his personality but he manages to get along with Izuku so maybe they're *all* wrong. Others seem to be more sensitive than his partner when it comes to this *getting along* thing and that was saying something. He knows that Deku is a big crybaby, a scaredy-cat – at least he was eight years ago. He doesn't know what changed over the past few years they haven't talked to each other and… and here's the *second* point.

Yummycat is *annoying.*

The guy doesn't say a lot but the way he's too carefree around *his* husband is making his palms itch.

"Dude! You have a lightning quirk like me!?"

Kaminari is an airhead so he doesn't count.

"Uhh… I think it's a strengthening quirk..." the other corrects over the mic, his tone deadpan. Yummycat is standing next to the body of a dead nomu, drops of blood staining his Epic grade cat apron. There's a scarf, a capture weapon, wrapped around his neck and Katsuki thinks that he looks bored, lacking sleep almost. "At least that's what he told me. Right, Deku?"

Izuku enthusiastically nods at the question.

Ping!

Sedun dnes

Deku:

>> It's called One for All!

Katsuki almost facepalms because *why are you telling them that, shitty nerd?*

Then again, the two are probably unaware of the fact that the quirk came from All Might himself. Back in the day, it was rare but right now it was basically considered *Legendary.* The NPC went from a secret quest character *to gacha, you only have a 0.5% chance of meeting me* because he apparently defeated the demon king and returned to find a successor. Katsuki didn't know what to do with this information when it was announced.

Even World Execute made an official statement saying that apparently, All Might already has a successor. Nevertheless, no one knew who that successor was – *except for Katsuki, of course* – because said successor had been offline for the past eight years. They would've stood out for sure

if they played. They might even get scouted by a few teams here and there. All for One was *that* big of a cheat.

“Isn’t it a pain to type?” Kaminari asks, a bit intrigued. “Just plug in your headset, open mic and let’s go, bro!”

Just as the chat toggles, Shinsou opens his mouth and says,

“He probably can’t ‘cause he’s too shy. He’s in a computer café right now.”

While the other three are in their humble abodes, comfortable and leaning back their seats.

“He can only play until ten. His apartment is way too far from the café,"

Why the fuck do you know that?

Shinsou grins when he sees red eyes glare at him, “Let’s go find that wind orb.”

This guy…

“Psst!” Kaminari calls out, falling behind so that he’s walking next to his teammate. “Your alpha is leaking,” some sort of slang for a dog or something. He doesn’t know where this kid gets these words. For someone who had low grades in high school, his vocabulary sure is pretty wide.

“You should really tone it down,” is what he says a few seconds later and Katsuki can feel his blood start to boil.

“Fuck off, Pikachu,”

“A great philosopher once said,” Kaminari clears his throat with a cough. “Thank you, next.”

Shinsou frowns because, “I’m pretty sure that’s Ariana Grande – “

Also, Kaminari, even if you whisper it’s open-mic you know.

“The point is that we need to move on,” everyone’s confused, really. Is this supposed to be some sort of uhh…. Advice? If so, for what?

“Don’t get let the alpha leak, Bakubro,"

And then he retreats to the front with this flowy step, repeating, “Don’t let the alpha leak.”

Katsuki stares confused because, “The fuck are you talking about!?”

“What do you even need a wind orb for?”

Deku:

> >> I’m making a windmill.
> >> The website guide said that I needed it to activate my quirk.

Kaminari frowns, “Isn’t it already activated though?”

The World Execute website basically has a consulting page for quirks in courtesy of the rare, epic, unique, and legendary ones that do not have tutorials to follow online. It contains details about the quirk one possesses, a guide in PDF format. There's a code needed for each quirk to access the one you have, a precautionary measure for leaks. Real money circulates in the game after all.

"Is it not working?" because it was definitely working earlier. "You mean that's *not* complete!?"

Yummycat is baffled. Deku shrugs his shoulders.

>> It was written on the website.
>> I'm just following instructions.

"You…" purple-eyes narrow at Deku before Yummycat sighs over the mic. "Why am I even shocked?"

Katsuki is leaning back on his seat, silently threading after the trio when he hears a sound go off.

Ping!

Deku:

>> You alright, Kacchan?
>> I'm sorry we had to join a party. Your friend is here but do you still not like parties?
>> Let's do this fast and get the orb!
>> Make me Katsudon for my HP when we get back!

His fingers tap against his desk and he stares at the screen for a while before he sits up, clicking away.

Truth to be told, if it weren't for Izuku he would've been blasting these extras a long time ago.

Victory!

"Are we amazing or what!?" Kaminari cheers, Yummycat's avatar looking baffled. "A new record!"

New Record Set by
Chargebolt, Deku, Ground Zero, and Yummycat.
Team Sedun dnes
Time: 00:28:10:19

The only regret he has is that goddamn team name.

Ping!

“Ah, it’s here…”

Shinsou watches a message pop-up, not saying anything since he’s on the line. DMs are supposed to be private after all. They had just finished the quest and are now currently heading back to Musutafu. It’s not like he has a quest to do so might as well pester these two. Kaminari seems to have the same idea as well, too curious about Sweet Caring Husband.

“Took you a bit longer than I expected,"

Ground Zero:

>> oi.
>> what’s your relationship with deku?

Shinsou’s fingers click against the keyboard as he smoothly types out –

<< *We go to the same university.*
<< *Why?*
>> the fuck? which school?

Ahhh… Bakugo Katsuki is really predictable.

<< *I dunno, why don’t you ask him yourself.*
>> shitty nerd doesn’t tell me anything.

Shinsou blinks before he laughs.

Katsuki doesn’t know what to do with this information.

That guy Yummycat was annoying as hell but he got valuable information from him – mainly Deku’s surname.

His fucking *surname.*

One fact is that Katsuki already knows that Deku’s given name is *Izuku,* written with the kanji that can be read as *come out,* the second character *long time*. He still remembers that because they’ve talked about it before when they were still teens and he read it wrong thus the nickname. It’s a bit ironic as well because he really did come out after such a long time – eight years to be more exact. Yummycat probably gave him the surname thinking *there’s a ton of Midoriya in Japan anyway.* It wasn’t *that* big of a risk.

Don’t get him wrong, he knows that asking others is cheating but he’s goddamn curious dammit. He needs to know what he’s up against.

With the surname revealed, that could only mean one thing.

“I’m only telling you this because I know that Midoriya’s strong,” he can practically feel the smugness dripping off the sentence Yummycat sent him a few minutes ago. “You’re not a stalker, are you? He’s the top student in Criminology and he’ll beat your ass.”

Is this guy planning on interrogating someone!?

Katsuki stares at the phone lying on his desk.

Mina would laugh at this face if she finds out – not that he'd ever tell her.

"Fourth-year student – "

He ends up writing a name on the search bar.

"Green hair, green eyes – "

Midoriya Izuku.

It's a *trap.*

Katsuki presses his lips into a thin line, scrolling through the page.

The account is still new – the oldest post uploaded a year and a half ago. Yes, he scrolled that far. Izuku's Instagram doesn't have a lot of photos with him in it. There's still quite a handful though but they're not selfies, they're taken with the help of another person. There's one from his graduation, one with his former soccer team in high school, one with his mom, and that one –

Midoriya Izuku decked in a tight police uniform.

He's with his friends and Katsuki barely realizes the fact that he's zooming in.

It's been uploaded a few days ago meaning he currently looks like this.

He looks like *this.*

Green hair styled in an undercut, green eyes, a kind gentle smile, those arms, goddamn freckles –

Freckles.

Katsuki leans back on his seat, taking a moment to calm himself.

Deku:

> *<< i asked that shitty zombie about you.*
> >> !!!!
> >> WHAT DID HE SAY
> *<< you wouldn't tell me your fucking name so I asked him.*
> >> NOOOOOOOOOOOOO
> *<< no?*
> *<< YOU THINK I'M GONNA COME AFTER YOU OR SOMETHING!?!?*

It's not that, really. Izuku was worried about something else.

>> That's not it Kacchan. It's just a bit embarrassing!
>> I don't want you to get disappointed!!
<< *am not.*

And then a few seconds later.

<< *you look like a nerd, as expected.*

A *lie.* A complete blatant lie.

Shinsou sweatdrops at the teary-eyed look his best friend sends him from across the table.

"He offered me ten thousand quartz," world execute's in-game currency. It's a lot – about five thousand yen in total. He isn't the type to spend real money for games so after being offered such a large amount for one question, he was tempted and he succumbed. "I'm sorry," he wasn't that guilty when he did the deed but after seeing the other's face… it rose to about sixty percent.

Midoriya Izuku has a really good weepy puppy-dog look.

It's so good Shinsou's starting to hallucinate puppy ears on his friend's head.

What the…

"You sold me off, Shinsou-kun!"

"I'm sorry…"

"He knows who I am now! What I look like!"

Ahh… Shinsou presses his lips into a thin line because, "You also know what he looks like, don't you?"

"That's…" Izuku pulls back, remaining silent for a moment before continuing, "That's different."

Well, it's understandable why he's like this. It's none of my business in the first place.

"Are you mad because I ratted you out?" he asks, noticing how the other slightly perked up before frowning in his direction. Then again, how would he have known that Ground Zero already knew Izuku's first name? "Are you mad because I told him without your permission?"

Izuku almost stands up from his seat because, "Of course not!"

"It's just… It's just…"

Shinsou patiently sips on his drink, waiting for his friend to gather his thoughts.

"It's just embarrassing!"

“Why are you embarrassed?”

“He’s basically a celebrity, Shinsou-kun! Meanwhile, I’m… I’m…”

Campus heartthrob. Number one student. I look like a literal Greek God when I’m shirtless Izuku.

Shinsou frowns because, “What? What are you so self-conscious for? It’s not like you’re planning on dating him or anything.” He peers at his friend for a moment before he blinks, realizing that Izuku had gone from pale to extremely red.

No way.

The corner of Shinsou’s lips twitches before he mumbles, “No freaking way.”

Did he just become cupid or something?

You have activated One for All: Float!

Deku made a happy dance around his husband’s avatar.

Katsuki impatiently taps his fingers on the table, glancing at the door a bit too frequently.

He seems a bit too desperate like this – ten minutes early, dressed in new clothes, cologne on his nape and wrist. There’s AC in the café but for some reason, it’s very hot. He’s sweating and it’s not a good look. He feels like he’s about to meet some sort of higher-up – this is probably worse, to be honest – when in reality it’s just Deku. He’s finally meeting Deku.

Sweet Loving Husband.

Goddamn Midoriya freaking Izuku.

This has to be one of the top ten most nerve-wracking moments in his life.

Three minutes past ten and the door opens again, Katsuki glancing to look before he realizes ohh…

He’s here.

Midoriya is dressed to the tens and Katsuki can feel his heart hammering against his chest.

“You’re late, shitty nerd,” he scoffs, a poor attempt to hide how happy he is.

Izuku sends him a sheepish smile before he opens his mouth to speak.

“Wha –” Katsuki frowns after having the same dream for the third time in a row. “The fuck is happening to me?”

He has come to a realization that although he now knows what Deku *looks* like, he still doesn’t know what he *sounds* like. He keeps having these strange dreams and although he has a visual, with no audible reference everything just seems…. *weird.* His brain had already discarded Deku’s voice from eight years ago. Surely he’d sound different after quite a bit of time had passed. Perhaps his voice is deeper, perhaps he still sounds like a dork.

His mind flashes back to green eyes because, *“Kacchan.”*

Fuck.

It doesn’t matter because Katsuki just wants to *know.*

He grabs his phone from the bedside table, glancing at the time before he immediately heads to his messages. As usual, there’s a message from Deku.

Deku:

>> Good morning, Kacchan!
>> Are you still asleep?

This is totally normal. He’s grown accustomed to this, yes.

<< *nn. you have morning classes?*

The blonde gets off his bed to head to the bathroom with his phone in one hand. He’s in the middle of brushing his teeth when he gets a notification again.

>> Yep!
<< *what time is it going to end?*
>> Eleven if I remember correctly.
>> Why?

Katsuki stares at his reflection in the mirror, contemplating for a moment before he sends –

<< *i wanna call.*

Chapter End Notes

i'm alive. also, meh... probably about 6 or more chapters before they meet.
there will be a lot of things happening in between.

ten pm at a computer cafe

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Katsuki frowns at the letters on the screen, rapidly clicking his mouse in irritation.

Defeat!

It's almost been two hours and he's still stuck on this stage.

The details said that it'll take at least a party of six to succeed in the quest but there was no actual player limit. This basically means that he can do it solo but whether he succeeds or not is entirely up to his skills. His hatred for parties is a well-known fact so of course he'd be stubborn and insist on doing this by himself. He's always been like that even with a professional team behind his back. It's a matter of pride, really.

Then again, for some reason, it's a bit worse today.

Live Chat:

>> He's so triggered today wwww
>> STOP HEADING IN YOU'LL DIE AGAIN!!
>> how many times has he died? lololol
>> Fighting! Fighting! Fighting! Fighting! Fighting!
>> It's impossible to solo Neo Genesis!!!!!
>> you can do it bakuuuuuuuu (๑>ᴗ<)

"SHUT UP YOU GODDAMN EXTRAS!"

He screams at the mic in front of him and thank goodness his set-up is designed to slightly filter and lower down his loud voice. The company made it so that his viewers wouldn't lose their hearing while they watched his stream. The audience knows what they're getting when they stick around as well so at this point they didn't particularly mind. They got used to it, actually.

"No shout-outs for today because you'll all being shitty,"

Katsuki rants, ignoring the green, blue and red flags of super chats flooding in. Usually, he'll read a few but he currently wasn't in the mood. He was *pissed off,* anyone could tell.

"I won't be stopping until I fucking defeat Neo Genesis, you got that?"

Click. Click. Click.

>> it's a twenty-four hour stream today then? wahahaha
>> PARTY! PARTY! PARTY! PARTY!
>> Hey, @*pinky* is in the chat hi @*pinky!*

Katsuki watches as Ground Zero enters the domain again, the screen loading for a few seconds.

>> He probably had a bad day guys.
>> @*minato* it's just two pm HAHAHAHA
>> WHY ARE WE CHALLENGING NEO GENESIS AGAIN!?

>> omo? are we finally going to set a record with this one!?
>> Before setting a record we need to clear it first wwwwwww

Red eyes glance at the chat before his frown deepens, “No shit Sherlock, I had a fantastic day today!”

The chat then proceeds to send him a bunch of exclamation and question marks.

Katsuki grits his teeth before he runs his fingers through his hair, “Don’t fucking piss me off.”

Izuku wonders if he made the right choice.

Ever since he said no to Katsuki’s request, he’s been on edge for some unknown reason.

It probably has something to do with the fact that the other’s *upset.*

The blonde left him on read so that obviously means that he’s upset, right? *Right?* This was different from the usual Kacchan he knew. He was used to being screamed at and dragged around so being subjected to the silent treatment – *even though it’s only been a few hours* – is oddly *mortifying*. It feels like some sort of villain is about to attack, the calm before the storm. Also, why on earth was he *sweating?*

“Dude, what’s wrong with you?”

Shinsou has a deadpan look on his face as he looks up from his work.

They both have the same class in Criminal Justice so they spend quite a lot of time together.

“I… I may have done something unnecessary,” is all he says but for some reason, that’s enough for his best friend to know what he’s talking about. They’re currently in the library researching a bunch of materials for an individual activity to be submitted in a few days.

“I think he’s mad at me,"

“Ahh… Bakugo,” Izuku awkwardly laughs. It’s still a bit strange to hear Kacchan’s real name. “You fought with Loving Husband?”

“Please don’t call him that, Shinsou-kun…”

“What? It’s funny,”

This guy… Izuku really doesn’t understand how his mind works sometimes.

“He… Kacchan wanted to call,” he starts off and Shinsou hums as if urging him to continue. “I said no and told him I can’t because I still had a bunch of schoolwork to do but… Kacchan probably thinks I’m lying and that I just said that as an excuse.” He probably thinks that Izuku doesn’t want to talk to him now and that he got shot down or something.

“Well, true. I mean… that’s just an excuse right?”

Shinsou’s not entirely wrong. Izuku flinches on his seat.

“It’s a phone call. It’s not like you’re not free for a minute or two,”

“But it’s Kacchan, Shinsou-kun,” Izuku points out with a desperate expression. “It’s *Kacchan.”*

Shinsou sighs, feeling a headache start to approach.

“Midoriya, it’s a phone call,” it’s not *that* big of a deal compared to getting married for eight years. “It’s just a phone call.”

Also…

“He’s probably more upset than mad because it’s you, to be honest,”

Izuku stares at the ticket in his hand.

1,200 yen for three hours.

“My dinner…” he sniffles, heading towards his own booth.

Izuku had planned on eating Katsudon for today but he had to pay for a more expensive computer café.

The previous place he was using didn’t have private booths and the pcs and seats were next to each other. This place on the other hand – *one he found on the internet* – had private rooms. It wouldn’t be a problem if he started to talk. The space was clean – *as expected of a Japanese café* – and it was pretty wide. He’d probably be able to stretch his legs fully under the desk.

Izuku places his coffee next to the mouse and he takes off his bag before he settles down on his seat.

Even the gear’s high-tech…

The keyboard is glowing and stuff. He doesn’t know what that means but it looks pretty impressive.

The cursor hovers above World Execute for a moment before the screen starts to load, Izuku typing in his username and password. Unexpectedly, Katsuki’s not yet online. He’s usually playing even before he arrives. Perhaps he’s still mad…

Kacchan:

> *<< I don’t think I can call. I have school work to do Kacchan.*
> *<< Maybe later?*

And that was last read at 10:12 in the morning.

> *<< I’m online. Wanna play together, Kacchan?*
> *<< Let’s do the Neo Genesis quest!*

He’s left on his own for quite a while, half an hour or so before his message is read.

Izuku watches the chatbox toggle before –

>> Sure.
>> Wait for me, nerd.

He lets out a sigh of relief, leaning back on his seat as he waits for the ever familiar notification to pop-up.

Your husband *Ground Zero* is online.

Izuku then nervously fiddles with the audio settings, the red mic symbol turning green.

Katsuki was scrolling through his phone.

Although it has been a routine for him to play with Deku at this time during these past few weeks, he didn't want to see the nerd's avatar for today. Call him petty and shit but he's pretty pissed off you see? The reason should be damn obvious. He had planned on not logging in but he saw a message pop up – a text from Deku, and that's all it took before he got on his feet, grumbling about shitty freckles as he made his way towards his desk.

He has this angry scowl on his face, head-set on for the full bgm experience as he typed away.

Your husband *Deku* is online.

They both have the same spawning spot – *their house* – because they agreed to do so.

Katsuki watches as Deku approaches Ground Zero, the other's neutral expression changing into a happy one.

***Deku* cheered x10 times!**
You sent *Deku* x100 angry emotes.

Deku:

<< *YOU'RE IN BIG TROUBLE SHITTY NERD!!*

Your husband *Deku* is requesting a call.

Eh?

The blonde freezes on his seat.

>> You wanted to call right, Kacchan? Let's call!
>> I can call now!

Katsuki's obviously in a daze because he doesn't think about it too much before he clicks *accept.*

About a second or two later, he *hears* a nervous laugh.

Katsuki *blinks.*

“I guess you’re still mad about earlier?”

His fingers on the mouse and keyboard pause, everything hyperfocus all of a sudden.

“I’m sorry for earlier, Kacchan,”

You received x10 loving emotes from *Deku.*

“Hmm? Is my voice not going through?”

Izuku blinks, wondering why Ground Zero’s not moving all of a sudden.

He hasn’t received a reply as well. Maybe Katsuki didn’t hear him speak. Just to be sure, he makes sure that his audio settings are correct before Deku runs around the house, obviously trying to catch the other’s attention. He feels nervous like this – not receiving a reply and talking by himself. Since he went all the way to find a private room, he wants Katsuki to speak as well.

“Kacchan?”

Maybe it’s because of the lag? He doesn’t really know since he’s new to this computer café.

“Kacchaaaaaaaaaaan,”

He draws out, Deku running against Ground Zero’s avatar.

After about half a minute of no response, Izuku starts to pout.

You sent *Ground Zero* x100 grateful emotes.
You sent *Ground Zero* x100 loving emotes.
You sent *Ground Zero* x100 sweet emotes.

“Kacchaaaan, talk to me – “

There’s a clatter on the other side of the line.

“Huh?” Izuku tilts his head to the side, a bit confused.

Katsuki feels like he’s about to *explode.*

“Kacchaaaaaaaaaaan,”

Izuku’s voice is *nothing* like he remembers eight years ago.

He should’ve expected this but he had too much confidence in himself and the contrast was so bright he’s starting to regret his decision now. Izuku’s voice was deeper, much more mature but it wasn’t the raspy kind. It was clear, very clear and Katsuki wasn’t sure if it was just the audio or

the person himself. It was a voice that charmed people. The type those high-ranking NPCs in the game had, a voice that belongs to a goddamn announcer or some voice actor or some shit because –

"Kacchaaaan, talk to me – "

The blonde bumps his head against his desk, one hand clenching his chest.

Katsuki then grits his teeth and he literally has to refrain himself from groaning right then and there.

Ping!

You received x100 grateful emotes from *Deku.*
You received x100 loving emotes from *Deku.*
You received x100 sweet emotes from *Deku.*

Fuck you, Midoriya Izuku.

"Huh?" Izuku speaks again, confused since no one's replying. *"Can you hear me, Kacchan?"*

Katsuki stares at the screen, his cheeks and ears flushed. His eyebrows are also furrowed and he's frowning. He's frowning but he's not mad and he's definitely in a much better mood than earlier. Rather than mad, his expression screams *how dare you do this to me?* A bit upset but slightly warm.

"I can hear you just fine, shitty Deku!" he doesn't bother sitting up on his seat, only shifting so that he can bury his face into his arms. "Your audio was so freaking bad it took me a while to understand what you were saying!"

"Ahh…" Izuku awkwardly laughs and Katsuki can feel his heart constrict. *"Sorry, Kacchan."*

"You said *no* to me this morning,"

"It's true that I was busy this morning though. I had something to finish..."

"You still said *no,"* Katsuki repeats as if to prove a point. "You said *no* to *me."*

Izuku hums in reply and his mouse clicks once, *twice,* before, *"We're talking now though?"*

A sweet, fond tone.

"What else should I do to make it up to you, Kacchan?"

Katsuki hangs up before he screams.

Victory!

> **New Record Set by**
> Ground Zero and Deku
> Time: 09:12:45

Katsuki feels smug because was Neo Genesis always this easy?

"You're so cool, Kacchan!" the other praises on the other side of the line. *"We did it on our first try!"*

It wasn't really *his* first try but yeah… *acceptable.*

He doesn't want to tell Deku that he's failed this quest multiple times earlier this morning.

"Let's do one more quest, Deku,"

Click. Click.

"Uhh… My time is almost up, Kacchan. I have to log out,"

Click.

The blonde glances at the clock – *10:13 P.M.*

"Open mic again tomorrow," since Izuku managed to do it today, surely he'll be able to do it next time as well. He hears a laugh from the other – a bad omen, and Katsuki's lips curl into a frown. He doesn't like where this is going. "What?"

"But my wallet will be suffering, Kacchan,"

"Send me your LINE account – "

"What? No, no, no, no, no – "

Katsuki's frown deepens more.

"You wanted to call because you wanted to talk right, Kacchan?" the blonde hums in reply. Izuku chuckles on the other side of the line before he continues saying, "*Private computer cafes are expensive. I'll still be able to play with you if I go to the one I went to last time –"* followed by a long explanation. Generally, it's a bit frowned upon if one is loud in public and that is also applicable in internet cafes.

"I'll tell you when I'm free so that we can call, how about that?"

"Yeah, right," Katsuki scoffs, arms crossed above his chest. "You're always busy."

Izuku awkwardly laughs.

"I'll call you in the morning before I leave for school then?" the offer is good enough for Katsuki to contemplate. They're both early risers so it isn't really a problem. "Or I can call you after I finish with school?" since it's not every day they manage to play together. Sometimes Izuku's late and sometimes he can't play because of university. Three out of seven times a week he does manage to log in though.

"Both," Katsuki negotiates. "Call me both in the morning *and* at night."

There's a moment of silence and the blonde snaps asking, "Well?"

"O-Of course!" Izuku laughs and he replies saying, *"Anything you want, Kacchan."*

Katsuki's lying down on his bed, face pressed against his pillow with his phone next to him.

"I think we can set a better record if we have support items – "

Izuku's mumbling on speaker, the timer on the call showing 00:42:19.

"I have a lot of support items,"

Since he's a professional gamer and all. He has connections to that one developer company – *Hatsume Industries.* They're in charge of developing team UA's customized gear for tournaments as well. "We're definitely setting a better record next time," Katsuki grins, not bothering to look up from his pillow.

"We're going to fuck up Neo Genesis,"

They end the call at two in the morning.

Chapter End Notes

oya? fast update? reviews really motivate me.
anyway, chapter eight will be up after i finish my exams this week.
wish me luck!

p.s. - i was trying to make a soft, subtle bkdk fic but wow, this is hella gay huh?

possessive or obsessive?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Mina coyly smiles as she watches their team captain argue over the phone.

“The fuck!? Who said you’re allowed to go out and play!? We have a raid tonight!”

And by *play* he means Deku going out somewhere with his friends.

His tone is loud and boisterous as ever, albeit a bit more pissed off than usual. Mina kind of understands nevertheless because after listening to what her friend was saying, it seems like Deku had canceled their plans at the last minute. She kind of feels bad for Katsuki but at the same time she’s giddy because *this is what you call development, i’m glad you’re both doing great.* A relationship needs to have spice.

This is just the *beginning.*

Child, she sighs lamenting, *you still have a lot to learn.*

“I TOLD YOU MY TEAMMATES SUCK HOW MANY TIMES DO I HAVE TO REPEAT THIS – “

Mina doesn’t know whether to agree or deny that statement because oddly enough, just Ground Zero and Deku are enough to break records left and right. It’s pretty easy to notice since half of the pair is literally the number one player on the Asian server. There was also that tournament accident. Thankfully, things have calmed down and it isn’t as hectic as before.

“Say something other *than ‘I’m sorry’,* dammit. You think I wanna hear you ramble, shitty nerd – “

Mina takes a sip of her tea.

“You can just refuse them, can’t you? Say *I FUCKING MADE PLANS WITH SOMEONE PRIOR TO THIS, GODDAMN FUCK OFF – “*

The phone call goes on for approximately two more minutes before Katsuki hangs up, his expression *livid.*

“Baku,” Mina’s tone sounds a tad bit disappointed and she shakes her head from left to right. “Too possessive, Baku.”

“The fuck you mean by that!?”

“I said…” she starts again, intent on getting her point across. “You’re too possessive, that’s scary. Let your husband have some fun once in a while.” *Haven’t the two of you been playing regularly?* Mina thinks that Katsuki is a bit too attached to the other after seeing how he snaps over *one* missed schedule. Poor Deku is probably flustered.

“He has enough *fun* when he’s with me,”

Katsuki scoffs and Mina can feel her heart flutter because *ahh, I get it now.*

For some reason that frown on the blonde’s face kind of looks like a pout.

“But still, if he told you not to go out won’t you hate that as well?” everyone knows that Bakugo Katsuki is the *I do it my way* type of guy. Once he starts, he won’t stop until he gets what he wants. It’s always been like that when it came to ranks, achievements, and the like. It wouldn’t be surprising if he was the same when it came to romance. “Maybe he wouldn’t have gone if you asked him *cutely.”*

She can’t imagine him doing anything cute but she’ll put the option out. He might consider it.

Please consider it.

Katsuki’s frown only deepens and he says, “You don’t know shit, Pinky.”

There’s a reason for this.

“The dimwit is going to a fucking bar.”

“Why are you so nervous? It’s not like you’re dating or anything,”

Shinsou points out because Izuku’s complexion is becoming really worrisome.

He looks *pale* – like he’s in *trouble,* that’s what.

Seriously… that Bakugo Katsuki.

“It’s just that uhh… Kacchan does have a point. I promised him that I’d be playing with him today – “ and now he feels guilty for standing him up. It wouldn’t be shocking if he’s a bit too worried, really. Recently, he also realized that he has this habit of making people wait for him. It’s not a good thing. “But I also think that it’s not nice to refuse Uraraka-san just because I want to play video games.” They don’t get the chance to see each other a lot – not since their second year.

Shinsou understands because priority-wise, friends are supposed to weigh heavier than games.

Bakugo Katsuki is that one random variable that somehow manages to get Izuku into a loop.

“Ehh… Just make it up to him or something,”

Izuku awkwardly laughs. There’s silence, Shinsou scrolling through his phone for a while before he realizes something. Purple eyes peer at the other thinking *I don’t think he’s mad because you canceled on him though.* It’s probably because of a different reason.

“Hmm…”

Anyway –

“Wouldn’t it be fine if you just kept him updated?”

Kaminari grabs his phone when he hears a ping, owlishly blinking at the notification on his lock screen.

_toshii **posted for the first time in a while.**

He recognizes him as that guy – *yummycat.* The two of them exchanged info three weeks ago. He didn't manage to get Deku's since Katsuki kept interrupting but the purple guy was quite approachable despite his somewhat dark, *I haven't slept in four days* demeanor. Shinsou's feed is mostly cats, a bunch of landscapes, coffee, and a few candid photos of his friends. The last post was about a month ago so indeed, it's been quite long.

The most recent one that has just been uploaded on the other hand –

i want to sleep @_toshii • 2 min ago

> how i take my friends' photos vs how they take mine.
> [**Photo attached:** (1) Izuku dressed in a black button-up, gently smiling with strobe lights behind his back;
> (2) Blurry photo of Todoroki and Shinsou.]

"Hmm?" Mina peeks over Kaminari's shoulder, noticing the green-haired male. "Who's that? Another idol?"

"Nah, Yummycat I think?" he doesn't know why he expected purple. Maybe it was because his avatar was of said color. Green was more of Deku's color – from his hair, to his eyes, to his suit to his… *ohh.* "Mina!" Kaminari's eyes widen and he stands up from the sofa, realization sinking in. "Doesn't he kinda look like a Deku to you?"

Well, it's only because he looks similar to the avatar but still…

Yummycat and Deku are friends so it's possible, right!?

As the pair banters in the living room, Katsuki who's making dinner in the kitchen turns around to narrow his eyes at them. As usual, he's rather alert when it comes to a handful of things. Kirishima who is playing with his switch also looks up from his game to look at what's happening. There's this menacing expression on their team captain's face and the redhead mentally counts down from three, two, *one* –

"Who looks like a Deku, Pikachu?"

He's not screaming at least.

"This guy!" Kaminari holds his phone near Katsuki's face. He'd be screamed at and beheaded at this point if it weren't for the image on the screen.

"His face kinda screams *sweet caring husband,"*

Katsuki snatches the phone out of his teammate's grasp, glaring at the photo.

As if knowing that he needs to explain, the other then says, "It's Yummycat's account."

There are about half a dozen questions Katsuki wants to ask but that'll have to wait for now.

"Bro, they go to Kyushu University – "

Judging from that one photo on Shinsou's feed with Iida and Izuku donning their maroon jackets. Kyushu University is basically one of the top law schools in Japan. It was located in Fukuoka, a city way too far from Tokyo. Everything's stitching together and *fuck.* Katsuki all of a sudden remembers that photo of Deku wearing a police uniform. Mina goes on leaps and bounds, comfortably scrolling through Shinsou's feed – *she swears she's not stalking* – and even goes as far as going through his following list.

"GAH DON'T START LIKING THINGS MINA – "

The owner of the phone complains; attempting to snatch the device from her hand only for it to be passed over to Bakugo.

They then realize that *_toshii* had just uploaded a bunch of stories and the team captain doesn't even hesitate to click on it because it's Kaminari's account, not his.

_toshii • 1 min ago

> Someone come fetch their jackrabbit.
> [**Photo attached**: Izuku looking lost and awkward surrounded by girls.]

"Oh no," Mina gasps, leaning against Katsuki's arm to take a closer look at the photo. "Oh no, he's hot."

Thing is, she appreciates eye candy when she sees one.

The photo cuts off just below Izuku's knee, a good indication that Shinsou was standing afar from the other when he took the photo. Mina notices that he's dressed in a black button-up – sleeves rolled up and *are those scars on his arms?* That's kind of cool. The guy obviously worked out because he's *built* – probably on par with Kirishima and Bakugo if not better. He filled out that shirt like a majestic being and she kind of wants to see his back profile. For a guy of his stature, the babyface kind of suited him.

Actually, *babyface* might be a bad term. With a jawline that sharp, it obviously –

"Uhh… Bakugo?" Kirishima calls out, waving his hand in front of his friend's face. "You alright dude?"

There's silence.

"Bakugo?"

Katsuki licks his lips as he stares at his masterpiece.

"No more, Kacchan – "

A red-faced Izuku says with his eyes in a daze and in complete disarray.

He looks like a mess, like he's just been thoroughly kissed. The shirt he's wearing is crumpled, a few buttons missing from the fray, toned stomach and chest exposed for all to see. The blonde has no idea how they've gotten to this. He also doesn't know where this place is. All he knows is that he's currently straddling Deku's lap, his hands everywhere and –

"Off," Katsuki huffs against the other's lips, tugging on the last button that's keeping Izuku's shirt together until it detaches. "I want it off."

"Kacchan!" Izuku complains, grabbing the blonde's hands that were about to do more damage on his newly brought button-up.

"It's already off!" that seems to snap the blonde out of his daze. "See?"

Izuku guides long slim fingers against his abdomen, green-eyes peering upwards, Katsuki's breath hitching because –

"It's already off, Kacchan,"

"You have bags under your eyes," Sero out of all people points out as he snickers.

Katsuki glares and he sends him the middle-finger before he returns to cooking breakfast, his phone conveniently placed on the countertop in case he receives a message. Thankfully, his teammate doesn't press for more details. Perhaps it's because he already knows what's up or he's not that curious. Both don't matter to Katsuki at least, he doesn't really care.

They're all in their twenties for goodness sake so the teasing doesn't work anymore.

Ping!

The blonde silently grabs his phone.

Deku:

>> Morning, Kacchan!
>> I have a hang-over ahhhhhhh
>> Sorry for yesterday.

Serves you right, shitty nerd!

<< *go drink water and take a fucking bath.*
<< *you still up for world at six?*
>> Yep! Let's play at six!
>> Btw, can Yummycat play with us as well?

Katsuki frowns at the message.

He doesn't really want anyone else teaming up with them and Deku should know that as well.

<< *no i don't want to.*
<< *why?*

The reply he gets after that explains everything.

>> There’s a tournament at my university in three weeks!
>> There’s no level cap since team battles convert to LVL. 80 automatically.
>> Kacchan help us pls

Yeah, he kind of knows that already — the level cap he means. It usually happens during tournaments; the system sets all levels to 80 so that all the participants have the same base. That way it'll be purely up to their skills to determine the real champion. Apparently, it's a group tournament — *this thing Izuku's joining* — not a PvP. Katsuki has experience with those as well since he's in Team UA and not to brag or anything but they're kind of the best. They won this year's games with Shiketsu a close second. It seems like universities play World Execute as well.

>> A friend of mine told me yesterday.
>> First place gets a brand new PC!

A pc?

A laptop? No… A computer?

<< *and you’re participating?*
<< *with yummycat?*
>> Yep! Along with three more teammates!
>> They said they’ll let me have the price hahaha

Katsuki stares at the text on the screen before he replies –

>> *the fuck??*
>> *call them over for training shitty nerd!*

As much as he hates parties, Izuku getting his own PC sounds a bit too tempting.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) university tournament - kyushu university is holding a world execute tournament with a full-set computer as a reward. it's for some sort of promotion, they also did it last year. also, the author wants to give izuku his own pc because he'll go broke going to internet cafes all the time.
(2) kyushu university - in chapter one the midoriyas moved to tokyo but now they're in fukuoka? i edited the first few chapters a few days ago. now, kacchan is in tokyo and deku is in fukuoka. i changed it because if they're both in tokyo then they can meet up pretty easily. for plot purposes actually.

this was originally going to be a very lewd smut fic but everyone's saying it's cute and i now have a moral dilemma.

these guys are kinda meta

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Uraraka Ochako is a very simple girl.

The moment she saw the poster on the bulletin board that said *Kyushu University Garena Tournament* with the words *100,000 yen and Full Predator PC reward* she was down to participate. It isn't like she's broke or anything – well, actually, *yes,* she is broke. With how her parents had been funding her tuition fees, as a twenty three year old it's quite shameful to ask for allowance as well. She's been surviving so far by staying at the female dorms and working a part-time job but that's only *enough.*

She has no savings and a girl has her wants you know?

Like that 100,000 yen reward, for example.

She's played the game quite a lot during her high school years so she might as well give it a try.

"Heh…"

Was Shinsou's reply when she asked him if he'd ever played the game before.

Apparently, he does so regularly, and now that he's heard that there would be a school tournament –

"I have over 1000 hours on my account you know," *is it just her or is his smile kind of scary?* "I'm not a rookie like those underclassmen of ours," prideful because he's dedicated his sleep, money, and soul to the game. At this point, Uraraka is convinced that the word *addiction* is sufficient enough to describe Shinsou's obsession. She finally figured out why her friend is *always* lacking sleep. It wasn't just insomnia after all!

"World Execute?" Iida Tenya was kind of confused at first. "I've heard about it before. I think my brother plays it as well."

Oddly enough, he didn't hesitate as much as she expected him to. Perhaps because it's an activity supported by the school, he's alright with the tournament. He hasn't really played before but he's always been kind of a fast learner when it came to games so it'll definitely be fine! That's what she thinks at least.

"Sure," Todoroki is as monotone as ever. "If you guys want to join, I'll join as well."

This one also doesn't play but since he sulks when he gets left out so he gets to join as well.

"A PC!?"

Ah yes… Izukkun.

She doesn't really want the PC since she lives in a dorm. Also, since it's a PR package it can't be sold anywhere so chances are they'd have to use it or give it away – maybe sell it to a classmate who wouldn't leak that it's a PR package but they're law students you see!

They have morals to uphold.

“You’ve been playing recently right, Izukkun?”

“Nn!” ahh, there it is. That lady-killer smile. “But I’ve never been in a tournament before, Uraraka-san!”

Shinsou who’s sitting next to Izuku has this dark smile on his face because, “This guy’s maxed out.”

Also, “He has a pro with him.”

Uraraka blinks, wondering what that’s about. Anyway, a pro sounds impressive.

“Kacchan is really good at the game,” yeah, she’s never heard of that name before. A girl? A guy? She doesn’t know. Izuku always got along with tons of people so hearing that he has a friend in-game isn’t really shocking. “He’s a ranked player!” before he goes on leaps and bounds praising this *Kacchan.* Shinsou looks a bit gloomy because *ranked player huh…* It seems like that’s kind of understating it?

Three days later, they meet Ground Zero, the number one DPS player in the entire Asian server.

“You have shit stats,”

Is the first thing Katsuki tells Uraraka during open-mic.

***Ingenium* sent *Ground Zero* x100 angry emotes.**
***Shouto* sent *Ground Zero* x100 angry emotes.**

At least the beginners seem to know how to navigate the game now.

“That’s— KKHHHKKK – mean KacchaKHHHHKKKK – “

“You don’t have to force yourself to open mic, Midoriya…”

“Are they really that ba—DGGGGKKKKHHHH – “

“You too Uraraka…”

Yummycat used sticker*: GG TEAM!*

It seems like because there are *two* of them now, Izuku’s less shy about using mic in public. Uraraka’s sitting next to him in the internet café, both of them with headsets on. College dorms have a curfew so they can only play until ten. It’s just seven so they still have three more hours at least. Shinsou has his own PC at home, Todoroki, and Iida as well. They don’t struggle as much as Izuku and Uraraka technology-wise.

“You don’t have to be so rude about it,” Todoroki’s audio is very clear for some reason.

As expected of a rich bocchan!

“I BELIEVE THIS IS OUR FIRST MEETING? GROUND ZERO-SAN YOUR LANGUAGE IS NOT APPROPRIATE – “

From behind the screen, everyone silently lowers Iida's volume.

"YOU HAVE A PROBLEM WITH THAT FOUR EYES!?"

Katsuki's loud voice isn't as disruptive. Perhaps it's because he has a professional mic with a condenser on.

As expected of a pro gamer!

"Listen up, this is my turf! You wanna win, you follow my orders!"

***Ingenium* sent *Ground Zero* x50 angry emotes.**
***Shouto* sent *Ground Zero* x100 meh emotes.**
Yummycat used sticker*: IT'S ME GROUND ZERO!*
***Uravity* cheered x100 times!**

"AND THAT INCLUDES YOU, SHITTY DEKU!"

Ground Zero then proceeds to angrily circle Deku.

***Deku* sent *Ground Zero* x100 loving emotes.**

Uraraka watches as Uravity floats around the screen.

Ping!

You have suffered 200 damage from nausea.

"You have Zero Gravity as well, Izukkun?" she asks, taking a peek at her friend's monitor. As long as she keeps her mouse moving her avatar will continue to do so as well. She's farming in a sense, building up her resistance to her quirk's weakness. "You can also float," she notices how Deku can also get off the ground for a short amount of time.

Unlike her nevertheless, he doesn't seem to be suffering from some sort of side-effect which is a bit rare.

"It's uhh… hard to explain,"

"Can the both of you turn your mics off already?" Shinsou complains from the other side of the line. "The static is kinda distracting."

Uraraka and Izuku hastily go to their settings, the green light turning red.

"I can't really practice alone,"

Shinsou has a high base level – *LVL. 180* – but his quirk is still LVL. 4.

“You think I wanna be your guinea pig?” Ground Zero crosses his arm above his chest. He already knows what Yummycat’s quirk is since they’ve played together a few weeks ago. The brainwashing worked against monsters as well. It got removed the second physical attacks hit nevertheless. “Go ask your robot friend.”

Ingenium’s running from Musutafu to Hosu though… He’s already far away.

“Or icy-hot,”

Shinsou’s kinda irked that Todoroki managed to get such a meta-quirk. He’s also still grinding to level up.

Uraraka on the other hand is probably floating somewhere.

As for Deku…

Click. Click.

Ground Zero:

> >> [**Photo attached:** Red-faced Izuku who had too much to drink.]
> >> Still a no?

When Izuku looks up from his laptop, he notices that Shinsou has his phone directed at him.

Is he taking a video?

“Hmm? What’s that for Shinsou-kun?”

They’re currently in the library studying for a quiz. They have to revise often since topics that they previously learn tend to show up frequently. Also, they’re both really diligent students. Iida, Todoroki, and Uraraka are not around since they’re in a different class. It’s actually lucky that Izuku managed to match with Shinsou most of the time.

“I was taking a photo,” *oh, so it wasn’t a video.* “Glasses suit you.”

Izuku blinks, slightly tilting his head to the side.

Well, yes, he wears glasses from time to time. He’s been playing games and studying in the dark so reading fine text is a bit difficult. It’s not to the point where he has to wear it all the time like Iida though. It’s only when he’s reading small fonts that are hard to see.

“Uhh… thank you,” to which Shinsou nods, pressing something on his phone.

Another photo I guess?

Izuku laughs before he shakes his head, finding no issue in the matter.

Uraraka is *irked.*

Ping!

Ground Zero:

> << *You keep saying my stats are bad but are yours really that good!?*
> << *What's your quirk lvl??*
> << *1V1!!!!!!!*
> << *You're no. 4 on PK list!!!!!*

This guy… He really keeps talking down on her!

She manages to endure it since Izuku is usually around to support her with his *it's alright, Uraraka-san. Kacchan doesn't actually mean it. He's just shy* but he's not around today because of his part-time job with Torino-sensei. On contrary, Katsuki doesn't want to do this without Deku around as well. Then again, he *promised* that he'd do this. If it weren't for the other he would've blasted them to infinity days ago. Why do they think he's going through all of this trouble!? This wasn't charity work for goodness sake!

> >> HAH.
> >> WAIT AND SEE ROUND FACE.

Ground Zero **invites you to** ***appraise*** **him.**

Accept!

Uraraka clicks her tongue at the five number stats, as expected of a maxed-out LVL.300.

Quite a few things do catch her attention though, mainly the skills – Cooking Master LVL.10, Housekeeping LVL.10, and Patience LVL. 10. It's very difficult to max out skills since they require varying degrees of mastery that become more difficult at every stage. Anyway… Patience LVL. 10? Ground Zero doesn't really seem like the patient type, no offense.

Also, *that!*

That!

> **Status:** [Married]
> **Spouse:** [Deku]
> **Titles:** [No. 1 DPS Player], [Most Favored Player 20XX],
> [10th Asian Cup MVP], [UA Team Captain]…
> [Loving Husband]

!?

> << *ASKJDASKJK*
> << *MARRIED???*
> << *TO IZUKKUN???*

You received x100 angry emotes from ***Ground Zero.***

Three weeks pass by in a flash.

Izuku notices how Uraraka seems a bit *strange* around him from time to time. He doesn't mean it in a negative sense nevertheless. It's just that often times when they'd make eye contact, she'd smile before giggling. He wonders if there's something on his face. Or if there's an inside joke he doesn't know? He also means those moments where-in she's like *ahh, it's fine if you have other plans, Izukkun.* Usually, she'd want to hang out with all of them because it's more fun that way. He feels a bit lonely now.

"Are… Are you texting, Ground Zero?"

See? She's doing it again!

"Nn," he nods, half-finished with his reply to Katsuki's text. "He helped us so I wanted to let him know."

Uraraka has this pleased smile on her face due to his response, brown eyes brightening up in bliss.

"You're a good boy, Izukkun!" she then laughs as she ruffles his hair.

Kacchan:

>> you can do it.
>> go win first place, deku.
<< *Thanks, Kacchan! I'll call you when it's over!*

Four and a half hours later, they end up winning the entire thing.

<< *[**Photo attached:** Group photo with Iida, Todoroki, Shinsou, and Uraraka.]*
<< *Thank you for helping us, Kacchan!*

Helping out in the tournament seems to be the right call.

Deku:

>> I don't think I'm doing it right.
>> [**Photo attached:** Izuku's hand holding up one cable he doesn't know where to connect.]
<< *behind the monitor.*

The other seems to be comfortable enough to be sending him photos now. Up until a few days ago, it's all just text but recently there seems to be a good amount of pictures, albeit none including his face. Katsuki still appreciates them nevertheless and tries to reciprocate by sending his own set because *Deku might think I'm being distant and shit.* Both their photos are mostly about food; or objects or that view Deku sent him yesterday paired with a text that said – *a red sunset kind of reminds me of Kacchan.*

What's that supposed to mean!?

Katsuki had to pause for a while during his stream when he received that message.

>> Thank you again Kacchan!
>> You always help me and I feel bad. I'm becoming too spoiled I think.
>> If you need help from me as well feel free to ask!

Red eyes owlishly blink, typing a reply for a moment – *hesitating* – before deleting and thinking again.

Hmm… that's kind of tempting.

>> [**Photo attached:** Izuku's PC finally set up on his desk.]
>> [**Photo attached**: PC starting screen.]
>> ASHSHDASJDH IT'S WORKING KACCHAN

Actually, he should go for it.

<< yeah, i need help deku.
>> Hmm? Is it a legal concern?

Izuku studies a lot at school and he's pretty decent at it – legal concerns, he means. Iida has better grades but he's confident that he'd be able to give sufficient advice as well. He might not be able to assist directly but anything concerning law he might have a bit of knowledge in! That includes cyber laws of course. He's a graduating fourth-year student, you know!

<< *nah.*
<< *you said you're interning next week right?*
<< *do you already have your uniform?*
>> Nn! Nighteye agency!

The chatbox toggles for a moment before Katsuki cuts him off.

<< *send a picture of you wearing it.*

And a few seconds later –

<< *i wanna see.*

Izuku stares at his reflection in the mirror, frowning when he sees the messy knot of his tie.

He's self-conscious for some reason and he never usually cares about how he looks.

Actually –

Izuku tugs at his tie, taking it off before unbuttoning the first few buttons of his uniform.

Yeah, that looks better. He doesn't know how to tie a tie anyway.

Kacchan:

<< I still don't have my badges so it looks incomplete.
*<< [**Photo attached:** Mirror photo of Izuku wearing his police uniform.]*

The chat toggles for a while before a ping is heard.

>> looks good.

Green eyes soften at the response.

<< Thank you Kacchan!

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) 100,000 yen - not everything went to Uraraka ofc.
(2) Base Level - the level you are currently on. Max level is 300.
(3) Skill Level - level of skills that you have. Max level is 10.
(4) Skills - can be acquired through gradual repetition.
(5) PK List - list of top 50 players that have the most player kills.
(6) Nighteye Agency - the agency where Izuku will be interning.
(7) Meta - effective gaming. Shinsou thinks that Todo is too meta because of his quirk.

anyway, in the next chap izuku will log in at about ten in the morning (the time where katsuki usually has his streams).
per usual, he's oblivious as ever because on his end he can't see the live chat.

super chat goes berserk

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Izuku has been trying to update his new pc for a while now.

Apparently, when it's new it needs a ton of stuff to be installed on it. He got it two days ago and he spent his entire time wondering which is a better antivirus program to install – they're all *expensive* and there's a ton of choices. Apparently, it's no good to just pick one as well because they're all different and you might end up with a bad one. He ends up getting what Katsuki recommended because *hey, it's Kacchan.* Does that even need an explanation?

There's also that update setting – *Microsoft.*

The wait was torturous, to be honest, and with how much he needed to install, he had approximately wasted sixteen hours in total.

Mind you he had school and his part-time job as well so he can only do this when he gets home by six or seven. Good thing he's rather patient, Katsuki's not though – judging by his texts. Every day they seem to be getting more and more impatient because *just goddamn let it run while you're at school, shitty nerd.* Izuku refuses because he's scared of some sort of short circuit or fire happening – an irrational fear. Also, that'd be a waste of electricity!

Kacchan:

>> [**Photo attached:** Screenshot of *How to create a standard user account with password for your pc.*]
>> you made a recovery drive already? good.

Click. Click. Click.

Izuku sighs before he leans back on his chair, glad that everything's finally finished.

On one tab he has his email open, another for wallpapers that he's planning on making his desktop cover. He ends up with this blue and yellow photo of All Might in his New Age costume, a photo World Execute used as a cover for their webpage about a year ago. In the background the game is smoothly installing as well, 68% after about an hour and a half of waiting.

At this point, it'll probably be done by ten a.m. or eleven. He feels excited to play actually.

<< *Are we playing at six again, Kacchan?*
>> i thought you had work at six during fridays?

Well yeah, but it's a non-working holiday, isn't it? Since there are no classes as well, Torino-sensei doesn't really need to go to the University. Izuku has no one to assist so it's basically a day-off.

<< *I have no work today!*
>> when are you free then?
<< *Anytime!*
>> ha???
<< *??*

Anyway –

>> i have no idea what you're saying.
>> just log in at six if you want.

Izuku smiles, heading to the kitchen to grab his breakfast.

About an hour later, World Execute finishes installing.

Ping!

Katsuki watches as the first few viewers arrive, the stream chat slowly flooding in.

He usually streams at around ten to twelve in the morning since he has other matters to attend to during the afternoon – tournament practices with team UA, for example. Or going to the office to do some sort of PR stunt that the company wants him to do. Unexpectedly, he gets quite a few interviews as well. He finds it ridiculous because he's not an idol or celebrity.

Then again, with how big the game is, he's basically one of its leading figures at this point.

His net worth is not something to be laughed at either.

62,860 viewers.

That's a lot considering how he streams almost every single day. The numbers are always consistent as well. If there are events or new updates the count is much higher than it usually is. He doesn't even have to say anything for now because the moment the website loads his stream – super chat immediately starts filling in.

Click. Click.

"Ah, Ah –" mic test, a neutral expression on his face. "Mic's been having problems for a while now. Can you extras even hear me?"

Stream Chat:

>> Yes Bakuuuu~!!!!!!
>> GOOD MORNING BAKUUUUUU
>> too close omo
>> My left ear is enjoying this wwwwww
>> Sound's not even Bakugo www

Katsuki clicks his tongue before he runs through his setup, adjusting a few things, "What about now?"

>> LOUD AND CLEAR!
>> Thanks for fixing it, Ground Zero-sama!
>> your voice sounds handsome wwww
>> Did you not brush your hair again??

"Shut up,"

And World Execute starts to run on his screen, not even needing to input his password since it's already been saved right from the beginning. He seems rather calm for now since contrary to what others might expect, he's rather put together in person. The trash-talking and heat only come out in-game or when something happens and he gets pissed off.

"Someone tell me who won last night. I didn't watch it since I was playing,"

>> Gale Force vs Grand from Ketsubutsu?
>> gale force won. it was a close fight though.
>> RAID! RAID! RAID! RAID!
>> season 24 is kinda weak tho wwwww
>> Are you going to join the PvPs?

The blonde grins, red eyes peering at the comments, "You'll just have to wait and see."

Izuku is *trembling* in his seat.

It's not from fear though; it's from excitement because his pc is *working!*

The monitor graphics is clear! Very, very clear! There's this short bit of animation on the loading screen so even that looks impressive. It looks like some sort of movie or something. He's seen it multiple of times before in the internet café but gaming computers are *different!* The graphics are fluid, smooth, and the colors are so vibrant *ahhh* Izuku wants to *hug* his screen. It doesn't even take a minute for him to input his account details before he's back in Musutafu.

Ping!

Your husband *Ground Zero* is online!

Oh, Kacchan's here!

Anyway –

Izuku's lips curl up into a smile when he exits their house and he's greeted by this high-quality view.

What kind of pc has he been playing on after all this time!? To think that he was impressed back then… No wonder Shinsou was looking at him with pity during that time at the internet café. There's barely any lag and he could see *every* detail. He doesn't have a headset, he's using earphones and despite that, the bgm feels like he should be in a hall listening to an orchestra concert or something.

"Oh, hi Kacchan," he blurts out, noticing Ground Zero's avatar next to his.

***Ground Zero* sent you x100 angry emotes.**

When did he get here?

He was too busy admiring his new pc's graphics.

Ping!

Ground Zero:

>> THE FUCK HAPPENED TO SIX??
>> weren't you going to play at six?
>> did you skip class deku?
>> HEY STOP STANDING AROUND

He missed quite a lot, didn't he?

<< *It's a holiday, Kacchan www*
<< *I have no class and it finished installing so I thought I'd play for a bit.*
<< *You play during the morning without me? TT*
<< *Bad Kacchan!!*

Deku runs around Ground Zero's avatar, the blonde seemingly still.

Ah, that's right…

Call your husband *Ground Zero?*

Yes!

It's 11:27 a.m. and Katsuki's been streaming for about an hour and a half now.

There's not much action since he's already maxed out. He's currently in the midst of farming for a weapon because he's somehow gotten bored of the gauntlet that he has. The goal is to find materials that are S-rank or higher so he challenges a bunch of dungeons where he knows it's dropped. Inwardly, he slightly curses because this would've been much easier with Deku around due to their raised drop bonus. Then again, it's not like he can just drag the other around to farm anyway.

There are more fun things to do with Deku rather than farming.

Like setting records and raiding boss dungeons for example.

"Drops are shit in this area. Who said this one's good?" Katsuki blames chat, frowning and obviously pissed off. Not wanting to make their idol angry, various viewers start to apologize in the comments and suggest another location. It's the usual banter, really. "Kohera City? Kohera City doesn't have a fucking blue gem mine, you shithead – "

Ping!

Your husband *Deku* is online.

!?

A red dot then appears on the upper left-hand mini-map of his screen.

Stream Chat:

>> !!!!!!

>> AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA
>> HUSBAND IS HERE OMG OMG OMG OMG
>> is this true or is this this a prank i'm going to cry dafuq
>> OHHHH PK PK PK PK PK PK PK
>> Look at Baku's face wwwwwwww
>> THAT'S GOTTA BE A MEME WWWWWWWW

"Deku – *wha –*"

Red eyes glance at the in-game clock before shifting to chat,

" IF ANY OF YOU BITCHES TAKE SCREENSHOTS I SWEAR TO FUCKING GOD I'M GOING TO KICK YOUR ASS – "

Ping!

>> [**momoring donated ¥15,000:** congrats on your marriage bakuuuu]
>> [**Nabiya007 donated ¥2,423:** WHATWHATWHATWHATWHATWHATWHAT]
>> [**Morinaka_ donated ¥3,000:** HOW MUCH FOR A HUSBAND REVEAL????]
>> [**isaisabella donated ¥1,200:** Is it finally happening!? Looks like he didn't see this coming LOL]
>> [**Gabii.ru donated ¥8,200:** everyone STAPH PANICKING PLEASE AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA…]

The number of super chat that are being thrown seems to be twice, no, *thrice* the amount than usual.

"STOP SPAMMING GODDAMIT – "

Katsuki raises his voice, rapidly clicking away. He doesn't seem mad, he seems flustered almost.

Anyway, since Izuku never logs in during the mornings due to class he didn't really expect this kind of situation to happen.

Also, didn't they set a time? What happened to six? The blonde then proceeds to throw a bunch of insults at his viewers as if it's their fault that this happened. They're overly excited and it's fucking pissing him off. It's not that he doesn't want anyone to know about Deku, it's just that he knows that they'd be bothering him and he can't fucking stand that.

His head is already hurting just by thinking about all the threads that are going to pop up.

If anything, he's a bit glad that all his viewers can see is the other's username.

You choose to teleport to *Musutafu Subdivision.*

Chat basically squeals when they see Deku standing in front of their shared residence. He looks like he's in a daze, his avatar looking around but not really moving in its place. The 3d graphics doesn't make it better because in this angle the light seems to hit all the right places, a halo of some sort behind his husband. It takes approximately four minutes before Izuku finally notices and Katsuki grits his teeth, annoyed.

Deku:

<< *THE FUCK HAPPENED TO SIX??*
<< *weren't you going to play at six?*
<< *did you skip class deku?*
<< *HEY STOP STANDING AROUND*
>> It's a holiday, Kacchan www
>> I have no class and it finished installing so I thought I'd play for a bit.
>> You play during the morning without me? TT

Also…

>> Bad Kacchan!!

Katsuki's brain short-circuits.

Stream Chat:

>> [**nanami27 donated ¥12,000:** OMG WE SIMP]
>> His endearment is *Sweet Caring Husband* LOL. I can't with this Baku AHAHAHAHAHA
>> someone make a bad kacchan gif pls!!!

Your husband *Deku* is requesting a call.

"Fuck," he curses under his breath, rapidly sending a message saying, *i'm streaming right now.*

You received x100 angry emotes from Deku.

Deku:

>> Stream?
>> Ohhh HIIIII CHATTTTT

THIS DUMBASS.

Stream Chat:

>> OMG HE'S SO PRECIOUS
>> SWEET CARING HUSBAND??
>> HIS NICKNAME IS SWEET CARING HUSBAND REALLY BAKU!!!
>> who is kacchan? he doesn't mean katsuki right?
>> Noooooooooo answer his call!

A bunch of super chat then come flooding in, most of them demanding an open-mic.

>> [**atsui_fever donated ¥2,000:** bribe for open mic]
>> [**luffyta donated ¥800:** BRIBE]
>> [**Kamiyaaan donated ¥3,500:** OPEN MIC U COWARD!!]

"YOU AIN'T GONNA GET IT!"

Katsuki announces, leaning back his seat, a vein popping on the base of his neck.

"You're all wasting your fucking money. Don't expect anything. I'm about to end the stream,"

Deku:

>> Ahhh was that alright?
>> Did I log in at a wrong time?

And then –

>> I'm sorry if I disturbed you Kacchan.

Izuku apologizes because Katsuki hasn't replied.

He probably thinks that he pissed off the other even though he was just talking to chat for now.

A misunderstanding, really.

Steam Chat:

>> LOOK WHAT YOU DID BAKU
>> Apologize!
>> Bad Kacchan!!!!
>> Prayer circle for open mic (1)
>> Prayer circle for open mic (2)
>> [**junipaaaaaa donated ¥10,000:** DEKU PLS DON'T BE SAD]

"WHOSE FAULT DO YOU THINK THIS IS!?"

The blonde presses his lips into a thin line, gritting his teeth before he types.

Deku:

<< *it's fine. i was just talking to chat. it's none of their business.*

This seems to be some sort of miracle because according to his viewers he's never *this* nice. Katsuki begs to differ though because he always treats them well. On contrary, they're the ones becoming a bit too spoiled. They wouldn't be sticking around this long if they didn't like his content. Speaking of viewers… the number seems to have increased.

>> Ohh
>> Okay then Kacchan!

Deku sent you x100 loving emotes.

Katsuki closes his eyes, taking a deep breath.

Red eyes silently watch as Deku and Ground Zero run around Musutafu, the explosive hero trailing behind the other.

Stream Chat:

>> LOOK AT THAT FACE HAHAHAHAHA
>> He's so whipped LOL
>> Whipped (2)

He's not even paying attention to chat at this point, the light on his computer reflecting on his neutral expression. A bunch of other players has messaged him, other chat boxes filled with red numbers but only Deku's is open and pulled up so that he can reply immediately. This seems to be the most peaceful stream he's had so far because ten minutes in and he just *stops* talking. Oddly enough the numbers don't really decrease.

>> Is he a good player Baku?
>> What's his LVL?? Is he also maxed out??

"You guys don't know anything," is what he says, passive-aggressive bragging. "He's *my* partner."

More emphasis on the *my* rather than *partner.* Chat picks up on the cue of course.

>> Is this a game date?
>> please dungeon at least once please please please

Click. Click.

Deku:

>> Are you still streaming?

It's so bad he's reading the text using the other's voice.

<< *nn, chat's still here.*
<< *wanna go for a raid?*
<< *if you don't mind.*

Chat then erupts because *he said if you don't mind wwwwww*

>> Of course Kacchan!
>> Let's go play!!!

Katsuki's lips curl up into a grin before he sits up in his seat, ten minutes past his usual stream length.

"Look closely you extras!"

You and *Deku* entered a dungeon.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) PvP - there is a PvP tournament for world execute season 24.
(2) Super Chat - a method to donate money to a streamer.
(3) Dungeon - a place where you can raid to kill monsters, solo or by party.

i wanted to update earlier but school was a bit more hectic than usual. hopefully, i'd be able to update again by saturday or sunday this week. i just have to finish all my

laboratory experiments. anyway, there's a continuation for the stream. it was too long so i cut it into two parts. please do comment if you have any ideas, i'm starting to run out of 'em, not gonna lie. all these pharmaceutical terms are taking over my brain. anything would be appreciated!

a not so lucky hand's pull

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Call your husband *Deku?*

Chat coos at the words written on the screen, not letting anything slip by.

Katsuki ultimately ends up following what his viewers want and it's leaving a bitter taste in his mouth.

It's not because of them though. It's just that both he and Deku decided that it'll be more convenient to cooperate this way. Now that Izuku has his own pc and all, it's a bit redundant to still use the chatbox to talk. It's a waste of time and during a fight, they wouldn't be able to use it anyway. It's not like the audience would figure out much with just the other's voice as well. That one gamer, Eva, doesn't show her face on stream and there's no face claim up until now.

It also probably helps how a Japanese audience knows their limits. Generally, they're all law-abiding citizens here. If a leak does manage to get out though, they know that Katsuki would definitely be *furious*. Prior to this, he gave his viewers a long talk about how *stalking is gross, don't ever stalk people and I'm gonna fucking rip you to threads if you try to look into Deku.*

Loving Husband, indeed.

"Kacchaaaaaaaaan,"

Izuku draws out from the other side of the line – *sweet and gentle* – a good contrast to his partner's usual tone.

"Can you hear me, Kacchan?"

"I can hear you, shitty nerd," the blonde replies, voice lacking its usual harshness and bite.

From beside Ground Zero, Deku cheers.

Stream Chat:

>> IT'S REALLY HAPPENING OMG
>> aaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaa
>> Deku sounds hot though?? He's really male!
>> is it an older guy? He sounds like an older guy!
>> THEY'RE SO CUTE I CAN'T EVEN –

"Tell me if anyone bothers you,"

And by that he means *anyone*. If a *single* fan dares to pull something ridiculous, he announced that he'd *immediately* cut the stream, no questions asked. Other individuals getting involved in his business is annoying and he *hates* annoying. In the first place, Deku is someone he isn't supposed to share on the internet. The other might be fine with exposing his avatar but he's not. The last thing he wants is for Deku to pull back because of this fan issue.

"Are you going to scold them for me, Kacchan?"

Ahh, an angel.

"No, I'll fucking kill them,"

A demon?

>> HIEEEE NO PK! NO PK!
>> Everyone give them their privacy, okay?
>> anyone who attempts anything is cancelledt
>> keep your fangirling to a t pls everyone.
>> BAKUGO YOU'RE SCARING ME WITH THAT FACE!

Katsuki was staring dead at the camera, slowly dragging his thumb across his neck.

"That's not nice! You can't kill off anyone, Kacchan," everyone watches as the number one DPS player gets lectured live on stream. The blonde's frowning in real time but he's not saying anything or complaining. There's no *shut up, I'll do whatever that I want* that's happening and everyone finds it strange but endearing in a way. It looks like Katsuki's pouting almost. "This is why you're number four when it comes to PK!"

Shinsou told him, yes.

For some reason, that somehow pisses Katsuki so he goes, "The fuck!? Don't tell me what to do!"

Ahh… It's a little bit late but there it is.

What are you!? A domineering husband?

"If Kacchan agrees then I'll do you another favor," Izuku says, confident like he knows his method is going to work. Much to chat's surprise, it does seem to work because Katsuki looks like he's showing interest, narrowing his eyes at the screen and all. *"No threats to your viewers and you can't kill them today! It's because of them that you're successful you know. Kacchan should really treasure – "*

Red eyes slowly turn and glare at the camera while chat is basically having a field day.

>> GO MOM
>> DEKUMOM??
>> MAMA
>> his husband is against him HAHAHAHAHAHA
>> This guy really issued us a no kill pass for the day!

"What makes you think I'll agree to that!?" it should've made sense but it didn't because after that follows, "What kind of favor will you agree to?"

The other side remains silent for a while before Izuku says,

" I don't know. Maybe something like sending you another picture? Kacchan can decide."

He really didn't think this through.

Katsuki hums, leaning back his seat, considering his options. In the corner of his eye, chat explodes.

>> Picture? What picture??

>> NUDES!? DON'T TELL ME THEY'RE NUDES!?
>> yo, did we just hear something scandalous???
>> hmm… yes, give us more content.
>> BAKU WHAT ARE U MAKING HIM DO

The smug grin they receive makes everything worse.

Anyway, Ground Zero and Deku head towards Rasa Forest to challenge a well-known dungeon.

There are a few things that happen while they're walking.

"By the way, how'd you know that I was a streamer?"

Izuku didn't seem shocked about chat and all.

"Shi – Hmm… A friend told me, Kacchan," it was after Shinsou realized that he was married to Ground Zero in World Execute. Imagine his surprise when he found out that the other was actually very popular. He was a bit worried about it at first but after talking to Katsuki for a while, most of his worries had started to disappear. Also, it was fun to play with the other! *"You know who I'm talking about."*

"Ahh…" the blonde nods, remembering that purple avatar. "That guy."

"SMASH!"

You have received *2,782 EXP!*

Navigating through the forest is really troublesome with all these high-leveled monsters – not that they stand a chance against him and Deku. Also, the way they share experience points is quite convenient. It basically worked anywhere in World Execute, a cheat almost.

>> WHAT WAS THAT
>> oneeeee punchhhhhhhhh!!!!!
>> HE KILLED A TREEANT IN ONE PUNCH DAFUQQQQ
>> is deku a ranker? is he in the hundreds?
>> Not even phased smh

Katsuki's grin becomes wider, Ground Zero trailing after the other.

"You guys haven't even seen anything yet," he brags, smug and confident. "There's a reason I don't team up with extras," and when chat becomes curious, Ground Zero activates his skill calling out, "Oi Deku!"

The player turns around, eyes widening before he activates float –

"AP SHOT!"

— flies up, and then he *dodges.*

Katsuki snickers, pleased with his work, headset filled with Deku's upset voice screaming,

“What did I say about PK-ing me, Kacchan!?”

Deku **sent you x100 angry emotes.**

>> HE HAS TWO QUIRKS!? IS DEKU A UNIQUE CLASS!?
>> Strength enhancement and fly?
>> I think it’s float. Inaho also has float right?
>> fly can only be granted to those with wings… i think.
>> if they can both fly why are they walking???

Chat has a point. They can just fly over the forest and find the dungeon entrance.

That’s no fun though. They get more drop items this way, farming in a sense.

“I wasn’t going to kill you, I knew that you were going to dodge,” is what the blonde says to defend himself.

Deku **sent you x100 angry emotes.**

Ping!

New Record Set by
Ground Zero and Deku.
Time: 08:56:17

After they defeat the boss, chat becomes unreadable with the messages flooding in a bit too fast.

Katsuki leans back his seat and observes it all unfold, satisfied by what just happened. He has this big proud grin on his face and in his ear, Deku is happily cheering.

“How’s that?”

He asks his viewers as he clicks away on the screen. Ground Zero teleports back to Musutafu with Deku after they’ve claimed their rewards, the both of them storing rare items away. It’s not like they *need* these materials, they just challenge bosses for fun. Chat seems to be even more taken aback when they see the epic level drops lining up on his and Deku’s chests.

“Gamma Summit taken down by only two players, *hah,"*

>> SO IRRITATING WWW
>> Deku supports you well
>> good job baku!! good job deku!!
>> CAN WE TALK ABOUT MOTHER’S QUIRK EVERYONE!?
>> Ground Zero aside… WHAT ARE YOU DEKU??

“I don’t even need this shit. We have like 14 of the same thing,”

He drags his mouse across the rare items they have.

>> !!

>> STOP FLEXING YOUR COLLECTION
>> Baku let me remind you that you usually have bad luck
>> Why does he have 14 red fang!? Doesn't it have a 5% drop?
>> THIS GUY HAS THE ENTIRE GACHA IN HIS HOUSE

Katsuki blinks at the last comment before remembering something.

Speaking of gacha, "Oi, Deku! Let's use the tickets!"

Gamma Summit is one of the hardest dungeons to clear in World Execute. Many rate it five stars in difficulty, very hard to clear without a full party that is at least LVL.200 above. Many want to clear it because of the drops that the boss gives – Gamma gem, Magicite, Emperor Scale, Eye of the Hawk, and the one that all players *want.*

Gacha tickets.

World Execute, in a way to earn money aside from downloads, put up a Gacha system. There you can win limited edition outfits, weapons, and the like. Because the game is so popular now though – *and they have more than enough money* – to spice things up they've scattered golden gacha tickets throughout the map, tickets that summon *familiars.* You can't really use them in PvPs but because they are not actual players, they can be brought in a party without affecting the player limit. Many want it because of that.

The drop rate is very low though that's why it's difficult to get.

Nevertheless, because Deku and Ground Zero are married –

"What do we do with ten gacha tickets, Kacchan?"

– the accursed 10% loot bonus strikes back again.

"We use it that's what," the blonde rolls his eyes, stating the obvious. "Deku you pull."

Izuku makes a choked noise on the other side of the line, his avatar nervously receiving the tickets from Ground Zero. "Kacchan, do I pull one at a time or I pull all at once?"

>> ONE AT A TIME BECAUSE THE PERCENTAGE IS HIGHER THAT WAY
>> am i… am i really about to see a gacha pull?
>> lmao what if they're all dud wwwwwwww
>> DEKU PLS BE LUCKY!!! PLEASE BE LUCKY!!!!!
>> I HOPE WE GET AN S-FAMILIAR!! PLS BE A DRAGON!!

"Pull all at once,"

"Pull all at once!?" Izuku nervously gulps, holding up the tickets in his hand. *"Summon gacha!"*

On cue, a humungous *gachapon* shows up in their living room.

Kichaaaaaaa! It's here!

"Wha— What if I pull bad stuff, Kacchan?" Deku wobbles towards the other, his hands shaking. "*On second thought you pull!"*

"I don't want to," a petty excuse because in reality he also doesn't want to get blamed for shitty pulls. When he hears the other complain again, he cuts him off mid-sentence with a, "Did I fucking

stutter, nerd? You really wanna fight about this!?"

Izuku whimpers on the other side of the line saying, *"Hngh… No, Kacchan."*

>> prayer circle for dragon
>> prayer circle for dragon (2)
>> WHAT IF WE GET THE LEDGENDARY NEDZU!?!?!?
>> Baku the angle's kinda bad pls move aside we can't see
>> Why am I the one getting nervous? I can't even –

Ground Zero stands next to Deku as the other enters the tickets on the x10 slot.

There's only silence in the room, the gachapon making a weird happy sound.

Katakatakata – Ping!

>> IT'S WHITE OH NO IT'S A DUD
>> it's just the first one tho
>> nine more!
>> I hope they get at least one good one!
>> PLS BE A DRAGON

Katakatakata – Ping!
Katakatakata – Ping!
Katakatakata – Ping!
Katakatakata – Ping!
Katakatakata – Ping!
Katakatakata – Ping!
Katakatakata – Ping!
Katakatakata – Ping!

Katsuki's eyebrow twitches as he grabs the last ticket shouting, "How can your luck be this bad!? Give me that!"

Katakatakata – Ping!

>> OMG IT'S A GOLD
>> THE FUCK IS THAT AN SSR!?
>> Super super rare!?
>> NOT A RARE OR A SUPER RARE
>> BUT A SUPER SUPER RARE!?!?

"Ka-Kacchan!" Izuku happily exclaims, sounding like he's on the verge of crying. *"Let's open it – eh?"*

Red eyes dim at the image on the screen.

Usually, when you open gachas they shine and do sparkly things. After that, the item you get appear in front of you or in your inventory if they're too big. That's what happened to everything they've opened up until now. This one though…

This one has a piece of paper inside and on that piece of paper –

You can claim your children at Hosu Orphanage anytime.

Ground Zero and Deku exchange the same baffled looks.

Three seconds later, Katsuki screams, *"THE FUCK IS THIS SHIT!?"*

Stream Chat freezes due to too many messages.

Trending Worldwide:

#BakuDeku
107K Tweets

#TriggerAlbumRelease
87K Tweets

#WorldExecute
82K Tweets

#Deku
75K Tweets

"Deku,"

Izuku flinches on his seat when he hears Shinsou call for him from behind.

"Shinsou-kun!" Izuku complains, watching his friend settle down on the seat in front of him. "Don't call me that," the other lets out a short *heh* because *are you conscious about it now or what?* It's not exactly like that for Izuku though. The nickname just makes him nervous because of how popular it is now. He doesn't know how to not make it a big deal but it's kind of trending online? He knew that Kacchan was popular but uhh… Was World Execute always this big of a deal?

"Daily bribe for the husband," is what Shinsou says as he holds up his phone and takes a quick snap.

Izuku tries to glare but all he musters is a scowl, his friend grinning at the sentiment.

"You act as if you hate it but you're always letting me send the photo,"

It's been like that for a while, really.

"Sneakyzuku, you're not fooling anyone."

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Gacha - a game of luck that's borderline gambling. one may succumb to gacha like me, try to avoid gacha if you can.
(2) Gachapon - a vending machine where you pull your reward by random.
(3) Dragon - chat wants a dragon because dragons are rare and cool.
(4) Sneakyzuku - izuku has feelings but he's being sneaky about it. top!izuku tag exists for a reason.

that's gacha alright. random af.

what's with this terminology? it used to be so formal and informative and all, i wonder what happened. anyway, here's the accidental baby acquisition. they're married anyway meh. it's not that deep though, it's like yui, kirito and asuna's daughter in sao. they'll only be appearing every now then.

kota-kun and eri-chan

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Things have been quite hectic for Katsuki this past week.

Stream Chat:

>> So you didn't go to the orphanage with Deku yet TT
>> where are the babies?
>> DID YOU GET THEM BUT YOU DID NOT STREAM???
>> disappoint.
>> You doing us a big disappoint.

He should've expected this after ending his live with Izuku.

It's almost been a week and things still haven't calmed down. He'd even dare say that it got *worse*. Heck, there are a bunch of compilations and clips online, all from that one six-hour stream. The plan was to start at 8:30 and end by 11:00 but they somehow finished up at around one or two. Lunch that day completely flew over his head and no one in his team even bothered to call for him because *we were watching it on tv downstairs hahaha* says Kaminari with that grin on his face.

Those bastards…

Mina munching on her sandwich as she sends him a red super chat, sharing the link on her Twitter.

Those freaking bastards…

No wonder the view count was almost a hundred thousand.

It's not like the response was bad, it was good*, way* too good. None of it matters though because he knows that all it takes is for *one* fan to cross the line and all of this would be over. He's spent the past eight years standing by idly on pause for Deku and now that he's back, if that one fan manages to scare him off and make him disappear again – *help him*. Katsuki might just blow up six whole generations of that person's bloodline.

"You're overthinking this," is what Kirishima says.

Then again, the red-head shuts up and just awkwardly smiles when he sends him a glare.

What's worse is *management.* Freaking *management.*

"Nedzu wants you to collab with Deku again," the guy's not even a streamer, more or less a gamer. Katsuki hates this so he snarls *What? He* wants *to make money off him, you mean*. Aizawa sighs, feeling a headache approach before he replies with, "He says it's good PR."

PR for him and UA, that's what. Deku doesn't need PR.

"You alright, Kacchan?" Izuku's worried voice at eleven pm on speaker mode, Katsuki's face pressed against his pillow. Late-night calls are quite frequent nowadays and no one really says a thing. Is it casual? Is it romantic? Katsuki doesn't question it because whatever this is, he wants this to keep going. *"You've been quiet for quite a while now."*

They haven't even talked about it yet – the eight-year gap, he means.

Deku told his reasons and the entire issue's been brushed off since then but he hasn't told *his.*

Katsuki hasn't told Deku about *his* side.

"I'm sleepy,"

"Hmm…"

"What time are you online tomorrow?"

"I have work so maybe around seven,"

Katsuki nods saying, "Seven it is then."

And the cycle repeats.

Katsuki finds it funny how a person he hasn't met once is the first to notice.

Stream Chat:

>> you died again baku hahaha
>> Are we going to Mirage this time?
>> **midoriya_izuku07: You look tired. I hope you're not pushing yourself.**
>> Is it me or is the loot kinda bad? Three feathers? What?
>> it's literally a bad hand www

Red eyes glance at the chat following the name, lips pressed into a thin line.

"Deku!? The fuck!? Why are you here!?" is what he says due to surprise.

It's eleven am, don't you have class!?

Chat responds with –

>> DEKU!? WHERE??
>> where?
>> IS DEKU IN THE CHAT???
>> WHO??? DEKU??
>> haaaaaaaaaaaaaaaaa?

"Fucking bastard," Katsuki huffs, face turning red. It's embarrassing since he looked so sleepy earlier. Also, how long has he been here and since when!? *"DON'T WATCH MY STREAM SHITTY NERD!"*

It's safe to say that he became completely alert after that.

***Deku* sent you x100 loving emotes.**

"I was free this morning because our teacher had to go to a seminar," is the excuse he gets. Izuku was vacant so he pulled up the website Katsuki streamed on and decided to watch for a bit. *"I'm sorry, Kacchan,"* the other's avatar follows Ground Zero around, both of them walking around Musutafu. It almost looks like he's sulking which in this case, he's not. That's completely skewed from the truth. *"Kacchaaaaaaaaaaan."*

***Deku* sent you x100 loving emotes.**

"I had the time and I was curious as to what your stream looked like. It was my first time watching, I promise!"

Understandable, really.

"You looked very cute dozing off like that, hehehe,"

You inflicted 14,900 damage on *Deku.*

"AHHHH KACCHAN NO – "

Deku and Ground Zero are both sitting on a bench, Izuku's avatar crying while Katsuki wraps the other's arm with a bandage.

On-screen, the word *+2000 health* keeps repeating itself in green text above their heads.

"Hnghh… So mean Kacchan,"

"Shut the hell up, I'm patching you up, aren't I?"

If it weren't for the fact that Katsuki didn't have a revival root on hand, Deku would've died already. The damage was still present nevertheless. One attack from the number one DPS player ate about a quarter of his health. Over the mic Izuku was faking a cry, whining about how this wasn't right and how he was just trying to make the other feel better. Who would've known that it would backfire? He really let his guard down since he wasn't getting PK-ed by the other these days.

"You could've been nicer to me, Kacchan," Deku pouts, the other spamming A to heal. *"I was worried."*

"Hah? I'm nice enough to you shithead," is what Katsuki grumbles under his breath.

From behind the screen Izuku hums with a smile.

Anyway –

"Do you not want to claim the reward, Kacchan?" they've talked about this over the phone last night. It's almost been a week since they last pulled the gacha and they still haven't decided on what to do. It's a bit of a shame to just let it go. Golden tickets are very rare after all. *"Hosu*

Orphanage, I mean," referring to the place they were supposed to go, the address written on the paper.

"I have PvPs next week. I don't have time for children, Deku,"

Ah, that's right. Katsuki won his number one title in *that* tournament.

The other player blinks because, *"It might not be children?"*

"The word *children* was written on the paper, shitty nerd,"

Also, just to point out – not *child* but *children.* Plural.

"You think we can take care of kids!?"

Oddly enough, that option is available in World Execute. Since they're married it also most likely raised the probability on that draw. Apparently, children are the rarest types of familiar that show up in the gacha. It's not unusual to adopt or bear one but those from pulls are said to be extremely strong. I mean… they're designed after humans after all. Technically, they are more useful compared to some sort of unique monster that has a low cognitive ability and is not able to communicate.

Raise them well and you have another player with no party count! How convenient is that?

"Nn, I think we're ready for kids," Katsuki narrows his eyes at the screen, lips pressed into a thin line.

He then opens his mouth to say something but pauses for a while to close it again.

"Wha – "

It's kind of… Uhh… The topic's become kind of heavy for some reason!?

HE DOESN'T MEAN IT LIKE THAT YOU FUCKER!

Thank goodness he's not on stream and the other can't see him because his face is *red.*

"I mean… It's such a waste, Kacchan!" Izuku complains; his argument sound at first before it gradually turned worse with, *"I wanna have children too!"* With the limitless number of possibilities in the game, having a child is just another option. World Execute is basically a crossover of Harvest Moon and Rune Factory in steroids with a hint of Open-World on PC. *"Think about it, Kacchan! Don't you think it's time?"*

TIME FOR WHAT!?

Katsuki grits his teeth, running a hand over his face as he leans back on his seat.

"I can't look after a child," his inner-self screams because *that sounds so fucking realistic, it's just game!* "I don't like children, Deku," that might work better.

FUCK THIS.

It's just a game. It's just a game. It's just a game. It's just a game. It's just a –

"Even our child?"

Katsuki almost fucking *whines* when he hears that come out of Izuku's mouth.

"You won't like it even if it's ours, Kacchan?"

They end up heading to Hosu that day.

It's a cut scene.

"I hate heroes!"

This child…

"His parents are the Hero Duo Water Hose and they died on the job – "

Katsuki watches as the scene unfolds, Izuku sobbing in his ear, "You're really crying over an NPC!?"

"But Kacchan… It's so sad – " seriously, this guy can't do anything properly.

It's obvious how Izuku was already getting attached to this *Kouta* kid. Never mind his rare elemental quirk, Deku seems to be more interested in his *personal* story – the one written and made by programmers behind the desk. The only good thing about this situation is that the boy's age is six. Katsuki was more than ready to file a complaint if their reward turned out to be a newborn child.

When the cut scene ends, Ground Zero turns to the worker and asks, "Where's the other kid?"

Because clearly, there only seems to be only one child around.

On cue, a notification pulls up on both of their screens.

Ping!

> **[Hosu Orphanage Incident]**
> Difficulty: Rank S+
> Reward: Unknown.
>
> There have been multiple kidnapping incidents in the city lead by an infamous yakuza organization and Eri, a girl from Hosu Orphanage, is one of their most recent victims. Track down the syndicate to save her and figure out their intentions along the way.
>
> **[Accept]** **[Decline]**

"Kacchan?"

Izuku's gentle voice asks from the other side of the line. Katsuki already knows what he wants so ultimately, the final choice depends on him. Kota and Eri are definitely included in the rewards though. It might not be stated but they're from the gacha so it's a bit obvious. There might be more rewards as well but they don't know. They'll just have to wait and see, I guess.

"Kacchan, are you alright?" he worriedly asks when he hears no reply after a while.

“It’s an S-Rank quest…” the blonde shakily laughs, almost unbelieving of what he’s seeing.

“IT’S A FUCKING S-RANK QUEST, DEKU!”

GROUND ZERO @bkgkatsuki_official • 24 min ago
6:00 pm stream later with deku, extras!! *@herotube.yllbkdk*

Nonoha @ninenni_chi • 24 min ago
replying to *@bkgkatsuki_official*
ARE YOU GOING TO STREAM THE GACHA AFTERMATH!?

EHH NANI GA? @Kreactzyyy_ • 24 min ago
replying to *@bkgkatsuki_official*
Baku, pls no. I’m going to start expecting more collabs after this #bakudeku

i reincarnated as a slime @rimuru-sama • 24 min ago
replying to *@bkgkatsuki_official*
fumu. it looks like our agenda for today has already been decided.

Hot Coffee @Nesukapei • 24 min ago
replying to *@bkgkatsuki_official*
*slowly takes out wallet preparing for akasupa

Ei, tomaaaaareeeeee!! @stoppppu • 23 min ago
replying to *@bkgkatsuki_official*
FINALLY! I’VE BEEN WAITING FOR THIS ALL WEEK!!

Deku be damned, he’s not going to let this S-Ranked quest slide.

“You look excited, Kacchan,”

Running around their house, preparing gear and all.

“You’re the one that’s weird,” the blonde scoffs, following up his statement with a, “There are only twelve S-Ranked quests in the entire game. They are extremely rare.”

And they somehow managed to land on one? A hidden quest on top of that?

Izuku doesn’t understand but, *“Nn, we’re so lucky, Kacchan.”*

Stream Chat:

>> Deku that sounds so fake LOL
>> zero enthusiasm for the quest wwwww
>> He probably just wants to rescue Eri.

>> Baku who's the nerd now?????
>> aren't we too lucky these days? is this rigged?

"Are… Are you sure the yakuza are NPCs, Kacchan?"

Deku gulps, letting himself get dragged by the arm as he exits the door with the other.

You have activated One for All: Black Whip!

"Eri!" Deku shouts, extending his arms and quirk out to catch the young girl mid-air.

Katsuki's eyes widen as he stares at the screen, watching the sky get covered in black lines.

>> THE FUCK IS THAT!?
>> BAKU MOVE CHISAKI'S GONNA HIT DEKU HELP HIM
>> I thought Deku's quirk was muscle strengthening??
>> is he a unique? no way!!!
>> We can only see from Baku's screen so idk

Ping!

[Hosu Orphanage Incident]
Difficulty: Rank S+

You and Deku have successfully rescued Eri from Shie Hassaikai.
QUEST CLEARED!

[Claim rewards]

"Hey,"

Ground Zero looks back, noticing the small boy that's tugging on the edge of his gear.

"Thank you for saving Eri,"

In the corner of his eye, Eri is happily sitting on Izuku's lap.

Ping!

You and *Deku* have acquired *joint responsibility!*

Exclusive Raid Interface* registered as *daughter.

Kinect Online Technical Analog* registered as *son.

"Geez," the blonde sighs over the mic, Izuku fondly laughing as well. "We've got a bunch of

cheats, that’s what.”

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) S-Rank Quest - there are only a dozen quests known in world execute but nobody knows how many hidden quests there are. katsuki is excited because he's a nerd who always streams about those kinds of stuff.
(2) Herotube - the website where katsuki as well as other gamers like team ua stream.
(3) NPC - non-playable character or mob. not a player but a character inside the game.
(4) Eri - exclusive raid interface. has a time rewinding quirk, support character that can turn into a digital guide.
(5) Kota - kinect online technical analog. has a water quirk, support character with battle commands.

anyway, here's eri and kota. they're basically jarvis at this point or great sage from 'i reincarnated as a slime'. i said that deku and katsuki will meet at around chapter twelve and i'm regretting it at this point. they still have a lot of scenarios to go through. also, if you haven't noticed, deku's starting to make moves.

saturday pvp tournaments

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Team UA is *confused.*

“Are you sure you two are not dating!?”

Leave it up to Kaminari to voice out what everyone’s thinking. He might add trouble –*and may often be the cause of trouble* – but he can be quite useful sometimes. He’s quite handy during moments like these because they’ve been wondering for quite a while now and no one’s brave enough to confront their captain. Kirishima seems to know something but he won’t spill. Apparently, there’s some sort of drama involved? All they know is that Katsuki had been stood up by Deku before – judging by how he acted out during the tournament about three months ago.

“HOW MANY TIMES ARE YOU GOING TO ASK THAT!?”

Ah, there it is. This is why everyone’s hesitant to ask.

Mina snickers from her seat, Sero grinning and clicking away.

They’re in UA headquarters practicing for the upcoming PvP tournament which will be held in a few days. They would have been able to practice at home as well but Aizawa and the other staff members wanted to see their progress. There’s also the fact that they’ll be using this kind of set-up during the game, not their own customized one. It’ll be better for them to get their hands accustomed to the keyboard and the like, see what the format is like.

“Dude, we’re practicing and you’re literally with Deku right now – “ referring to Katsuki’s monitor where he and the other are currently farming for mana stones. It’s for Eri to ascend her level, it seems like. “You’re married, you call each other every single day and you have children following you around,” Eri and Kota trailing after the pair, Hipokute herbs in their arms for some sort of potion.

“Focus on your work, Bakugo,” is what Aizawa says with a sigh.

Sero laughs at that because, “He’s not even with us in this game. Who’s this random dude!?”

And the screen locks, everyone heading to their own lanes. Kaminari snickers before he leans back on his seat. Their teammate’s love life is quite interesting. They’ve known each other for a few years now but they don’t have that much information regarding his personal life aside from the basics. Also, it’s strange to see him so out of character. What’s the word that Mina used again? *Whipped?*

“Have you guys met before?” Mina curiously asks, glancing at her teammate. “With Deku, I mean.”

Katsuki clicks his tongue, annoyed at all the questions as he replies, “No we haven’t.”

Click. Click.

Ah, his mic is off. Is it because they’re around?

“Everyone thinks that he’s your lover in real life,”

“The fuck!? I just said that we weren’t dating!”

“Yet…” she grins, Katsuki glaring at her before he flips her off. “There are compilations of you two online!” if she had her way she’d sit them down for a thorough talk. Team UA often gets tagged with posts so she frequently comes across those kinds of videos. “Just ask him out! And bring him to the dorm so I can see him!”

“Not gonna happen,” unexpectedly, the other’s pretty calm. “Deku’s not gay. He’s straight,” that seems to make Mina back off a bit, the girl groaning before she sinks down her seat. If it’s like that then they can’t do anything. Sexuality is quite a sensitive topic after all.

It’s then a thought passes by, “Ehh? But what about you?”

They haven’t seen Katsuki show any interest to anyone other than Deku.

“Did you ask him?”

“Did he say that himself?”

“I’m pretty sure that wanting to have children with another man is pretty gay, Bakugo,”

“SHUT UP!” the blonde snaps, rage clicking his mouse. *“IT’S FUCKING DIFFERENT INSIDE THE GAME.”*

Yeah… because graduating students have that much free time in their hands to play World Execute?

Izuku seems to be spoiling Katsuki. Clearly, it’s difficult to allot time just for a game.

“That’s not what the fans think at least,” Mina says, shrugging her shoulders. She then turns to her friend to say, “Have you even seen the BakuDeku tag? If thousands of people think you’re dating then that’s probably a sign.”

It’s a sign.

Katsuki narrows his eyes at the screen, Eri and Kota cheerfully showing him what they’ve gathered.

It’s most definitely a sign.

“A PvP tournament this Saturday?”

Izuku blinks before he remembers *ahh, Kacchan did say that quite a while ago*. A few days have passed since then so he kind of forgot. The blonde then proceeds to spill a bunch of details over the phone saying things *like yeah, that’s why I won’t be able to play with you that day* and *probably Sunday as well because I have to work the entire day*. It’s a bit disappointing that they won’t get to play together this weekend but ohh well…

It can’t be helped if the other’s busy.

“Is it going to be streamed live?” because tournaments are popular right? “Can I watch?”

Katsuki remains silent on the other side of the line before he says, *“No…”*

“Ehh? Why!?”

Izuku didn’t think that he’d get rejected because streams are public, yes?

Technically, *anyone* can watch them!

“Are you still mad that I commented on your live, Kacchan?” he asked for permission because he didn’t want Katsuki to react like he did last time around. “I already apologized for that, didn’t I? So mean…” Izuku fakes a whimper, phone tucked between his ear and shoulder as he organized the files that Sorahiko-sensei asked him to do. He’s still at the university working but it isn’t rare for the both of them to call each other during random times of the day – except for class hours, at least.

“Tournaments are not that interesting, shitty nerd!”

“But didn’t you help me out a lot when I joined one?”

He was referring to the time he competed for the PC.

“Because you wanted to win the price,” Katsuki says, effectively defending himself. He didn’t spectate during Deku’s event as well, not that it was streamed or he would be able to. *“I’m going to win anyway. Those extras don’t stand a chance,”* if the results are set in stone then there’s no thrill. That’s the point he wants to get across. Why spend your time watching something when you already know the end result?

Go do something productive.

“Help the brats farm or something,”

Kota and Eri he means. Izuku hums in reply.

“Ah, that’s right. Eri-chan and Kota-kun still need to level up,” ascend their quirk mastery and all. They were looking for materials last time. Technically, since they’re familiars they still need the items. “Since Kacchan is going to win and is already maxed out, are you going to give them the hero crystal?” No question asked about the affiliate because both parents are heroes and on the side of light. It would actually be stranger if their children became villains.

“It’s only one hero crystal even if I win,”

It’s not like he can ask for the second and third place’s. It’s a common reward for the high rankers in the tournament but he wasn’t *that* desperate.

“Hmm… There are a ton of duo tournaments after the PvPs right?” but since there are two winners, it doesn’t affect the official rank list like the PvPs. It does raise one’s reputation nevertheless. Last year’s winners were Pinky and Crimson Riot – Katsuki’s teammates. “We can join one. We need two hero crystals anyway!”

The other line remains silent for a while, “Kacchan?”

“Duos? Yeah, we can fucking do that. It’s troublesome to come up with a name though,”

Izuku blinks because, “Ehhh? Don’t we already have a team name?”

“Hah?” Katsuki sounds confused. *“The fuck? What?”*

“BakuDeku?”

Katsuki hangs up.

It happens the day he’s streaming for the tournament and Katsuki is *horrified.*

Clearly, he has no idea that there are *special events* that happen when you’re registered as a parent for an NPC. Apparently, whenever you participate in a tournament and the like, they get all worried and stuff, cheering you on when you go because they’re programmed to think that their parent is heading to some sort of battleground. *Battleground* as a term doesn’t even sound that good. Eri had been anxious ever since he logged in, Kota as well, but hiding it in a much better manner compared to his sister.

“Dad!”

The cut scene activates the moment he steps into the arena.

Where did these two even come from!?

Apparently, he’s the only one with NPC children around here. Everyone’s single in the game.

>> DAD!?
>> IT’S ERI CHAN OMG WE HAVEN’T SEEN HER SINCE SHIE HASSAIKAI
>> kota u grumpy so cute wwwww
>> Look at Kota’s face omg that’s so like Baku hahaha I can’t
>> Baku set his nickname to Dad HAHAHAHA LOL

You can choose what name your children call you. They can even call you *father, papa*, heck *angel* or *master* if you really want to. They’re NPCs so it doesn’t matter. Red eyes widen at the screen when he sees the girl run towards Ground Zero with teary eyes, some sort of dramatic music playing in the background. Everyone’s staring at this point, it’s a *nightmare.*

“You’re not going to get hurt, aren’t you?”

Is it just him or does Eri have better graphics than others?

Katsuki scowls as he looks around because *the fuck is this!? Where’s Deku!?*

Ah, right. He didn’t log in because he wanted to focus on watching from his phone.

The shitty nerd is probably laughing right now.

>> HUG HER WTF
>> Bend down you dolt!!
>> Kota’s hat is so cute HAHAHAHA
>> THEY BOTH HAVE RED SHOES ON OMG
>> Is Deku also around?

Also, what is this!? He can't even come up with his own reply!?

(A) I'll make sure to come back safe.

(B) It's alright. Don't cry now.

(C) I love you and I promise not to die.

The fuck are these choices!?

Katsuki glares at the camera daring chat to say anything before he clicks A, the most tolerable of all the choices. Is this World Execute or some sort of dating simulator!? He can see Kota's teary glare from a few meters away from them, the boy frowning while Eri sobs near his knee. Ahh, he still needs to raise his relationship points with Kota. The boy is closer to Izuku than him. Actually, now that he thinks about it, both might be more attached to the other.

"Old man!" ah yes, Kota is an analog so he's not quite as obedient as Eri. He takes back what he said about NPCs following the name you set for yourself. Maybe it's a bug or Kota's just too smart of a cheat. "You better keep your promise."

What promise!? Is this supposed to be a touching scene?

Your reputation rose by *3,000* points.

"Huh?" Monoma just had to voice out, a strange intonation to how he speaks. "Is that sobbing little piglet your rumored daughter?"

Katsuki's hand on the mouse pauses, his co-worker's voice resounding in proximity chat.

>> HAH!?
>> CANCEL MONOMA!
>> rudeeeeeee! What piggy!?
>> Eri's an angel What the fuck!?
>> BEAT HIM UP BAKU!

Kota and Eri silently watch from the sidelines with Eraserhead as the preliminary match starts, their father a bit more fired up than usual.

A few hours pass and Ground Zero keeps his title as the number one player on the server.

"You signed us up for a duo tournament this Saturday!?"

Katsuki frowns, pulling the shirt over his head. Izuku's on speaker, as usual, the event finished.

"*Did you not want to join?"* the other asks to confirm. *"The reward's a hero crystal for Kota."*

Since Eri already has hers, the one he won yesterday.

"Nah, it's fine…" he plops down the bed, not particularly minding. "It's just a tournament anyway."

And he just won solo so how hard can it be?

It's the hardest thing Katsuki had ever participated in.

You sent *Deku* x100 angry emotes.

You sent *Deku* x100 angry emotes.

"Now, everyone write your answer on the whiteboard!"

Present Mic just had to be the MC, Ground Zero, and Deku sitting next to each other on stage with a bunch of other pairs. Someone's definitely streaming in the audience, showing the world what's happening. It's tournament week after all and since it's World Execute, per usual, the number of possibilities is unmeasurable. As expected of a game made by top programmers. Even these kinds of things exist, he should have known.

Out of all things, it's a *game show.*

"WHAT IS YOUR SPOUSE'S FAVORITE FOOD!? TIMER STARTS… NOOOOOOOOOOOOOOW!"

>> why are they here hahahaha
>> Isn't the reward the Best Couple title?
>> LMAO BAKU WHAT ARE YOU DOING!?
>> what is he writing that he's not even hesitating HAHAHAHA
>> Someone record this in case Baku strikes it down LOL

Ding! Ding! Ding! Ding!

"TIME'S UPPPPPPPPP! NOW, PARTICIPANTS. PLEASE STOP TYPING. LET'S START OFF WITH NAMIHARU –"

"…"

"…"

"…"

"BAKUDEKU!" Deku has a smile on his face as he turns to Ground Zero, Katsuki observing everything with a neutral expression. *"ANSWER REVEAL – "*

"Katsudon," he deadpans with his usual raspy voice.

"ARE YOU SURE OF YOUR ANSWER!?"

"It's gotta be freaking Katsudon," Katsuki is convinced because every time they talk in the evening and he asks what the other ate, Izuku always replies with the same boring answer. If it isn't his favorite food then he has some serious problems he needs to fix. "I will file a complaint if it isn't," Izuku awkwardly laughs over the mic, Katsuki confidently grinning in real life.

"Hmm… Confident aren't we, participant number 6!? For the answer Deku go *REVEAAAAAAL –* "

Katsudon.

Ping-pon! Ping-pon!

Chat happily cheers.

"How'd you know that it was my favorite?"

Izuku asks on the phone, his voice a bit low because he's tired and it's late.

"I had a hunch," is what Katsuki replies at first before he says, "You eat it all the fucking time, geez."

"Hmm…"

"Nn,"

"You pay attention to me quite a lot, Kacchan?" the other asks, Katsuki staring at his room's ceiling. *"You wouldn't have known if you didn't."*

There's silence for a long while but no one bothers to hang up before –

"Nn…" Katsuki nods at nobody, not bothering to deny anything. "I pay attention to you quite a lot."

Izuku laughs on the other side of the line, replying, *"I pay attention to you quite a lot as well."*

That night, the phone call seems to last a bit longer than usual.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Aizawa Shouta - the team manager and one of ua staff. also an overworked programmer and ranker in world execute. is a duo with present mic and works as a mod from time to time.
(2) Monoma Neito - ua affiliate but is not in the official team ua. team ua consists of the top five players in the company which are katsuki, kirishima, mina, sero and kaminari.
(3) Hero Crystal - used to ascend quirks up to level four.
(4) Game Show - izuku thought that it was the easiest route to gain the crystal.
(5) Farming - gathering a large amount of items in one sitting.

fast update, huh? their meeting is still far off. also, the eight-year gap talk isn't going to happen anytime soon. it's still a bit too early for that, i think. for timeline basis,

izuku first logged in during april and it's currently july. it's almost been three months since they started talking again. a hint of romance will start dropping here and there so do look forward to it!

banishments and flags

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

It's been about two weeks since they've gotten the children.

"That's not how you do it, Papa,"

Eri says with her soft gentle voice, tone akin to Izuku's.

They're in the middle of looking for materials and apparently, herbs would lose effectiveness if you pluck them wrong. The little girl seems to have noticed her father's constant mistakes, opting to make it her responsibility to kindly correct and monitor his work. It's good that she's being respectful about it but getting lessons from a six-year-old does a bit of damage to Izuku's pride. Anyway, Eri's cute so he'll let it slide for now. It's good to see her so active anyway. As expected of an S-Rank NPC with special mods.

"That's right, papa," Katsuki says over the mic, his avatar lounging to the side and not doing anything. "Do it properly, papa."

He can practically feel the smugness drip off the other's voice.

Izuku almost pouts before he realizes, *"You called me papa."*

Ka-chak!

"Ahhhhh – Kacchan! Kacchan, don't hang up, Kacchan!"

Ahh… He accepted the call request. *Phew.*

"It… It's fine, Deku!"

And here comes Kota not following the nicknames they've set. Really, what kind of NPC goes against his own programming? It's a bit strange. It's like he has his own mind or something. If it weren't for the fact that there were choices popping up from time to time, the pair would've assumed that they were actual players. Their setting was *that* advanced. It was a first for Katsuki so no wonder he called them a cheat.

Aside from their rare abilities, isn't their cognitive skill a bit too high!?

"Even if you mess up, Eri can just rewind it!" and he turns to his sister to loudly ask, "Right, Eri!?"

"That's right!"

Katsuki's eyebrow twitches because, "Is it alright to use your rewind quirk that casually, oi!?"

Izuku laughs on the other side of the line, Eri patting Deku's head as a way of consolation.

It’s a bit different these days.

“Deku’s not joining. You guys already saw him last week,”

Unexpectedly, the number of times Izuku appeared on his stream had increased. Despite his prior hesitance, the response they received seems to be more good than bad. There’s nothing strange popping up so far which is good. The other said that he doesn’t mind as well and Katsuki finds relief in the fact that it’s his monitor that chat sees, not the other way around. In this scenario, the only thing they’d find out about Deku is his voice and avatar unless he slips anything personal.

He’s warned Deku about *that.*

With how they reach about fifty thousand viewers per stream, Katsuki’s always on edge.

Then again, he can’t just tell the other to stop playing because of that fussy notification that pops up whenever the other’s online. Deku can play whenever he wants to and sometimes it just happens to be when Katsuki’s streaming as well. Chat gets too annoying during those instances and as much as he wants to hide the other, Deku just comes warping into his personal space.

Without even thinking twice, he accepts the call.

“DIDN’T YOU SAY SIX!?”

He can’t remember how many times they’ve had this conversation now.

Stream Chat:

>> Hi Dekuuuu!
>> he’s here hahaha deku’s always online during tuesdays lol
>> Maybe he doesn’t have work during Tuedays??
>> What kinda person has day offs during Tuesdays?
>> what if he’s a student though??

“Hi chat!” Izuku laughs, knowing that Katsuki’s angry rambling is more so directed to his viewers. “Can I join?”

“You can’t,” the blonde says, his face scowling on stream. “You’re spoiling them too much and the *goddAMN FUCKERS ARE GOING TO CLIP THIS SHIT. DO. NOT. FUCKING. CLIP. THIS. SHIT.”*

He’s seen those BakuDeku compilations online. They’re everywhere on his page because they tag him in it, they put hashtags, he’s involved in it and it’s fucking popular for some reason? HeroTube’s algorithm is broken because clearly, it’s not helping. He hopes that those get removed on the recommended page soon. They don’t need exposure or PR. Heck, they’re picking weeds and it has hundreds of thousands of views. Anyway, people seem to find this interesting?

They think they’re some sort of combo unit or something!?

“Aww, don’t be mean to chat, Kacchan,”

>> That’s right Kacchan!
>> Mama Deku
>> no, follow eri and say papa deku
>> Or daddy
>> #DADDY

Red eyes glare at the camera, Katsuki clicking a bunch of keys on his keyboard.

>> # -----
> call Deku ------
>> IT GOT BANNED HAHAHAHAHA
>> OMG HAHAHAHAHA HE KNOWS
>> BAKU FUCKING KNOWS WWWWWW

"Whatever," Katsuki huffs, obviously annoyed by the current development. "I'm streaming so bye."

"Bye,"

Katsuki frowns and narrows his eyes because, "No, what the fuck come back."

Izuku's laugh echoes in his ears before he asks, *"But didn't you just say bye?"*

A tick mark appears on the streamer's forehead, pissed.

"YOU'RE NOT SUPPOSED TO FUCKING LEAVE DUMBASS,"

>> how to deal with your tsundere husband
>> *Sigh* Baku… *Another sigh*
>> Happens all the time wwwwwwwww
>> SOMEONE CLIP THIS. HE'S WHIPPED HAHAHA
>> cause of death: didn't get attention for five minutes.

***Deku* sent you x100 loving emotes.**

"Someone go buy me coffee,"

Shinsou says, too lazy to move and do it himself. Also, he's seated on the inside next to Izuku so it's not like he can just stand up and head to the counter. Todoroki doesn't even look up from his plate and Iida's not around – he's usually in charge of these kinds of stuff. Uraraka… well, she also seems to be busy with eating for now. When no one replies for a while, the insomniac closes his eyes and starts to plead.

"Please, anyone… Please buy me coffee,"

He sounds so desperate his best friend slightly laughs.

"Alright, what do you want Shinsou-kun?" Izuku asks, standing up to do it himself.

"Black. No milk. No sugar,"

"Uwaa… That's scary," Uraraka comments, awkwardly laughing, and beside her Todoroki nods, scrolling through his phone. It's been a while since they've gotten together for breakfast. Everyone agreed to meet up since it's not like they have the energy to cook at home anyway. Unexpectedly, the first period is at ten so they still have quite a lot of time before that. "Is it your paper?" the thing that all graduating students have to do.

It’s a pain in the ass, really.

“It’s just the second chapter and I’m already dying,” Shinsou says it so casually but his eyes are telling a different story. They’re all taking up different courses related to law and criminology so everyone relates in a way. The only difference is that Shinsou’s teacher is *strict.* Very strict. “I should’ve enrolled earlier…” Kan-sensei is nice but his grading is pretty bad. Everyone’s nicknamed him *Blood King* because you’ll literally cry blood by the time you finish your work.

“Midoriya looks fine though…”

“He’s Midoriya,” Shinsou frowns, narrowing his eyes at his friend. “He writes thesis papers as a hobby.”

Now that they think about it, “Nn, papers are quite easy for Izukkun.”

“Sorahiko-sensei wouldn’t have personally taken him in if he wasn’t any good,” Todoroki adds.

“I heard from Ishiyama-sensei that Izukkun received an offer from TMPD,”

“Really?”

“It’s just July…”

Well, Izuku is good at fighting and he works well. Not to mention the fact that he’s on top of his batch and smart with a bunch of achievements to boost his back. Anyone would be lucky to have him on their team. There are quite a few bitter classmates that say it’s because he’s sucking up to the teachers but really, is it *that* easy? Their professors have master degrees and doctorates, you know.

Nevertheless, those rumors died down after *that* incident.

“Won’t he be very busy from now on?” Tokoroki asks, Shinsou nodding in the background.

“I just hope he doesn’t get injured again,”

Because if there’s one thing Uraraka’s noticed, it’s her friend’s self-sacrificial habits. Last year’s internships were a *mess.* It wasn’t a mess because things failed – it was a mess because although Izuku succeeded, he ended up staying in the hospital for two weeks straight. That event was the talk of the entire school for a while. It’s a good thing that Chiyo-sensei is affiliated with their school or else things would’ve taken a turn for worse.

“Did he get injured again?”

“A few bruises here and there but nah,” Shinsou’s been with him almost all the time. Practicals always go well but internships start in autumn so not much had happened yet. “I’m actually glad that he’s taken up a new hobby. He would’ve ended up overworking himself.”

Uraraka nods before she sighs in defeat.

“You’re looking at that photo again!?”

Kaminari exclaims, noticing the look on his teammate's face.

It's the photo Yummycat sent him a few days ago where Izuku was smiling, eyes bright. His attention is focused elsewhere but that simply adds to the charm. Everyone in his team had seen it at least once. They tend to look over his shoulder from time to time to catch a glimpse of private BakuDeku interactions. Whenever he's on his phone nowadays everyone just tends to assume that he's talking to the other.

No one gets to catch his attention as Deku does.

"Bro, just set it as your wallpaper if you like it that much,"

"The fuck!?" Katsuki frowns but he's not really mad. "Why would I set a guy's photo as my wallpaper?"

And replace All Might? *No way.*

Kaminari owlishly blinks before he shrugs his shoulders and says,

"I dunno? Don't you wanna set your boyfriend's image as your lock screen or something?"

That's normal right?

"No, that's not normal," *ahh, was he talking out loud?* "That's fucking creepy."

Before Kaminari opens his mouth to defend himself, Katsuki speaks again, "And how many times do I have to tell you that we're not dating!?" He then gets scolded for about three minutes straight, Chargebolt turning to his teammates with a look on his face that says *is it really that creepy?* Isn't that what lovers do though? He doesn't know what to think anymore.

Anyway –

"A party of six is needed to enter Kamino Ward, Baku,"

Mina starts off, not moving an inch from the couch. He knows what she's trying to do. It's already been decided that he'd go since he's a part of team UA. It's one of those streams where he has no choice but to go. As much as he hates parties, work is work and he has to be professional. Now that he thinks about it, five is already enough. It's that goddamned player limit. Kamino Ward has a locked count because of the storyline it has.

"Ask one of your shitty friends,"

"Aww, but they're all busy!"

"I don't care,"

"Can't you ask Deku to join? We're short on one person,"

"No," the answer is short and straight to the point, a grin on Mina's face. "Don't even think about it."

"Kaminari!" she calls and the other looks up from his phone. "You know Yummycat, right!?"

Mina laughs when she sees Katsuki glare at her from his seat.

"Okay chat, be nice!"

Stream Chat:

>> OMG IT'S BKDK
>> Pinky how??????
>> AAAAAAAAHHHHHHHHH
>> Is this why Baku's not streaming today?
>> Eri and Kota are also here wwwwwwwww

"Ah – Is it connected?"

"We can hear you loud and clear, bro!"

Kaminari cheerfully says, bright and energetic as his avatar rounds their guest for today. They're all not streaming except for Mina because it's her turn for team UA's collab. It's a way to boost views in a way because if everyone is on live, the number would be divided. It's much better if the audience is focused on one channel. The six-digit number on screen is a good indication that their plan is a success. Also, super chat! From time to time Mina would send a wink and thank those that donate, the others following in the background except for a seemingly grumpy captain.

"Sweet Caring Husband!" Sero snickers, Cellophane approaching the other. "The legend is here!"

If he could wrap his arm around the other he would've done so.

"Nice to meet you Deku! I'm Ashido Mina, Pinky's my user –"

"Can I add you as a friend? What's your user id –"

"Your quirk is so cool man! What's it called – "

"HEY!" Katsuki calls out, pissed at all the invasive questions. See? This is why he didn't want Deku here. What user id? So that all the extras can add him? They've already leaked that at the team tournament's stream and thankfully, those bothersome friend requests can be closed. As for his quirk, are they even ready to hear that this guy is All Might's successor? *"STOP. BOTHERING. HIM."*

His teammates owlishly blink before their snicker. Chat also coos.

"That's right!"

And here comes Kota with his glare. His strict father rates it a 4 out of 10 because it's about as intimidating as a newborn kitty's scowl. No one is threatened by it – Izuku finds it cute, Katsuki finds it amusing and Eri thinks it's not as intimidating as her dad's. Also, unexpectedly, he seems to resemble Katsuki more than he does Izuku personality-wise.

"Can't you see he's uncomfortable!?"

They don't really know how he can tell since it's just an avatar but… uhh… yeah?

"Ahh – Koucchan, no!" Eri's like Izuku in that regard – easily flustered, a bit shy, and extremely kind. Also, *nicknames.* The nicknames run in the blood. Or program in this case. She then slowly

turns to Ground Zero's teammates, nervously fidgeting in her place. "We'll be supporting everyone from the back. I can uhh… buy you time and Koucchan can help negate status effects since his quirk is an elemental type –" the muttering as well.

>> ERI CHAN OMSKJASKDJS
>> Kota he protecc
>> SO CUTE HNGGHHHHHHHH
>> Kota's like Bakugo LOL
>> MINA CALM DOWN CALM DOWN

The streamer guffaws, leaning back her seat with her hands wrapped around her stomach.

Plus Ultra Scans:

Two hours of team UA + BKDK + Eri and Kota content? Count me in! They were challenging the Kamino Quest (which took about ten minutes in total because they're all OP, ngl) and the rest were just absolute chaos HAHAHAHAHA. Mina might take down the video from her HeroTube archive so here's a full transcript of what happened in case you're curious. You'll also be able to find a few clips online, I think. Hopefully, UA doesn't strike them as copyright? Since team UA streams are usually just live exclusives. They've been quite lenient nowadays so hopefully not. Fingers crossed!

02:06 – Just the introduction and everyone's already teasing Baku HAHAHAHAHAHA

09:51 – Kiri and Kaminari flexing their new proto-gear from Hatsume industries.

18:19 – Bakugo's 10 minute rant warning everyone to not do anything weird.

24:33 – Finally Deku arrives! Chat goes berserk LOL. Also, *#EriAndKotaSupremacy.*

35:44 – Heading towards Kamino Ward. Jutten Forest has a lot of monsters.

56:12 – 120,000 yen super chat WTF JUST HOW RICH ARE YOU DUDE.

1:05:58 – CAN WE TALK ABOUT HOW BAKU AND DEKU TALK TO EACH OTHER OUTSIDE THE GAME??

1:10:45 – Bakugo desperately clarifying how the pictures Izuku sends aren't nudes HAHAHAHAHA

1:17:36 – Short Q&A. It's mostly BKDK questions, thanks Mina!

1:20:11 – Been happily married since 20XX awwww

1:29:42 – *"I ain't gonna divorce you, stupid,"* MY HEART UGHHHH IT'S PHYSICALLY HURTING

1:32:40 – *"Kacchan's the cutest when he's half-awake during calls in the morning, haha,"* STRIKE TWO

1:40:57 – Eri and Kota crab dance *@herotube.olkQVJy*

1:46:08 – Kamino Ward starts. They win obviously.

1:57:00 – AHHHH NICE SAVE KIRI!!!

2:04:19 – BAKU'S GETTING EXPOSED BY HIS TEAMMATES HAHAHAHA HE HAS PHOTOS LOL

2:12:36 – Deku promises to join Kaminari's Mario Kart Tournament. I'm marking it on my calendar.

2:19:14 – Me ugly crying because, *"Nn, Kacchan promised to play with me after this."* THAT VOICE IS JUST SO UNFAIR UGHH. IS IT JUST ME OR DOES THAT SOUND LEWD WHAT PLAY.

Anyway, this video will keep me sane for the next two weeks before I go diving into the BKDK fanfiction site again. Btw, if you have any good fanfic suggestions please do comment. The one I like is this one, *When You Read This by Naniwa.* It's good, very angsty, so check it out if you want. Plus Ultra everyone!

Katsuki narrows his eyes at the screen, clicking on the link attached.

When You Read This by Naniwa
ワールドスタート | World Execute (Video Game)
Content Rating: Explicit, Only for Adults, R18+
Pairing: Bakugo Katsuki / Ground Zero x Deku (World Execute)

Bakugo Katsuki has been dating Deku for a while now. It all started with a simple *hi* inside a game before short messages gradually turned into long night calls. One day, he gets into an accident and slips into a state of coma for eight years. Struggling to get his life back into track, his therapist suggests World Execute which has been newly patched for VR. After logging in again, Katsuki then finds the desperate messages of someone who has now disappeared from the grid.

With nothing but the name *Deku* as his clue, Katsuki starts to look for his long lost lover.

Click!

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Clip - when you take a part of someone's stream or video and post it online.
(2) TMPD - tokyo metropolitan police department.
(3) Crab Dance - eri and kota's dance that the viewers clipped and became viral. it's based on blackpink lisa's dance because the author thinks it's cute and very adorable.
(4) When You Read This by Naniwa - a popular fanfiction in their world. the trope is very cliche because izuku has a terminal illness and dies in the end.

casually changes the rating from T to M. also, thank you everyone for the nice comments! they really motivate me a lot. next chap will take a while since i have way too many quizzes hahaha.

breaking the fourth wall

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

It's a bit *peculiar.*

When You Read This by Naniwa, he means.

> "Ahhgg— hnn… *hah,* ahh – "
>
> Katsuki's fingers curl into the sheets as the other slowly sinks in, the heat filling up the base of his stomach. It's enough to make him spill tears; cheeks flushed as those large hands wander everywhere on his body, hips moving forward insisting Katsuki to take it all in. Red eyes flicker in and out of consciousness before they land on his lover – *Deku,* a thoroughly fucked expression on his face despite this being just the beginning.
>
> There's a lewd sound that fills the room when he starts to move, Katsuki shifting up and down on the bed.
>
> "Deku," he calls, head tilted back, throat exposed, marks marring his skin. "*Deku."*
>
> A pair of hands trail up his abdomen before they settle on his chest, kneading the soft fat underneath because he knows – this guy *knows.* A mewl makes it past his lips as he's toyed with and used, slick in between their thighs, his nipples hard and perky.
>
> "Kacchan likes being teased here…" a low hum, Deku harshly tugging. Katsuki's drooling and the worst part is that all he can do is obediently lie down and take it. "Like this…" as he cups both of the blonde's pecs, brushing his fingers against the nubs before he rubs down until the other's squirming. Nevertheless, he can't shift that much with his lover in between his legs.
>
> Katsuki's in a haze and amidst his moans he manages, "M'not… M'not a woman."
>
> "Nn…" Deku's lips curl up into a gentle smile, hips snapping forward harder. "Of course not, Kacchan."
>
> He doesn't sound convincing because after that he leans in for a kiss and says,
>
> "Spread your legs wider, will you?"

His eyebrow unconsciously twitches at the line, scrolling down the page with a frown.

First of all, the way they portray him is all *wrong.* He's not that –

"Haah… Ghnn— ah, ah, Deku –"

— he's not *that* shameless. Not that he is. They write him like he's some sort of slut for Deku's dick.

Also, why is *he* on the receiving end!? Shouldn't it be Deku who –

His mind flashes back to how Izuku's built, muscles filling up his police uniform, freckles across

his collarbones, cheeks and –

Anyway!

17:48 PM – Izuku's about to log-in now. Katsuki sits up on his bed, heading to sit down in front of the PC.

The work was tagged as angst and it had tons of good reviews so he had expected something along the lines of that. At first, he was just surfing through the net trying to see if some fucker was causing trouble for Deku before he ended up reading that thread and finding the link. Admittedly, he was bored and curious. He doesn't live under a rock so he knows what fanfiction is. It doesn't help how Mina's been tattling about those all day long. He's seen her giggling on the couch by herself.

Also, he didn't read nineteen chapters just to see himself act all bitchy.

He was reading it because he simply wanted to know the plot. It's about him and Deku after all but who knew that he was going to get fucked? Is that how those goddamn extras see him? Do they see him as a bratty whiny character? He's not.

He's not like that. Crying? *Hah.*

"Yeah right, I'm Ground Zero for fuck's sake,"

He's the number one DPS player with good looks and epic gaming skills to boot. He has a good built – six-feet tall and manly. Both genders come crawling on the floor just to ask for his number and he's alpha as fuck.

He's totally not the type to get dicked down.

He's not.

Apparently, he is.

Katsuki stares at the wall in front of him, seemingly in a daze with his hair sticking up in different places.

Beside his pillow is his phone with its seven am alarm on, still continuing to beep and he's not even paying attention to it. He's somewhere in between stunned and horrified because he can *feel* it. He doesn't even have the look down or lift the blanket to see. He can *feel* it. There's also the fact that this isn't the first dream he's had about Deku.

Ping!

Red eyes glance at his phone, noticing the familiar name pop-up.

Deku:

>> Morning sleepy head!
>> [**Photo attached:** A photo of a frying pan with eggs in it].

The blonde groans, plopping down on his back to stare at the ceiling.

He owlishly blinks once, *twice* before his face turns red.

"Kacchan's been acting weird nowadays,"

Izuku tattles off to his personal therapist, Shinsou.

They're both currently at the gym trying to get in shape because internships are about to start soon. It's also why he can't appear on Katsuki's morning streams from now on. He's back to gaming at six pm and perhaps even later than that because he would most likely have a lot of things to do. For now, this is his priority, it'll be bad if he gets a failing grade because he hasn't been working hard enough. Hopefully, Katsuki understands. The other gets upset – *Katsuki says mad but Izuku thinks he's sulking* – if he can't log in after all.

"What did Kacchan do?"

Shinsou is deadpan at this point because this isn't the first time they've talked about this.

He's some sort of double agent. He sends Ground Zero exclusive Deku photos and he gets paid through the game currency and he tells Izuku what happens to keep their friendship. It's a good deal, he thinks. Also, he favors Izuku more that's why he's doing this. As long as Ground Zero doesn't find out then he's safe… probably…

"He's been kinda quiet nowadays," and it's bothering him. "We still play together but…"

Ah, there it is.

Midoriya Izuku's depressed bunny look.

"It feels like he's avoiding me for some reason,"

Shinsou hums, remaining silent to think for a moment.

"Isn't that it?" referring to how Izuku's been kind of aggressive these days. He's not that creative or brave when it comes to romance in real life but he's able to do it because it's online. It feels less embarrassing that way. "It's working. Your *I want to get closer to Kacchan* plan I mean," thus the morning log-ins despite his very busy schedule. If it were Shinsou he'd probably spend it sleeping. University's very hectic after all.

"How is it working?" didn't he just say that he felt like Katsuki was avoiding him? "Isn't it the opposite, Shinsou-kun?"

He can't understand his friend's logic sometimes.

"It means he's conscious of you, stupid,"

Izuku tilts his head to the side, confused.

"Look," Shinsou sighs, placing his hand on the other's shoulder. "There's only one way to find out."

Katsuki is in the middle of a photoshoot when he sees the photo.

Deku:

>> You were right… I should stop eating Katsudon, Kacchan.
>> [**Photo attached:** A mirror photo of Izuku lifting his shirt to show his stomach.]

Peeking over his shoulder, Mina gasps in a scandalized manner.

“Oya!?” there’s a big grin on her face, leaning against their captain’s arm to look at the picture. “So it was true! He does send you nudes!” the popular online rumor, she means. It’s in almost every BakuDeku compilation there is. Katsuki sends her a glare and shushes her immediately because people are looking and everyone in the studio probably knows about Deku. It’s a shoot for an E-sports magazine after all and his husband’s been garnering quite the attention because of the mystery.

“NUDES? WHAT NUDES!?”

And here comes Kaminari, barging in after he’s heard the gossip.

It doesn’t take long before every Team UA member is looking at the pic, Katsuki sitting on a chair with his hands on his face, elbows on his knees. The number one player looks downright *miserable.*

“What Katsudon? Katsudon with those abs!?”

“HE’S MORE BUFF THAN KIRI YO –“

“Isn’t this dangerous? Baku, you sure you’re not getting scammed?”

“FUCK. MINA ZOOM IN! ARE THOSE FRECKLES ON – “

Katsuki stands up to snatch his phone, growling, “Back the fuck up.”

Sero and Kaminari snicker at his reaction and everyone else has this playful expression on their face, ready to tease the hell out of him.

“Aww, we were just looking at it, Baku! He’s yours!” Mina coos, patting him on the back.

Katsuki then glares but doesn’t say anything.

The first thing Katsuki notices is –

Fuck. Deku’s half-naked.

His eyes trail down his face to his neck, to that white shirt he’s pulling up and those abs that he –

Huh?

Red eyes narrow at the photo, zooming in at the base of Izuku's abdomen.

Kacchan:

>> you have scars all over your hands, the fuck!?

Hmm… Izuku wasn't expecting that reply.

He was expecting something along the lines of *why did you send me this!?* Or maybe something like *yeah, you should stop eating Katsudon* because that's who Katsuki is. If he's lucky he might even get a *send me another* because if Kacchan asked for a photo of him in his uniform then he'd certainly like it off. Izuku's dense but he's not *that* dense. That's basically a red sign waving at his face. Another shocking thing is that he actually *agreed* with it.

<< *Nn, I seem to get into fights quite a lot.*

It's part of his curriculum.

Criminology is not an easy course, you know.

>> and that's one nasty scar on your stomach.
>> well?
>> ????

Ah, that… Katsuki's waiting for him to explain. He knows that because of the tone he's using.

<< *I've been stabbed once or twice before.*
<< *They couldn't do anything about the scarring though.*
<< *Does it look bad Kacchan?*

His abs, he means.

He sent it for Katsuki to comment on his abs.

Please notice.

>> it looks like someone used a blunt knife on you wtf
>> what the fuck

Hmm… This is getting off track. It looks like he'll have to try again at a later date.

They spend the next ten minutes talking about Izuku's injuries before Katsuki has to get off his phone to resume his work. It doesn't end there nevertheless. He gets a *give me call later* as a follow-up text as well as *this conversation is not over yet, dumbass*. Izuku doesn't mind if others find out but it does slightly make him uncomfortable when they pry. It wasn't a good experience after all, not something he would willingly want to talk about. Oddly enough, he doesn't feel like that with the other. He feels pleased actually.

Kacchan seems worried…

A smile curls up on his lips.

That turned out better than expected.

It is safe to say that Katsuki's fantasies are *ruined* by that pic.

The fact that he doesn't know Deku that well dawns into him.

It's expected but it still makes a sickening feeling pool in the pit of his stomach. It's not anger, it's something else. It's all of those eight years condensed in one emotion because *this is so infuriating, what the fuck.* What on earth is he even feeling? He hates the fact that he doesn't know the backstory behind that scar. Hates the fact that although he did know that the other had injuries on his hands; didn't realize that they spanned up to his elbows, the marks very obvious. Izuku always wore long sleeves and jackets in his previous photos after all.

He knows that it couldn't be helped but it's still so *maddening.*

Also, that text –

Deku:

>> Got in a fight with a serial killer last year during my internships.
<< *dafuq? what serial killer*
>> Hmm… I dunno if Kacchan knows him but he's called Stain.
>> I happened to be interning near Nagoya.

Katsuki scowls, fingers typing away on his keyboard.

He doesn't know who the fuck that is.

Admittedly, the blonde doesn't watch the news that much or at all in that regard. His range spans from E-sports to gaming, that's it. He'd stumble upon one or two articles online if he's lucky but even then he doesn't open his social media often, only uses it to tweet about his schedule so that his viewers would know. He tries to avoid anything political due to obvious matters and even if it's trending, there's his lack of interest.

Ping!

Katsuki turns to look at his phone on his desk.

>> Can I still call?

Yeah, they should do that.

Shitty Deku is a much more reliable source.

Katsuki types *yes* before his attention returns back to the monitor; scrolling down on an article about the killer Stain. The words *Akaguro Chizome* and *48 victims* stand out quite a bit. They're hard to miss because they sound dreadful. It's a basic article covering the event but below under the suggested list is what's interesting. *A young hero from Kyushu University* and *Kyushu student saves the day* catches his attention. There's a hint of green on the thumbnail and all of a sudden

dread starts to form.

Surely not? Deku's not *that* dumb, is he?

Katsuki clicks on the article and his phone rings at the same time.

Weekly Japan News:

> **NAGOYA** – A 31 year old Japanese man who has been wanted since 20XX known for murder and homicide had been caught in a building attempting to kill prosecutor Nagao Yuuto. Akaguro Chizome, alias Stain, has been on the run for nine years with a total of 48 lives taken. Most, if not all of his victims, politicians and members of the Court of Justice have been exposed and charged with corruption either prior or after dying. In a previous hostage incident at Hosu, Stain said, *"I will purge society."* His ideology had been viewed as hypocritical by many but with footage uploaded on various platforms; a few Japanese citizens had started to take his side. On Friday, Nagoya District Head of Police had released a press statement announcing that the serial killer has finally been caught.
>
> Kyushu University student, **Midoriya Izuku,** age twenty two…

"You're fucking stupid,"

Izuku awkwardly laughs on the other side of the line.

"Hmm… I couldn't be helped," he says, a soft hum in his voice. *"There were children inside."*

— fifteen-year-old Kamisato Airi and Namikawa Yuta have replied with the following statements…

Katsuki sighs; wondering if the other's heroic or completely out of his mind.

"It's completely better now though," he tries to assure the other. *"Wanna see?"*

Katsuki *freezes* when he sees the photo.

That's not Deku's goddamn stomach…

It's angled from above, scarred fingers tugging at grey sweatpants to pull them down.

The scar on Izuku's right abdomen is as horrid as he's seen earlier but what he focuses on this time are the lines trailing down the other's crotch. That v-line is downright sinful and he can see the band of Deku's underwear. It's just enough to be decent but it definitely qualifies as rude. Surely, Izuku knows that this counts as teasing? His heart is beating so goddamn fast because that's a *horrible* angle for his sanity. Just a little lower and it's… it's…

Ping!

>> Like what you see Kacchan?

Katsuki’s face flushes, lips pressed into a thin line as his entire body shakes from anger,

“This… This fucking bastard!”

Alright. Is this how he’s going to play? Let’s go.

Let’s. Fucking. Go.

<< *fuck I don’t know. the angle’s bad.*
<< *i have better abs i think. i don’t have any shitty scars.*

A moment later he gets a reply,

>> Really?
>> Show me then.

Katsuki then proceeds to muffle a scream on his pillow.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Stain - serial killer that izuku caught. he's in jail right now and because of that, izuku has gained popularity among his teachers and peers. stain is quite well-known among their circle because of their course. the police has been searching for him for a very long time now.

also, a word from shinsou kun.
shinsou: i would like to clarify that getting stabbed is not part of our curriculum.

the next update will probably be late because it's exam week for me. i'll work on it after i finish my exams because i have a lot of free time after! as usual, thank you for reading. it'll get very steamy from now on. i have an entire draft planned out! they meet in... hmm... it comes up in a few chapters.

privileges of being a husband

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Uraraka owlishly blinks, noticing the state her friend is in.

"What's wrong, Izukkun?"

The other seems to be downcast, a bit too quiet than usual. He has his head resting on the table, eyes looking past the ceiling-high glass windows of the café and unto the street. Fukuoka during midday is a bit empty since everyone's either at school or at work. He and Uraraka are currently on a break, the both of them free from classes. On the other hand, their friends still had a bunch of stuff to do at the university, so it's just them for now.

"Hmm… It's nothing Uraraka-san,"

Uraraka awkwardly laughs because something definitely happened to make Izuku look like *that.*

Cool, looking quite unapproachable.

The total *I'm in a long-distance relationship with my lover and I don't know what to do* kind of vibe. Actually, it's a bit more than that. He looks *pained.* He has this faraway look in his eyes and he sighs like a shoujo manga character every few minutes or so. It's as if he's some sort of otome game capture target that has a hidden dark past. She can tell. Usually, that's Todoroki's role but it looks like he's taking his place for today.

"– handsome…"

"– think she's his… girlfriend?"

"– maybe… number…"

Uraraka presses her lips into a thin line because *I can hear you guys you know!*

Please recover soon, Izukkun!

That face has quite a destructive effect…

If this was Uraraka a few years ago she would've been offended but by now she's realized that it's just one of the perks of being acquainted with a good-looking person, *bunch* in this case. Izuku and Todoroki are quite self-explanatory, Iida's built is pretty good and he's smart; and Shinsou… Shinsou might deny it but he's quite popular with the girls. He thinks he hides his cat addiction pretty well but a few actually caught him petting a bunch of kittens behind the school. Everyone basically sees him as a secret capture target at this point.

What's this!? Some sort of shoujo manga? Calm down Uraraka Ochako!

"Is it…" it'll be a lie if she said that she wasn't interested. "Is it Ground Zero?"

She's seen the tags on Twitter, you know! Since Izuku is her friend it's automatic for her to become a fan.

"Wha – *How did you know!?"*

“Aha, your face kinda says it all,”

Green eyes dart around nervously before Izuku groans, freckled cheeks flushing red.

Cute.

“Please don’t tell anyone, Uraraka-san,”

“I won’t!” she pouts, a bit offended by what he just said. “You think I’ll tell others?”

“Ahh… it’s not like that! It’s – “ and then he rambles on and on, scared that she’s offended by his previous statement. It definitely wasn’t his intention. He’s just a bit worried. Izuku presses his lips into a thin line, gulping when he sees the expression on her face. She’s basically telling him *go on, go ahead. Tell me what happened*. The male shakily laughs before he says, “I uhh… Kacchan is mad at me right now.”

“Hmm? I didn’t quite catch that. What did you say, Izukkun?”

“I said…” scarred fingers fiddle with each other, the male heavily sighing. “Kacchan is mad at me right now.”

Katsuki scowls, glancing at the phone on his desk.

That bastard.

Stream Chat:

>> Baku stop being distracted.
>> I wanna see Eri-chan
>> let’s go to musutafu baku!!!
>> where’s deku it’s tuesday
>> I miss Eri-chan and Kotaaaaaaaaa!!

That fucking bastard!

“Give it up, you’re not going to see the brats today,” the last thing he wants is for his viewers to clip his stream and upload it somewhere. Usually, he doesn’t have any problem with that but nowadays they keep coming up with ridiculous titles like *Dadchuki* and it’s getting very annoying. It didn’t help how the cut scenes seem to be popping up more with how the children grow up. “No kids. No Deku.”

Speaking of Deku, did he mention how that jerk is a fucking bastard?

Yes? Well, he’ll say it again.

Deku is a fucking bastard.

>> ohhhhh is it a fight???
>> lover’s quarrel wwwwww
>> IS THIS THE TOURNAMENT PART TWO LOL
>> What did he do HAHAHAHAHA

>> It's probably Baku's fault tbh wwwww

"None of you guy's business,"

The blonde clicks his tongue as his avatar heads out to another city, trading the items he has for currency. It's ridiculous, really. He wonders if it even counts as a fight.

Shitty Deku is not texting me back!

And the worst part is that he's left his message on seen this morning! The nerve.

The fucking nerve!

"Just know that if you see him around make sure to tell me and beat his fucking ass," because who knows if Deku logs in during an earlier time. He hasn't done that before but Katsuki will definitely be irked if he does. That basically means that he's intentionally avoiding him. "You guys are allowed to PK him. Fucking camp the spawning site and cut him down."

>> SO PETTY HAHAHAHA
>> I don't think we can kill Deku tho
>> your husband is strong baku!!!
>> Don't wanna kill Deku he's nice
>> He's our ---- deku

Katsuki huffs before he clicks away on his mouse, red eyes glancing at his phone one last time.

The brunette gups as her eyes flicker back and forth from the photo and to Izuku.

"You send him uhh…"

"Shinsou-kun convinced me that it's a good idea,"

"It's your uhh… uhh…" her face was becoming redder by the second and she lowers the phone on the table to fan herself with her hand. Izuku's not naked, not quite. He's still wearing something and he has his pants on but still! Abs! V-line! Scarred hands with veins popping – *okay.* "No wonder he was flustered Izukkun. You shouldn't do that."

Green eyes owlishly blink because, "Why? He asks Shinsou for photos of me."

Oh dear God Shinsou-kun is in on this!?

"Still! You can't do that! He'll get flustered!"

As she scrolls down the sappy chain of messages, noticing how Katsuki was obviously panicking.

>> FUCK
>> YOU WANT ME TO SEND YOU WHAT
>> FUCK M
>> FUCK OFF

And then their conversation ends there, followed by a brief *you up, nerd* earlier this morning which

Izuku left on read in a fit of nervousness and embarrassment.

Are we just going to ignore *that!?* Yeah, Ground Zero definitely likes Izuku. Her eyes stare down at the third message wondering how that got past the number one student in Kyushu University. Izuku's pretty dense for being a renowned genius. Isn't breaking down information supposed to be his forte? That's literally his college degree!

"Does… Does he always talk to you like this?"

"Nn, Kacchan always talks down to me,"

Not like that! Like some sort of tsundere!

"Hmm… I'm going to apologize, I think," Izuku says, already having decided his main course of action. He'll log in at six later and properly state his piece. "I made him uncomfortable. It wasn't nice," Uraraka sweat drops because *no, he definitely liked it!* At least it seems like they'll be discussing it later. It's not unusual to send your husband photos anyway! Right? *Right!?*

"Wait, you guys are married but he's still flustered over that?"

Izuku dumbly nods saying, "Nn."

Your husband *Deku* is calling you.

Freaking finally.

"You're late," is how he greets the other, Ground Zero swinging at Deku's avatar. He doesn't do a lot of damage since he's not using his quirk and stat wise the other's physical defense is much higher than his. "Where were you this morning?" wait, that sounds like he's nagging – which in this case, he's *not* – so he changes it to, "You're supposed to be online during Tuesdays."

Izuku awkwardly laughs on the other side of the line, Deku showing a crying emote.

"I was at school, Kacchan. Sensei called me in early,"

Since although it's July, there's already paperwork for the internships in September. It's mostly student forms – where they'd like to train and if they have had received recommendations, things like that. It's usually done in advance because there's a lot of fourth-year students that go intern to different cities.

"I saw your text,"

"Yeah, and you didn't reply,"

"Nn… sorry,"

"Start speaking now or – "

"Papa!" Deku makes a startled expression when two figures come running towards him, embracing his lower half. Katsuki groans obviously annoyed, impatiently clicking away his mouse. "You're fifteen minutes late!" ah, Eri is accurate as ever. Kota's glaring and scowling but all he's clinging

unto his father's side, insistent on not letting go. It's cute how both are clingy towards Izuku, really.

"Oi!" Katsuki frowns, pulling them both by the scruff of their neck. "I'm talking to Deku."

"Gahh… Ground Zero!"

"Talking? About what dad?"

The blonde presses his lips into a thin line, not wanting to say it in front of the two. Clearly, it's an inappropriate topic for the children. He's not dumb.

Izuku seems to have noticed due to the silence so he goes, *"Ahh that's right! We're supposed to be hunting to level up, aren't we?"*

Eri and Kota's expressions light up in excitement.

"Sorry," the other says as they make their way out of the house. *"Let's talk about it later, Kacchan."*

Katsuki frowns.

It's *awkward.*

"Do we really have to kill the Obazard?"

Eri looks up at her parents, red eyes teary.

"Stop being such a weakling!" Kota huffs, approaching the cute crying monster they tied up. In the background, there's a high-pitched pathetic cry begging for its life. "It's a level twenty!"

The siblings then proceed to argue but in reality, it's more so Kota nagging at his soft-hearted sister.

Izuku awkwardly laughs at the sight, trying to calm the two. When it looks like none of his words seem to get through, he turns to look at his partner to ask for help. Unexpectedly, he gets no reply from the ever-so-active Ground Zero. The settings say that both of their mics are on but the avatar is unmoving, the university student a bit puzzled. *"Kacchan?"* Is he AFK perhaps? Maybe he went somewhere.

"What,"

"You're dozing off again,"

Ahh, it looks like he's here. It seems like he never left in the first place.

"Should we stop here for today? It's getting pretty late,"

"S'fine," Izuku can easily imagine the blonde shaking his head on the other side of the line. "We have to help the kids level up," because although their quirks are strong, they both barely have any battle experience. Luckily for them, one of their fathers is a ranker so low leveled areas where

weak monsters spawn is barely any effort. It's not the same for the young pair nevertheless, obvious by how they're fighting over whether to kill the monster or not.

"Really? You seem pretty quiet today,"

Katsuki takes a deep breath because *who's fucking fault do you think this is!?*

"We started off in this spot as well," referring to where they're currently standing in Musutafu Forest, Eri and Kota running off to the distance to hunt the low-leveled obazards and slimes. "*We met right here, huh?"* they were both about thirteen at that time, beginners in World Execute. Izuku remembers how they met because it was quite dramatic. *"Kacchan fell in the river,"* followed by a soft laugh.

Red eyes glare at the screen.

You sent *Deku* x100 angry emotes.

***Deku* sent you x100 loving emotes.**

"Stop being sentimental," Katsuki clicks his tongue but oddly enough, he can't bring himself to refute or get mad. "It's gross."

"Yes, Kacchan,"

***Deku* sent you x100 loving emotes.**

Katsuki feels like he wants to rip all his hair out because *why does this guy keep sending those kinds of emotes.* It's *killing* him.

"Hey, Deku," the blonde starts off, earning a hum from the other. "Aren't we going to talk – "

"AAAHHHHHHHHHH!"

"Papa!" Eri calls out from the distance. "Koucchan fell in the river!"

Izuku owlishly blinks before he laughs.

What a coincidence.

"Ahhh, you're soaking wet,"

Katsuki's lips curl into a frown.

"It's not my fault!" Kota refutes, scowling all the while his father dried him off. It would be bad if he got sick. In World Execute, familiars and avatars could experience illnesses due to changes in status and accumulation of fatigue – another feature of the game. The boy has a water quirk but that doesn't mean he's immune to colds. "It jumped into the river!" pointing to the monster in Eri's arms.

"Eri-chan, your dress is also soaked," Izuku awkwardly laughs, noticing the state his daughter is in. "*You should let it go now. Let's hunt again tomorrow."*

The young girl stares at him for a while before she pouts, “But it’s Wednesday tomorrow, papa.”

And Wednesdays mean that Izuku can’t play because of University.

It’s amazing how NPCs keep track of schedules and dates accurately. They even know this pattern.

“Ahh… err…” green eyes flicker back and forth, sending Ground Zero an SOS signal.

“And dad won’t play with us in the morning because he’s streaming!”

“That’s right! That’s right!”

“WHAT? WHO DO YOU THINK IS EARNING FOR THIS FAMILY YOU BRATS!?”

(A) I’ll make it up to you guys next time, okay?

(B) Stop crying and let’s go home!

(C) It can’t be helped.

Wow, it’s a cut scene.

It’s a bit odd with their daughter holding an Obazard but yeah…

“I’ll make it up to you guys next time, okay?” Deku pats both Eri and Kota on the shoulder. “*Say goodbye to your friend now.”*

The children exchange looks for a moment before the monster is lowered to the ground.

“Bye Gonzales…”

Gonzales!? They named it!?

“We’ll be back for you alright! Don’t get killed by hunters!”

As they head back to Musutafu, Katsuki sends Izuku a look which makes the other gulp.

It’s just a pc game, Izuku thinks. *It’s just a pc game, it’s just a pc game, it’s just a pc game –*

“Talk,”

Izuku unconsciously shrinks in his seat as he starts to nervously sweat.

Katsuki is scary when he uses that tone. Ground Zero and Deku are in the same space, yes, but that’s their avatars. Even through the mic, it’s clear that the other is pissed off. He can imagine the other crossing his arms above his chest and scowling, waiting for him to confess his sins. Talking about sins, is he about to get scolded for the photo? Or for not replying?

Anyway, *why is he so goddamn nervous!?*

He’s not your boyfriend or anything.

“I’ll… I’ll stop teasing Kacchan from now on,” he starts off and on the other side of the line, Katsuki freezes in his seat. He’s had this entire paragraph prepared since earlier so hopefully, he’ll be able to say it well. *“It’s clear that I made you uncomfortable by leading you on and baiting you to replying that way yesterday. I sincerely regret what I did and I admit that it was pretty bad. I shouldn’t have sent you a naked photo even if it was meant to show you my scar – “*

“What?”

“Eh?”

“Eh?”

“Eh?”

“What do you mean fucking *eh?”* Katsuki snaps annoyed at the fact that he’s wearing a headset right now. If this was over the phone he would’ve done much bolder gestures to express how triggered he currently is. “Wha – You were *teasing* me?” Him? Bakugo Katsuki? Being teased? *“THE FUCK DOES THAT MEAN,”* perhaps the term was a bit wrong. Surely Izuku meant something different. “*YOU WERE LEADING ME ON!?”* Izuku flinches at his volume.

“WHY THE FUCK WERE YOU LEADING ME ON!?”

And why did he, Bakugo Katsuki, willingly walk into it!?

He can still remember himself saying that he has better abs.

On the other side of the line, the blonde’s face is red, one hand covering his mouth.

Wow, this is confusing. Wait a second.

“Cause,” Izuku pouts, sounding a bit upset all of a sudden. *“I also want a photo.”*

That doesn’t change anything, Midoriya Izuku. That doesn’t fucking change anything.

“Explain why you want a goddamn photo,”

“I just want it,” is the reply that he gets. *“I just wanna see Kacchan.”*

Katsuki legit feels like his heart is about to leap out of his chest.

“I’m your husband. I can’t do that?”

Bakugo Katsuki ends up spoiling Izuku by the end of it all.

Deku:

>> Nn, still think mine are better.

That is what Izuku says to the mirror photo he sent.

<< *you’re training to be an officer. it’ll be goddamn disappointing if it isn’t.*

>> Nn
>> By the way Kacchan
<< *what*

What continues after that makes Katsuki scream.

>> Your nipples are pink www

“THE FUCK IS HAPPENING RIGHT NOW!?”

Mina, worried about the noise and concerned that an accident occurred, stumbles upon their team captain sitting on the bathroom tile, shirtless and flushed red up to the tips of his ears.

Katsuki thinks that Deku’s gotten worse during these past few days.

Do you send those kinds of photos to your friends?

No the fuck, not you don’t. I’ll kill him if he does.

Then again, he’s not a friend. He’s his husband.

Deku has to be interested.

He has to be.

But what if he’s not?

“This confusing motherfucker,” Katsuki curses under his breath as he leans back on his seat, one hand wrapped around his cock. He’s been at it for quite a while now, ever since he received that new photo actually. “Gonna pay for this –“ *after,* after he’s done with this. Red eyes shut close before he speeds up, soft pants filling the air. It’s late, half past midnight and his hips buckle as he releases in his hand. There’s a short groan that makes it past his lips, the monitor bright in front of him.

Katsuki twitches in the aftermath, sweat dripping down his chin and eyes in a daze.

Ping!

>> I don’t have scars over here.
>> [**Photo attached:** A close-up of Izuku’s freckled shoulders and collarbones, a glimpse of his neck and throat.]

Katsuki scowls because he can feel himself get hard again.

“This fucking nerd,” he plops his head on the desk, banging his forehead once, *twice.*

“This goddamn fucking nerd!”

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Spawning site - the place where dead players revive.
(2) Camp/Camping - the act of surrounding the spawning site and killing the spawning players so that they'll spawn over and over again. it's a form of gaming spam that is found annoying.
(3) Obazard - a small monster found in the musutafu forest. it's some sort of bunny, somewhat like izuku which is why kota and eri find it hard to kill. they come in different colors.
(4) Gonzales - the name of the obazard they found. it's colored green like izuku.
(5) July - current month. next month is august (they hold the festival during the first week. the one katsuki and izuku promised to go to eight years ago).

my exams are done now! i can go back to updating, thank you for the wait!

also, i keep getting reviews saying that i plagiarized this.
i have stated from chapter one that this story is based on and inspired by a novel named waiting for you online by xi he qing ling. the plot is identical because it is inspired by it, but the following events that unfold are by no form copy-pasted from the novel itself, it is my own creation. the summary is the only thing i took inspiration from because i thought it would be fun to write a bakudeku version. i'm quite fond of gaming aus so i thought that i could manage.
plus, it would be fun. this is just hobby.

being told that i'm plagiarizing drains my motivation to be honest.
i just wanted to clear things up. there are many that write fics inspired by other yaoi manga as well.
plagiarism is such a heavy term for me. before you proceed please check the notes. it's been there since day one.

anyway, i'll be updating again in a few days. i have an entire plot planned out so i can write smoothly at least.
thank you all for the nice reviews and the bookmarks! i really appreciate it!

half-asleep and half-awake

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Your daughter *Eri* has leveled up.

Your daughter *Eri* has leveled up.

Your son *Kota* has leveled up.

Your son *Kota* has leveled up.

"We're finally level twenty!" Kota exclaims, staring at his status board with sparkling eyes. He's quite excited about this because it took them quite a while to get to this stage. NPCs have a different system compared to actual players so it's definitely harder for them to raise their stats. "At this rate, we'll be reaching thirty soon, Eri!" to which his sister nods, just as thrilled.

Leveling up is like a rite of passage for NPCs.

Technically, because they're familiars, they can support their parents in a raid without having to worry about their level but skill-wise they could only use their quirk once or twice before. Because Bakugo and Izuku are good, just once is enough but Kota and Eri want to assist more than that.

[Rewind LVL. 5 to *LVL. 6*]

[Water Gun LVL. 6 to *LVL. 7*]

Katsuki has this smug grin on his face while Izuku just sheepishly laughs.

"You both did a good job," he bends down to pat their head and give them praises. They both look star-struck like they've just been awarded medals or something. *"It's very hard to raise quirk mastery past level 5,"* Izuku is still at four while Katsuki is maxed out per usual.

"It's fine, papa! We'll help you!"

"Oi, Katsuki! Why aren't you helping him!?"

"Shut up brat!" the blonde scolds, flicking the boy's forehead. "This guy's a special case. His quirk is so fucking random and it's difficult to raise! It's not my fault!" and he's been telling Deku to farm ever since he got black whip. That seems to have been delayed because of the children. "Unlike you both that only need items and training, his is triggered by specific situations. Right, Deku?"

He then turns to his husband as if to say *right? I'm fucking right, aren't I?*

"Well… it was raised by an item once,"

Katsuki can still remember that time they built the fucking windmill.

"But yeah… it's a bit complicated, Kacchan,"

There are instructions on his profile page and on his skill bar but –

One For All LVL. 4 to *LV. 5*

Conditions: Rescue 100 players at once.

What is that condition!? It's confusing.

How does he fulfill that!?

"Anyway, you don't have to worry about my skill Eri-chan, Kota-kun," Izuku says on the other side of the line, smiling at his monitor. The pair exchange glances to each other for a moment before Deku's avatar sends them a bunch of emotes. *"Kacchan will help me level up."*

"That's right," Katsuki's grinning, Ground Zero looking smug as ever. "Leave the carry to the pro you goddamn brats."

Eri owlishly blinks while Kota turns red because *I can help Deku as well!*

Kota and Ground Zero argue for a while after that before they're cut off by the others.

"Oi," Katsuki calls out as they head back to Musutafu, Eri, and Kota running off to the distance. "Is it still *that* after this?" Deku pauses on his tracks, the scene seemingly looking like a cut scene.

By *that* he means…

"Hmm… of course, Kacchan," Izuku sounds like he's enjoying this. *"You also have to do your part though."*

Katsuki remains silent on the other side of the line, flushed up to the tip of his ears.

Ping!

Deku:

>> [**Video attached:** A short clip of Izuku raising his shirt, the frame cut off just below his chin.]

Stream Chat:

>> Wow Baku you're really lacking sleep
>> Look at those bags wwwww
>> were you playing all night long again
>> Are you joining autumn tournament??
>> Did you play with Deku off cam LOL

True, there were bags under his eyes.

It’s not that bad but because Bakugo Katsuki is always known to be in top shape while he streams, his viewers easily notice. It doesn’t help how a good amount of females are always in his audience, gushing about the state of his skin or whatnot. It’s definitely noticeable if you’re an avid fan of his which in this case, he has one of the most loyal fan bases.

“Yeah, didn’t get sleep last night. I was up,”

To which everyone is shocked because.

>> Don’t you usually go to sleep at eight?
>> you were up!? whyyy?
>> LOL WHAT IS HAPPENING
>> I bet it’s Deku
>> Yeah it’s gotta be Deku this is the power of love

Katsuki clicks his tongue, unable to refute because it is indeed goddamn Deku. Is he that obvious?

“It’s not shitty Deku,” he lies through his teeth but no one is convinced. Clicking away on his mouse, Ground Zero runs around the screen before he pauses to read the chat one more time. “I just couldn’t fucking sleep. Don’t make this dramatic,” he’s seen those drama channels and those channels that clip things and add funny text. Apparently, everyone thinks that he goes to sleep at eight because he doesn’t attend Kaminari’s Late Night Team UA streams.

Is it really that serious!? I just don’t want to fucking play!

But it’s alright if it’s Deku?

Katsuki’s hand pauses in realization, chat going off because of his expression.

>> WHAT. WHAT IS IT
>> why does he look like that wwww
>> STOP SCARING ME BAKU
>> I told you it’s the power of love
>> PRAYER CIRCLE QUICK

The stream is silent for a good minute and a half, the blonde just sitting there and staring at the screen.

No… that’s not it.

That’s not fucking it.

Ping!

Kacchan:

>> [**Photo attached:** A mirror photo of Katsuki shirtless at the gym.]
>> prepare yourself shitty deku.

“You’re always texting them and you want to see them,”

Mina sounds out what’s written on the magazine.

“You like making them smile and you end up agreeing to everything,”

Kaminari nods, arms crossed above his chest.

“That’s gotta be love,” is what she concludes, teasingly grinning at her friend.

Katsuki then snaps saying, *“HOW MANY TIMES DO I HAVE TO TELL YOU IT’S NOT!?”*

Mina and Kaminari blink at each other, confused.

“I was talking about Jirou and Kami though?”

The blonde frowns and everyone’s silent for a moment before Mina and Kaminari get up on their seats, screeching.

“Fuck,”

Kaminari gulps after listening to what their team captain just said. Basically, because he found them annoying, he ended up spilling information just to satisfy their curiosity. He didn’t tell them anything beyond the lines of *I get fucking pissed off if Deku doesn’t play with me* nevertheless. No one has to know what happens behind the scenes. Nope — *over his dead body.* They already know that he’s been waiting around so this much is not a big deal.

Even Mina is impressed because, “That’s some next-level fanfiction shit you’re living.”

What’s this!? Some sort of teenage shoujo manga rom-com!?

Speaking of fanfics –

“Have you read the story I sent you?” referring to the links she sends Katsuki on Line. Usually, he just leaves those on seen. Just like that, Katsuki’s dilemma is swept under the rug because *yeah, we’ll just pretend we didn’t already notice that.* Anyone with eyes can tell that the pair is basically dating at this point. “You should read those. They’re fun. Appreciate your fans’ hard work and all.”

Kaminari nods again, saying, “Yeah. I haven’t read fanfiction but out of all streamers you probably have the best fan art, bro.” Even he appreciates those. And he’s not even understating things – Katsuki’s fans are hella good. “You should pull up Twitter from time to time. They draw you and Deku quite a lot.”

Ground Zero and Deku, he means.

“I won’t read it,” he’s read fanfiction before and it was creative and all but he didn’t particularly like it. *When You Read This* by *Naniwa* is way too dramatic for him. Also, it’s kind of creepy how

it hits true to life – the not seeing each other for years and waiting around shit. “You know how disgusting it is to read about yourself? I don’t want to know about my fans’ kinks and shit.”

Kaminari looks dejected because, “Just give it a try Bakubro.”

Mina on the other hand blinks, “You’ve read it?”

“No the fuck I haven’t,”

“You’ve definitely read it!” she’s convinced that she’s right. “How do you know about the kinks then!?”

“I SAID I HAVEN’T READ IT!”

He’s on chapter seventeen of *There’s no way my husband is this cute!*

At first, he was put off by the ridiculously sappy title but after giving it a chance, it had started to grow on him.

Currently, he’s halfway through the entire story and there’s no sex so far which is good. He’s still a bit wary though because of the rating. He just doesn’t like it when people fantasize about individuals that exist in real life. It’s one thing if it’s a movie character or some shit but he’s *real.* It’s creepy and disgusting. That should be the case so why?

WHY AM I STILL READING THIS!?

There’s no way my husband is this cute! is a rather fun and carefree fic about Deku and Ground Zero being domestic. Deku has a sweet and slightly submissive personality – nothing like the horrible, torturous, incubus that he is in real life. It’s probably why he likes this fic better than the ones he’s read previously. He just hates it when he’s portrayed as this shitty, soft, *I’m whipped for Deku* kind of person in general. He’s not like that.

Anyway, the fic was good until it reached chapter twenty.

> “I’ll just go find someone then,” Deku says, green eyes glassy with tears. “I’ll find a husband that treats me better than you do.”

THE FUCK!?

Well, yeah, the plot was too good to be true and it was leading up to that but –

THE FUCK!?

No wonder it was added to a compilation called *Tear Jerker.* There were hundreds of comments under the chapter as well, all of them crying and complaining about the current development.

An hour later, Katsuki finishes reading the entire story.

It's *official.*

> "Just this once," Deku wraps his arms around Katsuki's shoulders, leaning in for a kiss. "After this and we're done. We're done, Kacchan."

He's hooked.

He's hooked but it feels *horrible.*

The ending sucked but he could see why the readers liked it. He ended up crying by the time he finished all thirty-two chapters and he's currently lying down on his bed, face pressed against the pillow, in a daze. He has no energy to read another story, feels like he's just been drained of his entire energy. Is literature supposed to affect you this much? He can kind of see where Mina's coming from now. Why are his fans stuck in that shitty website instead of getting a job as I dunno… an author or something? Their work is good enough.

It's just four o'clock, two hours till six. *I'll just close my eyes for a bit.*

Because they hurt from crying and they're rimmed red.

It doesn't take long before Katsuki falls asleep.

> "Kacchan —"
>
> Katsuki looks up to see Deku's figure above him, extending out his hand to caress his cheek.
>
> The other is in between his legs and the blonde can *feel* him, impossibly deep as his mouth gets pried open, tongue brushing against his.
>
> The other's hands roam everywhere – on his hips, his thighs, his waist, and on his chest. One hand ends up settling on his cock, Deku playing with him until he arches his back and releases. It's tortuous in a way but all he can do is lie down and take it. He's under this person's mercy, his legs spread impossibly wide in a lewd manner, a slick sound filling up the room.
>
> "Taking me in so well, Kacchan," the larger male hums, their pace enough to have the blonde shifting up and down on the bed.
>
> "I don't think you'll be able to do it normally again with a body as lewd as this,"
>
> He presses his hand against Katsuki's abdomen, both their hips spasming as he fills him up.
>
> "De—kughh—" Red eyes shut close, tears spilling down as the other moves to make him take it in deeper, feeling the warmth in his stomach.
>
> "Ah… hah— *hahh—*"
>
> Izuku then leans over to kiss him on his throat, marks littered on his skin. It doesn't end there nevertheless because the other starts to move slowly again, Katsuki gritting his teeth to contain his moans.
>
> "Don't break up with me, goddammit," he manages to choke out after a while, glaring

at the other through teary eyes.

All he gets is silence and an affectionate kiss in response.

Thank you for leaving kudos!

It's six-twenty and Katsuki is woken up by a call.

"Are you sick, Kacchan?"

"M'not," his eyelashes are heavy and damp, voice muffled because he has his face pressed against his pillow. His phone is somewhere off to the side where his hand can reach and he has Izuku on speaker. It's more comfortable that way, likes hearing Deku's voice that way. The blonde sniffles once, *twice* and it's enough to make the other a bit concerned.

Katsuki on the other hand is still comfortable in his bed, unaware of what is happening.

"Are you crying?"

"Fuck off,"

Followed by silence because Izuku is *confused.*

"We already broke up," is what he says in a daze. "Stop calling me."

No reply.

"Wha – " Izuku opens his mouth to speak but is a bit taken aback before he promptly recovers, laughing and softly saying, *"Hmm… We didn't break up Kacchan."*

"What an absolute liar," he scoffs, eyes still closed. "You're an asshole who only likes my body."

"Are you drunk?"

"Fuck off," he growls, repeating, "Fuck off. Fuck off. Fuck off."

Izuku thinks he's drunk and it's just six pm.

"I don't know what this is about," Izuku leans back in his seat, wondering what was happening. Anyway, he feels a bit pleased to see this side of Katsuki. He's never seen him like this before. *"All I can tell you is that we didn't break up,"* Nn, the best course of action here is to play along. He finds him adorable right now. *"Kacchan is still my husband. We have Eri-chan and Kota-kun together,"* when he doesn't hear a reply he continues with, *"I'll never break up with you."* Or divorce in this case.

"Really?"

"Really,"

"Hmm… okay,"

“I’m glad that got through,”

Izuku laughs before he remembers and asks,

“Now tell me about me being an asshole who only likes you for your body. Where’d that come from, Kacchan?”

“And in the story we… slept together?”

Izuku sounds like his breath had been knocked out of his chest after hearing the explanation. He never imagined the blonde to be interested in those kinds of things. It’s not that it’s bad, it’s just unexpected. Katsuki had shown interest before but it was never anything… sexual. And here he is thinking that he was starting to overstep boundaries. Maybe he’s slower than he expected actually.

Gulping, Izuku takes the courage and asks, *“Hmm… what exactly did I do to Kacchan?”*

All the while pulling up the said topic on his computer for better reference.

“Deku – “

Katsuki flushes, eyes shut close, voice muffled by the pillow.

He has one hand inside his pants and boxers, still seemingly in a daze.

“Ahh, Kacchan you’re bad,” Izuku says on the other side of the line, encouraging the blonde’s moans. He’s in the same state as the other, leaning back his seat with his underwear pulled down, phone on loudspeaker on his desk. *“Tell me where you like it,”* there’s sweat dripping down his chin, green eyes half-lidded with lust.

“Deku – “ Katsuki calls out, voice a bit more raspy than usual. “Make me cum –“

Izuku curses under his breath.

It’s nine pm when Katsuki fully wakes up.

He stares down at his bed, noticing the state it’s in.

His bedsheets are a mess and his thighs are wet – although it's not that unusual during these past few days. What’s unusual on the other hand is his phone showing Deku’s phone number, the call length 3:42:01, and still counting. It basically means that they were on call for almost four hours. Katsuki silently sits up with the device on hand, confused as fuck. Izuku seems to have noticed him

shifting because the keyboard clicking pauses all of a sudden.

“Kacchan?” comes the soft voice from the other side of the line. *“Are you awake now?”*

Katsuki owlishly blinks before realization sinks in.

“Wha – “

He then flushes and starts to exclaim the dirtiest set of curse words he knows.

Izuku fondly laughs in response.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) There’s No Way My Husband Is This Cute! - a tear jerker cloaked under fluff, do not be fooled.
(2) One For All LVL. 4 - deku gains a level every time he gains a quirk.

quick update! things are progressing smoothly. i love giving second-hand embarrassment lol.
and yes, they did that on the phone hahaha. inspired by that one time i fell asleep at four pm and woke up at five pm. i legit thought an entire day passed and messaged my teachers apologizing for the quiz i missed. turns out the quiz is still tomorrow.

eight year delayed promise

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Izuku spends an entire hour coaxing his husband.

“It’s fine, Kacchaaan,” he extends his tone out as if he’s talking to Eri and Kota.

“No it’s not fine! We just… we just –“

If Izuku could see his face now he’d definitely notice how red he currently is. Katsuki is lying down on his bed, face down and completely humiliated. He’s never been *this* embarrassed his entire life. It’s a first and it just had to be with Deku out of all people. The worst part is that he can remember most of the things he was saying. He wasn’t asleep but he wasn’t quite awake. Perhaps he was too out of it since he’s been having dreams about the other recently but still – *fuck,* Deku *knows* that he’s fantasizing about him.

It’s not just one issue, it’s *multiple.*

“I couldn’t actually see you know,”

A bit sad in a way but relieving on Katsuki’s end.

“And if it makes you feel better I was also turned on so...”

Izuku awkwardly laughs at himself and Katsuki wants to cut his own arm off because goddamn Midoriya Izuku just admitted that. Another downside to this situation is that he was so focused on himself and his fantasies that he didn’t pay attention to Deku. Now he can’t remember how the other reacted. *The fuck!?* What did he act like!? A once in a lifetime opportunity and he can’t fucking remember! Where’s Eri’s rewind quirk when he needs it!?

“Are you… Are you embarrassed because it was your first time?”

“Hah? Who do you think I am? Of course not – “

A complete utter lie. Bakugo Katsuki lying through his teeth.

“Have *you* done that before?”

Is what he comes up with as a snarky reply.

Izuku softly hums on the phone before he says, “Of course I have. I’m twenty-three, Kacchan.”

Of course he hasn’t – *huh?*

What the fuck that kinda pisses me off.

“Oh, I see,” Katsuki scoffs, sitting up on his bed all of a sudden. He feels *wronged,* feels like he’s just been cheated on, and had just recently spotted his long-lost husband with a woman whose name he doesn’t know. It felt like Pride and Prejudice all over again. “No wonder you play around so fucking much. I fucking see,” he scowls because he can hear the other laughing on the other side of the line and it goddamn pisses him off. “You think this is funny, shitty Deku? For all I know you probably have a girlfriend right now!”

There's more laughter, Izuku wiping away his tears before he says, *"I was joking, Kacchan."*

The blonde is still frowning, *unconvinced.*

"And I don't have a girlfriend. Never had one actually,"

That sounds too good to be true and Katsuki doesn't want to believe that because he's seen how Deku looks. Even Yummycat says that he's popular at university. He's kind, good looking, smart and he'd definitely be sweet to whoever he'd –

"You don't have to worry about it, Kacchan,"

Katsuki freezes, blinking for a moment before he flushes red.

"THE FUCK DO YOU MEAN BY THAT!?"

Izuku continues to laugh.

They have their finals next week and Shinsou is on a boundary.

The boundary they call life and death.

That much coffee can't possibly be healthy.

"You're so annoying," is what he says as he stares at his best friend's face, watching him happily type away on his phone. He doesn't even have to ask who he's texting. It's most likely the same answer. Beside him, Uraraka is nodding off, a pen in her hand. They're in a café because they serve food and drinks here. Plus, they're university students so that's the vibe they're going for. "You're so annoying," he repeats just in case the other didn't hear.

Izuku looks up from the device before he sheepishly laughs, "Sorry, which part were you on?"

Often times he has to ask for help. Shinsou frowns as he points at a section on the book, the other chattering away to explain.

"So?"

"It means that a portion of the costs of a program funded by a grant under this section may not exceed seventy-five percent,"

"That's not what I mean," Shinsou starts again, clarifying. "I mean Bakugo Katsuki."

Uraraka seems to have woken up after hearing that, her head turning to her friends.

Izuku sweat drops because, "What about him, Shinsou-kun?"

"He keeps asking me if you're dating someone," ahh there he is, snitching on his employer again.

Green eyes blink before he softly smiles saying, "Nn, Kacchan's cute."

Shinsou's eyebrow twitches in irritation.

“I’m not going to confess,” Izuku says, knowing where this was heading. He’s known for quite a while now that Katsuki liked him. It was very obvious. “He was continuing to send me messages even though I was offline,” the thing that struck him the most. It’s not difficult to fall after seeing that.

“The least I can do is confess in person…”

Silence.

“Alright,” Shinsou submits, shrugging his shoulders. “Don’t take too long though. He might end up crying if you tease him too much.”

Izuku forces a smile because *actually, Shinsou-kun…*

That’s already happened once.

Izuku informs Katsuki during his break at work.

“You won’t be able to log in starting next week, why?”

It kind of sounds like he’s asking his lover for permission.

Well… in this case, that’s not too far off.

“Final exams, Kacchan,”

He softly replies, skimming through the piece of paper that Sorahiko-sensei gave him to organize. Even during breaks, he’s working because he wants to go home early. At least he’s allowed to use his phone during this period. He’s usually not the type to use it often but it’s become a habit to check if he’s received a message or two, maybe a call sometimes if he’s lucky. There’s silence on the other side of the line, Izuku waiting for a reply before deciding that he’d probably receive none.

“Are you sulking?”

“No, I was fucking reading something,”

“Ah, fanfics?

“THE FUCK!? NO! THE OFFICIAL WEBSITE STOP BRINGING THAT UP – “

It goes on for quite a while but when the other finally manages to calm down he asks *why.*

“It’s August next week,”

Well, true.

“I was wondering if you were planning on going to the festival,”

Izuku blinks, looking at his desk before asking, “Which one?”

It’s been eight years since he logged in so he doesn’t remember a lot. Also, quite a lot of things changed during that period. Things like tournaments, familiars, cut scenes, and the like are still

slightly foreign to him since the mechanism is a tad bit complicated. Back then, there were quite a few festivals as well depending on the city. He can only remember a couple and who's to say they haven't multiplied?

"The Dragonfly festival,"

Izuku's eyes widen because *ah*, "The one we promised to go to together."

The summer event eight years ago.

They were quite excited during that time because it would've been their first time attending one. Also, it was a new patch so it would've been fun to try it out. The silence is a bit stifling and Izuku knows that it's a good indicator that the other is nervous.

Sorry.

"Okay, we can go together. We can't play in the morning but it lasts for twenty-four hours, right? We can go in the evening or night time,"

He then presses his lips into a thin line, a sharp feeling in his chest.

It's six pm and Katsuki grumpily stares down his children.

"Where's papa, dad?"

"Why is it only you, Ground Zero!?"

A tick mark appears on his forehead, irritated.

"He has exams," the pair pauses, system processing the word. It takes them only a few seconds before they nod in realization, understanding what it means. "He won't be here for an entire week. He has to study," and probably a few days more because he has to take exams. It's not advisable to play games when you have a test during the morning after. At least the festival is set on Deku's last exam day, how convenient.

"We won't be seeing him?" Eri dejectedly pouts since she's always looking forward to him during the evenings. They rarely see him during the daytime, unlike Katsuki who drops by from time to time so they'd definitely miss him a lot. "But he didn't even say goodbye!"

The blonde raises an eyebrow before he laughs because, "Yeah, he has that habit huh?"

Kota and Eri exchange glances at each other.

"How about you two help me stream today then?" since they don't have that much to do. "Chat can help us."

GROUND ZERO @bkgkatsuki_official • 12 min ago
come home cheater we're making katsudon for dinner *@herotube.nYJbkdk*

ZAKURO @_kuro_nowaa • 11 min ago
replying to @*bkgkatsuki_official*
THAT'S SO CUTE HAHAHAHA

Nyam-nyam @kosumosuLD • 11 min ago
replying to @*bkgkatsuki_official*
They're baiting him with Katsudon I can't –

rinne @rindohagekissu • 10 min ago
replying to @*bkgkatsuki_official*
IT'S A BEK

mugi-cha @_matchaaa • 9 min ago
replying to @*rindohagekissu*
BEK NIGHT OUT

Macaroni Sarada @nekomakiii00 • 9 min ago
replying to @*bkgkatsuki_official*
we need a sibling crab dance showdown wwww

Kacchan:

> >> [**Photo attached**: Eri and Kota in aprons cooking.]
> >> good luck

Izuku fondly smiles at the photo, typing and sending a reply before he returns to reading.

Plus Ultra Scans:

> Apparently, Deku has exams so he can't play with Baku, Eri, and Kota for an entire week. I don't know if the weekends count but it probably does. We know that he's the same age as Baku so he's probably a graduating student that can't be disturbed right now. Everyone, please be patient! It's fun watching the kids get bored out of their minds and I just love seeing them get spoiled rotten by Baku HAHAHAHA. He's such a fun dad they're so lucky ngl. Anyway, here's a rundown of their first stream.
>
> **0:42** – Kota and Eri complaining because they can't see chat HAHAHAHA
>
> **1:26** – KIDDOS HAVE AN INTRO PREPARED OML SO PRECIOUS
>
> **1:35** – Iconic crab dance by the siblings LMAO *@herotube.kzaIASJ*

4:00 – They're cooking Katsudon everyone! Deku's favorite!

8:26 – GUCCI DAD GIVING GUCCI CHILDREN SUNGLASSES WWWWWW

12:26 – Flexing because the conservative papa is not around

15:26 – Eri-chan singing Love Scenario *@herotube.wniSNO*

28:26 – Baku reveals his skill [Cooking Master LVL. 10] .

37:26 – YOU DON'T HAVE TO USE SOAP WHEN WASHING THE MEAT KOTA

44:26 – "You two can join tomorrow's morning stream, I guess," tsundere dad is so cute hnghh

50:26 – Katsudon party. Red super chat flood omg

53:26 – Eri and Kota convincing Baku to stay a little bit longer.

1:02:26 – They're going to play offline now awww

I think they're going to continue streaming more content while Deku's away so let's look forward to it everyone. Baku said that he'll help the kids level up next time so we'll probably finally be able to see their skills outside of casting support during raids. I'm quite excited to see them in an actual hunt tbh. See you next time!

Izuku sighs out of relief when the exam finally ends, stretching his legs under his seat.

"You aced it," Shinsou says, all of a sudden standing beside him. The bags under his eyes seem to be a bit worse than usual. It couldn't be helped since this was their last exam in university; it's either all or nothing. "I know that look," like he's relieved and glad that it's all over, getting the highest score in their course just like he does every year.

Izuku just laughs and asks, "How did you do, Shinsou-kun?"

"I did fine," is what he says, brain reeling to his answers. "I think…"

"THE ANSWER ON NUMBER 27 IS C!"

Shinsou narrows his eyes at Uraraka because, "No it's not, it's B."

"Actually, the selected project in the Act on Promotion of Private Finance Initiative appears as a pursuant to the provisions of Article 7 so…" Izuku smiles at his friends that slowly start to pale. "The answer is D, none of the above."

"The fuck!?"

Izuku laughs as he stands up and pats both of his friends on their shoulders.

"Come on, let's go meet up with Todoroki-kun and Iida-kun,"

Kacchan:

>> [**Photo attached:** Kota and Eri attending the Dragon Fly festival during the morning.]
<< *Cute!!*
<< *I just finished my exams!!*
>> good job

Sixth of August, Friday.

Izuku's log-in site is at their residence – *per usual* – but unlike any other day, he doesn't spot Kota or Eri around. They're usually in the living room during this time of the day waiting for him to appear but no one is present. Pulling up the mini-map, he then spots their location at Kohera City and Katsuki at Musutafu Square. *That's strange,* he thought that they were supposed to go to the festival together so why is everyone scattered? Deciding to message the other he pulls up the chatbox before –

Ping!

Ground Zero:

>> hurry the fuck up!
>> teleport!

Ahh… Kacchan is impatient as ever.

<< *Wait Kacchan why aren't you with Kota-kun and Eri-chan?*

The bar toggles and he gets a reply that says,

>> i'll explain when you get here
>> stop making me wait dumbass!!

It's just five-fifty… I'm a bit early you know, Kacchan.

He proceeds *to* find a teleportation scroll. The screen then starts to load.

Musutafu Square is filled with tons of players when he arrives. There are lines of colorful ribbons, stalls, and lanterns everywhere. It's a bit late so the sky is covered in warm orange lights, the sun setting and starting to turn into a purplish hue. It's definitely the long-awaited festival and from time to time he can hear voices speaking due to proximity chat. That setting is usually on when it comes to large events like these in order to allow players to socialize.

<< *Where are you Kacchan?*
>> MAP!

Izuku wants to cry because *the map is small you know!*

He spends the next few minutes or so navigating the area before he spots Ground Zero near the stairs of the festival temple.

That looks like a cut-scene,

Is what Izuku thinks when he sees the other surrounded by red and orange hues.

Ah, he's calling. Accept.

"You're late," Izuku chuckles before he nods, deciding that's the best option. They were supposed to meet up at six and Izuku's ten minutes early. It probably means that Katsuki logged-in much earlier than him. *"How was your exam?"*

Yeah, he sounds nervous.

"It was good Kacchan," as he approaches the other, their avatars standing next to each other.

You sent *Ground Zero* x100 loving emojis.

There's a choked sound on the other side of the line and Izuku laughs.

"So?" he starts off, tilting his head to the side. Not that Katsuki can see. "Why aren't you with Kota-kun and Eri-chan?"

Ground Zero becomes silent and unmoving for a few seconds.

Katsuki then mumbles something that Izuku's ears fail to catch.

"Sorry? What did you say, Kacchan?"

"Kirishima and Mina…"

"Hmm?"

"I said that they're with Kirishima and Mina!"

Green eyes blink, puzzled. Why would they be with the other's teammates?

"What? You have a problem with that!?"

Izuku stares at the screen for a while before *ahh…* Realization finally sinks in.

"Of course not, Kacchan,"

His lips curl up into a smile, bright and pleased.

"We can attend the festival with just the two of us. If that's what you want,"

Katsuki doesn't bother to refute.

Pinkyyy @alienqueen • 52 min ago
I'm the cool aunt!! Babysitting stream with @*crimsonriot* while the parents are out on a date. *@herotube.KJnajhUbkdk*

SERO SERO @serohanta_official • 11 min ago
replying to @*alienqueen*
WHY WEREN'T WE INVITED I FEEL BETRAYED

kamiiiinari @chargeboltt • 11 min ago
replying to @*serohanta_official*
guess whose stream we're gonna raid tonight lolololol

Huili @kotokoo236 • 11 min ago
replying to @*alienqueen*
OH NO ERI KOTA RUN

sashaaaz @trapzzz • 11 min ago
replying to @*alienqueen*
Is Baku going to stream his date? OMG IT'S PROXIMITY CHAT WHAAAA

78% depressed @combogod • 11 min ago
replying to @*alienqueen*
prayer circle for the kiddos, i'll start
[**GIF attached:** Lighting up a candle.]

"Ah that's right,"

Katsuki notices how Izuku's avatar stops moving all of a sudden, both of them halfway up the stairs.

"I have a gift for Kacchan!"

Red eyes blink at the monitor confused, asking, "What gift?"

Ping!

You have received a *gift* from Deku!

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Dragonfly Festival - takes place in musutafu city and held during the sixth of august. imagine lantern rite from genshin, loi krathong from thailand, or that lantern

festival from tangled. it's a summer event in world execute, the one izuku had promised to go to with katsuki eight years ago.
(2) Proximity Chat - if your mic is on during the event, other people will hear what you're saying as long as you're standing within the three-meter radius.
(3) Gift - what do you think it is?

rush updates are finished. i'll probably be updating every four days after this, unless i'm motivated again. by the way, notice how katsuki seems so cool in izuku's pov? that's why he's so unsure sometimes hahaha.
he doesn't know that kacchan is panicking around him.

long awaited summer event

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

You have received *Dragonfly Yukata.*

"I was planning to give it to you eight years ago but it looks like it still works so yeah…" Izuku awkwardly laughs, pulling up his panel before his avatar spins and changes his outfit. His is in a green yukata with a black obi – the outfit they've both been eying in the past. It was a limited-time skin in commemoration of the festival starting. They were married so he got a discount but still, it was a bit expensive because they were both just students. "See? Matching skins!"

And Izuku continues to chatter away, Katsuki flushed behind his screen.

"Kacchan?"

The other calls out.

"Kacchan, are you alright?"

The blonde snaps out of his daze before he replies, "Fuck, ahh… yeah. Wait a sec."

Ba-dump. Ba-dump.

His heart is racing so goddamn fast, dammit!

Click. Click.

Ground Zero's outfit turns into a red yukata with a black obi, both of their avatars matching.

"Your favorite color is red, isn't it?" that's what he remembers the other saying when they were both teens, at least. It was hard to forget since Izuku's was also the same – blatantly obvious with how fond he was of his red sneakers at that time. *"We used to wear a lot of matching skins but you hated it when the color scheme was the same so I got green. Do you like it?"*

Mute.

Bang! Bang! Bang!

Katsuki hits his head on his desk, on the verge of ripping his hair out.

Izuku is still talking in his headset, asking why he muted himself all of a sudden.

There are a lot of players that collect skins because they are items that can be sold on the marketplace and are often promoted by the game. Also, it's virtually pleasing if your avatar has a good skin. Support companies also create them but the ones made by the game itself are more valued. The price rises based on rarity and how old it is. The one Izuku just gave him is a good example. Because it was a limited item, only a few hundred people in Musutafu were able to get it. Out of that few hundred, how many are still playing today? Not a lot, that's what.

Price-wise, it means that it's very expensive.

It's sentimental value on the other hand…

Click. Click.

“Nah, it’s nothing,” as Katsuki zooms in on both of their avatars, the tips of his ears red. “Thank you, Deku.”

Izuku lets out a pleased hum as he softly replies, “You’re welcome, Kacchan.”

“Alright, here’s the plan Deku!”

Ground Zero crosses his arms above his chest, stalls with lanterns behind his back. There are a lot of players walking back and forth, a few of them noticing who they are but continuing on with their business. It’s not that unusual to see popular icons because others can customize their avatar in a similar manner. Being added to their friend list is more impressive than spotting them. Also, they seem to have grasped the mood, noticing that the two are in the middle of a date and all.

It’s either that or they’re having fun just watching.

“Go fucking wild,” because he doesn’t have a gift. “Buy anything you want! It’s all on me!”

Expensive weapons? New skin? Skill books and ascension materials only limited to the summer festival –

“Ehhhhhh? But I don’t have anything I want, Kacchan,”

This goddamn fucker.

“JUST PICK SOMETHING!”

Deku’s out here always embarrassing him and making him feel bad. If he knew that he was going to receive a gift he would’ve prepared one in advance as well. Now he looks like some sort of dumbass that doesn’t know how to repay other people. Does this guy know how much this skin is even worth? Katsuki can see the other avatars’ look of jealousy even through the screen and is that even a feature!?

This is the only Yukata skin, you know. The others are ugly and that is a fact.

Ground Zero rounds Deku’s avatar before something triggers and a panel shows up.

Ping!

(A) Hold Hands

(B) Link Arms

(C) Wrap one arm around the waist

Umm… Excuse me!?

When was this available!? He’s been playing for ten years!

“Ohh yeah, it was the new patch because more and more players seem to be getting married,” they

may or may not have had any influence on that. Also, Katsuki didn't know because he doesn't keep track of every minor update there is. His computer automatically updates it for him and he focuses more on the technical combat features so yes, he completely missed this. "It's on my screen as well."

Click. Click.

Both of them are silent all of a sudden, Katsuki's lips pressed into a thin line.

Why the fuck am I nervous!?

It's just a game, it's just a game, it's just a game, it's just a –

"I think I wanna hold Kacchan's hand," Izuku says as he clicks away on his own panel, Deku cozying up to Ground Zero, his avatar smiling and a bunch of hearts around for the first few seconds. "Kacchan look!"

IS THAT EMOTE REALLY ALL THAT NECESSARY WORLD EXECUTE!?

They both look happy as fuck.

"Ahh, that's cute," Izuku laughs and Katsuki drops his head on his desk again.

Bang! Bang! Bang!

"Kacchan?"

No reply.

"Kacchan?"

"Here, a candy apple,"

Izuku smiles, lifting it towards the other's avatar, still holding hands. They're standing near one of the stalls, bright warm lights across their faces and players all around. Someone's squealing in proximity chat but their volume is lowered, unlike Deku who's on call. In that instance, the blonde knew that this was most definitely going to end up somewhere online.

"Say ahh,"

"No!" Katsuki complains, moving his mouse around to get his avatar loose but the game mechanics wouldn't allow him to. "You're embarrassing me! What are we? In third grade!?"

And why is this shit working on him!?

***Deku* sent you x100 sad emotes.**

"Kacchan, Ground Zero is going to eat it, not you," now Deku is making it sound like he's actually getting affected in real life; which was true but he'd rather die than admit it to the other. *"Just a bite? I want a screenshot of the cut scene,"* which was generated and not drawn but still good because of the very advanced graphics nevertheless. *"And you said that I could do anything I*

want today…"

"I said you could *buy* anything, not *do* anything!"

Ground Zero then stares at Deku's sad face.

***Deku* sent you x100 sad emotes.**

Fuck.

"Just… Just one bite,"

Katsuki says through gritted teeth, trying to find the option on his screen as Izuku cheers in success.

The blonde stares in confusion when 10 out of 10 targets are cleared.

"Why are you so good at shooting games!?"

All the while looking confused as an extra-large bunny plush toy gets shoved in his arms.

Nn, this is for Eri. Kota's is already stored in my inventory.

"I'm training to be an officer, Kacchan," Izuku laughs as Deku pulls Ground Zero away from the crowd. It'll be bad if he doesn't know how to handle a gun. It's also partly due to the fact that the quality of the game is very high. *"It's just a game but it reflects even here, I guess."*

"An All Might mask!"

All Katsuki can see is that avatar's bright face and grin.

"Our favorite hero, Kacchan!"

"You're really asking me how the fucking Takoyaki tastes?" Katsuki looks baffled, watching Ground Zero take a bite from the share they bought. It's funny how Deku would sometimes attack him just so that he could lose health and eat. Are all of these really necessary? "You know that I'm not actually eating it, right?" rephrasing what the other said earlier. It's their avatars that are eating. Not them. He can't actually taste it in real life.

"Geez, don't be such a killjoy Kacchan,"

As Deku takes a bite on his own.

“We’re on a date so you have to play the part,”

Katsuki becomes silent, eyebrows knitting together before he clicks his tongue and shouts,

“IT’S FUCKING DELICIOUS WOW. I’VE NEVER TASTED ANYTHING LIKE THIS IN MY ENTIRE LIFE – “

“Goldfish? For me?”

Ground Zero nods.

Izuku laughs before he says, *“Thank you, Kacchan!”*

“Ohh, it’s a High Striker!”

They both watch as a bunch of players take turns in raising the hammer and hitting the target. Multiple eyes rise and follow the bar letting out *ahhh* and *that was close* when the number didn’t exceed the top score. You’ll get a price as long as it exceeds a thousand, it seems like, but the score to beat was 1,400. It was most likely set by someone with a very strong skill because quirks were allowed to be used. Being creative was the key to getting a high result.

“You wanna try, Kacchan?” they don’t really need another plushy because they already have two but, *“Just for fun?”*

Ground Zero nods as he rolls up his sleeves, “What’s the high score?”

“A thousand and four-hundred,” as Deku pays the shopkeeper.

Katsuki grins behind the screen, setting his avatar in place, “Easy, get out of the way.”

Ping! Ping! Ping!

New Challenger!

“DIE!”

Izuku has a smile in place while the bystanders look horrified by the sight, startled by the big explosion. There’s clouds of dust and smoke everywhere, the screen fogged up in a few seconds before it clears and Ground Zero is smugly grinning, the numbers 3,782 on the machine. Even the NPC looks shocked, the blonde letting go of the hammer before heading to grab his prize – the biggest one because he just won. They don’t need it but he’s not just going to leave empty-handed, you see.

“Yosh!” Ground Zero turns around to see Deku standing in front of the mini-game.

“You’re going to play!?” not noticing the NPC’s teary-eyed look after being robbed of his most

expensive prize in just one try.

“ YOU’LL BREAK IT YOU IDIOT – “

Ping! Ping! Ping!

New Challenger!

“SHITTY DEKU NO – “

History was made that day.

“I can’t believe you broke it,”

Katsuki says on the other side of the line, obviously annoyed by the previous development.

“I didn’t know that it could break!”

“It was not supposed to break!” as far as he knew, mini-games weren’t supposed to do that. They weren’t armor or equipment; they were things outside of combat. Then again, they should’ve made it sturdier seeing how it was supposed to take hits from various quirks. In a way, he understands where the other was coming from. *“Now they’ll be more confused about your quirk,”* those that had seen it earlier at least. Maybe someone was recording, who knows.

Many are aware that Deku’s quirk is a complicated one. They’d seen him fight on Katsuki’s stream before. They know that it’s some sort of combination between super strength and black whip. They probably think that Float is just a bonus. Either way, everyone is *confused.*

“Is it really that bad if they know about my quirk?”

“You’re All Might’s fucking descendant,”

Izuku used to pride himself as a quirk fanatic but hmm… it looks like All Might became an icon over time.

He used to just be a normal hero… The one he and Kacchan looked up to.

“The one and only in the world,” he continues, *“Many would try to get their hands on you.”*

He probably meant that in a different way but Izuku couldn’t help but jump on the chance.

“Hmm… Too bad for them because I’m already Kacchan’s husband,”

Is what he says with a pleased hum.

Izuku watches as Ground Zero turns to look at Deku, laughing at how the other’s avatar paused.

Cute. Kacchan’s very obvious.

You sent *Ground Zero* x100 loving emotes.

Ping!

The atmosphere is really nice, choose an available option:

(A) Kiss your spouse

(B) Hug your spouse

(C) Head pat

(D) None of the above

Nice timing!

"Come on," *Click. Click.* "Let's go make a wish at the temple, Kacchan."

Deku leans over to press a kiss against Ground Zero's cheek, the cut scene filling up the entire monitor.

You sent *Ground Zero* x100 loving emotes.

Katsuki stares at the screen with his face flushed, lips tightly pursed.

This goddamn nerd, like he's on the verge of exploding, taking off his headset as he leans back his seat. *This goddamn shitty nerd!*

He muted himself again because he couldn't take it and –

He *hates* this. He hates this so fucking much it's physically painful. It hurts but he doesn't want it to stop and it feels like his heart is about to leap out of his chest. It's annoying how Deku knows all the things to do and say to make him feel like this. Trembling, knees weak, flushed, and unlike himself because Bakugo Katsuki doesn't do shit like this! He's not a teenager. He's not some sort of middle-school student that's having their first exposure to romance. He's prepared eight fucking years for this and just one goddamn world is enough to turn him into this puddle of mess.

If he's like this on the other side of the line then how will he react when he meets Deku?

Will they even meet?

Does Deku want to meet?

Because he wants to.

Bakugo Katsuki wants to meet Midoriya Izuku.

"You're back, Kacchan?" when he unmutes, headphones on. *"Have you calmed down?"*

See? This guy knows what's up. He knows that saying those kinds of things will get him to react like this.

What an asshole.

"I hate you," the blonde says, Ground Zero and Deku heading up the temple. "I hate you so

goddamn much."

Deku sent you x100 loving emotes.

"Fucking asshole,"

Deku sent you x100 loving emotes.

"Isn't it about time you become honest, Kacchan?" there's that soft voice again but Katsuki knows better than to trust that. He knows that it's just a façade for the devil underneath. He's still flushed, red covering his cheeks and trailing down his neck, a scowl – somewhat like a pout on his lips. *"You don't actually hate me right?"* vague, unclear, indefinite, *Midoriya Izuku.*

"No, I don't hate you,"

I like you.

"You don't know me though,"

"I want to," and the room is spinning, "I want to get to know you."

The room is fucking spinning.

Deku's hands are on him.

Half-lidded red eyes, fingers wrapped around his cock, teeth tightly clenched on the hem of his shirt. It's not like this is their first time, Katsuki recalls doing this with Izuku while he was slightly out of it two weeks ago. He would be lying if he said that he didn't think about that time once or twice a day because he does. Katsuki *remembers.* He wants to do it again. Maybe Deku's the same because he's actually in on this right now, guiding him through with that soft voice of his and making him overthink, sending him to overdrive because –

"Kacchan's cute. Do you always moan when you jerk off like this, Kacchan?"

The blonde shakes his head as if the other can actually see.

World Execute looks like it's on pause right now, both of their avatars standing next to each other.

"It sounds wet," Katsuki twitches, throbbing in his own hand. *"Did you already cum?"*

"Ghnn…"

"Let's fix that then," and he hears him say, *"Lower Kacchan."*

The blonde shakily follows, long slim fingers pressed against his entrance. He knows how this works, read enough material to know how it's done. He shuts his eyes close as he lets the pre-cum drip between his thighs, groaning as fingers enter him and –

"Deku," Katsuki calls out, desperate, *"Deku –"*

It doesn't feel good. His references were lying. It slightly stings even though he's so wet and –

Will it feel better if Deku does it to him? Will Deku even –

"You have to do that first, Kacchan," Izuku's voice sounds deeper than usual and Katsuki lets out a pleased hum, glad that he's not the only one like this. There's sweat dripping down his brow, a thoroughly fucked expression on his face. *"Do that first before we proceed, okay?"*

The blonde obediently nods.

"Kacchan," Izuku fondly laughs saying, *"I can hear you pout through the call, Kacchan."*

"Shut up," he tells the other, cheeks flushed red after what they both just did. "Just shut up."

***Deku* sent you x100 loving emotes.**

"Hmm… I would've kissed you if you were with me right now," there's a snicker. *"Cute."*

Katsuki bangs on his desk, shouting out a bunch of complaints.

***Deku* sent you x100 loving emotes.**

And they resume watching the lanterns float, both Ground Zero and Deku sitting side by side as the festival comes to an end.

***You* sent Deku x100 loving emotes.**

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Skin - clothes that your avatar can wear. these can be obtained for free or brought using real money that is converted to in-game currency. the dragonfly yukata skin that bakugo and izuku are wearing is a limited-edition.
(2) New Patch - allows married couples to interact if the system finds the atmosphere suitable.
(3) High Stiker - the hammer game you often see at arcades. a mini-game in the summer event.

hmm... returning back to regular agenda. there will be eventual smut hahaha.
looks like the M rating can involve smut as long as it doesn't take up the entire story.

the internships are starting

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"You really haven't seen that photo?"

"What photo?"

"You and Deku!"

Katsuki narrows his eyes at his screen, annoyed and confused because there are *hundreds* of their photos out there.

She'll have to specify which one she means or they'll have a hard time seeing eye-to-eye. Even then, the possibility of him actually knowing said photo is pretty low because he's quite uninterested when it comes to these kinds of things. He surveys the internet to monitor public response but he never really digs that deep. It's probably some sort of screenshot or fan-art again.

"Two hot boys wearing a matching outfit? A kiss in front of the high striker booth?"

Katsuki's lips curl into a scowl, red eyes scouring the comment session.

Their team was doing their monthly collab and everyone's streaming.

Stream Chat:

>> I've seen it!
>> baku pls go on twitter more
>> Unfazed cause kissing is normal??
>> I drew a fan-art based on it!!!
>> VERY VERY CUTE

"I saw it too,"

"Very manly my dude,"

"I thought you already knew about it,"

Katsuki's scowl deepens because, "The fuck? Stop stalking us!"

"I told you guys it was the real deal~!" Mina sing-songs to her own viewers because quite a few said that it was fake. Players can take photos in the game anytime and that includes almost anything within sight. A handful of people speculated that the two on the image were posers, candidly posing for clout. *"Ground Zero himself just admitted it,"* and she knew that they'd both be at the festival so yeah.

"What's Deku up to though?" Kaminari asks, a bit curious. *"He hasn't been on your stream for almost a week,"* it's only been Eri and Kota so far, as well as a few other collabs.

Katsuki leans back his seat as he replies, "He's busy."

>>Our papa has work!
>> Real work!

>> what's our papa's work again?
>> YOU MEAN -----??
>> ------ has school work

Yeah, Deku said it himself to chat a while ago.

It wasn't quite like an announcement, it was more of a casual mention all the while they were fighting monsters inside a dungeon. The children were quite bummed about but it couldn't be helped. At some point, Katsuki started to interfere because Eri and Kota's puppy-dog eyes seemed to start working and Deku was starting to forget the difference between virtual and reality.

"Deku has stuff to do," the last one before he graduates. "Won't be back for a while."

Kaminari lets out a loud sound of complaint, *"Ehhh? He promised to join my Mario Kart stream!"*

Kacchan:

<< *are you done with school work yet?*
>> Hmm… not yet. Sorry, Kacchan.
<< *can I call*
>> I'm working on something but it's alright if it's just for a short while

---

"You rejected the TMPD internships!?"

Uraraka was shaking in her seat, dramatically fainting backward before Iida catches her back.

"THAT IS SUCH A BAD DECISION, MIDORIYA-KUN!" Iida starts off with exaggerated one-handed gestures. They're all seated in the café they frequent at, Shinsou dropping the sandwich he's holding. "They are the best choice! They don't accept trainees that often, you should know this as well!" everyone in their school *wants* to go there. Aside from the excellent work environment and good salary, Tokyo is the aim. It's not that living in another prefecture is bad, the capital is just *different.*

"It's official," Shinsou says, gulping after he realized he was gaping. "This guy is crazy."

His aim is to join TMPD's Criminal Investigation Bureau so hearing that his friend refused an offer from there is taking quite a toll on him.

"Todoroki-kun also got an offer from TMPD,"

"EHHHHHHH!?"

Referring to the guy sitting next to him who is sipping on a straw with a poker face on.

"I also rejected them," another gasp, Izuku awkwardly laughing. "For the record…"

"WHY!?" Uraraka asks, standing up in her seat. *"WHY ARE YOU GUYS DOING THIS TO YOURSELVES!?"*

"My father works there," and not just any other worker but a high-ranking executive, Superintendent General named Todoroki Enji. "I don't want to get accused of nepotism," it's too difficult to deal with, and to be honest, he just finds it troublesome. It's not like he *has* to work in TMPD, he would like to avoid it actually. "There are other good options aside from those in Tokyo."

They all turn to Izuku to find out his reason.

"Well?"

"What about you Midoriya-kun?"

"Why reject TMPD?"

Izuku gulps before he replies with, "Uhh… Just as Todoroki-kun said, there are other good options."

"It's not like we get to work there right after," is another. "It's just internships."

Iida starts to contemplate while Shinsou looks scandalized, "What else is there?"

"Didn't you want to go to Tokyo?" Uraraka asks, remembering what their friend said.

Izuku hums, nodding in reply.

Well, true, he did want to go to Tokyo. That is still his goal actually. He wanted to go there not just for his career but for something else as well. His motives should be clear as day now, a familiar face popping up in his head – of blonde hair and red eyes that bring a soft smile to his face. His friends watch as he nervously rubs his palms, trying to formulate an answer that would make sense and is straight to the point. Don't get him wrong because although that someone plays a part, ultimately, this is something that he actually wants to do.

"It's not that different but uhh… it's still the police force but based in Osaka,"

Just not Tokyo.

"Sorahiko-sensei also said that this was good," everyone except Todoroki gapes at him. "If I make a good performance there then they might take me in the headquarters," the goal is Tokyo, to make an impression so good he gets an offer straight from the base. Since his professor said it then it might be possible. It also helps how they've had their eye on him for quite a while now.

"I'm also going to Osaka with him," Todoroki adds as an input.

Their friends blink, trying to process what's happening because if only the location's different.

"Osaka?" Iida repeats, remember what happened last time. "Isn't that where – "

Shinsou gapes at the pair, realization finally sinking in, *"The criminal alliance!?"*

Izuku kindly asks him to lower his voice, the other loudly whispering,

"You want to help catch fucking psychopaths on loose!? That's your good performance!?"

“Isn’t Todoroki-kun’s brother part of… you know…”

“It’s fine Uraraka-san,”

Deku:

>> [**Photo attached:** Exam results.]
>> I passed!
<< *!!!*
<< *fuck*
<< *good job*

Katsuki stares at his monitor in boredom.

Deku’s been busier lately. His exams are over and although internships are still two weeks away, he’s drowning in school projects and paperwork. It’s the final spurt for his academics before the practical portion starts. It wouldn’t be an understatement to say that his current schedule was worse than when he actually has classes. Aside from regularly going to the gym early in the morning, he also has to help with the orientation process because he’s Sorahiko’s protégé.

The blonde prided himself as a pretty patient individual but yeah…

This sucks.

Stream Chat:

>> where’s papa deku
>> It’s tuesdayyyyyyyyyyyyyy
>> Deku has school work guys
>> OMG THEY’RE SO ANNOYING
>> Papa Deku went to work

Not to mention how chat’s being an absolute *menace.*

There are those who weren’t present during Deku’s last appearance so of course, they’re confused.

It’s none of his business though and he doesn’t give a damn.

>> this is what happens when there’s only one functioning parent
>> Meanwhile the other husband’s a NEET
>> Where’s Deku I don’t see him today

>> i miss deku wwwwwwww
>> Baku do you have any idea when Deku is gonna come back

“Fuck you,” he knows that they’re joking but yeah, that’s annoying. “This is my stream, get out if you’re only here for Deku,” it reels in the numbers but it’s just him on a regular basis. See? This is why he didn’t want to spoil them too much. They keep asking for the impossible. “Also, I’m not a fucking NEET. I’m the number one in super chat rankings bitch,” true, he’s a record holder in Japan. Aside from his income from gaming in World Execute, he also profits on HeroTube and super chat.

Financially, he’s stable. He has more than enough. He’s rich as *fuck.*

>> Baku’s more mellowed than usual www
>> we miss him too Baku, it’s fine
>> Papa Deku will pick us up soon
>> I bet they call each other in real life
>> they’re dating right? they see each other regularly www

Katsuki’s eyebrow twitches before he leans back on his seat, clicking away.

This sucks.

“Let’s go raid freaking Blue Crystal today,”

This sucks.

Kacchan:

<< *you said we were going to play*
<< *where are u*
<< *if you ain’t here in five i’m gonna party with someone else*
>> Ah sorry Kacchan
>> Just woke up.
<< *hah*
<< *it’s six thirty*
<< *nevermind go back to sleep*

Katsuki stares at his phone because –

It’s a selfie.

It’s been three weeks.

I don’t need a fucking selfie.

Also, who the fuck is that old man in the back?

Deku:

>> How do I look Kacchan?
>> [**Photo attached:** Izuku with half-rimmed glasses.]

Okay, first and foremost this is not his first time seeing Izuku in glasses but he'll act like it is. Shinsou sent him a photo a few months ago but Izuku's not supposed to know about those private consultations that they have. He looks *good,* good enough for Katsuki to want to bite but that's not the main issue here.

<< *your face is round*
<< *stop eating katsudon!*

A lie, Midoriya Izuku's face is not round.

He's saying that to deflect himself from the truth. To not show how much he likes this.

Typical Bakugo Katsuki.

It doesn't help how he's been very irritated nowadays because although Deku still sends him photos during the day, they're mostly random like the food he ate or some sort of scenery in Fukuoka. Despite that not being unusual behavior from Izuku… something is missing. There's a big glaring contrast that's *missing,* something that's been a part of their routine since a while ago and now it's just *gone.* It's making him pissed off and unable to sleep at night.

Yeah, you're handsome and all but where are my nudes.

Is what he's tempted to type because there's no way Katsuki will initiate sending one, that's Deku's job.

There's no way.

There's no fucking way.

Six days later, just the night before Izuku's about to head out to Osaka he sends it.

He folds. He doesn't even last a week.

Fuck.

Despite the confusing relationship that they have, he knows that the other would like it.

The nervousness comes from the fact that he's the one doing this. Then again, he's been in more than a handful of humiliating situations with this guy so this doesn't affect him as much. It's less embarrassing than that one time on the phone with him half-asleep. *Bring it on,* is what he thinks. *I'll fucking kick your ass if you don't like it* because Deku's *supposed* to like it. It's him, Bakugo Katsuki, why would he not like it? That would be *absurd.*

Ping!

Deku:

>> Omo
>> Kacchaaaaaaaaaaaan

Is the reply that he gets.

That's right, he smugly thinks. *Feast your eyes on this shitty nerd.*

***Deku* is requesting a video call.**

Kasuki freezes because *the fuck we've never done that before.*

Photos are still images. Calls are only audio so those are allowed but… *this?*

Is he even prepared to see Deku *moving?*

<< THE FUCK WAIT A SECOND
<< STOP CALLING

Back. Back. Back. Back. Back.

Retreat. Everyone retreat.

Katsuki leans back on his seat, one hand pressed against his chest.

He might be more fucked than he thinks he is.

Izuku stares at the phone in his hand, dumbfounded.

Did he just…

"Did Kacchan just hang up on me?"

He kind of understands it now, the feeling of being teased and left hanging in the air.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Criminal Alliance - an organized crime group in Japan that is based in Osaka.
(2) NEET - not in education, employment, or training.
(3) Osaka - izuku and todoroki are going to osaka for their last internships.

by the way we have fanart *by snotky7 or imtyjeshh at twitter.*
chat is slowly becoming alive. my motivation is now through the roof.
see you next chapter!

internet famous overnight

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Izuku sighs out of relief when the orientation finally ends.

“What’s wrong?” his friend asks, noticing the change in his demeanor. “It’s just our first day.”

And usually he'd be excited about these kinds of things. Izuku likes being on the field and after long months of academe, they finally get a break from writing papers and studying. It’s still a part of their curriculum but it’s much better than being cooped up indoors in the university, is what he thinks. Last year he was quite pumped up for the internships as well so Todoroki is a bit puzzled to see him like this – quiet and a bit dejected. Perhaps something happened before they arrived at Osaka this morning.

“It’s fine, Todoroki-kun,” is what Izuku says, “I just couldn’t sleep well last night.”

Todoroki nods and leaves it at that because he knows that the other knows how to handle it anyway.

Is it bad to have that much confidence in your friend?

Anyway, it doesn’t really matter if Izuku’s in good shape or not because today their schedule is just orientations, and a bit of fieldwork so –

“Cute –“

“Like a puppy – “

“Finally eye candy – “

There are women here you know.

The police department doesn’t just consist of male police officers. There are also those that do desk jobs for the base. It looks like they’ve been getting tired of seeing their co-worker’s faces over and over again. It’s good that they don’t seem to have any ill intentions but yeah, getting that much attention is a bit overwhelming. Todoroki doesn’t mind it but Izuku... yeah, he also doesn’t mind. Actually, since they both don’t mind perhaps it’s not as overwhelming as it seems.

It’s not an issue after all…

Moving on –

“Have you guys been to the cafeteria yet? It’s still so early so the both of you haven’t had breakfast, right?”

“Wow, Kyushu University… you two must be hella' smart!”

“We’re glad that 'cha came here! You’ll definitely learn a lot!”

Ahh... kansai ben!

Todoroki perks up at the mention of breakfast while Izuku still has that dejected puppy-look.

“Nn, we hope to learn a lot… miss?”

“No need for formalities! Jus' call me nee-san!”

“Nee-san…” Todoroki and Izuku tilt their head to the side.

“Like that! Nee-san!” someone from the accounting department squeals. “You two learn fast!”

The pair sends each other hesitant looks before Izuku ultimately submits and says, “Alright, nee-san.”

Rule number one of interning is to always follow what other people say.

Uraraka Ochako feels the catastrophe all the way from Kanagawa.

I’m not fucking ready.

Is the conclusion Bakugo Katsuki gets after an overnight contemplation.

He’s fine with seeing Deku, fine with hearing Deku... but seeing *and* hearing Deku at the same time?

He has his limits. Nope, he’ll most likely explode. He’ll *definitely* explode.

He *knows* that Midoriya Izuku is handsome; anyone with eyes can tell and if they say that his husband is ugly then they better get ready to be canceled online. Clearly, they have poor taste if that’s the case and Katsuki is more than ready to unleash six generations' worth of karma upon said person’s family. As for his voice, it’s no secret how he’s… gotten off to it a few times before. The first time they had a call he was excited as fuck, overdosing on serotonin. It also led to a series of… dreams – *lustful ones.* That’s how sexy – *never mind.*

Anyway, for the sake of his mental health, he now hereby declares that he is not ready for a video call.

Photos and calls are fine but video calls? Nope.

Isn’t doing it on the phone lewder, his brain supplies, *you’re twenty-three years old.*

Yeah, that’s right. He’s an adult *bUT THIS IS HIS FIRST TIME WITH A FUCKING MAN ALRIGHT!?*

It’s not just seeing Deku. It’s also about showing himself to Deku.

Anyway, it’s fucking complicated, okay!?

Deku:

>> M’heading out to Osaka now, sorry if I scared you off last night.
>> Good morning, Kacchan!

Ah, there it is… the one thing he hates about Deku.

He always acts like a nerd, apologizing when he hasn't done anything wrong and shit.

You're a Kyushu student, man up, is what he wants to say. *For someone so big you're such a crybaby.*

Or maybe he's like this only towards him? That would be nice.

Katsuki presses his lips into a thin line, feeling butterflies in his stomach.

> << *good morning*
> << *you didn't scare me off. i wasn't ready for the call.*
> << *where in osaka?*

He tries to play it off casually. Yup, that would be for the best. Izuku then goes on leaps and bounds on explaining where he and his friend are stationed for internships. It looks like he's still allowed to use his phone for now so that's good. That makes Katsuki feel a bit pleased, Izuku using his free time to text him – that is. Makes him feel important and shit. A small smile curls up on his lips before he freezes in his place, realizing what he just did.

Katsuki then flushes, the red reaching up to his ears.

How long has it been since he's gotten a call or a photo again?

Shouldn't have rejected that last night, his inner voice laughs. *Look at you.*

The blonde grumpily retreats to the bathroom to take a cold shower.

Todoroki and Izuku are *extremely* popular.

Not just with women but with men as well.

Their looks make them favored but their obedience is a plus as well. It also helps how they're efficient with their tasks, easily answering questions and knowing the ins-and-outs of how police headquarters work. It's obvious that they've both had experience before and it shows. It's safe to say that they're viewed by their mentors as some sort of younger sibling, cooing and gushing over them whenever they can. This district isn't as strict as the ones they've been in before.

People in Osaka are always friendly and warm compared to those from the other parts of Japan.

"The crime rate 'round here is pretty high compared to other cities,"

The highest in Japan actually.

An older supervisor explains as they do their rounds, Izuku and Todoroki following in tow.

"We usually have those spots marked – Neyagawa, Shinsaibashi, Tennoji, Nishinari most especially –"

Ah, the infamous Nishinari, a famous hiding spot for yakuza and criminals. They've been trying to

do something about it for a while now but since it's still a city where people live, it's dangerous to just jump in. They've started to operate slowly since a new organized crime started to move but they're proving to be more tricky than expected.

Another reason why both choose Osaka has something to do with the work ethic. Although TMPD hires efficient and elite workers, the high-performing ones that excel in the field are assigned to this city or choose to stay in this city. Internship-wise, this place was the best choice to gain experience in. They're graded based on their performance and contribution so a city bustling with crime –

"THIEF!"

Izuku watches as a blur passes by him, legs immediately kicking into gear.

– is more or less the best choice.

"You have him pinned down, Midoriya?"

"My purse! Thank you officer – "

"He keeps struggling. Please stay away, ma'am – "

"What's this!? Another fight?"

"Midoriya, here," Todoroki monotonously hands his friend what he's holding, "Cuff him up."

A crowd starts to form, their instructor attempting to tell the civilians not to approach.

Katsuki ends up in front of his monitor again.

He had just finished his morning stream so he has *a lot* of free time in his hands. It's become a habit to play with Deku in the evenings so now that most of that is gone – *he's being dramatic, Izuku still plays with him on the weekends sometimes* – he has nothing to do and his schedule is cleared. Streaming would have been a good choice if it weren't for the fact that he'd be running out of content sooner. It's a pain in the ass to come up with topics, you see. With Deku, it was always unexpected.

Fuck, now he's sounding like he misses him.

He does not.

"It's all shitty Deku's fault," as he angrily clicks on a bunch of links. *"Goddamn bastard."*

That guy hasn't done anything after the summer event.

Isn't that usually the turning point for all relationships? Since they just had… uhh… I dunno?

Consensual online se – Katsuki doesn't want to phrase it that way. They did it through a call, that's what. He doesn't know if it counts but the fucking idiot doesn't get to just back out now. He knows he's goddamn busy but does he really have to do it this way? Katsuki's been nothing but understanding about his schedule. Also, Katsuki sent him a photo last time so he should get one as well!

At this point, he's just ranting – grumpy that he hasn't been receiving attention.

Deep inside he knows that Izuku's really busy with school but he just wants to nag.

Anyway –

"The fuck which chapter was I –"

Ah there it is.

He spends the next few hours or so scouring through a website.

"Thank you! Thank you!"

The woman continuously bows her head, on the verge of tears as she thanks her saviors.

Todoroki and their instructor are involved in her display of gratitude because they've assisted in the arrest and now a police car was escorting the thief – *Bubaigawara Jin* – to the headquarters for detainment. He'll be questioned later because there's been a series of incidents like these in this part of the city for a while now. Who knows if he's part of an organized group? He might have been acting on his own as well. At least that's one problem solved today.

"You're welcome, ma'am,"

Todoroki watches as his friend's usual kind and gentle demeanor returns. He feels kind of bad for the woman now because that smile is always a lady killer. He's immune to it since he's the best friend – *excuse me sir, Shinsou would like to argue* – and has been exposed to it for quite a while.

"Are you injured anywhere?" since she was running in heels trying to run after the thief as well.

"Ehh? Ahh… I think I sprained my ankle – *uggh* –"

"Liar!" their instructor thinks, watching as the woman leans against Izuku's chest. *"She's lying!"*

Todoroki blinks, looking at her feet but ultimately unaware of what's happening.

This guy is just as bad as Midoriya. He looks good looking but he's an absolute airhead.

Izuku blinks before he flushes at the proximity, hands anywhere but on the lady, "Uhh… S-Sir?"

"What would be the best course of action in this situation, sir?" Todoroki asks, genuinely concerned.

Their mentor awkwardly laughs because he's never seen this happen before.

“Well… uhh... lemme go get the first aid kit for now,”

Izuku nods, gulping as the woman continues to cling unto him.

"Don't worry," Todoroki says, a serious expression on his face. "Midoriya is very good with first aid."

Shinsou’s coffee almost scalds his tongue when he notices two individuals on the screen.

There’s no freaking way –

“And this guy just came runnin’ in and the handsome officer stopped ‘im,”

The newscaster is interviewing a bystander, the streets empty showing no issue but the screen flashing back to footage of his friends taken by a phone during the incident earlier. It’s no wonder why the scene caught the attention of those who were just passing by. The thief was screaming and struggling a lot and even Izuku – *goddamn, I will break your bones during a spar Midoriya Izuku* – was having a few problems. Overall it was handled pretty well.

“Then another good-looking officer came in – “

Cue Todoroki Shouto casually walking up to Izuku giving him handcuffs.

With the two standing side by side –

THE FUCK ARE THEY DOING!?

“I kinda wanted to join in, jus’ jokin’ AHAHAHA – “

Is this some sort of afternoon drama or some shit!?

Shinsou’s droopy eyes are now awake, trying to find his phone on his desk. When he manages to find it he’s not surprised to see their group chat blowing up with messages from Iida and Uraraka. Of course they’d know as well, they’re interning in stations where they have to keep up with the recent news. Imagine their surprise when they see their friends on screen. Surprise doesn’t even cut it, they’re stunned, amazed, *baffled.* It’s just the first day you know!

Also, to make things worse –

“We have come to Osaka Headquarters to interview our heroes for today – “

Oh no, don’t interview them please.

Izuku’s fine but not Todoroki. Anyone but Todoroki.

“I didn’t really do anything,” his friend says, now former because he’s so fucking embarrassing and Shinsou wants to crawl into a hole and die. Why is he associated with these people!? Is that appropriate for an officer in training to say? “*Midoriya was the one who did everything,”* someone in the background sobs because *I called for the car you know. I also wanna be interviewed.*

“Oh wow aren’t cha’ Superintendent Todoroki’s son?”

That's a taboo topic lady! Then again, Shinsou knows it's not her fault because she's just doing her job and –

"Yes," not even denying anything. *"I will surpass my father."*

Todo please, just stop it. You will become a meme at this point.

Meanwhile, Midoriya Izuku says, *"Uhh... Umm... We were just doing our jobs, ma'am."*

Someone in the crew coos and lets out an *awwww,* the audio caught live.

"Please stay safe everyone," a soft and kind but slightly awkward smile enough to make everyone melt.

Shinsou groans, realizing that his internship isn't as fun.

Kaminari is *addicted* to social media.

He's on it if he's not sleeping or streaming, constantly watching videos and keeping up with tweets. Also, there's nothing private about him, a big reason why Katsuki doesn't tell him *anything*. He overshares everything he does online, from what he eats to selfies before he goes to sleep. In short, this guy is a *risk.* Their team captain is quite surprised – *and ever so grateful, thank God* – that he hasn't given out clues about Deku's true identity. Perhaps it's because he's scared of Katsuki's wrath but so far so good.

Anyway, because he's always on his phone, he sees *everything* that goes viral.

MIAO MIAO @chakats • 2 hrs ago
Please arrest me too officer.
[**Photo attached:** Candid photo of Izuku and Todoroki.]

odette @swanlake • 1 hr ago
replying to @*chakats*
fuck look at those thighs, dat booty tho

Northh @twinklee • 1 hr ago
replying to @*chakats*
Does anyone know the green-haired guy's name? The other one is Todoroki Shoto right?

JKL @moiannas • 1 hr ago
replying to @*chakats*
Green-haired guy doesn't have twitter but he has insta @*deku.* Todo's is @*chouto.*
[**Photo attached:** Izuku in a police uniform.]

ECHOO @kai_mine • 1 hr ago
replying to @*chakats*
GREEN HAIRED GUY IS SO HOT OMG WHAT TO DO RAWR WOOF WOOF

Kat @thenewkid • 1 hr ago
replying to @*chakats*

Green-haired daddy can get it. If you know what I mean.
[**GIF Attached:** Man wiggling his eyebrows suggestively.]

The blonde slowly gets off the couch, heading upstairs while nervously calling out,

“Uhhh…. Baku?”

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Chouto - todoroki's username because *shouto* is already taken.
(2) Deku - izuku's username *everywhere* expect herotube.
(3) Kansai Ben - the unique accent people have in kansai.

a lot of flags have been set in this chapter. i'll update again in the weekend!

bakugo katsuki's dilemma

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Katsuki's eyebrows knit together, annoyed.

Knock! Knock! Knock!

It looks like what he's reading has to wait because Kaminari has been banging on his door screaming bloody murder for quite a while now. At first, he tried to ignore him but it literally felt like the dolt was about to break his goddamn door with how hard he's knocking, shaking the knob as if doing that would make it open. If it's one of those memes or unnecessary team announcements again he swears to God he's going to murder him in his sleep. Katsuki really does not appreciate being interrupted like this.

"THE FUCK DO YOU WANT – "

All the while opening his door, screaming back to prove his point.

"Dude! Dude, you have to see this – " as he tries to invite himself inside their team captain's room, Katsuki immediately blocking and cutting him off with a *just say it here!* Kaminari smirks at the treatment he gets because, "Wow, is that how you treat a friend who's about to tell you vital information about your boyfriend – " about to cut him off for a correction before – "that's trending online!"

Red eyes narrow at the other, skeptical.

"Yeah, right. The extras miss him and shit so what – "

"I worded that wrong," Kaminari tries again, trying to be clearer this time. "*Midoriya Izuku* is trending online."

Katsuki frowns, crossing his arms in front of his chest, still doubtful.

This guy's not really the most reliable person around here.

He's not that bothered that his teammates know Deku's real name because they'd find out through Yummycat's account anyway. They've seen the photos and accounts as well. It's really not that hard. He doesn't care as long as they keep it under wraps and don't give out hints to their followers. They should know this as well.

"Ah-ah!" Kaminari waves his hand, noticing how the other was about to say something. "I have receipts," he pulls out his phone – the latest, most trendy one they seem to have on the market right now. Honestly, this guy must be changing his device every year or so. Katsuki swears that he sees a new one pop-up every single time. "I present to you… Twitter."

Katsuki scowls as he accepts Kaminari's phone, scrolling down the top posts of some weird trending hashtag.

It doesn't take a few swipes before he comes across a familiar face.

Trending Japan:

ARREST ME TOO OFFICER
70K Tweets

#CrabDance
64K Tweets

#OnePiece1010
62K Tweets

Baki Trailer
59K Tweets

Izuku blinks, in the middle of eating lunch when he notices a text.

Kacchan:

>> what are you doing
>> you're everywhere on the internet

His smile then slowly fades; a bit let down by the fact that Katsuki's long-awaited message is regarding that issue. It's not that he hates the other or the topic itself. He was just expecting a more casual conversation like Katsuki asking how his day was or something. It's not often he gets messages during the middle of the day. They also missed a few chances to call so…

<< *Ah, you saw that? There was a thief.*
<< *People in Osaka are really friendly*

True, they are very open and cheerful.

Usually, it's not allowed to post someone's photo online in Japan without their permission –*due to privacy laws* – but in this case, there was a crime scene. They let it slide because it reported on events and news. It would've been different if those photos were taken candidly with another purpose but at that time, the bystanders were focused on the theft itself. It just so happened that the people on the internet are rather well… enthusiastic.

People from Tokyo like Katsuki, who are very cool, are quite different.

>> change your username.

Ah, that. Izuku remains silent for a while, contemplating.

He's had the username *Deku* for a quite long time now. It's easy to remember and there were no duplicates – at least before his avatar persona became famous, that is. He uses it everywhere except for the accounts he uses for school or work. Being asked to change it is understandable and easy to do but…

Hmm…

<< *Why, Kacchan?*
>> cause people will find out, nerd

It's that after all.

<< *Okay.*

I'll change it.

Katsuki is *pissed.*

Everyone including his teammates finds it funny but it's seriously no laughing matter. He'll let the photo slide but the interview – Izuku's *talking* in that. It's only a matter of time before a bunch of people figure out the similarity because surely, they'd be able to recognize the voice they've been going crazy over these past few months. Katsuki knows that he's not understating this. There are creepy bastards out there that'd go lengths just because someone sounds or looks similar.

Also, that username. That fucking username. It's a dead giveaway.

He's not even going to mention that. That should've been changed right from the start.

Then again… who would've thought that the other would go viral? Not him, that's what.

<< *are they still bothering you online*
>> No, I turned the notifs off and I don't use social media that often, Kacchan.

Good.

"Man, Deku has it tough," it's Sero who points it out, the entire team lounging around the living room while waiting for dinner. Mina and Kaminari are on cooking duty, Katsuki lurking behind their backs because they often put random stuff that's usually not included in a normal recipe. "You look pissed. Chill dude," he's snickering, not even looking up from the console he's playing on. Someone from the kitchen seconds the statement and Katsuki clicks his tongue.

"None of you guys' business,"

"You still need to calm down though,"

"I am fucking calm,"

Sero looks at Katsuki's direction before raising a brow in question.

Kaminari also laughs because, "You were so pissed when I told you."

"Yeah, I *was,"* he scowls not bothering to deny that part, "He had his username as *Deku."*

"Ah, that's bad,"

"Yeah, pretty bad,"

It's basically common sense not to put anything that might give the audience leads on the internet. Even your following can serve as a clue. About ninety-nine percent of the audience is alright but there's always that small percentage that goes up and beyond expectations. In some cases, it can even pose a threat. Take Utsushimi Camie from Team Shiketsu for example. She used to have a stalker following her around and it blew up into this big scandal that had the E-Sports community talking for days.

"Boys, boys – " Mina cuts in, holding up a spatula. Things seem to be heading in the wrong direction so she felt the need to step in and set things straight. "Deku's not a streamer, remember? He doesn't have the same irrational fear as you guys have," basically anything regarding identities or being found out. They seem to be more worried about this than the actual person is. "Also… He's an officer!"

"I don't give a damn if he's an officer. Shitty extras will always be shitty extras,"

Kirishima and Sero snicker because, "That's so overprotective hahaha."

Katsuki flips them off in response.

Deku:

>> Are you asleep, Kacchan?
>> I called but you didn't answer so I was wondering if you were
>> My internships went well today

Bakugo Katsuki has a *complaint.*

This morning his scan was shallow and he was only able to see those that were trending so he didn't notice the wide array of… *scandalous* tweets but now he does and he has a *problem.* He has a bone to pick with someone – women and teenagers, most especially. He's visited approximately sixty-two profiles during the last hour and a half, silently seething in a cocoon on his bed with Deku's text notifications on top of his phone's screen.

That guy can wait, anyway –

Zankoku dane @himawariii • 14 hrs ago
He needs to step on me

emoii @kanso_01 • 14 hrs ago
i am about to become a criminal and no one can stop me

Na2 @saltt • 14 hrs ago
THE FIT!! THE GODDAMN FIT IS TIGHT ON THE CHEST HEUK –

This. This is why he hates the internet.

It's quite hypocritical of him to think that because he earns a living out of it, but during days like these he just feels the *need* to fight somebody. Deku maybe because *WHAT THE FUCK WAS HE DOING!?* Isn't he supposed to be… I dunno? On patrol? Doing internships!? What on earth was he doing on the streets of Osaka doing goddamn photoshoots!? Actually, now that he looks closely most of these photos are taken by a phone from a bystander's perspective. It's either people in Osaka have expensive ass phones or Midoriya Izuku is just goddamn photogenic in real life.

That woman's clinging on him way too much!

She looks somewhere in between her late twenties and early thirties.

WHY IS AN OFFICER DOING FIRST AID ON CIVILIANS!?

He's just denying Izuku's career scope, too triggered at this point.

The original posts were rather informative with their captions saying *OMG THERE'S A THIEF IN OUR STREET AGAIN EVERYONE BE CAREFUL* before it was gradually retweeted and everything became thirsty.

Either way, it's bad. Also –

Ping!

>> I'll call you tomorrow. Good night, Kacchan!

Isn't this guy supposed to be… I dunno? Annoyed that he's being demanding? Maybe ask what right he has to tell him to change his username? The subject is not that big of a deal but Katsuki ought to be screaming if it was the other way around. He'd definitely be shouting something along the lines of *YOU DON'T GET TO DECIDE WHAT I GET TO DO SHITTY NERD.*

"Arrrrghhhhhhh!" Katsuki muffles a scream on his pillow, grabbing his hair. "Fuck – "

It would be much easier if the other was petty but no, he just had to be nice and kind. What a low blow.

Katsuki stares at the message on his phone, scowling before he presses a few buttons.

"Kacchan," Izuku sits up on his bed, perking up at the call. "I thought you were asleep. Good evening."

There's silence before, *"Good evening."*

Ah, there it is. "Did I wake you up with my text?"

"No, I was reading something,"

He feels the urge to ask *ah, is it fanfiction* but decides against it because the other's been in quite a bad mood since this morning. It would be bad if he triggers that again. He wants to have a casual conversation so yeah… not doing that would be the best option. Izuku was currently staying at a dorm reserved by the school because he's taking his internships in Osaka. It's quite far away from his home in Fukuoka – about three hours by train so they have to stay here for the entire duration.

“Nn… No wonder you couldn’t reply,” he hums, a small smile on his face. “You must have been very engrossed.”

Silence.

“Kacchan?”

“The fuck? Are you always this nice to everybody?”

Izuku awkwardly laughs trying, “Only towards my husband.”

Silence again.

“Kacchan?”

“Fuck – Shut up – Ghnn…” there’s some sort of grumbling which he finds cute. It sounds like a small Pomeranian ready to pounce, held back by a leash. The image suits Katsuki. *“How was your day?”*

“Hmm?”

“I SAID HOW WAS YOUR DAY!?”

“It was good, dear,”

Silence.

“Good…” oh, he isn’t going to deny that nickname? Does it mean that it’s welcome? That it’s accepted? Izuku takes mental note, reminding himself to try a bunch more next time. *“No one was flirting with you or anything?”* Ahhh cute, Kacchan’s very cute.

“No, I told them I was married so…” that didn’t actually happen but yeah.

“…”

“Ohh…” Katsuki says, sounding very dazed. “That’s… *fuck you.”*

Izuku doubles over in laughter.

“I was a bit upset you know,” is what he hears from the other side of the line. *“You rejected my call.”*

“I wasn’t ready for it,” Katsuki defends himself, a bit nervous from being confronted.

He can feel the pressure all the way from Tokyo, goddammit!

“But Kacchan sent me a lewd pic!” the blonde flushes and scowls upon being reminded. It was a topless photo of him, one hand raising his shirt to expose his chest. He received a similar one from Deku before so he figured it was alright. *“What was I supposed to do?”* Izuku’s pouting on the other side of the line. *“It couldn’t be helped! I liked it!”*

Katsuki almost sputters because *you like it the fuck wha –*

“You were supposed to send one back!”

He just needs his daily dose. Give it. Hand it over shitty Deku!

Yummycat’s not around so he needs another method to acquire it.

“But aren’t video calls supposed to better, Kacchan?” they’ve already done it twice over the phone anyway. Last time was good and there wasn’t any awkwardness. They even spent their free time after that playing World Execute. *“Do you not want to see me? You seem fine with calls,”* this guy has it all wrong. Izuku’s quite an airhead sometimes.

“I just fucking said I wasn’t ready!”

“Ready for what?”

“Seeing your face dumbass!” moving, with audio and in real-time that type of thing. Katsuki groans as he starts to explain his case, leaving out the embarrassing details of him being grumpy and pent up. “Fucking feels like I’m going to explode or some shit,” way to go Bakugo Katsuki, what a good choice of words. Then again, he seems to have expressed his intentions well because Izuku’s humming on the other side of the line, seemingly thinking about something.

“Nn, that sounds like a serious condition, Kacchan,”

There’s a low amused chuckle and Katsuki is *burning.*

“It fucking is. That’s why leave me alone,” he covers his eyes with one arm as if the other could see. “Just do your job and send me the goddamn photo!”

Izuku, of course, gladly obliges.

Deku:

> >> Good morning, Kacchan!
> >> [**Photo attached:** A mirror photo of Izuku in his uniform.]
> << *what a slob. your tie is ugly*
> << *take it off*
> >> [**Clip attached:** 12 second video of Izuku slowly unravelling his tie, carefully zooming in.]

Katsuki almost chokes on his breakfast when he catches a glimpse of those thick veiny hands.

> >> like that?

Mina laughs as she takes a photo of Katsuki’s flushed face from across the counter.

The Secret Plotter @scrtpltr • 9 hrs ago

Check out my theory about Deku of BKDK's true identity *@reddit.SC/kjuYKn*

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained

(1) Receipts - kaminari means evidence or proof.
(2) Dear - what to call katsuki so that he shuts up.

forgive the late updates. i'm dying due to chemistry and anatomy right now.
i'll definitely be busier during midterms so if you have any plot bunnies for inspiration, feel free!

i kinda miss you, not gonna lie

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

r/BKDK • Posted by u/secretplotter • 1 day ago

Discussion **Who is Deku and what is his real identity?**

It is common knowledge for avid E-sports fans to know that the number one DPS player of Japan and Asia in World Execute has been married for quite a while now. Not literally but inside the game at least. The rumors started even before his debut during the 20XX PvP Tournaments before it was later confirmed during a stream because let's be real, he can't hide his status page from his viewers. He has to open it from time to time giving the audience a full view.

Back then although it clearly showed the married status, because his spouse hasn't been online for a long time only the word *offline* showed beside the title instead of a username. Bakugo debuted at the age of 18 so it's almost been 5 years since then.

Flash forward to April 18, 20XX and out of nowhere Deku appears. It happens in the middle of the WE Team Finals just after UA claimed their victory against Shiketsu. Many believe that Deku is just a PR stunt but on this thread I will explain why I believe he is real and legit. Yes, I do think that he has some sort of relation to Ground Zero and that his appearance is not just for clout. Also, below are information that are available online that show leads to what I think is his real identity. Recently quite a lot of things have been trending and I noticed quite a few similarities.

- **Background Information:** During his fourth stream Baku mentioned having a best friend who he always used to play WE with. Many assumed that this was Kirishima but it was later confirmed that they haven't met prior to being signed to UA. Also, *past tense.* Baku said that he started to play at around age thirteen so they probably met at that time. He also said that they used to hunt a lot of slimes together (low leveled monsters) meaning they were together at around LVL. 10 to 15.
- **Purpose for marriage:** he hasn't mentioned anything about it. He's always been pretty vague. Many think that it's for the benefits but come on guys... If you're a thirteen year old and you're getting married, although it's in game you really won't feel a thing? Chat even suggested that he file a divorce but Baku said no.
- He mentioned that his spouse was the same age as him that's why they get along.
- Hates partying because other players are useless. He once mentioned that there's only one person who can keep up with him and said person is not in team UA. See compilation *JU/kjuHKL*
- **Deku's Appearance:** Have you even seen the look on his face? Do you think UA can convince Bakugo Katsuki to put up an act? Aizawa literally had to threaten him to log out because at that point he was starting to leak private information with their DMs on stream. I don't think it's a PR stunt. I think it's a coincidence, a good one.
- **Deku Information:** They started to stream every Tuesday morning together

because Deku's free during that time. That alone confirms that he's a college student because high school students and lower have class in the mornings. It is also said that he has spare time in between his classes (definitely college student) and it has been confirmed that he's busy with University.

- They haven't played for quite a while together. We know it's years though because he hasn't appeared in Baku's streams prior to this. They're quite close because they call and text outside of streams. They also play duo during the evenings (as stated by many players in the Musutafu Area and Bakugo himself).
- **The TEA:** Baku's quite strict and private so there's only crumbs but *that* hashtag went viral on Twitter. There's been a theft in Osaka and two individuals were interviewed – Midoriya Izuku and Todoroki Shouto. Now… if you listen closely you can tell that Midoriya and Deku's voice are *very* similar. They both have the same soft and gentle, sometimes a bit awkward because they're nervous kind of tone. Link here: *@herotube.IUJ/kjaYK*
- Prior to that Baku also mentioned that Deku won't be appearing on stream for a while because he has University and who has university? Midoriya Izuku. Click on 02:17 on the video above to confirm. He and his friend are interns from Kyushu University and they're graduating students.
- Deku is also a graduating student *bkdk/UIOkna*
- HIS INSTAGRAM HANDLE IS @deku
- THIS HAS TO BE TOO GOOD TO BE A COINCIDENCE
- Deku's avatar has green hair and green eyes. Midoriya Izuku has green hair and green eyes.
- Looks: Voice: *same.* Education Status: *same.* Social Media Name: *same.*

You lot can't convince me otherwise. FIGHT ME!

14.2k Comments ↳ Share

"The fuck? No, that's not Deku,"

Katsuki deadpans, red eyes focused on the combat that's showing up on his screen.

Click. Click. Click. Click. Click. Click.

Under his seat, his knee rapidly bounces in its place.

"Stop believing everything you see online. I haven't read that post but it sounds shitty and dumb,"

Actually, he has read the post. He's read it last night to be more exact. Only a few thousand people have seen it but yeah, that's a lot. He reported that shit as well so hopefully they take it down. It's during instances like this he has no shame in using his online abilities and influence. He sent that link to Aizawa the moment he's seen the contents as a form of damage control. Hopefully, it won't be reposted and all.

Chat:

>> it was a good thread but the user took it down
>> Probably because of the hate comments

>> It’s an invasion of privacy smh
>> they were really pushing it with their theories www
>> So creepy. Even if it was true isn’t that doxxing?

“I already told you guys but stop trying to figure out who Deku is,” he starts off, clicking his tongue all the while glaring at the camera. “That’s gross and if you keep this up you won’t ever get to see him again,” or *hear* in a sense. That seems to do the trick because chat immediately panics and promises not to do so. One advantage of having a Japanese audience is that most, if not all of them, respect your privacy. Then again, there’s always that small percentage of shitty extras and it’s better to be careful.

“You can clip this shit and repost. I swear to God if I see you guys continue with that witch hunt I will – “

>> *immediately deletes twitter post*
>> Can I still use that guy as a face claim for Deku tho?
>> Only fake fans will do something so low!!
>> I miss ----- we’re getting scolded again even through we’re innocent
>> You tell ‘em Baku! GO! GO! GO! GO! GO!

“So yeah, cut that shit out,”

All the while Ground Zero’s running around with Eri and Kota. He’s been including them in his streams frequently nowadays. He has that happiness bar to fill and it does go lower if he doesn’t manage to log in during the evenings. The children will get upset if he’s absent as well.

“Good,” he says when he sees the responses, a bit smug and proud. “Know your place shitty extras.”

" – fault. It’s all your goddamn fault! Why was your username Deku – “

“I use that username everywhere, Kacchan,” Izuku awkwardly laughs because Katsuki seems to be more worried about this over him. It’s a bit flattering and slightly worrisome. He knows that the other is very troubled over this and it’s kind of obvious since he brings it up almost every night. It’s one of the issues a popular gamer has to go through – privacy issues. “It’s always been like that since back then and they didn’t pay attention to me,” he shrugs his shoulders because he’s changed it a while ago.

“You’re not taking this seriously,”

“I’m an officer, Kacchan,” or would be at least. “I think I have a better sense of danger than you do.”

Silence.

That’s right. Understand that Bakugo Katsuki.

“Kacchan?”

“Ghnn— fuck – okay goddammit,” maybe he’d drop the topic now and they’ll talk about

something else. *"Pikachu told me to remind you of his Mario Kart stream,"* usually he won't bother doing this but since Kaminari did inform him about the viral post on Twitter, he's willing to let this slide for once. *"Since you promised him and shit,"* referring to that Team UA stream Deku joined along with Kota and Eri.

"Ah, that!" Izuku perks up. "Sure! Tell him I can play!"

"The fuck!? You have time for the dolt and none for me?"

He opens his mouth to reply before pausing to shut it close because *Nn, that sounds cute Kacchan.*

He's not going to point it out though because he'll definitely get mad.

"Todoroki-kun always brings his switch with him," he explains, remembering the details they talked about previously. Katsuki's teammate was also quite detailed about it since it would be Izuku's first time playing a different game with them. "And I can use my phone to talk to you guys on discord right?" using the call function and all. Kaminari said that it was the app they used for these kinds of streams.

Silence.

"Kacchan?"

"Who the fuck is Todoroki-kun?"

"The colleague I told you about. The one who's in Kyoto with me," he remembers mentioning his friend in one of his previous text messages so maybe the other forgot. Who knows. "You've probably seen him on Twitter, Kacchan. He's the other person they're also talking about," superintendent Todoroki Enji's son. He really didn't want to go to Tokyo for his internships.

"He casually lends you his switch?"

Izuku laughs because, "He always brings it all the time!" Even at school, yes.

"And he's not possessive of gaming equipment unlike you, Kacchan,"

Since he's rich and all. Todoroki can definitely buy multiple if he wants to.

"Hah!? I'm not possessive!" Izuku hums, going along with it. *"I can also fucking lend you my switch."*

Oh? Green eyes blink before he fondly smiles saying, "Hmm? Is that so?"

"That so," Katsuki repeats on the other side of the line.

It's almost been a month since Izuku's internships started.

"Osaka is very pretty during fall, Kacchan,"

It'll be the month of October soon.

“Osaka is not as red as Kyoto but it’s still pretty. I’ll send you a photo next time.”

Deku:

>> [**Photo attached:** Selfie with Todoroki, red maple trees in the background.]
>> With Todoroki-kun!
<< *did you eat katsudon again*
<< *your round face takes up half the screen*

The photo is oddly clear and Katsuki finds himself zooming in unto those freckles.

>> maybe it’s this
>> [**Photo attached:** Izuku holding a taiyaki to the camera, the photo taken by Todoroki.]

Ah, it’s been a long time since he’s gotten something that isn’t a selfie. The image cuts off at Izuku’s waist, a scarf around his neck. He’s dressed appropriately for fall, coat on top of his uniform and all. It doesn’t help how there are red leaves falling in the background, the photo looking more picturesque than it originally intended.

“I can take a better photo than that,” is what Katsuki thinks before he saves the image.

“Shinsou-kun, you’re here,”

Izuku’s face brightens when he recognizes his friend, the other male groaning in response. He’s come all the way from another prefecture just for this. The Osaka headquarters have been working on a certain case for quite a while now but due to how meticulous their targets are, there aren’t a lot of leads even after months and almost a year of intel gathering. Nevertheless, today there’s a big fish. They found out that Bubaigawara Jin, the thief that Todoroki and Izuku caught, is actually part of the organized group of criminals they’ve been looking for.

He’s been detained since he had no one to bail him out – *strange but not uncommon* – and has been in jail for a while now. To add to his case there are also charges of not just theft but also robbery, assault, fraud, smuggling, and illegal possession of firearms after deep investigation. It’s gotten easy to source CCTVs in that street he always frequents because the lookout has been caught.

“It’s only been a few weeks….”

They sourced Shinsou from Izuku. They were looking for someone who was good with talking and interrogation. *It’s like he’s brainwashing them or something,* is what Todoroki said when he seconded Izuku’s suggestion a few days ago. He may not be the top student at Kyushu University but his skill in that area is very prominent just like how Izuku is with analysis.

“You guys have it tough. How much have you gathered?”

“There’s digital data and evidence but we need something from him if possible – “

“Midoriya made two files worth of info alone,”

Shinsou deadpans at his friend who just awkwardly laughs.

“It’s different if it’s from a direct source!” well, true. No arguing with that. “Can you do it, Shinsou-kun?”

Purple eyes blink before he says, “I took a three-hour train for this… I’m not sure.”

“I’m sure you can do it!”

“Don’t be pessimistic…”

Shinsou groans and after realizing that they’re still standing at the door so he says, “Well?”

Izuku and Todoroki stare at him curiously, waiting for him to finish his sentence.

“When do we start?”

They then lead him to the conference room where a bunch of other officers sit by waiting.

Kacchan:

>> pikachu’s stream is on the fourteenth
>> that’s a saturday. you don’t have internships on saturdays
>> do you?

“Kacchannnnnnn,”

Izuku whines as he plops down on the bed face flat, uniform still on. He has the other on speaker, a few inches next to his face. Apparently, Katsuki had sent him messages earlier today but he was too busy and wasn’t able to check. He could’ve checked during his break but he was so engrossed in mountains of paperwork that the thought didn’t even cross his mind. He was enthusiastic since it was his long-awaited big case but after leaving the headquarters, the exhaustion finally sunk in.

“I was working on a case. How was your day?”

There’s a shuffle on the other side of the line before he hears, *“It’s already ten.”*

“Nn, I got out at nine forty today,” his eyes are already closed at this point. “Working on something big.”

“Good work,” Izuku hums, pleased. *“Have you had dinner yet?”*

“Later,”

“Bath?”

“Later,”

“Midoriya Izuku, what a fucking slob,” he chuckles at how his name rolls off Katsuki’s tongue, liking how he’s being referred to with his real name. The intent is different but it still seems like it so he’ll let it pass for now. *“Don’t tell me you’re buying take out again. I don’t really want to see any selfies of your round face tonight,”* there’s also that option of stopping by at a convenience store but to someone like Katsuki, anything other than homemade food is basically viewed as take-out.

I’m sorry I can’t cook.

Izuku laughs because, “I don’t send you selfies at night time though.”

It’s a different kind of photo.

“Fuck you,”

“Nn,” he hums, cheek pressed against his pillow. “I miss playing World.”

“There are internet cafes in Osaka, you know,”

“But they’re too far,” from his dorm that is. “I don’t have the energy for that.”

Nowadays he just wants to lie down on his bed because he’s exhausted by the time he finishes work. It was somewhat tolerable when he was back at Fukuoka before the internships started because he doesn’t really run around for the entire day. He’s just sitting in class and the most exercise he does is at the gym. Now it’s different with all the patrols, raids, and operations they do on a daily basis. Not to mention paperwork. It’s good that he likes it but even Todoroki and Shinsou are having a hard time.

“Hurry up and finish your internships then, dumbass,”

Izuku smiles pleased, all the while hugging his pillow.

“You sound like you miss me, Kacchan,”

There’s a rustle on the other side of the line, a few seconds of silence before, *“Shut up.”*

He’s probably red right now, all puffed up because *Kacchan’s not actually denying it. Cute.*

“Yeah?” Izuku hums, tone careful and soft. “You miss me? How bad?”

Katsuki groans, grumbling for a while.

Izuku is leaning back on the headboard of the bed with his phone tucked between his shoulder and ear.

“Kacchan…“ Eyes half-lidded and eyebrows knitted together. “Did you do it, Kacchan?”

On the other side of the line is Katsuki in the same state, complying with his instructions. It's been a while since they've done this. They've sent pictures and all but with how busy Izuku was, they couldn't really find the right timing. It's half-past ten – the officer still in his uniform with his pants zipped down and unbuttoned. There's a slick sound that fills the room, thick scarred hands wrapped around his dick as he listens to the other call out to him.

"Ghn—"

"Did you put your fingers in?"

"Nn…" there's a slight mewl from Katsuki. *"I put them in."*

"Good," Izuku nods, moving his hand a bit faster before he grits his teeth, the image filling up his head.

"It's a good enough replacement for now,"

They remain in that position for quite a while.

Deku:

>> [**Photo attached:** Izuku's hand holding a paper bag from McDonalds.]
>> I guess you're right
>> You'll be seeing my round face again tonight

Katsuki stares at the photo in a daze, still not having recovered from earlier. He's already changed his clothes and finished cleaning up but yeah… he's still a bit confused regarding something.

"A good enough replacement…" he blinks, looking up from the device to stare at the wall.

Silence.

Katsuki then starts to turn red when he realizes what it means.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Doxxing - searching for and publishing private or identifying information about an individual on the internet. this is usually done with malicious intent.
(2) Discord - an app they use for voice chats during streams.
(3) Bubaigawara Jin - alias twice, the thief todoroki and izuku caught.
(4) Round Face - izuku's face is not round.
(5) WWW - stands for *wara wara wara* or *laugh laugh laugh.* it's basically *hahaha* or *lolololol* in japan.

peace offering because it's midterms next week. i'll update after my exams but for now i have to cram.
mario kart chap coming right next!

kaminari's mario kart stream

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Are you guys ready for our guest today?"

Kaminari grins at the camera, clicking something on the screen.

It's his long-awaited Mario Kart stream! He's always wanted to do something like this, you see. World Execute is cool and all but he'd like to play something less competitive from time to time. Plus it's fun! It did take him quite a while to find people to play with nevertheless. Katsuki proved to be the toughest to convince, harder than team Ketsubutsu who will be playing with them today. They need twelve for a game after all. It won't do if they're incomplete, definitely no good!

It's an All-Star party!

"Ehh? We're not the guests?"

Camie fakes a pout on the other side of the line.

They're all connected in discord right now – team UA, Shiketsu, and Ketsubutsu plus one special person. It's not visible on Kaminari's screen though because he only has his face and game up. No one aside from him is streaming as well because the views would be more concentrated in one place that way.

"You always play with us so you're not a guest!"

"But it's our first time with Mario Kart…"

Mina and Camie, the only girls on call start to chatter.

Chat:

>> someone that's not from ua or shiketsu??
>> IT BETTER NOT BE MONOMA
>> ANYONE BUT MONOMA
>> Did they force Aizawa to play with them again www
>> That guy from Naniwa danshi? The one they did a collab with?

Kaminari is snickering, eyes scanning the chat, "Special guest-sama, please introduce yourself!"

Click. Click.

Silence.

"Where's the guest?" Shindo asks after about fifteen seconds. *"He's typing something in the group chat."*

"GODDAMIT," an ever so familiar voice exclaims. *"YOU'RE MUTED AGAIN SHITTY DEKU!"*

Katsuki's already explained the app's controls *twice* to him, you know!

>> !!!!???

>> PAPA!!!????
>> DEKU!? DEKU'S HERE?? WHERE!?
>> OMG IS IT REALLY HIM DON'T PLAY WITH ME MAN
>> FFFFFFF WELCOME BACK

Their team captain is nagging all the while chat explodes, Kaminari laughing at the commotion. A short while later there's a muffle on the other side of the line. It's obvious that this person is only using headphones because unlike the streamers on call, his volume is a bit more compressed and slightly muddled. The switch he's using is playing the game's theme in the background as well. Katsuki then starts to rant about the volume, Izuku turning the console's music down in a flustered manner.

"Sorry, Kacchan," one phrase and chat runs at the speed of light. *"I clicked the wrong button… I think."*

>> ahhhhhh DEKUUUUUUUUUUUUUUUUUUUUUUUUUU
>> [**Tenmaa donated ¥20,000:** I'M HAVING A HEART ATTACK]
>> [**tachibanaaaa_ donated ¥10,000:** welcome backkkkkkkkkk!!!]
>> I MISSED YOU SO MUCH AHHHHH! I'M SO GLAD I'M WATCHING THIS LIVE!
>> [**ARIIIIRANNNGG donated ¥20,000:** WHY DIDN'T YOU TELL US THIS SOONER BAKU!!!!???]

"Wait, wait, *WAIT – "* Kaminari's eyes are dizzy, barely keeping up. "I can't read you all at once!"

It's basic courtesy to answer most, if not all, super chat as a sign of gratitude.

"Wow he has a lot of simps," that's a lot coming from Camie, E-girl, and number one on the super chat rankings this month. She's definitely keeping track of the comments on another device of some sort. "Let's collab next time, Deku~!"

Pissed off, Katsuki clicks his tongue as he exclaims, *"CAN WE JUST GET THIS OVER WITH ALREADY!?"*

Plus Ultra Scans:

I cannot tell you how bitter I am for not being able to watch this stream live.

I don't usually watch a lot of Kaminari's streams because I'm busy being a Baku stan and although it was a collab… I should have known. I thought it was one of those usual team UA streams but noooooooo. My day is ruined. Esteemed father was a guest. We haven't seen him in over a month and he pops out of nowhere! I saved up money for his return you know! There are clips on the internet and thankfully Kaminari archived it but still! Watching it live must have been very fun. Deku was answering questions and all.

Anyway, here's a rundown. DM me if there's something I missed *@herotube.IBv/KJmaE*

07:24 – Kaminari finishes his intro and team Shiketsu and Ketsubutsu are introduced.

08:38 – Does team UA even need an introduction wwwwww

11:42 – Mina bringing her own gaming chair from her room LOL

14:20 – THERE'S A SPECIAL GUEST!!

15:52 – Baku has been teaching Deku how to use discord off cam in private. Write that down. *SOMEBODY WRITE THAT DOWN.* If that ain't domestic I don't know what is. Also, isn't it cute how they're bickering and all? Give the man some slack Baku geez wwww. Deku's so patient hngghh

22:36 – Camie tries to flirt with Deku. THANK YOU CAMIE. WE GET TO SEE JEALOUS KACCHAN.

27:51 – Inasa's map is chosen. It's his and Deku's first time playing Mario Kart. They joined because their friends asked them to and they couldn't refuse awwwww. Baku's probably the same WWWW He hates these kinds of games. Remember Fall Guys? He loathed that with a passion. Maybe he'll play with Deku someday? FINGERS CROSSED! *@herotube.VYt/KUg*

40:02 – "Long time no see chat," *LONG TIME NO SEE TOO DEKU OMG I MISSED YOU SO MUCH IT JUST HIT AHHHH IT'S SO FREAKING PAINFUL* *sobs* He still has work though. It's his day off so he can play like this. Please don't overwork yourself!

45:12 – It's Baby Park ahhhhhh everyone's fighting LOL

54:19 – I present to you the cluster of chaos *wwwwwww*. It's fine even if you're last Inasa! We still love you! Also, aren't you supposed to be the expert here Kami? HE'S ALSO LOSING AT ELEVENTH PLACE WWWWWWWW I CAN'T EVEN –

01:02:04 – Camie convincing Deku to say "Hi baby".

01:02:49 – OH NO. FUCK FUCK FUCK *@herotube.KJn/LKij*

01:03:18 – Cute nagging Kacchan! He doesn't like it when Deku does fan service wwwwww

01:12:51 – Kirishima and Sero singing the baby park theme song at fourth and fifth place.

01:17:32 – Last match? NOOOOOOOOOOOOO *crying*

01:24:06 – Free talk session for the super chat and stuff.

01:30:23 – OUR BOI BAKU GETTING OUST BY CHAT LOL.

01:31:40 – Yes we'll keep your identity a secret Deku hnggghh voice so mellow. FUCK DOXX-ERS I'MA REPORT THAT SHIT IF I EVER SEE ONE. Please stay from now on ahhhhhhhhhhh

02:04:15 – Next team UA stream will be on Baku's channel! FINGERS CROSSED!

This stream made me happy and a mess. I'm somewhere in between right now.

"Today was really fun, Kacchan!"

Izuku says over the line, Katsuki leaning back his seat with his headphones still on.

The stream ended just a few moments ago and twitter is already filled with thousands and thousands of posts regarding that one event. Usually, the gamer would pay no heed to these kinds of things but right now he's glad that the prior issue's been taken over – the identity thing, he means. Also, chat was quite obedient today. They're always like that, goody-two-shoes with Deku and very snarky with him. The contrast is quite obvious but at least they're not causing trouble for the other.

"Tell Kaminari thank you! He said that he'll give me quartz even though he doesn't have to…"

Ah, that's right, Izuku's one of those guys who doesn't spend money on games.

"Yeah, yeah," Katsuki monotonously agrees. "What are you doing after this?"

"Me? I don't have anything planned so I'll be in the dorm,"

"That's boring,"

"Nn, makes you wanna play World huh?"

Silence.

Click. Click.

"Maybe next time Kacchan," he says after a while. *"I won't be lazy and I'll go visit a computer café."*

Katsuki purses his lips because, "I didn't say anything."

Izuku softly hums in reply.

Katsuki almost *ascends* when he sees the message.

Yummycat:

>> You're welcome.
>> [**Photo attached:** Izuku rolling up his sleeves, looking elsewhere.]
>> [**Photo attached:** Izuku in the middle of eating.]
>> [**Photo attached:** Tired Izuku leaning back his seat with no tie on, first two buttons undone.]

Anyway –

<< the fuck are you doing in Osaka!?

It barely takes the other a few seconds to reply saying,

>> Long story.
>> We're working on a big case.

Deku:

>> Nn, I don't really have time for breakfast
>> There's food at the cafeteria but it opens at nine

Katsuki narrows his eyes at the screen.

The moment Izuku returns his friend's console he gets interrogated, mismatched eyes focused on him.

"So what's he like?"

Todoroki's always been curious ever since that tournament. He finds it a bit unfair that Izuku's only talking to Shinsou about Katsuki when obviously he's the best friend. He doesn't look like it but he's a bit petty when it comes to these kinds of things. It's not his fault their classes are different. He almost filed a protest regarding that but that's an issue for another time. *I also want to be a supportive friend,* is what he thinks. *I can also give love advice,* is what he assumes.

"Hmm? Who?"

"Kacchan – " in a parallel universe, Katsuki is screaming because he doesn't like it when people other than Izuku call him *that*. Kaminari's attempted that once and has received retribution. "What's he like?"

Izuku blinks because *oh, Todoroki's curious.* That's new.

"Well… First of all, Kacchan's very cute."

Ping!

Izuku takes his phone out of his pocket, on his way to the headquarters with Todoroki.

Bakugo Katsuki **has sent you a LINE gift.**

You received 2x *Pumpkin Spice Latte!*

Kacchan:

>> you can claim it if you show it to them
>> it's a fall special

Izuku blinks, his heart squeezing before he shows a very pleased smile.

<< *Is this one your favorite?*
<< *Thank you Kacchan*

For the first time after a month of internships, he asks Todoroki if they could make a quick turn.

<< [**Photo attached:** Izuku's hand holding coffee.]

Later Shinsou complains because *why did you only send him two, not three.*

There's a meeting.

"Bubaigawara confessed,"

One of the higher-ups who is sitting next to Shinsou says.

The statement is enough to make the few remaining voices vanish in thin air, everyone completely focused on the division leader. Izuku smiles at his friend for a job well done while Todoroki nods, satisfied with the outcome. They knew that the other could do it. He was a bit reluctant at first but in the end, he did manage to get a confession. It wasn't a forced one as well. It was one filled with details and information about the organization's whereabouts and motives. Their friend would definitely get a good word in after this. It's a very big achievement after all.

"Is it in Nishinari ward as expected?"

"Yes, in Kamagasaki,"

Someone in the room sighs because *of course.*

They had their hunch but having it confirmed was different.

Even if they know where the headquarters is now, they can't really do anything if it's at Nishinari. That place is a breeding ground for crime – drugs, alcohol, gambling, money… anything illegal, you name it. Criminals are untouchable there, gathered in large groups, a good countermeasure against police. It doesn't help how they probably have firearms as well. It won't do it they have a shoot-out. Contrary to what one expects, there are schools and civilians living in said area – those near the poverty line.

"Are we going to issue a warrant of arrest?

They have to submit something to a judge soon for that.

“No, we can’t do that for now,”

Izuku and Todoroki glance at each other.

“We need a bigger incident,”

Four days later the entire Amano forest camp sets ablaze.

Deku:

>> Have something scheduled today!
>> Might not be able to call you cause we’ll be finishing up late
<< *s’fine*
<< *call me tomorrow morning then*

It’s all over the news.

“Isn’t this… bad?” Kirishima gulps, staring at the television.

Everyone’s gathered in the living room because they just had dinner. A few of their team members per usual were skimming through the channels for entertainment before something caught their eye. In a country as peaceful as Japan, an incident of this scale is considered a *disaster.* Thefts are tolerable but arson? Katsuki who’s standing near the kitchen counter narrows his eyes at the screen.

“Hey isn’t that – “

“ – 14 students from Setagaya High School are still yet to be found. The students along with their teachers are said to be on an excursion from Nagano. According to officials and a few witnesses, the incident was intentionally caused by someone. Motives are still unknown and they’re tracking him down as we speak but as you can see, behind me there’s a curtain of smoke and although it’s already night time, the sky’s tinted red because of the fire – “

Osaka?

“ – ambulances have arrived about an hour ago and the victims are receiving first aid. There are no heavily injured amongst the teachers, staff, and students – “

Mina nervously glances at their team leader.

“ – three officers have been shot, two stabbed. This may not be the work of just one person – “

Katsuki blocks out the rest of the report as he heads up to his room to grab his phone.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Pumpkin Spice Latte - popular at starbucks during fall. it's not katsuki's favorite drink but he thinks that izuku would like it. (2) Line Gift - app setting that allows you to send gifts to another person.

we have fanart again!
this one is by frozs in tumblr. do check it out! it shows katsuki streaming ahhhhhhh goodness, you're all such good artists. you have the fic down to a t. i can't believe we're getting fanart www
also, i'm starting to regret the fact that i have neither twitter or tumblr.

the art of eye contact

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Shinsou could feel an upcoming headache – actually, never mind – he *has* a headache.

"Wow, you guys look fantastic,"

Is what he sarcastically says as he dumps a bunch of paper bags on Todoroki's lap.

It's takeout because one out of two has been complaining about hospital food for quite a while now. It's a bit ironic because food in Japanese hospitals is much better than the rest of the world. Also, he wasn't exactly complaining but well… you get the gist. One fact is that Todoroki Shouto cannot survive without eating soba at least twice a week and it's already been two days.

Yep, both of them are injured. It's nothing life-threatening but it's still enough to get them admitted.

"Thanks,"

"It wasn't a compliment you bastard,"

Shinsou groans as he plops down on a chair, the bags under his eyes more prominent than ever.

"What am I? Your mother?"

In the corner of the room – *sitting on his bed* – green eyes start to water because *mother.*

"I called Inko-san days ago. Don't worry about it Midoriya,"

He then elaborates about how she was on the verge of buying a ticket to Osaka just to see her son. Thankfully, Shinsou with his top persuasive skills convinced her not to ditch that court trial she has scheduled. Izuku's friend group is quite close to the woman, you see. It also helps how her profession is related to their course so anytime they need some sort of advice; they always go and ask her opinion.

Also, it looks like for some reason his friend and his mother are text buddies?

Hmm? Is he being replaced?

"Inko-san also texted me," Todoroki says, rummaging through what Shinsou brought. "I told her you were injured but that it wasn't anything too serious. She wanted to call but you were sleeping."

Izuku almost sulks because, "You should have told me, Todoroki-kun…"

Todoroki simply shrugs his shoulders, unfazed.

"Ahh… by the way," Shinsou blinks, remembering what he had to say. "They said that you can get a new phone as long as it's within the budget. The headquarters will be covering it for you," how convenient is that? Izuku broke his phone during his fight with that guy – *alias Muscular* – along with a few of the bones in his right arm. It was a rough fight so it couldn't be helped.

He was scolded at first because *who fights a criminal with hand-to-hand combat?*

His weapon was deflected, okay? The guy was good!

“Thank you Shinsou-kun,” their friend has been going back and forth these past few days. Even though he was just supposed to be here for the interrogation, he ended up taking care of him and Todoroki. “I really appreciate it. Sorry for the trouble.”

The other just nods as he leans back on his seat before he grimaces, feeling the vibration in his pocket.

Ah. Now that he thinks about it –

“I also told Ground Zero,”

Izuku slightly tilts his head to the side before he nervously presses his lips into a thin line.

Wha – so you’re fine with your mom finding out but not this guy?

“Midoriya,” Shinsou sighs, exhausted. “If you’re really sorry then answer this text for me.”

He’s tried clarifying things but for some reason, it’s never enough.

“I don’t think he’ll stop unless you explain it yourself,”

Izuku nervously stares at the device his friend extends towards his direction.

How long will the shinkansen take from Tokyo to Osaka?

Has been on the top of Katsuki’s search board for a few hours now.

It’s present along with phrases like – *how much is the ticket from Tokyo to Osaka? Amano Forest Camp Incident, Osaka Headquarters, Setegaya Highschool accident,* and the likes. Obviously, his search history revolves around one core – *Midoriya Izuku.* He doesn’t even want to utter the unlucky bastard’s name. His blood is burning even at just the mere thought of it. He’s heard the details from Yummycat but the way things line up is completely *absurd.*

Criminal Association? Big Fish? Hostages? Arson?

What do you mean there was a fight and Deku successfully protected a bunch of students from this… this… this Muscular guy who’s part of said feared organized crime? Why is he even called *Muscular?* What a lame-ass name. Also, you mean to say that his phone broke in the midst of it all? It’s either he dropped it or forbid – *Katsuki is seething* – got hit so hard the glass shattered.

What kind of barbaric strength do you need to do that?

Is this a web novel or some shit?

This ain’t Solo Leveling goddamnit!

The blonde feels the need to scream or rip out his hair.

Maybe both at the same time. It doesn’t help how Yummycat’s so greedy about the details.

"He keeps leaving on me seen," Katsuki grimaces as he turns his attention back to his screen. He just finished streaming this morning so he's not live right now. He's currently playing World Execute nevertheless because the children will goddamn sulk if no one visits them. *"WHY THE FUCK ISN'T HE ANSWERING!?"* too used to Izuku immediately replying. It's starting to turn into a bad habit actually.

It's only been fifteen minutes… This is how it usually works, you know.

Ping!

Fucking finally –

Yummycat:

>> I'm all better now, Kacchan.
>> Sorry I wasn't able to contact you I broke my phone
>> I'll get it replaced in a few days

Ping!

>> This is Deku

Deku? The fucker who got his arm broken after a fight?

Katsuki remains silent, deleting the things he places on the text box – *struggling* with what to send. The last thing he wants is for Deku to think that he's being nosy and impatient. The fucker can get stabbed if he wants to, just to be clear. Then again, he doesn't like being left in the dark. Although this relationship of theirs is rather ambiguous, Katsuki is confident that he's *special*. He's gotta be or there's going to be hell to pay.

Anyway –

Katsuki doesn't get to send his reply because he's taking too long and the phone rings.

***Yummycat* is requesting a video call.**

Ah.

There might have been some sort of immovable force because this time, Katsuki doesn't hesitate before he accepts.

"Shitty Deku –

"Yo," unexpectedly, it's Yummycat's face that welcomes him and not Izuku. He's sitting on a hospital bed and beside him is some dude with mismatched hair. He's also in the middle of eating soba for some reason, heterochromatic eyes focused on the blonde's face on the screen. *Todoroki Shouto,* he notes. *The guy with the switch,* is another. *"I was the one typing,"* fuck so was he getting trolled then – *"Midoriya was telling me what to write because his dominant arm is in a cast. He's a snail right now."*

"Fuck… so he really broke his arm?"

“Shattered his… what did they call it Todo?”

“Ulna,”

“Yeah, that,”

He then explains how it would’ve been a career-ending injury if it weren’t for one of Japan’s top medical doctors being coincidentally present in the hospital. She’s so good with surgery they call her *Recovery Girl.* She’s old now though so the *girl* part is rather strange. Anyway –

Like I said is this Solo Leveling or some shit!?

“How long will it take to heal?”

“She said eight to twelve weeks – “ before Shinsou realizes, *“Why am I explaining this? Talk to this guy.”*

And the phone gets tossed, the screen dark as it’s facing down on the sheets for a short while.

Katsuki watches and listens as there’s a shuffle, Izuku’s familiar voice mumbling something.

Fuck.

Katsuki can feel his heart hammer against his chest.

He might’ve been much more worried than he had originally expected.

“Kacchan?”

Ahhhhhhhhh – *fuck.*

Fuck. Fuck. Fuck. Fuck. Fuck.

“Ahh, I can see you now,” there’s that soft smile and gentle voice, some sort of weird angle that for some reason works. *“Sorry, wait a sec – “* Yummycat is doing something in the background and the two are talking before the phone gets propped up on the bed table, Izuku leaning in to balance the device in front of a bunch of snacks his friend brought.

Katsuki purses his lips as he catches a glimpse of that freckled collarbone peeking through a loose hospital shirt. When Izuku leans back; the angle is finally alright and the smile returns to his face. Someone is snickering in the background – *Yummycat.* Todoroki on the other hand is definitely listening in, judging by Izuku’s slightly embarrassed expression.

“Hi Kacchan,” he awkwardly smiles and Katsuki’s heart *constricts. “You accepted Shinsou-kun’s call…”*

I thought it was you dammit.

The blonde grimaces asking, “You don’t have anything to say to me?”

“Nn, sorry for worrying you…”

Katsuki forces himself to scowl again because, “Don’t be so full of yourself. I wasn’t worried or anything.”

As if on cue Yummycat says, *“You kept texting and asking me…”*

Katsuki grumbles, starting to defend himself. *Fuck that guy. Anyway –*

"Still… I'm sorry. I missed your messages,"

He watches as green eyes peer through dark lashes. For some reason, Deku's exactly what he looks like in photos, maybe even better. In this scenario, Katsuki would've ran his mouth moments ago but he's a wreck right now, some sort of statue sitting on his gamer chair with Eri and Kota complaining about his monitor screen because Ground Zero is being a still avatar. He can't hear them nevertheless because he's taken his headphones off. The children can wait for now.

"Fuck – " is what he says to snap himself out of it. "You said your phone will be replaced. When?"

"I need it so maybe after we get released tomorrow," he and Todoroki are basically cleared.

"Good,"

"Nn, good," Izuku nods, shyly glancing at the screen.

The fuck is this guy doing?

There's silence for a while, Izuku flushing when Yummycat's laughter echoes in the background. He knows that his friend is *amused*. Shinsou is in on this and finds it funny how they are acting out of character. He probably thought that they've gotten to this stage already but no. It's their first time seeing each other.

"Shin— Shinsou-kun!" he tries to scold, red from his cheeks to his ears and neck. *"Don't tease me."*

Katsuki also explodes from embarrassment so he exclaims,

"You're fucking bad at explaining! Give the phone to Yummycat!"

"Ehh? But I can explain it to Kacchan – "

"On second thought I'm still mad and I don't want to see your face – "

A lie. A big blatant lie.

"Fucking switch! *NOW!"*

And Izuku submits, dejectedly handing the device to his friend.

Shinsou's laughter also worsens when he sees the expression Katsuki's wearing.

Yummycat:

> >> [**Photo attached:** Izuku flushed and pouting, lying down on his bed.]
> >> It's a lobster.

Ping!

Deku:

>> For some reason this phone is much more expensive and better than my last one…
>> I got my contacts back! Emails are awesome

“Hi again, Kacchan,”

Izuku greets under the light of his lamp.

His room is dark because it’s late and he doesn’t want others to see that he’s still up. His upperclassmen and mentors are quite strict because he’s injured you see. He’s still in his internship period and although they were given the choice to go home, both he and Todoroki decided to stick around for a while and help out in different ways. He’s free for the next few days nevertheless.

“I don’t want to get caught,”

So his curtains are also drawn and the light is at its lowest setting.

It’s much more comfortable now that it’s just the two of them talking.

Oddly enough, the sight is enough to make Katsuki’s heart skip a bit despite the bad lighting. He knew that Deku has always had a face that stopped people in their tracks. He doesn’t even realize that he’s staring before they make eye contact and the other gently smiles at him.

Fuck.

“Stop whispering shitty Deku,” with AC on its highest setting, Katsuki just wants to lie down and listen to the other's voice as he falls asleep. They always do that when they call. “Your mic is shit remember?”

“Nn, sorry,” there it is again, that awkward laugh.

Katsuki’s scowl falters and he groans, covering his eyes with one hand as he feels his face turning red.

That voice.

“Is it better now?"

That *fucking* voice.

"Don't do it again?"

"Hmm?"

"Disappearing for two days," Katsuki explains, "Scared the shit out of me."

Izuki hums on the other side of the line before he nods.

"If I disappear I think Kacchan would know..." Izuku pauses before adding, *"That it wasn't my intention, I mean."*

“Good night, Kacchan,”

A little past ten. There was a lot to catch up on and usually, they can keep talking up until midnight but Katsuki insists on the other to sleep. He’s injured after all. He has a horrible personality but he’s not a shitty person that would make a recovering patient lose sleep over something so trivial. They’ve been extending the time anyway and if Katsuki had his way, he would’ve hung up at around eight or nine.

Surely, Izuku’s still tired from all the physical work he’s been doing recently.

“Good night,” Katsuki replies, eyes already closed, cheek pressed against his pillow. “You hang up.”

“Okay,” Izuku nods before he pauses, remembering something. *“Kacchan?”*

“Nn?”

“Do me a favor?”

“What?”

“I wanna do something,”

“The fuck is it?”

“Press your phone against your forehead,”

“Why?”

“Just do it,” Izuku slightly laughs, rocking back and forth on his seat. *“Hurry.”*

Katsuki opens one eye and frowns at Izuku’s giddy face before he complies, pressing the screen on his forehead.

“Good night, Kacchan,”

Izuku’s careful and gentle tone, a shuffle before there’s the sound – a soft peck, a *kiss,* and the call ends.

Piiii – Piiii – Piiii – Piiii – Piiiiiiii –

Katsuki’s eyes open and he sits up, staring dumbfounded at the disconnected call in his hands. He presses his palm on his forehead before realization sinks in and he grabs his pillow giving it a good

squeeze. He manages to contain everything for a short while, shivering like some sort of dog on a leash.

Ultimately, a few moments later, he lets out a muffled scream.

Deku:

>> I got praised
>> [**Photo attached:** Izuku's medal of recognition.]
>> [**Photo attached:** Izuku, Todoroki and Shinsou with the Setegaya High School students.]

Kota and Eri's eyes glisten when they see a familiar figure appear in their living room.

"Papa!?" even the young boy who usually refers to him as *Deku* manages to slip.

Ground Zero looks unfazed, his avatar unmoving for now because he's still adjusting stream settings.

It's not an event! Why is there a cut scene!?

"Eri-chan, Kota-kun," Deku greets, and in the midst of it all chat starts to cry for some reason. *"Long time no see."*

There's no pause as the two immediately run up to him for a long-awaited hug.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Todoroki's Injuries - he had a concussion because he also fought.
(2) Shinkansen - bullet train, high-speed railway in japan.
(3) Medal - given to izuku to recognize his efforts.

we're back on track! eri and kota are also back!
they won't be doing any raids for now though because izuku's struggling with one arm.
chat and the children will surely understand.

super chat goes berserk again

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Papa!"

Eri exclaims, immediately extending out her arms to be picked up. When the command appears on Izuku's screen, he clicks and allows the action to happen, watching as a cut scene shows up. The graphics are unbelievable as always and he's never seen this picture with Eri before. Perhaps it a new patch? As far as he remembers, familiars don't have this many minor scenes.

In the background, Katsuki's still grumbling about something, threatening chat that's currently misbehaving.

"Welcommhhh backhhh – " her voice is muffled, face buried against his neck. "We missed you!"

Izuku brightens behind the screen as he replies, "I missed you too!"

He's currently back in his apartment in Fukuoka since he was given a week-long break along with Todoroki. It's some sort of reward for a job well done and for the both of them to recuperate. There's the option of staying in the dorms during that duration but both decided that it would be more efficient to go home for the time being. Also, Izuku would be able to play games that way!

Raids would be impossible with one hand but he can still talk to Eri and Kota at least.

"You're back Deku…" a flush-faced Kota approaches, small hands gripping the ends of his shirt.

Nn, very cute. Let's take a screenshot and save this for later.

"You're not going to call me papa anymore?" Izuku asks, the boy's cheeks brightening.

You said it earlier didn't you?

Anyway, it would be bad to tease him. Kota has a temperament like Katsuki so –

Ping!

(A) Aren't you going to give me a hug?

(B) It's good that you waited patiently…

(C) You're overreacting!

Another cut scene!?

"Aren't you going to give me a hug, Koucchan?"

To which the boy complies, the two of them in a cuddle pile with Deku on the couch.

A shy *welcome back* is then heard from the boy, one which makes Izuku all warm and giddy.

Chat:

>> [**pikaole donated ¥15,000:** I'm jumping in the screen and joining the group hug don't stop me.]
>> [**ASTER donated ¥7,000:** WELCOME BACK *cries*]
>> [**tanaka_01 donated ¥10,000:** i have been waiting for this moment!!]
>> [**mmorkomii donated ¥7,000:** Baku stop nagging and join them www]
>> [**RA.VII donated ¥12,000:** I bet Aizawa patched that new image lol. I saw it on twitter!]

"FUCK,"

Katsuki curses, clicking away with his mouse. It's a pain to keep track of those comments when they're overflowing on the chat bar.

"STOP WITH THE SUPER CHAT I AIN'T READING ANY OF THOSE."

Usually streamers have a positive response to donations but in this case, Katsuki just sees them as spam even with the money involved. It's not even super chat at this point. It's just a red blur with the pings going off in his ears because the settings make it so that he's notified. It's annoying to hear *ping! ping! ping!* every second you know. If he turns it off it won't be up for days and he can't risk that as well.

He's on the verge of exploding, to be honest.

"You alright, Kacchan?" Izuku who can't really see the comments asks. "Hi chat!"

Fuck, Katsuki loudly exclaims in his head. *You're making it worse, shitty nerd.*

In the end, today's stream manages to rank first on the super chat rankings for the month of October.

"How on earth did you manage to earn one million yen in one sitting?"

Aizawa stares at the record before shifting his attention to the team leader.

The other members snicker in amusement while Katsuki just huffs, completely unbothered.

"At this rate you should just stop competitive gaming and start farming in Musutafu…"

Katsuki is *furious.*

He and Deku played together and streamed from nine to twelve this morning. They also did the same thing from five to eight offline. In summary, they've been playing all day and the only reason they decided to stop was because Izuku needed to rest. With the other still recuperating, Katsuki insisted that he sleep early per usual. They didn't call after gaming because they've been talking to each other for the entire day. It's understandable and Deku said that he'd be going to be after eating

dinner and watching the news.

Imagine his surprise when he sees the other online.

Your husband *Deku* is online.

At two a.m.

Katsuki doesn't have an excuse.

He's playing because he can't sleep and he's bored. Nevertheless, he's not injured like the other and he's not sore and exhausted from fighting a criminal. This is also his job which gives him some sort of advantage and excuse. Deku can do whatever he'd like but it *GODDAMN PISSES HIM OFF! FUCK IS HE LIKE THIS!?* Katsuki for some reason wants to rip his hair out. He's been experiencing that kind of feeling for the past few days.

He's not worried. He's *irritated.*

Take care of yourself more, shitty nerd!

Izuku must've received the same notification because he immediately goes offline.

This fucker!

Now he's even more triggered.

Katsuki grabs his phone and immediately gives him a call, the other line ringing twice before a burst of familiar laughter resounds. Izuku seems like he's on the verge of dying, seemingly finding the situation he's in hilarious and Katsuki notices that he's never heard the other laugh this loudly before. All of a sudden, the ugly feeling he has starts to fade and everything gets replaced with some sort of weakness. He doesn't even start to speak until the other's somewhat finished.

"You little shit… You think this is funny?"

Izuku fondly hums, taking a while to calm down before he says, "Nn… Sorry, Kacchan. I'll go to sleep now."

Ping!

Deku:

>> One-handed tamagoyaki!
>> [**Photo attached:** Slightly deformed tamagoyaki on a plate.]
<< it looks ugly
*<< [**Photo attached:** Tamagoyaki on a plate with Team UA eating in the background.]*
>> I also want to eat Kacchan's food TT

Plus Ultra Scans:

This stream was so much fun HAHAHA. It was just Baku and Deku at first before Kaminari and Mina joined in. They usually have different streaming schedules (so that Team UA doesn't overlap and compete with views) but they had something scheduled in the afternoon so they were live earlier than usual. They didn't do any raids because let's be real, they've cleared almost everything at this point so they were doing side quests. It was only for a short while but it was very chaotic and fun HAHAHA.

As usual, here's the link *@herotube.IU/lkIHy*

42:26 – They meet up at around this point in Baku's stream.

49:07 – Deciding not to do raids because Deku has a broken arm (?). It's also everyone's first time hearing about this. Apparently Deku's injured. No one really noticed that they were not entering dungeons these past few days (let's be honest, any content is fine as long as Deku's present) but now that they mentioned it hmm… Get well soon Deku! He said that it wasn't anything serious but still!

53:10 – Understanding the rules of chess. No one knows how it works except for Deku lol. You'd expect that Baku would also know how to play but apparently not. They have to ask Eri and Kota to explain.

54:41 – "THERE'S NO SUCH THING AS DOUBLES IN CHESS," Kaminari and Mina want to team up because they have limited knowledge www.

55:06 – Katsuki gives up and decides that he'll only move one piece, *the queen because it moves everywhere and it's easy*, and Deku will deal with the rest.

56:23 – "Is Kacchan my queen then?" HNGGHHH BAKU'S FACE AHAHAHAHAHA

1:02:44 – Apparently there's UNO in World Execute. It's Deku's first time playing.

1:19:39 – AHHHHHHH GO KOTA

1:22:57 – Baku getting betrayed by Deku *#Divorce*

1:35:13 – Baku promises to teach Deku League of Legends. I really want see them team up tbh. World Execute's competitive format is nice but Deku playing other games with them would also be fun to watch. An FPS game like APEX would also be nice. Imagine him with a pathfinder and them getting champion as a duo ughhh

1:40:41 – Apparently Kota and Eri's affection for Baku and Deku are now max awww

1:44:02 – Mina and Kaminari leave for their photoshoot. They said that they'd be posting the photos on their Instagram accounts soon. It's a collab with other streamers they said. Baku is also taking photos for an E-mag for November so do check it out on their social media accounts.

This stream was very refreshing and fun. I also want to see Deku talk with Sero and

Kirishima. Those two are playing League nowadays so they don't have time for World but soon! Maybe soon! Fingers crossed! I really hope Baku manages to teach Deku how to play League.

Ping!

Kacchan:

>> [**Photo attached:** Kaminari selfie with Katsuki in the middle of a photoshoot in the background.]
<< *!!*
<< *Hi Kaminari-kun!*
>> [**Photo attached:** Grumpy Katsuki glaring at the camera.]

"Are you really falling asleep on me right now?"

Katsuki asks with a scoff, glancing towards his phone.

It's the afternoon and Izuku can't play because he has things to go through. His mentors at the headquarters were quite hesitant to ask for help because he is still healing and it's only been a few days since the event. Then again, no one knows the case better than he does. It's just fact-checking anyway. It's somewhat similar to proofreading before they pass on the report to someone of higher rank in the force.

Two hours have passed since then. Katsuki's playing games on his PC all the while Izuku's reading through the pdf file on his monitor. They're both mostly silent, asking each other questions from time to time with the video call on. Izuku's glad that the blonde's gotten comfortable enough to casually request for this. The AC's cold, he just finished eating and paired with a sore body, Izuku started to nod off in the middle of writing corrections. He must've been tired.

Katsuki definitely noticed earlier but refrained from saying anything.

"Deku," he calls out, the other resting on folded arms on top of his desk. "Deku."

The blonde lowers his controller, turning his full attention to his phone.

This guy really fell asleep on me…

"Deku," He tries again but no response.

"Midoriya Izuku," slightly louder this time and then, "'Zuku."

No response.

Katsuki clicks his tongue, a bit annoyed and mumbling, "He's really asleep…"

Click. Click. Click.

Red eyes glance at his phone again as he grumbles, “You’re cheating with that face…”

Imagine *that* pressed against his pillow. That would just be *unfair.*

Katsuki’s frown fades and he plops his head on the surface of his desk, staring at his phone for a while.

Tap. Tap.

“Wake up,” Katsuki says, tapping his fingers on the screen. “Don’t you have to finish that at four? It’s already three.”

Green eyes slowly blink open and the blonde can feel his stomach do backflips.

“Nn…”

Izuku’s slightly groggy voice paired with a grimace from the bright light of his monitor.

“Thanks for waking me up, Kacchan,"

The short close-up of the other’s neck and collarbone is also an added treat.

The Secret Plotter @scrtpltr • 2 hrs ago
I reposted my theory because someone took it down. This time I’ve added more. *@reddit.Yf/gTYA*

Aizawa sighs as he drags his mouse, clicking on the link.

“Tell me when you reach Osaka,”

“Nn, I’ll make sure to text Kacchan when I arrive,”

Izuku sheepishly laughs, alert when the bullet train stops in front of the glass doors.

“I have to go now, see you later Kacchan,”

“Bye,”

A fond smile shows up on his face as he hangs up and boards the train.

Time to get back to work.

“You’re injured so you’re on interrogation, Midoriya,”

Is what his mentor says, a few of the officers in the same division grinning at him.

Everyone’s quite fond of the interns.

Both Todoroki and Izuku had been teased for getting injured because it just shows how enthusiastic they are with their work. It’s a bit admirable and cute to see their underclassmen try to so hard. It’s not every day they get such promising additions on their team. Izuku just awkwardly laughs at the sentiment while Todoroki visibly frowns *because I can’t believe they separated us* which leads to a bunch of laughter.

“It’s fine Todoroki-kun…”

“I don’t like talking to people,”

And that’s usually Izuku’s job.

“Can’t you still go on patrols?” those are rather calm. It’s not like there are fights everywhere – actually, never mind. This guy is a danger magnet wherever he goes. “On second thought, it’s fine,” not risking Iida’s anger because he did go on a long rant during that one phone call. Uraraka’s been quite active in their group chat lately as well. As for Shinsou…. Shinsou just wants to rest.

It’s just the beginning of November so they still have at least eleven weeks to go before it ends in February.

“You’ll be fine Todoroki-kun,”

Izuku’s infamous last words before his friend leaves and returns with a bunch of lost children in tow.

After having video calls with Izuku for more than a week straight, Katsuki came up with a conclusion.

It’s making it worse.

Both physically and mentally, the process is not healthy for him.

His sleeping schedule is *ruined*, he doesn’t know how to deal with his feelings and the slight peek of skin at random intervals is making him *insane.* He *feels* insane. It’s like he’s on hyper-alert. Like he’s just chugged a jar of caffeine or something. It doesn’t help how Izuku calls him every morning and leaves the phone on the kitchen counter where he gets a good view of his apron and when he turns around there’s that –

Anyway. It’s worse.

It’s worse because he gets to see that uniform in live-action.

He *knows* what it looks like under that shirt so he just can’t –

As he said, it’s gotten worse.

Another prime example of how it’s gotten worse is their current situation.

“The…” Katsuki’s breath hitches, gulping when he sees the other meekly smile at him. The pressure is somewhat enough to make him back up on his seat, internally panicking. *“THE FUCK ARE YOU DOING!?”*

Incubus. Midoriya Izuku is a fucking incubus.

“Hmm? I’m not doing anything, Kacchan,” slightly tilting his head to the side. “I’m just getting changed?”

Katsuki then watches as Izuku's tie slowly unravels around his neck.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Tamagoyaki - japanese omelette made by rolling together several layers of fried egg.
(2) League of Legends - an actual online battle arena game.
(3) FPS - first person shooter. a genre like apex, valorant, fortnite and pubg.
(4) APEX - an actual fps game.

i seem to be more productive during exams. i just had the last one today!
anyway... you guys know where this is going. guess if izuku's just teasing or nah.
here's what izuku's uniform looks like for inspo. he has a gun holster and all.

hi you're cute wanna go get bubble tea?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

This guy is *playing* with him.

He can *tell,* he's not blind and he won't be fooled by that face. He's fallen for the same trick once and that will never happen again. It's the way Izuku would slightly move his face out of frame leaving all the good parts in focus. The way those thick veiny hands shift that make his breath hitch, the way that tie slowly unravels, the way he unbuttons the first two buttons of his shirt before –

"You look red, Kacchan,"

The devil sits down and sends him the most innocent smile he's ever seen.

This fucker. You've finally decided to reveal your true goddamn colors.

The blonde looks *antagonized* on his seat, shaking with rage as if he's about to blow up. Izuku's usually attentive with his emotions but for some reason, he's not saying anything about it right now. *Fucking hold it in,* he tells himself. *Fucking goddamn hold it in,* because if he reacts the way Izuku expects him to then that definitely counts as a loss and he's *the* Bakugo Katsuki. Bakugo Katsuki doesn't lose.

"Yeah, I'm annoyed at the way you're tying your tie," he's mentioned this to the other before. For some reason, Izuku has this intricate way of failing even the simplest knots. "It's ugly. You're a professional so learn how to do it properly."

"Nn, I tried. I also got scolded for it but they gave up…"

Scold is a bad term, *point out* would be better. His workplace in Osaka is very friendly and warm so these kinds of trivial things don't bother them that much. It would be a different story if it were somewhere else nevertheless.

Izuku then goes on to explain that he wore a *gakuran* in middle school and how they didn't have ties as a part of their uniform in high school. It's usually different per prefecture and region but that's how it worked in Fukuoka at least. They dress casually at university as well so he didn't get the chance to practice that much.

"And my arm is injured, Kacchan," referring to the sling on his right. "I can't exactly do it properly…"

Katsuki narrows his eyes unconsciously because *fuck I forgot about that.*

Way to go, Bakugo. Bullying someone injured over something they can't control.

Now he feels like shit.

"And I wanted to take it off to show you but it gets in the way," there's that awkward laugh again, somewhat apologetic this time. "Even though Kacchan's finally comfortable with talking to me like this. I can't even send pictures," the other's slightly pouting, seemingly like a dog that's been left in the rain and abandoned. He looks *really, really* disappointed with himself.

Red eyes blink, puzzled, “The fuck are you talking about?”

“Hmm?” Izuku also tilts his head to the side in confusion. *“Don’t you need your photos, Kacchan?”*

Katsuki flushes because, “What photos?”

Now that he thinks about it he hasn’t been receiving any these past few days. It can’t be helped because Yummycat’s gone and the other’s injured. Izuku can’t exactly take a proper photo with a cast on. It covers more than half of the view – *anyway.* Point is that he didn’t notice that there was a lack of it. There were way too many things that have been happening on video calls. If he gets photos along with random peeks of skin throughout the day, it’d be an absolute living nightmare – in a good way of course.

“Nudes,”

It’s a bit strange to hear someone like Izuku say those words. The guy doesn’t even curse.

“You got mad at me because I forgot last time…”

Ahh… *that.* Remembering it now makes Katsuki realize how petty he was.

“It’s… It’s fine you dumbass,” *the fuck is he biting his tongue for!?* “I don’t need it for now.”

Yes, *for now.*

Izuku raises his brows before his expression turns into something fond, “Okay, Kacchan.”

“Is that why you were doing *that?”*

“That?”

“Taking off your clothes… slowly,”

“Nn,” Izuku nods, not really embarrassed. *“I figured you’d like it.”*

Katsuki squeezes his eyes shut, grimacing.

“You two haven’t met!?”

Team UA is aware that their team leader and Deku rekindled during the tournament but it's October now, you know! It’s been half a year since then. One would expect that they’ve already met judging by how close they are. It’s also a reasonable expectation because Katsuki doesn’t share much about his schedule or the significant events in his life.

For all they know he might’ve met up with Deku sometime before and just didn’t tell them.

Apparently not…

“Ehh? What are you waiting for? It’s not like you lack the money to meet him,”

Sero says, eyes flickering from the screen towards his friend.

“Yeah, a plane ticket to Fukuoka is like what?” Kirishima nods, shrugging his shoulders before he contemplates the price. “Fifteen thousand yen? That’s not even a fraction of your salary,” unexpectedly, shinkansen cost more and take more time for a one-way trip. “That’s like… one red super chat,” so money is definitely not the problem.

“Hehe,” Mina is grinning as she leans closer to their team leader, “So even Baku has problems.”

“Even Baku is troubled~” Kaminari seconds with a sing-song voice.

The blonde clicks his tongue because *it’s these two dipshits again.*

He shouldn’t have admitted the fact that he and Deku haven’t met. It kind of slipped because these guys have been asking why they haven’t been introduced to the other yet. Apparently, this topic is very interesting and perfect for his nosy teammates who have nothing better to do. If he had his way he would be up in his room avoiding this conversation but the kitchen would burn so he has to deal with it for now.

“He’s not replying…” Kirishima blinks, shocked, “He really *is* troubled!”

“I’M NOT SHITTY HAIR!”

It’s none of their business if he and Deku haven’t met!

It’s not like meeting each other is *that* important. They’ve been doing well with the texts, calls, and all. They’re playing games every now and then as well even with Deku back in his internships. The four continue to chatter on and on, excited because planning first meetings seem like fun. . If he and Deku decide to meet up then that’d be up to them and –

Does Deku even want to meet up?

“Baku?” Mina calls out, noticing how his hands paused all of a sudden.

Now that he thinks about it they’ve never talked about *this* before.

It all starts with one question.

When are you going to ask him then?

Followed by a skeptical, “Is Baku even going to initiate?”

If it’s not Bakugo then how long do you think it would take Deku?

After careful consideration, eighty percent of team UA decided that *since Deku is an independent variable, the best method would be for Bakugo to ask him himself.* Yes, the conclusion they’ve come up with is for their captain to take the lead. They won’t be getting anywhere if they just wait

around for something that's undecided. *Six months is enough to get to know each other,* Kaminari convinces. *Even high school students take shorter than that*, he follows up a few seconds later.

Also, they've somehow landed on the topic of how he'd ask Deku to meet.

All this in a span of a few minutes… *Un-freaking-believable.*

"Be manly and get straight to the point!"

"Just fly over without even telling him!"

"Since you don't want to initiate seduce the hell out of him – "

Wait, that sounds familiar.

"You have to be casual!" Mina's suggestion sounds the most decent. It's not that good but compared to the others it's acceptable. "Use something trendy as an excuse! You have to be cool about it…" girls know the way around these things, of course.

Per usual Kaminari dumbly asks, "Like what? Netflix and Chill?"

Katsuki pauses, realizing something.

"Not that!"

Mina crosses her arms across her chest and the boys look at her in confusion.

"You know… Be chic! Compliment them first and say *Hi, you're cute. Wanna go get bubble tea or something?"*

Kaminari's smile fades because *we're not talking about ways you'd want to get asked out Mina.*

Also, "It's October! No one buys bubble tea!"

Mina gasps exclaiming, "That's not true!"

"Yes it is!"

"Use an alternative then! If there's no bubble tea, ask him out for coffee!"

"That sounds like some sort of cliché shoujo manga rom-com chick-flick –"

Ping!

Deku:

>> [**Photo attached:** Todoroki and Izuku selfie with stoic expressions on their faces.]
>> Todoroki-kun's joining me for lunch today.

“But I also want to know what you guys talk about,”

Todoroki admits one day during lunch break.

It’s not unusual for him to invite his friend out or stay with him to eat but the circumstances are different nowadays. *You’re not in the interrogation division, Todoroki-kun,* he knew that the other gets lonely very easily but he didn’t expect it to reach this extent. *Your group’s office is on the floor below this,* wouldn’t it be more convenient to stay in your designated area? I mean… there are emergencies during lunch break sometimes but oh well… This guy is already eating his soba.

He even brought bubble tea with him as a bribe.

As expected of Todoroki-kun… He makes it so that I can’t refuse…

“Is what he said, Kacchan,” Izuku forces a small smile on his face. “Todoroki-kun’s very curious.”

Katsuki who’s sitting in front of a make-up table with his bangs pinned back frowns.

Todoroki on the other hand notices and asks, “Where’s he at?”

“Ohh… Kacchan is taking photos for an E-Mag,” he took one for Autumn a while ago, and now he’s doing one for Winter. Izuku always gets a glimpse of the behind-the-scenes because they’re always in contact with each other. “I guess that makes him a model of some sort,” understandable because the other’s very attractive. His popularity is a big plus as well, not counting the fact that both of his parents work in the fashion industry. Not a lot of people know that but oh well...

Mismatched eyes stare before he nods and says, “Hmm… I’ve also done photoshoots before.”

The blonde on the other side of the line frowns and calls out, *“OI CHOUTO!”*

“Don’t call me by my Instagram name,”

They’ve greeted each other a few times before through Izuku so yeah…

“By the way when’s the cast coming off?” at this point Katsuki’s just in the background listening in to their conversation because the make-up artist had already arrived. “It’s already been two weeks…” to which Izuku laughs and says *it takes much longer than that to heal, Todoroki-kun*. “Sometime in November or early December then?”

“Nn, probably sometime before winter break,”

The blonde peeks one eye open and asks, *“You have winter break?”*

“Yeah. Right before Christmas, Kacchan,”

Katsuki hums, remaining silent for a while before nodding, “That’s good.”

“Are you going to be with Inko-san again?” like last year and the year before that. Todoroki tends to spend Christmas wherever’s available because his family is quite busy. “Can’t we just let her join us?” with Iida, Uraraka, and Shinsou he means. The idea makes Izuku laugh so he says, *it’ll be uncomfortable for her Todoroki-kun.* He knows that she’d be very shy, worrying about a bunch of stuff and all.

“I’ll hang out with you guys in New Year’s…”

“Yes, let’s go visit a temple,”

And as the two continue on with their lunch, Katsuki’s left bothered by one question.

Who the fuck is Inko!?

---

chouto • 4 hrs ago

internships are fun. you should be an intern too.

[**Photos attached**: (1) Todoroki and Deku in the hospital, (2) Todoroki and Deku receiving their medals, (3) Todoroki and Deku blurry selfie, (4) Todoroki and Deku in their uniforms with red maple leaves falling in the background.]

↳ Liked by fuyumiii_02 and 8,233 others.

Iida_Tenya That is an interesting way to line up those photos Todoroki-kun!

urararavity Everyone’s internship looks like fun… (´ω ` *)

_toshii I was also around you know. Why is it only you and Midoriya? Didn’t we also take a photo together?

midoriiiiiiii It sounds like an ad Todoroki-kun www

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Gakuran - a black uniform with no tie. it is worn by japanese male students.
(2) Winter Break - starts at the twenty first of december and ends at the fourth of january.
(3) Inko - izuku's mom.

please don't mind chouto, he doesn't bite and he doesn't mean any harm.
he's just clingy and he loves izuku as a friend. he's not a threat hahaha.

kirishima is waving a flag

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Katsuki can't sleep.

Unlike Todoroki or Yummycat who always gets to see Izuku, he's never met him before. Sure they exchange text messages and calls frequently but it's *different*. Seeing each other in person is *different*. It's annoying because it feels like he's getting impatient every single day. He just wants that stupid internship to get over with already. It feels like he's waiting for something that isn't going to happen because one moment he's appeased and one second later there's *ahh…*

Another name I don't know.

Turns out he's not that familiar with Deku.

Now the other can live however he wants. He can befriend whoever he wants and go wherever he wants because Katsuki knows that's none of his business. What annoys him is that he doesn't actually know who Deku is. He knows the visual but what is *he* actually like? Does he also smile at others as he does in video calls? Is he as patient towards others? As gentle and soft-spoken? Because if he is then there's a big problem. Yes, Deku's cute and all but he stresses him the fuck out.

Also –

Who on earth is Inko!?

All the while grumpily scrolling through Izuku's Instagram page.

Inko is definitely a girl's name and she's not in Deku's friend group, Katsuki knows. If she was then she wouldn't be panicking around Todoroki – *why would she be panicking in the first place!?* Does she want to impress them because they're Deku's friends? Is she putting on a ditzy act because Camie does that sometimes. There's Uraraka too so why can't they just get along? And… And why would Deku skip out on his friends just to spend Christmas with this girl!?

Bang! Bang! Bang!

Katsuki doesn't even utter a sound as he repeatedly hits his head on the desk.

Is it a cousin? Some sort of relative who's lost their parents in a car accident and is now under Deku's custody – No, he would've heard of something that serious before. A family member maybe? But Todoroki seems to know them. You don't usually invite your friend's family to join your Christmas party right? It's a problem. A very big problem. You see, in Japan, Christmas can only go three ways. *One* – you spend it with your friends, *two* – you spend it with your family, and *three* – you spend it with your significant other. Sadly, his current information is more so leaning towards the last one but isn't…

Isn't he the significant other!?

I mean… He and Deku have –

Thinking about this is embarrassing. Great, he's all red now.

The amount of shit he has to deal with because the goddamn nerd has the gall to be friendly with everyone is un-fucking-believable. Someone ought to choke that bitch. Make him repent because it's his turn to suffer for once. There's no sign of Inko anywhere on his account as well. Nowhere in his following list or any of the comments – yes, he checked.

I'll just ask him, Katsuki thinks, scrolling up the page. *It's not a big deal.*

Deku always answers his questions anyway.

It's not a big deal.

Ping!

Deku:

>> My cast comes off in few weeks
>> I can't wait to play League
>> It sounds fun Kacchan!!!!

"Have you ever had a breakup without even dating?"

Kaminari brings up during one of Team UA's streams.

"That shit hurts like a motherfucker yoooo – *ACK!"* he exclaims, feeling the pain when he gets caught in the opposing team's crowd control. It's a riot in mid-lane, their team leader retreating and not helping him even when it's a 2v2. "Why'd you leave Bakubro!? You had your ult up!" noticing the green light on his teammate's champion's status.

What he said must have struck Katsuki because that was definitely intentional.

Chat:

>> JUNGLER GOT ABANDONED LOL
>> yeah unrequited love sucks it's been months and i'm still hurting
>> YOU HAVE TO START ALL OVER AGAIN WWWW
>> Change your build why is it like that? Kaminari you noob
>> Baku's fucking fed with that 9 HAHAHAHAHA

"That's what you get for being distracted!"

"I was answering chat's question!"

Referring to the red super chat he got asking what his first love was like.

They're usually like that during these streams – random, chill, and just going with the flow. The audience can also ask questions for free but with super chat, it's much more noticeable. It doesn't

have to be a red one because any color stands out. It's difficult to keep track of thousands of comments after all.

"Good for you because you still have your first love!" Kaminari leans back on his seat as he waits for his champion to respawn. "You know what I mean guys?" grinning and playfully raising his brows at the camera. Mina and Sero are laughing in the background while Kirishima is calling for backup from up top, the turret taken in a span of few seconds before he complains and dies.

>> Dekuuuuuuuuuu
>> Is Kaminari referring to our esteemed father?
>> I love how everyone's commenting the same thing LOL
>> have you guys introduced league to deku yet?
>> I miss himmmm TT

"Baku was blasting driver's license with his door locked yesterday by the way," Sero jokes, earning quite a few of, as Katsuki would say, *unnecessary* comments from both chat and his teammates. "I think he and Deku fought," there's that snicker again, Bakugo already starting to grumble behind his mic.

"I wasn't!" yeah he wasn't playing any song whatsoever but him denying that just makes him look guilty. "And we didn't fight. *WHY ARE YOU BRINGING HIM UP THIS IS NOT WORLD EXECUTE – "* these guys really like to annoy the hell out of him.

"Because you guys are cute!"

"It's interesting…"

"You always get so mad about it hahaha – "

"It was chat who brought it up!"

"Stop saying anything unnecessary," Katsuki points out, not really impressed with how Sero implied that they were fighting. "You know that shit gets twisted on the internet. Deku and I are not fighting," they're far from fighting actually. "We never fight. That guy is too fucking mature in everything he does," and it makes him feel petty because Izuku's the one who always does the talking. At this point, he's just getting dragged around.

"Ohh~" Mina coos at the information, "Well he *is* mature. He seems like the type to be popular with girls. Older ones."

Katsuki scowls at his teammate's comment.

"What girls?"

>> BAKU!?
>> Is this for real HAHAHAHA
>> OMG SOMEONE START RECORDING
>> Clip this shit I can feel it coming
>> yo i'm so sad deku's not here to see this

Mina smiles because, “You know. Girls like guys with personalities like him. Someone patient and kind – the type you’d want to introduce to your parents. Right ladies?”

Red eyes glance at the chat on his screen.

>> Yes! Deku is ----- for a reason!
>> He seems like he’ll take care of me well
>> and he has a job too! that’s a plus! stability is always good!
>> Deku is good with kids. Have you guys seen him with Kota and Eri?
>> I like how he never gets mad. And he’s so soft-spoken hngghhhh

Katsuki clicks his tongue, annoyed.

Deku:

>> Satou-senpai’s wife gave birth this morning!!
>> Everyone’s going out for drinks this weekend
>> To celebrate!!
<< *is your friend going*
>> Todo? Yeah. He’s in the same division as Satou-senpai

“Don’t wear that coat,”

Referring to the thing Izuku had draped on his shoulders. With his arm still in a cast that’s the best it would go. It’d look awkward in other cases but it looks fashionable like that for some odd reason. Maybe it’s the user’s face or the body proportion, it’s good after all. They’ll be going out in the evening so it’s bound to get cold – autumn’s almost ending. It’s a staple to bring a jacket or a coat in this season. Some people are even starting to wear thick scarves and gloves.

“But it’s the only coat I have,” Izuku explains, standing a few meters away from his phone. *“Why not?”*

Asking Kacchan for advice per usual.

“It’s ugly,” he scoffs, looking unimpressed.

Bakugo Katsuki is lying. The coat is not ugly because it’s a black coat that goes well with almost everything.

It’s pretty and it’s making me fucking nervous.

Midoriya Izuku’s goddamn face should be banned dammit!

“Ehhhhh?” the other whines; looking all pouty and cute as he slowly takes it off to rummage through his luggage again. He doesn’t bother complaining or asking why because everyone has been telling him that he has horrible fashion taste ever since he was young. He’s gotten better in

college but his skills are still pretty basic. “What would be good then? This jacket?” a thick padded one.

Yeah, that. That ought to hide those muscles from the girls.

“I don’t know Kacchan. How nice would it be if you were here to choose for me?”

He probably meant it in a way that meant they’d get things done faster but yeah…

“Definitely,” he unconsciously nods. “You suck at this”

Imagine Deku wearing an outfit *he* chose for him.

“You wouldn’t be that ugly if I was there to choose,”

A statement that for some reason catches Izuku’s attention, Katsuki’s scowling at the silence. The other’s expression then softens at the implication of his words, *“Nn, I’m sure I’d look better if Kacchan chooses for me.”*

Katsuki’s heart skips a beat because *fuck, look at that goddamn smile.*

How annoying…

“Isn’t that your husband?”

Todoroki points towards the magazine on display.

They arrived early so they were looking around the street and in one of the bookstores they stopped by were various kinds of E-mags lined up. Izuku knew that Katsuki was doing a photoshoot, but he didn’t know that he’d be on its cover. It seems like a pretty big deal if you ask him. Beside the blonde’s photo are the words *#1 Streamer of Japan* and *Bakugo Katsuki’s advice on how to make it big on the internet.* It looks like he did an interview as well.

“He looks different…” Todoroki comments, staring at what his friend is holding. “Scarier than usual.”

Izuku on the other hand is red-cheeked, barely suppressing an excited smile.

Deku:

>> AHHHHHHHH
>> I saw it. You look pretty!!
>> [**Photo Attached:** ESPA’s October Autumn Issue with Katsuki in the cover.]
<< *fuck*
<< *why did you buy it!??*

It's a bit rude to go through your phone in the middle of a gathering but Izuku manages to send a reply, sneakily hiding his hand under the table. The two people beside him don't seem to be paying attention that much or they just don't care. Perhaps it's the latter because their workplace is quite carefree in a way and everyone's just focused on having fun for now.

>> Because it's Kacchan!!
>> I will never skip Kacchan!!!!
>> Red looks good on you!!

Katsuki laughs in the middle of his stream on the other side of the line.

"I can't believe I have to go alone,"

Kirishima groans, slumping back on his seat on the couch.

"You're not going alone," Kaminari laughs, tilting his body as he maneuvers the game using a controller. Mina's sitting next to him on the floor as well and they're both competing against each other in Mario Kart. "Aizawa-sensei will be with you," and that's a no-brainer, really. Nothing is bound to go wrong with their manager accompanying him for the next following days.

If he can handle five chaotic streamers at once, he can handle one.

"I'm not worried about that,"

Kirishima laughs, having loosened up a bit after his friend's words of assurance.

"Why do I have to give the speech?" is his main complaint. "I heard it's a big convention."

It's for new upcoming game releases and team UA was invited. Anyone would have been alright but for some reason, everyone but him was free for that day and for the following after that. *At least I get to see Crimson Riot,* that one league player he really likes. I'll go and ask for his autograph, the main reason he accepted despite not being confident in speeches. He and Sero had been playing too much league lately you see. Also, hopefully, there's a new release that's catching on popularity.

"That's right!" Mina encourages, not glancing away from the screen. "Make sure to bring us souvenirs though. Osaka's popular with taro pudding and matcha ya'know!"

"And Mochi! Bring mochi too – "

"If it's Osaka it's gotta be crab!" Sero chimes in from the kitchen, earning an earful from their team leader because *even if it's cooked it's bound to go bad in the plane, you idiot!* "Tsk… What would be good then!? Your husband is in Osaka so you know quite a lot huh, Bakugo!?"

Kaminari brightens because, "Ahhhhh that's right!"

"Say hi to Deku for me if you manage to see him Kirishima!"

Katsuki deeply frowns as his teammates continue to joke around exclaiming,

"How stupid is that!?" he points out, a bit too sensitive. "Deku's not going to the convention."

True, so basically what are the chances?

“They’re not going to meet,” Katsuki scoffs, unimpressed.

If the situation was different then he would’ve asked to take over Kirishima’s place but what? It’s a weekday and it’s not like they’d get to see each other anyway. It’s just a two-day trip and they’d both be very busy. Also, that’s such a lame-ass excuse for a first meeting. *I was just passing by for a convention and ohh, do you do you want to meet up?* Even Mina’s bubble tea idea sounds better. Rather than him being sneaky, it’s better to come into an agreement – not that he wants to meet Deku or anything!

“That guy has a shit ton of work to do – “

Deku:

> *<< hah? what convention did you get assigned to?*
> >> [**Photo attached:** Screenshot of 20XX FallCon to be held next week.]
> >> Apparently there would be a lot attending so they need more security.
> >> It looks fun! I bet you’ve been to many events like these Kacchan!!
> >> It’s my first time
> *<< HA!?*
> *<< HAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAA?*

Katsuki then proceeds to give the other a call.

Chapter End Notes

> ***terminology explained.***
>
> (1) Jungler - a role in league of legends with no lanes assigned. they kill monsters and creeps.
> (2) ESPA - an e-sports magazine.
> (3) Crimson Riot - kirishima's idol. a very popular league of legends player.
> (4) FallCon - not as big as HeroTube events but still popular nevertheless.
>
> *aizawa: i had no idea you wanted to meet deku.*
> *anyway, their meeting is still a bit far off. it's deku's time to get jealous.*
> *kacchan deserves a break from all that teasing phew.*
> *see you tomorrow or whenever i finish proofreading chap 28!*

stop being vague about it

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Kirishima-kun will be here in Osaka?"

Izuku blinks at the ceiling of his room, a bit surprised by the sudden announcement.

"And he's attending FallCon?" now that was something. "We might run into each other then?"

He's never met streamers before so he's quite excited now. Also, it's someone he actually knows. He's quite friendly with Team UA, you see. They'd sometimes include him in their streams – Kaminari most especially. Izuku watches them live sometimes but it's mostly Katsuki's because well… he's biased in a way. Now that he thinks about it he's never actually had an actual conversation with Kirishima. They've greeted each other before but a proper talk? Hmm… that's debatable.

Is it alright to come up and greet him?

If they ever manage to meet he probably should. It'd be a bit awkward to just walk away.

"Yeah…" Katsuki groans, obviously burdened by said issue. *"What day are you assigned?"*

"Friday,"

"Yeah… That's the fucking same day,"

Izuku blinks, contemplating for a while before he hears the other talk again.

"I can't believe he's going to meet you before I do," is the complaint that comes out of the blonde's mouth. *"This is pissing me off…"* followed by a, *"I shouldn't have accepted that sponsorship. Why the fuck is it on the same day!? I KNEW IT WAS IN OSAKA BUT WHY DIDN'T YOU TELL ME EARLIER!?"* along with a long rant exclaiming *who the fuck dispatches police officers at a convention!?*

Izuku hums, gently smiling at Katsuki's sentiment, "I just got that task today, Kacchan."

So he couldn't have possibly warned him sooner. Also, it's crowded so of course they're needed there.

"FUCK – "

"It's fine. There's no guarantee that we'll actually meet, Kacchan,"

Aren't streamers kind of like celebrities? He doubts they'll be entering through the main entrance where they're assigned. He'd probably see them on stage during sometime of the day but he's not sure if he'd get the chance to talk to any – Kirishima most especially. *It's not like I can just come up to him Kacchan,* is the point that he wants to express, *I'm sure he'd be very busy working,* both of them actually.

"STILL – " a volume that says *I'm not convinced. "Don't fucking talk to him you got that!?"*

Hmm… Isn't that quite mean and a bit controlling?

Cute.

Izuku laughs because, “You want to be the first person to meet me that badly, Kacchan?”

Silence.

“He’s one of your friends so isn’t it better if I say hi?” it’s just a greeting anyway. “I want to be polite.”

“I knew you were going to say that, fuck – “

The biggest problem with Midoriya Izuku is that he’s too mature. In Katsuki's eyes, although they’re of the same age, the other is much more grown-up – reasonable, logical, and intelligent. He’s so goddamn nice that it’s starting to piss him off. Also, his points are so proper that he can’t even bitch about it. He’s like some sort of dignified saint or something. The guy doesn’t even get mad or curse, what the fuck.

“That’s right,” Katsuki admits, deciding that this was better. His tone is loud and aggressive per usual but Izuku has this feeling that the other is pouting on the other side of the line. *“I want to be the first person you meet… you got a problem with that!?”* being jealous of Kirishima is petty because they’re teammates but *FUCK –*

“No, not at all,” Izuku shakes his head, a bit surprised. “I’m glad that Kacchan wants to meet me as well.”

As well…

That makes Katsuki feel a bit relieved, to be honest.

“Maybe next time when we get the chance,”

The blonde grumpily frowns on his seat groaning, *“Got it.”*

Izuku’s convincing worked very effectively.

“Next time then…”

“When’s next time though?”

“When we’re both free, Kacchan,”

“I’m fine with anytime – “

Izuku laughs, Katsuki complaining on the other side of the line.

Ping!

Kacchan:

>> I KNOW YOU HAVE WINTER BREAK
>> STOP BEING VAGUE YOU FUCKER

Izuku has a dilemma.

“I think Kacchan has high expectations, Todoroki-kun,”

His eyes are practically swimming in anxiousness, one knee bouncing up and down under his desk.

“He’ll get disappointed,” if ever they meet and he gets to see all of *this*. This nerve wreck called Midoriya Izuku because he’s not as calm and collected in real life. “He’ll get *very, very* disappointed,” Todoroki just monotonously stares because *who’d get disappointed?* Has this guy ever seen his face? I don’t think he has and his worries are now considered null. He’s being overly anxious over nothing.

Then again, that’s a very Izuku trait.

He always gets jittery when it comes to things or people that he likes.

“Why would he be disappointed?” all the while calmly eating his soba.

Inside, Todoroki’s quite happy that he’s being asked for advice.

“I’m boring in person. I’m like an old man, Todoroki-kun,” ahh so he does realize it himself. Perhaps *mature* is interpreted in various different ways. “If we do meet up then what?”

“What do you mean *what?”*

“We meet up and *what!?”* is his main concern. “What are we supposed to do when we meet up!?”

Ahh… that. Midoriya Izuku has no romantic experience whatsoever. He doesn’t even know how to set up a date or the way it’s supposed to progress. He can keep a long conversation on the phone because he has a lot to talk about but interacting in person is *different.* He wasn’t that sociable before college, you see. His growth spurt started in his last year of high school when he joined the soccer club.

It’s like the world was preparing you for that guy or something, is what Todoroki thinks.

“You’re no fun and that’s fine,”

Yeah, that’s why Shinsou and Todoroki gravitated towards him. They can literally just sit in a café and eat without having to discuss anything. Those two prefer silence and peace, it’s not boring though. It’s *comfortable.*

“That’s… That’s not good!” Izuku sweat drops, completely nervous. “Have you seen Kacchan!?”

That guy on the cover of ESPA, yes. How many Instagram followers does Katsuki have again? Two million?

“You don’t necessarily have to be fun to be a good husband, do you?”

Izuku blinks, flushing because, “Wha – What are you talking about, Todoroki-kun?”

“Hmm? Isn’t *that* what the two of you are doing?”

Todoroki is also confused because he was sure about this.

“Dating with the purpose of marriage in mind, I mean…”

Izuku’s face turns into the brightest shade of red his friend has ever seen.

Kacchan:

>> W H E N
<< *Have you eaten dinner Kacchan*
<< *[**Photo attached:** 7/11’s lunch aisle, the camera focused on katsudon.]*
>> IT’S 11:30 WTF
>> u haven’t eaten dinner
>> DON’T FUCKING CHANGE THE TOPIC

Katsuki glares at Kirishima as he heads to the door with Aizawa.

A week has passed since the entire fiasco and he’s considered taking the other’s place, to be honest. The only problem is that his pride is too high and the usual Bakugo Katsuki would never ask to change his schedule. That’s bullshit. He doesn’t change his mind. There’s also the fact that their manager would definitely ask *why*. He was on the verge of doing it these past few days though but his inner demons won and –

Fuck.

He’s starting to change his mind again.

“Have fun Kiri~!”

“Don’t forget souvenirs, dude! “

“IF YOU EVER MEET HAWKS TELL ME – “

“I got it! I know!” their teammate laughs before he shows them his signature grin. “I’m leaving now! Bye!”

Katsuki scowls at the door before he grumpily heads up to his room.

Ping!

Deku:

>> Good luck with your interview today!
>> Tell me how it goes later

Izuku blinks, staring at the extended hand the streamer is currently offering in his direction.

Ahh…

"Midoriya Izuku,"

He introduces himself, snapping out of his stupor and accepting the handshake.

"Nice to meet you, Kirishima…san?"

A bit unsure on whether he's allowed to use – *kun* now that they're meeting in real life. Izuku's a bit star-struck. It's the first time he's meeting someone like Kirishima, a person who he's only talked to online. He wonders if he's allowed to use the term *friend* in this case. It feels nerve wrecking like he's some sort of shy high school student meeting a celebrity for the first time. If he's like this with Kirishima then…

"I want to be the first person you meet… you got a problem with that!?"

I wonder what it would be like to meet Kacchan…

Speaking of Katsuki –

I'm sorry, he can already hear him screaming through the phone. *It looks like we met, it couldn't be helped.*

"No need to be so stiff dude! Nice to meet you too Dek— Midoriya!" Kirishima cheerfully laughs, shaking Izuku's free hand a few times before he lets go. He seems nice, friendly enough to approach the officer who was standing by the waiting rooms, assigned to not allow non-personnel to pass through. With how the streamer rounded that corner he must've been looking for him. "This is so unexpected! Does Bakugo know that you're here!? I was so surprised!"

It looks like Katsuki didn't tell him.

"Ahh, yes,"

Izuku sheepishly nods, unable to deny anything.

"I knew that Kirishima-san would be here but I didn't think that we'd actually get the chance to talk to each other."

"Wha – This coincidence is a bit scary…"

“Nn, what are the chances?”

The streamer laughs and they exchange questions for a while before he notices that Izuku’s arm is in a cast. Ahh, right… he was in an accident. Their teammate was on the verge of flying to Osaka during that time. Red eyes then trail upwards to stare at the taller male’s face. *I think I know why Bakugo wanted to keep it a secret now,* he sweat drops. *I feel like I’m gonna get yelled at...*

Anyway –

“Hey, since we met and all do you want to hang out for a bit?”

Nn, since death is already set in place he might as well.

“Let’s go get bubble tea or something!”

Izuku tilts his head to the side because *bubble tea?*

He’s been drinking that quite a lot recently.

Katsuki’s day has been very… *difficult.*

He has an interview scheduled for today – 73 questions whatsoever. Usually, it’d only take an hour or two but halfway through everything the cameraman realized that the video wasn’t actually recording. It took them twice the amount of time to get everything finished. That means four hours. He spent the last four hours sitting on a chair, bright lights right in front of his face. To make things worse their company car broke down on the way home and Aizawa’s replacement doesn’t know *anything.*

At that point, he could’ve just taken a taxi and left but this is a *company* car.

He can already see Nedzu waving from afar.

Katsuki spends the next hour waiting for help to arrive and by the time he reaches their shared house, it’s already five. It’s fine. Five is still early. He won’t admit that his day sucks because he’s a professional and Bakugo Katsuki is fucking amazing, he’s not fazed at all. Nevertheless, his day wouldn’t have been so bad if someone got involved.

And by involved, he means *that* guy.

That guy who’s been cheering him on this morning but has now seemingly vanished in thin air.

Deku:

> *<< WTF YOU TAKE LIKE TEN YEARS TO REPLY*
> *<< DO YOU TEXT PEOPLE*
> *<< AND THEN THROW YOUR PHONE*
> *<< ACROSS THE PACIFIC OCEAN??*

Where’s the moral support when he needs it!?

I was there when you were struggling with exams, the main point he wants to get across,

FUCKING SUPPORT ME!!

The last time Izuku didn't reply for seven hours straight he was dying on a hospital bed.

What a great sign.

Ping!

"Fucking finally," Katsuki mumbles under his breath as he sits down on his bed, having just finished taking a bath. His last text was sent approximately twenty-seven minutes ago and that's a very long time based on his standards.

He then scowls when he realizes that it's just Kirishima.

Shitty Hair:

>> Baku
>> You won't believe me!!
<< *what*
>> I hit a tree
<< *what tree*

And at that point he should've realized what it meant because –

>> [**Photo attached:** Izuku and Kirishima selfie at a bubble tea place.]
>> His hair feels soft btw

Silence.

The blonde resembles a shivering Pomeranian for a moment, staring at his bed before he ultimately throws himself at it all the while screaming.

"Bakugo's mad at me,"

Kirishima laughs, his chatbox with the other exploding after he sent that photo.

Izuku blinks when remembers that he hasn't checked his phone in a while, reminded by it when the other took out his. He usually has it on mute when he's working you see. He checks it from time to time, every few hours or so, but it's seldom because he's the type that's very focused on work. Break times are different though. The officer then gulps when he notices the swarm of messages, starting to sweatdrop at the long line of texts Katsuki sent. There's quite a lot since they've stacked up from this morning.

Sorry, he apologizes inside his head. *I got distracted by Kirishima-kun, Kacchan…*

It's Kirishima-*kun* now because the person himself said that there was no need to be so formal.

Also, it was a convention so he had a bit of fun… Nn, he has no excuses.

I'll just play World with him this weekend,

That ought to calm him down a bit…. maybe.

“Wow, Bakugo texts you a lot,” Izuku snaps out of his daze. “Never seen that before.”

He feels a bit puzzled because *huh? Is Kirishima-kun mad or something?*

What’s that expression on his face…

“I guess you two are err… very close?” the streamer awkwardly laughs, touching the back of his nape. He looks elated and all but the officer notices that everything about his body language is off. It’s the type of movement that shows up when people are trying to cover up something or lie. “Of course you two are. Who am I kidding, everyone knows it hahaha.”

Ahh… Izuku presses his lips into a thin line, realizing where this was going.

“But hmm… you two have never met, right? That’s what Kat told me last time,”

Kat? Weren't you calling just calling him Bakugo earlier?

Green eyes lift from the table to meet red, Izuku wondering how he should reply.

“Nn,” he slightly nods, forcing a smile on his face. “Kacchan and I have never met.”

This guy is trying to one-up me.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Pacific Ocean - the place where izuku threw his phone.
(2) Tree - izuku because he's tall and very thicc.

i'm sleepy. fuck pharma, why did i take up pharmacy.
anyway... you guys know what's coming. by that i mean jelly izuku. it needs to happen.
i was planning to do an april special but i was like FUCK! it's already the eighth so nvm.
tell me if you still want it though. it's like an extra type of thing.

he makes me nervous

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Kirishima's eyes widen at the confirmation.

"Really!?"

Wow, that was very unexpected.

"You two haven't met up… He never went to Fukuoka and you never went to Tokyo? None of that!?"

Izuku nods with a small awkward smile, trying to be friendly. *Are you glad that Kacchan and I haven't met?* that's a bit rude, his teammates should be aware that they're somehow involved after all. Even if by chance his assumption is wrong, *he seems to be very happy about this.* For some unknown reason as well. Izuku hates to think about the possibility but perhaps…

Green eyes meet red and Kirishima *gasps.*

"BRO THAT'S NOT IT!" he's starting to sweat for some reason. *"Whatever you're thinking… That's not it! "*

Oh, was it showing up on his face? Kirishima seems a bit finicky.

"Bakugo and I are just friends! He's my gym buddy and we go out to eat sometimes but that's all!" he insists, eye to eye contact for more emphasis. "I like him but my like is different from – " *why is he so adamant about this?* Izuku narrows his eyes, the streamer stiffening up on his seat. "Anyway, he's yours dude! I totally respect the both of you."

When Kirishima sees the other loosen up he sighs out of relief and takes a sip out of his bubble tea.

Wow, that was intense.

"But I haven't said anything Kirishima-kun,"

Red eyes flicker to the side because, "Hah…You're really scary Midoriya."

A bit different than what he had imagined.

This guy tends to forget how intimidating he looks sometimes. It's not often but his expression slips every now and then and because everyone's already used to his soft, kind image, they're startled by the difference when they see it. Yup, that's what happened to Kirishima just now. It wouldn't be an understatement to say that he was scared.

Izuku was smiling but his eyes weren't. It wasn't a glare either but it was intimidating as fuck.

No wonder he's an officer.

I was getting overpowered, he nervously gulps. *It felt like I was a criminal.*

This is all Bakugo's fault.

Kirishima finds himself staring because yup, those pecs, and biceps look good. As someone who's obsessed with fitness, he's amazed at how the other built himself. He's not looking at him in a gay manner though; he just thinks he's manly. That's a stature one can only achieve through years of continuous hard work and perseverance.

Katsuki might like it just because it looks good but fitness enthusiasts know the actual points, you know!

As expected of an officer…

"I thought you were implying something else," Izuku says, noticing how uncomfortable he's made the other. "Sorry, Kirishima-kun."

"Ah no, it's fine Midoriya!" Kirishima flushes, reverting his attention back to his drink. "Totally fine!"

Yep… It's totally fine.

Deku:

> << *the fuck*
> << *are you serious right now?*
> << *BUBBLE TEA COUNTS AS A DATE YOU DUMBASS*
> << *WOW YOU HAVE A SHIT TON OF FREE TIME*

"But aren't you two dating?"

"Huh? We're not dating Kirishima-kun…"

"EHH – "

Another surprising piece of information. Everyone online definitely thinks that the two are involved romantically. They've never commented on it and people don't really ask because *isn't it already obvious?* It's *Sweet Caring Husband* and *Loving Husband* for goodness sake. They also have two children and they have a residence in Musutafu. It felt like it was common sense.

"But you two always call and text each other?" he thought that Katsuki was just embarrassed and denying it but… but…

They're really not dating!?

Mina's going to thrive on this information for *weeks.*

"Bakugo hasn't asked you out!?"

Well, understandable because it's Bakugo but…

What about this guy?

“It’s scary. I hate to admit it but nn… I’m a bit of a coward,”

Izuku sheepishly laughs, scratching his cheek using his free hand. He kind of knew what Kirishima was going to ask with that look on his face. He has no problem admitting this because even if it does reach Katsuki’s ears, it won’t make that much of a difference. The other seems to be waiting for it as well. Izuku just needs to find the proper timing.

“He makes me nervous,"

Not the anxiety-inducing kind.

It’s the kind that makes him all flustered, the kind that makes his heart race and his throat constrict because *it’s Kacchan.*

“I have to be careful with Kacchan,”

Kirishima stares at him with his cheeks flushed, shivering on his seat and restraining himself from saying anything.

It’s a yes for me, Bakugo!

“No, that’s cool. I totally get that. You want to be prepared, no problem!”

Wow, so it’s not just physical attraction then? I should’ve known…

“I’m sure that Bakugo wants to meet you as well! He’s probably just waiting around,”

They talk to each other for quite a while after that, the both of them deliberately avoiding their phone. Yeah, they’re doing that on purpose. Both know that they should enjoy the peace while it lasts. That person is bound to explode at some point – he probably is right now. Nevertheless, Kirishima does open his device when a bit of time has passed, groaning at the messages his manager sent him.

It looks like he doesn’t have that much time left for his break. It’s fine since they’re still near the convention hall but *ehhhh?*

He kind of wants to talk more to Deku.

“Actually…Kirishima-kun –”

Izuku starts off when the streamer lowers his phone, lips nervously pursed together.

“I kind of have a favor to ask.”

Kirishima blinks, puzzled and wondering, “What is it?”

Mina:

> *<< HEY*

<< *YOU WON'T BELIEVE WHAT HAPPENED TO ME TODAY*
>> Huh? What is it?
<< *[You have added Midoriya Izuku to this group.]*
>> **Mina:** !?
>> **Mina:** !!!!!?????

Katsuki stares at the photo on his phone.

He's currently lying down on his bed, one hand holding the device in front of his face.

Ping!

Shitty Hair:

>> Don't be so hard on him later!!
>> I was the one who asked him to hang out
>> [**Photo attached:** Izuku and Kirishima standing next to each other, the redhead showing a peace sign.]

Aizawa probably took it or something.

After an hour and a half, the streamer had finally managed to calm down. It looks like the pair's strategy to not reply to his texts was for the best. He doesn't feel like he's on the verge of exploding anymore, that petty feeling is now gone. All that's left now is the simmering heat in the pit of his stomach because *what the fuck Deku I told you not to meet up with him –* a feeling of *betrayal.* The fuckers look like they're having fun, attending FallCon, and going out to get bubble tea and some shit.

Even I haven't gone out with him for bubble tea!

Is what he thinks, pissed off at thought again.

Shitty Deku, just you fucking wait and see. I'm gonna make you drink bubble tea until you die –

Anyway, moving on.

The more he stares at the photo the more his anger subsides for some reason. As long as he doesn't think of the earlier events he's starting to calm down. He's not as mad about this compared to the first photo his teammate sent – a selfie. Perhaps it has something to do with how Izuku's standing next to Kirishima in that image, how his brain realizes *ohh shit, he's taller than shitty hair.* The streamer is about the same built and stature as him so all he can think is –

"You're the perfect height, Kacchan,"

Deku resting his chin on top of his head and hugging him or something.

WHAT THE FUCK – *not this again!*

Katsuki groans against his pillow because *I've already gotten past that stage nonoNONO –*

Red eyes peek at the phone resting on the bed, scowling at no one but himself.

I wanna meet Deku, he thinks with his face flushed red. *I wanna fucking meet Deku.*

"When we're both free, Kacchan,"

The same words repeat over and over inside his head.

Ping!

Deku:

>> Sorry for the late reply
>> I'm done with work now
>> How was your day?

"Nn, I'm sorry,"

Izuku says, nervously lowering his head at the screen.

Katsuki who's sitting in his gamer chair scowls all the while crossing his arms at the other. It's half-past seven now and the convention had ended more than an hour earlier. Izuku's currently back in his dorm, dressed in casual clothes and in the middle of being scolded by the other. *Scold* is a rather bad term nevertheless. Perhaps being *corrected* is better. After all, an officer shouldn't make promises they can't keep. That's just bad for their reputation. They're supposed to be the ally of justice, you know!

Okay, maybe Katsuki is pushing his agenda but still –

"Have you repented?"

Like a sinner of some sort…

"Nn, I'm lonelier than a cactus in a desert, Kacchan…"

"You fucking better be!"

There's a long rant, Izuku promising not to do it again before he sighs out of relief, glad that he's somewhat forgiven from his blunder. Kirishima won't be scolded it seems like. He didn't know that Deku would be there in the first place – a meeting by chance. What a lucky guy.

"So…" Izuku peers at the screen. *"I saw your texts. Did you have a bad day?"* another reason why he apologized. Over time he learned that it's not good to make Katsuki's temper worse. The best method would be to own up to it and avoid a fight. Even if it's not your fault, yes. *"Tell me about it,"* always trying to make it up and make him feel better, eh? At least he knows what to do.

“Yeah, unlike you who went on a date. My day sucked,”

Ah, here we go again.

“It was your teammate, Kacchan,” Izuku awkwardly laughs. *“It wasn’t a date.”*

“You went out for fucking bubble tea,” Katsuki starts to count on his fingers, ready to prove a point. “You talked to each other for more than an hour,” that’s a sin. “And you took photos,” the *ultimate* sin. Even *he* hasn’t taken photos with Deku! Who does Kirishima think he is!? Clearly, that guy only did that out of spite! For bragging rights or some shit and it’s working… *It’s really working!*

“But Kacchan also goes out to eat with Kirishima-kun. He said that you go to the gym together as well…”

The thing Kirishima told him earlier.

Katsuki stiffens on his seat because *fuck, this is starting to backfire.*

That small pout on Izuku’s lips is not boding well either.

“He gets to see you all the time,” is his main point. *“Should I also be worried?”*

Katsuki pauses because, “That… He’s a co-worker!”

“Exactly,” Izuku’s tone makes the gulp, posture slightly straightening.

The fuck is that!?

“You look uncomfortable,” Izuku forces a smile on his face but he doesn’t seem pleased. He’s had that passive-aggressive expression on his face ever since they’ve started the video call half an hour ago. He’s usually not like that. *“Sorry, I didn’t mean to make it sound like I was blaming you. I just wanted to get my point across,”* and he doesn’t seem mad either, he just seems… *different.*

“What is it?”

“Hmm?”

“Something’s up,” red eyes narrow at the screen, “Tell me.”

There’s a long pause, Katsuki tapping his fingers on his desk before he sees Izuku shrug his shoulders.

“It’s a bit petty,” fuck, now he wants to hear it. He’s never seen petty Izuku before.

“Don’t care,” the blonde replies, urging the other to continue. “Fucking tell me.”

Izuku laughs at the sentiment.

“Well… After meeting Kirishima-kun I just realized that hmm… How should I say this?” his tone is as soft and careful as ever, albeit a little less cheery. There’s also that short pause because he’s

thinking his words through, contemplating for a while. *"In a way… I guess I'm jealous of everyone who gets to see Kacchan every day."*

Katsuki blinks because, "What did you just say?"

Izuku suspiciously stares at the streamer's face before he sighs and repeats, *"I said I'm jealous."*

The blonde freezes.

"Of Kirishima-kun who gets to see you every day,"

Green eyes peer at red.

"The… *THE FUCK IS THAT – "*

Shameless.

"Kacchan, I – "

"WHY WOULD YOU BE JEALOUS OF KIRISHIMA OUT OF ALL PEOPLE – "

"Kacchan, I also said that –"

Fucking shameless.

Bang! Bang! Bang!

Katsuki hits his head on the desk two, three *times*. He doesn't bother lifting up his face because he's sure that he's completely red right now, both his hands tightly gripped into fists. He's stopped paying attention to Izuku as well, the other's voice blocked out of his ears with how loud his heartbeat is. Calm down, calm down, *calmdowncalmdowncalmdownCALMTHEFUCKDOWN –*

Ba-thump. Ba-thump. Ba-thump.

"WHY… WHY WOULD YOU FUCKING ADMIT THAT YOU'RE JEALOUS!?"

Isn't that supposed to be I dunno… *some sort of thing you keep to yourself!?* Some private shit you hide from everyone else because getting jealous is embarrassing and shameful!? If so, then why the fuck would this guy go and oust himself like that!? Is he stupid of something!? To make things worse… Why is *he* the one getting embarrassed!? *It's supposed to be the other way around, isn't it!?* He's not the one going around spouting shit!

"I don't know…" Izuku shrugs his shoulders and that solemn expression on his face makes him look like some MC from a shoujo manga or something. "I just wanted to tell you. It's been on my mind this entire day and you asked about it, didn't you?"

So he's been walking around thinking about it?

WHAT THE FUCK!? THAT'S SO EMBARASSING!

"Whether it's Kirishima-kun or Kaminari-kun… even Ashido-san," Katsuki tries to glare at the

screen, Izuku awkwardly smiling at him. *“I don’t think it matters who it is. We’ve never met so of course I can’t help but feel jealous,”* followed by, *“I guess that just shows how much I like Kacchan.”*

This guy… And Katsuki’s been thinking that it was unfair that Kirishima got to meet Deku first.

It looks like they’re on the same boat.

“That…” Katsuki manages to force out, covering his eyes with one hand, flushed to the tip of his ears. “The fuck should I do about it then!?”

Izuku blinks before he hums saying, “Well…”

Katsuki’s heartbeat is ringing in his ears.

“I just need to see you then everything will be better… I think,”

It’s fucking ringing in his ears.

Sedun Dnes:

>> **Mina:** IS IT AN AIRPORT MEETING THAT WE’RE PLANNING
>> **Kaminari:** YO I’VE SEEN THOSE ON TIKTOK
>> **Sero:** *@Deku @Deku @Deku* answer us
>> **Kirishima:** I think he’s talking to Baku rn HAHAHA
>> **Mina:** LET’S MAKE A BANNER GUYS

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Criminal - kacchan when he realizes that izuku's uniform includes handcuffs.
(2) Sedun Dnes - it was also kaminari, shinsou, bakugo and izuku's team name back in the earlier chapters.
i was hoping that someone would realize and point out it's meaning but no one did.
cue sad author.
it means *send nudes* written backwards.

will there be an airport meeting!? no, that's too... difficult to write.
there will be no banners as well. none of those tiktok ideas kaminari's spouting.
their meeting will be low key without the bakusquad. izuku's request is something different.
see you some time after i finish my quizzes!

tokyo, friday, on the twenty first

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Izuku's been pinged continuously ever since he was added to the group chat. He knew that Katsuki's teammates would be curious but he didn't expect it to *this* intense. It's not unwelcome nevertheless. He figured that since the other had Shinsou as a source of info, he'd try to have his as well. If Katsuki holds this against him he always has a rebuttal anyway. *Sorry Kacchan,* because he's doing this behind his back and as they say, *desperate times call for different measures.*

He knows a lot about Katsuki but his knowledge is limited.

Fact is that reality is different from perception and he knows that well.

It would be good to have primary sources to ask... At first, it was just Kirishima and Mina but it looks like the group chat had expanded and now everyone in team UA except the team leader is in on it. He's told them that there would be no surprises or epic reunions but they're still insisting on the idea, it looks like they all like flashy things. *Maybe next time after our first one,* is what he replies to those kinds of messages. *I'm not brave enough to bring a banner, Ashido-san…* It would be fun to see Katsuki's reaction but yeah…

Something more modest would be nice.

Truth to be told he's just a big scaredy-cat who prefers the safe option over anything else.

Ping!

Sedun Dnes:

>> **Kaminari:** Planes are waaay cheaper!
>> **Kaminari:** [**Photo attached:** Screenshot of Fukuoka-Tokyo flight prices.]
>> **Kirishima:** He said no airport meetings though!?
>> **Sero:** Probably cause you guys said you'll bring a banner
>> **Mina:** We won't bring a banner!
>> **Mina:** @*Deku* pls it's cheaper than Shinkansen, faster and more efficient
>> **Mina:** You can save more money and instead of 5 hrs it's only 1 hr and 40 min

Izuku laughs because under that Sero points out how their female teammate seems to have transformed into some sort of online seller all of a sudden. Kaminari and Mina both make good points nevertheless. Planes are cheaper and faster. It's not like he can't afford the shinkansen but hmm… yeah, it would be nice to save up money and not sit around as much.

>> **Deku**: Hmm… haven't asked Kacchan yet
>> **Sero:** S'not a surprise!?
>> **Mina:** PLEASE LET IT BE A SURPRISE
>> **Deku:** I think he'll get mad at me if I show up out of nowhere?
>> **Kaminari:** He won't! He'll love it
>> **Kirishima:** We'll help you out broooo
>> **Mina:** IT'S A ONCE IN A LIFETIME EXPERIENCE

Ultimately, Izuku's persistence won and surprises were off the list.

Kacchan:

> << *My cast is off!*
> << *[* ***Photo attached:*** *Izuku's right hand outstretched, a scar on his forearm.]*
> >> wasn't it supposed to be off at the end of the month?
> >> it's a week early
> << *Did a scan and I heal fast!*
> >> ??
> >> the fuck does that mean www

A healed arm means one thing.

You said you'd teach me how to play League, Kacchan!

Was their conversation prior to this stream.

Now, as what the statement implied, he, Bakugo Katsuki, was supposed to teach Deku how to play said game. The words weren't directed towards Kirishima or Kaminari. It wasn't for Sero either. Mina isn't present because she's joined some sort of All Girls stream – Camie and Jirou's probably. So it's just them boys right now playing an unranked game. There's no competitive spirit since it's just a practice round but still…

Stream Chat:

> >> Look at Baku's face LOL
> >> it's 2-1-2 SOLO MID HAHAHAHA
> >> Can you guys pls rotate poor Baku
> >> Deku's support is IMMACULATE
> >> Kaminari it's solo top stop tagging along Deku www

Double Kill!

"Wow, you're really good at this Deku!"

"That was a KS! KS is bad – *ack!"*

An ally has been slain.

"YO IS THIS REALLY YOUR FIRST TIME PLAYING!?"

Triple Kill!

Quadra Kill!

>> AHHH ONE MORE! JUST ONE MORE!
>> DEKUDEKUDEKUDEKUDEKUDEKUDEKUDEKU
>> Thirty min into stream and are we gonna get a Penta!?
>> *mouse hovers in front of donate button*
>> GET READY FOR RED SC!!

Penta Kill!

Katsuki is frowning all the while everyone's gathered up top, his teammates cheering with Deku. The chat looks happy as well. They're always pleased to see someone get that many kills in a game since it's quite difficult to get. It's also very impressive considering their enemies and the current teammates Deku has. *We might have a genius in our hands,* Kaminari says with a serious voice. *What do you think about becoming a professional league gamer from now on?*

The team leader's scowl deepens as he stares at his screen.

"Ehh? We're not playing League today, Kacchan?"

Click. Click.

"We're playing World," he huffs before saying, *"League sucks."*

Also, it will be good for Deku to see the brats. They haven't been on a raid for way too long.

Plus Ultra Scans:

> Deku's arm finally healed and after a long time, they were finally able to go on a raid. He's been logging in regularly but they were only farming and stuff, no complex strategy against boss monsters involved. This stream was so much fun because Deku was so shocked to see Eri and Kota's skills in action hahaha. Baku looked smug all the time because he was the one who trained them, of course. Proud dad spotted, couldn't be expressed better. Here's a rundown of the 11/15/XX stream.
>
> This is the link in Ground Zero's channel as well: *@herotube.uy/UIns*
>
> **02:19** – THEY'RE ALREADY PLAYING EVEN BEFORE STREAMING BAKU THAT'S UNFAIR
>
> **12:02** – Talking about the new patch, World Boss!
>
> **36:51** – There's some sort of inside joke about bubble tea? I don't understand.
>
> **40:02** – Kota saying *papa* and *dad* has enough destructive power as Baku's ult tbh
>
> **59:48** – They successfully finished the Blue Mine Raid! We're rich now kufufufufu.

1:15:11 – Deku is a proud dad. Baku is a smug dad.

1:37:08 – Deku likes league but he likes WE more.

1:45:33 – Another crab dance for the compilation *@herotube.uM/KJOm*

1:52:45 – Deku asks about the WE Global Cup this upcoming spring. Baku was champion during the last one so he'll be representing Japan. Ourboi isn't even a tad bit nervous because he also did this last year lol. Deku seems more nervous about it.

2:02:34 – Bakugo's end screen but you can hear Deku say, *"Let's play one more game after this, Kacchan."* MY HEART. DON'T END THE STREAM PLEASE NOT YET –

Anyway, the stream was pretty chill and lighthearted. SC was wild per usual though. I think they're playing behind the scenes more than they're streaming. They said that they play every evening but we only get to see streams once a week.

Ping!

Sedun Dnes:

>> **Mina:** Baku likes spicy food
>> **Kirishima:** Like really, really spicy food
>> **Sero:** And iced caramel macchiato
>> **Deku:** Oh? It's not pumpkin spice latte?

Referring to that time Katsuki sent him that Starbucks voucher on Line.

>> **Kaminari:** Baku doesn't drink anything other than iced caramel macchiato www
>> **Deku:** ???
>> **Deku:** [**Photo attached:** Screenshot of Bakugo sending him the voucher.]

"Hey,"

"Nn…"

"*Rumor has it,"* Izuku can hear the other mumbling on the other side of the line. Katsuki's lying motionless on his bed, face flat against his pillow, under his blanket with no intention of moving anytime soon. Izuku calls him *cute sleepy Kacchan* and he always gets scolded right after. *"Rumor has it that I make you nervous,"* there's a conceited chuckle, Izuku owlishly blinking.

Kirishima-kun! You snitched!

The officer lets out a low groan, lips pursed together.

He’s in the middle of writing a report, the lamp on his desk turned on.

“Yes, Kacchan makes me nervous,” a fond expression on his face, resting his chin on the palm of his hand to stare at the image on his screen. It’s not rare to see the other fall asleep. Katsuki’s quite insistent on late-night calls no matter how tired he is. Izuku is also usually the one who hangs up because the other falls asleep nine out of ten times. “In a lot of ways.”

“What ways,”

“Well… You’re pretty cute when you’re nice,”

“The fuck? What am I when I’m not nice?”

Like a puppy.

“Kacchan’s very cool. I prefer cute Kacchan though,”

Izuku leans back on his seat, stretching out his limbs for a moment. When he turns his attention back to the screen, the streamer already has his eyes open, looking directly at him. *Is it possible to make direct eye contact through video call?* he sweatdrops. *Kacchan you’re staring way too much,* as pulls down his shirt, realizing what the other was thinking when he saw him frown immediately.

“Ahh…” the officer blinks, knowing where this was going. “Did that wake you up?”

Deliberately leaning closer, giving the other a nice view of his neck, collarbones, and jaw.

“Don’t fucking give me that look,” and Katsuki returns to burying his flushed face unto his pillow.

“You’re supposed to get used to it Kacchan. What are you going to do when we meet up?”

That’s kind of hypocritical to say because Izuku also has the same problem.

“M’not gonna do anything,” cute, Kacchan’s very cute. *“I’m just gonna sit still and let you do all the work.”*

Izuku flushes because *what does that mean!?*

“Kacchan…” the officer groans, unable to take it any longer.

“Nn…”

“Let’s do it,”

“Nn…” Katsuki’s also flushed up to his ears. *“Let’s do it.”*

Katsuki gulps as he watches the other undress in front of him.

Fuck.

They’re gonna do it on fucking video call –

FUCK.

“I can’t see, Kacchan,”

“Ghnn – “ Katsuki spreads his legs wider, knees hitting the armrest of his chair. It’s difficult to keep his phone up while doing this on the bed so he’s switched locations, not minding how the screen cut off his face in this angle. “Fucking deal with it –“ he says through gritted teeth, two fingers inside his dripping entrance. Deku is mumbling something, earphones picking up slick, lewd noises.

It’s fucking big, red eyes hazily focus on the image. *Will I even –*

Katsuki’s cock twitches at the idea, slightly tilting his head back as he shuts his eyes close.

“Ahhhh, it’s soaking wet,” a deep gentle voice, Izuku’s lips pressed against his ear. He can practically feel those hands trail down his chest, one hand wrapping around his dick to jerk him off. *“Here too,”* thick fingers pressing in, Izuku kissing his ears, jaw, and neck. *“Take it in Kacchan, all way the way up to my knuckles – ahh, good –“* rubbing against his walls, playing with his insides.

Midoriya Izuku.

“Deku – “ he moans, eyes starting to glaze over. “Deku.”

“Keep them apart,” is what the other says, noticing how the blonde’s rubbing his legs together. “*You know it’s difficult to see, Kacchan.”*

Katsuki nods, twitching and flinching on Izuku’s lap as he’s fingered and jerked off. He can feel a digit rub against the slit of his dick, teasing the hole. “No – “ the sensation is enough to make him squirm, heat pooling in the pit of his stomach, tears filling up his eyes. “Not yet—hnn—gnhhh…*”* he mewls when Izuku moves his hand faster, forcing him to release and cum all over his stomach.

“Hah… *Ah –“*

Katsuki’s drooling, flinching in the aftermath before he feels the other rub between his thighs, his legs maneuvered and spread out again.

“De—kuuuuu—” he loudly moans, hazy-eyed as the other prods against his entrance.

Izuku’s thick cock is stretching him out so much, pale lashes damp before they spill over with tears. It’s not easy to take in. The other’s big and he feels so full, his dick leaking because he just came for the second time of the day. He’s only allowed a moment’s rest before he’s made to bottom out, red eyes widening as he hits the base, shivering and twitching all over.

“There we go,” and the other’s hands return on his exposed cock again, stimulating him even more.

*“*Haah – *Ah – “*

Long slow thrusts, the blonde tipping his head back at the sensation.

“That’s it,” Izuku hums, pressing a kiss against his cheek as he picks up the pace. *“You’re so good at touching yourself, Kacchan.”*

“Midoriya Izuku…”

Izuku sweatdrops at the other’s tone.

“I can’t fucking live like this anymore,”

Katsuki is sure that his mental health is starting to take a toll. Maybe he was just way too into it but still! The blonde is silently shivering on his seat, red eyes glaring. *Nn, he looks mad,* Izuku awkwardly laughs inside. *He looks really, really mad,* and he was sure that Katsuki enjoyed it as well. Maybe he pushed him a little bit too far. People say he’s good with essays so he’s very descriptive sometimes. Perhaps that’s the cause.

“Sorry, Kacchan…” he doesn’t know what he’s apologizing for but, “I didn’t mean it.”

It seems to have made it worse because, *“WHY ARE YOU APOLOGIZING!?”*

Ahh so he didn’t mean that?

Green eyes nervously stare at the other, noticing how Katsuki was pouting on his seat.

If it wasn’t because of earlier then… *Ahh…*

Should he say it now? Now seems like a good time.

“My winter break starts at the twentieth of December, Kacchan,” Katsuki who’s looking off to the side with his arms crossed above his chest, *freezes.* Izuku stares, carefully observing the other’s reaction before he continues. “If you want me to then I’ll be taking a flight to Tokyo on the twenty-first and I’ll be staying there for a few days.”

Izuku purses his lips, heart hammering inside his chest because *ahhhhhhhhh* –

He knows that Katsuki will agree but it is still nerve-racking.

“Really?”

The streamer gives him the side-eye, attempting to look pissed but ultimately failing at it.

“Really,”

“How many days?”

“Five days and four nights,”

“That’s fucking short. Extend it,”

Izuku forces a smile because, “I have something to do in university at the twenty-sixth, Kacchan.”

It’s not unusual for a lot of people in Japan to continue working even during holidays. The twenty-sixth is after Christmas so his school determined that many interns would be free and able to do work. Only high school students and below have rather flexible winter break schedules, you see. He’s already organized it the best way he could. Graduating students have it tough.

The streamer has this strange expression on his face, cheeks puffed up and slightly frowning.

“Well?” Izuku softly asks after a while. “Am I allowed to meet Kacchan?”

That seems to break the spell because the blonde grumbles something, lightly blushing before he nods.

“The twenty-first,”

“Nn, the twenty-first.”

Let’s meet in Tokyo, on Friday, on the twenty-first.

The Secret Plotter @scrtpltr • 2 hrs ago
UA really likes to take down my thread for some reason. Guilty maybe? LOL *@reddit.Qw/vBkdk*

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) KS - kill steal. killing other's prey is considered a bit bad.
(2) Penta Kill - five continuous kills.
(3) November - the current month. they have about five more weeks before they meet.

leaving this here because i might not update for a week or so.
we're finally nearing the meeting guys. it took us just about thirty chapters lol
it feels like a slow burn but at the same time, it doesn't.
according to my list they meet at around chapter thirty-four so yeah!
updates are frequent so it won't take that long! hold on for a bit!

picking out a gift

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Merry Christmas!"

When Katsuki and Izuku log in that morning they're greeted by Eri and Kota dressed in matching Santa Claus skins. The streamer had seen it on the page a few days ago since it was on preview but he didn't know that NPCs would be programmed to wear them. *Aren't premium skins supposed to be purchased?* a passing thought as Izuku gushes over how cute they are. *Oh well… maybe it's a familiar thing…*

They're SSR after all, they have their perks.

Click!

Katsuki then silently takes a screenshot of the cut scene on his screen.

"Me— Merry Christmas!" Izuku greets over the mic, his avatar pleased. *"It's a bit early but nn…"*

As long as it's cute.

It's just the fourth of December you know!

"Isn't it *that?"* Katsuki huffs, referring to the game setting. "Christmas event."

There are seasons in World Execute so of course Christmas is included. It's basically a marketing tactic and a way to add more content, one of the best-selling events only second to Valentine's. Katsuki's knowledgeable about the update so he goes on a long rant, explaining it to Izuku. It would be his first time participating after all. The month of December is quite full – there are quests, events, hidden gacha, winter ball, and the long-awaited World Boss.

They're both maxed out so they don't need the double EXP but yeah…

"*That's amazing, Kacchan,"*

Izuku praises, Eri sitting on Deku's lap with Kota clinging to his side.

"It's held on the twenty-sixth right?" and he would've been back in Fukuoka by then. *"I'll watch the stream,"* saying it beforehand because Katsuki always gets embarrassed whenever he shows up unannounced. He doesn't tell the other but he tunes in every now and then, observing how the other would start his stream grumpily because he just woke up or how he'd rage quit during difficult raids.

Nn, I'll definitely get scolded if I admit that… Let's not tell Kacchan.

Ping!

Deku:

>> !!
>> [**Photo attached:** Airplane ticket scheduled on 12/21/XX, 10 AM.]

Mina is *amused.*

“Ehh? Isn’t five days and four nights long enough?”

The boys are shivering in their seats, holding in their laughter, because everyone in team UA already knows about them meeting up. They were the ones who helped Izuku set up the date for goodness sake. It was something they agreed on, a consensus that was based on the officer’s schedule. They also took Katsuki’s into account and what better source than his actual teammates!? They would’ve liked Izuku’s vacation to last longer as well but alas… graduating students are graduating students.

It can’t be helped.

Katsuki thinks that they’re holding in their laughter because they think it’s funny but yes…

Let him think that.

It’s totally not because they already know what’s going to happen.

“It’s just your first time meeting,” Kirishima tries to support. “Maybe after you get to know each other?”

The team leader glares because *we know each other well enough shitty hair.*

In the first place, they’ve known each other since they were teens! There was that eight-year gap and all but they played together for two years. Katsuki is aware that he’s being a bit pushy, probably clingy and shit because yes, it’s just their first meeting but would it be so bad to make it last longer?

“Where’s Deku staying anyway?” Kaminari grins, acting as if he doesn’t already know. “Are you letting him crash in your room? Introduce us! Introduce us!” it’s not uncommon for other people to drop by. Mina and Kaminari’s friends often visit for fun and for collabs. No one really says a thing because the walls are soundproof and thick – a necessity for a house full of gamers.

“As if I’ll let him stay here,”

Izuku didn’t ask him but even if he did there’s no way he’ll allow that. Just imagining the other meeting his teammates is enough to bring his mood down. He knows that these guys are probably going to pull some sort of stupid stunt again. He’s not going to allow that on their first meeting, okay!?

“He said he’ll be staying at a hotel,”

His teammates snicker at each other so he snaps and asks, “What!?”

“Ehh? What do you mean *what?* It’s a hotel Baku! A hotel!”

Kaminari grins and Katsuki has the urge to blast this guy's face.

"Aren't you going to *you know?"* Mina also inches in closer, looking a bit too excited.

She then silently mouths a word that makes Katsuki turn extremely red.

Red eyes stare at his phone.

Ping!

Deku:

> >> [**Photo attached:** Izuku selfie with a police dog, snowflakes on his eyelashes.]
> >> Look at this good boy!

Katsuki is *excited* to meet Izuku. Excited is even understating it – he's *thrilled,* elated, he can hardly fucking wait. He's not feeling butterflies whatsoever. There's no nervousness brought by the nearing scheduled day. What he feels is impatience and restlessness because *can't it come sooner goddamit.* He wonders how he can explain the physical pain he feels in his chest when all he wants to do is be with someone.

It's just the first meeting, like what Kirishima said earlier this day. *A bit too heavy…*

Then again, they've already exceeded the line more than once or twice so…

Fuck heavy! It better goddamn happen!

He'll kill him if it doesn't!

Katsuki flushes as he angrily types in his reply.

> << *i don't like dogs*

He then goes on a long rant about how they're slobbery and how they bite and shit.

> >> [**Voice mail attached:** Izuku saying woof.]

Katsuki plops his head against his desk, one hand tightly clenched on his chest.

It's funny how one voice mail can make him react like this.

"Sorry, Kacchan…"

Izuku is leaning back on the headboard of the bed, a collar around his neck.

"You can get mad at me later," and he slips his hands around the blonde's waist, thrusting upwards.

Katsuki sits up on his bed, staring dumbfounded at the wall across the room.

"A present?"

Todoroki blinks, unconsciously tilting his head to the side.

"Ahh… For *him?"*

Not saying *Ground Zero* or *Bakugo Katsuki* because they're currently having lunch in the headquarters' cafeteria. Their mentors and upperclassmen are sitting on the same table as them, a few sending Izuku curious and intrigued looks. They knew that the other had a lover – *or so they assumed* – because they often see him texting during breaks. He also uses the same excuse every time someone asks him out.

Sorry, I'm already interested in someone so…

The heck is that!?

Anyway –

"Him!?" Satou, the guy whose wife had just given birth, asks in a scandalized manner. "Wha –"

"Midoriya-kun you like men!?" the girls are red-faced for some reason and everyone is in a daze.

Izuku awkwardly laughs replying, "Hmm… I guess you can say that, senpai?"

I mean Kacchan is male so…

He's never really thought about it before. He's had crushes on girls and he had a phase where he was too nervous to even speak or glance towards their direction so there's that. He's never dated so he can't compare but hmm… *Kacchan is different, I guess.* Bakugo Katsuki doesn't give him fleeting emotions. He doesn't seem like a one-time thing. The men freeze in their seats while the women immediately inch closer, Todoroki frowning at their proximity.

"You're giving your boyfriend a present, Midoriya-kun!?"

Izuku owlishly blinks.

"Clothes? What about clothes!?"

"Do you want him to embarrass himself!? Todoroki said his boyfriend was a model!"

Actually, Todoroki kind of misinformed them that but yeah… He did appear in a magazine.

"What about something handmade Midoriya-kun?"

"I agree! You can never go wrong with handmade things! Knit him a scarf or something!"

“It’s already the seventh, stupid. Not enough time!”

“What about something with meaning?” Satou cuts in and for some reason it makes everyone silent. He sweat drops at the attention directed at him and someone in the background mumbles a low *as expected of a married man.* “I mean… Wouldn’t it be good if he can understand what your intention is?” he has a point, something sentimental would be nice.

Izuku remains silent, contemplating for a while.

“I ended up buying it,”

Izuku whimpers, his friend ever so slightly smiling as they exit the shop.

“It was very expensive,” he sniffles, a pang in his chest every time he remembers the price. He’s not exactly broke because Katsuki linked him with super chat but still… The point is that he’s not used to spending this much money on one item. Then again, he can't really hold back when it comes to the other. Katsuki is very difficult to buy presents for. “Are you sure Kacchan will like it, Todoroki-kun?”

He’s more nervous about how the other would react actually.

“It’s your idea,”

“That… That’s not making me feel better…”

Todoroki’s lips curl up, slightly shrugging his shoulders because, “You picked it out for him.”

Even with just that it already counts as a good present. He’s sure that Katsuki will think the same.

“I think it’s pretty. Give it to me if he doesn’t want it…”

“Todoroki-kun!”

Ping!

Mom:

> << *Sorry mom*
> >> !!
> >> It’s alright, have fun!
> >> Tokyo’s a bit far though so be careful
> << *Nn*
> << *You can drop by on the twenty-fifth though*
> << *I’ll be back from Tokyo in the evening*
> << *I’ll bring you something*

Kaminari glances at the kitchen where their team leader is.

Ping!

Sedun Dnes:

>> **Kirishima:** This place
>> **Kirishima:** [**Poodle Maps:** Restaurant near Kabukicho.]
>> **Mina**: GOOD RATINGS
>> **Mina:** But is their menu online? What do they even serve there
>> **Sero:** STEAK
>> **Sero:** Cause it's a Christmas date
>> **Deku:** Ah, this one is for the 24th?
>> **Mina:** Does Baku even like steak?

"Do you like steak Bakugo?"

"Hah?" the blonde frowns, not bothering to look back. He's in the middle of cooking something you see. "If you want to eat steak go buy it yourself! It's gyoza for dinner and I'm not making something different!"

"I was just asking if you like steak!"

"I HATE IT. IT'S GYOZA FOR DINNER,"

Kirishima blinks and while Kaminari is pouting, he starts to type on his phone.

>> **Kirishima**: No steak
>> **Mina:** Can we find somewhere where they serve drinks?
>> **Mina:** Deku do you drink?
>> **Deku:** Yes I do
>> **Deku:** What about this one?
>> **Deku:** [**Poodle Maps:** A restaurant in Shinjuku.]

Katsuki is oblivious while everyone's on their phone in the living room.

"Excited?"

Todoroki asks his friend whose knee has been bouncing up and down for a while now.

They had just finished up with their internships and are currently on their way back to Fukuoka.

After this is their winter break and they’re free for the next two weeks.

“Nn,”

Izuku groans, leaning back his seat as he covers his face with both hands.

“I can’t wait to see him, Todoroki-kun.”

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Santa Skin - christmas themed outfit kota and eri are wearing.
(2) Poodle Maps - an app used to navigate and find shops, restaurants and etc.

just to make izuku's schedule more clear!
he arrives at fukuoka at december 20 and his flight to tokyo is at december 21, 10:00 am.
they meet at around 12 noon and spend the following days together.
izuku leaves tokyo at december 25, 1:00 pm! that's because he has to get back to university.

also, what do you think the present is? kukuku
we won't be seeing chouto for a while. everyone say goodbye!

the eight year gap

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"I've arrived at Fukuoka, Kacchan,"

Katsuki hums in reply, noticing how tired the other sounds.

It's a three-hour trip with a lot of stops so of course he's a bit tired.

Shinkansen are more comfortable than planes but he knows that Izuku's been very busy prior to this as well. The guy basically spent the entire night writing down reports, making sure that everything was recorded before he left for another city. It would be a bit troublesome if they wanted him to come back because of missing information, you see. It's one of the downsides of working in Japanese society. There's always this need to meet face to face even when something trivial can be solved through email or call.

It's not necessarily bad but it's definitely time-consuming.

"Are you asleep?"

"No," Izuku groggily replies, and for once their roles have been switched. *"Just resting my eyes."*

"That's the same thing. I'm hanging up so go to sleep,"

"Aren't we supposed to do a video call?" he reminds the other, referring to what they were talking about last night. *"You said you'll help me pack my things,"* because he's not really good at it. He tends to overpack and bring things that are unnecessary. As proof, he used to carry that large yellow backpack throughout high school. They didn't need a lot of books in high school…

And they had student lockers…

"That's postponed," Katsuki announces, noticing his snickering teammates behind his back. "Set an alarm for six pm or something."

"Okay…"

"Hang up now,"

"Nn, bye Kacchan…"

Piii – Piii – Piii – Piii –

After the call ends, Katsuki sighs and he turns around asking, "What?"

Mina smiles because, "Nothing. I'm just excited for the both of you."

Everyone in team UA is. Kirishima, Sero, and Kaminari are also grinning in his direction.

"You look like you can't wait for tomorrow, Baku,"

Was it that obvious?

Katsuki narrows his eyes at his teammates whose laughter only gets worse.

There is a reason why Bakugo Katsuki is looking forward to meeting Midoriya Izuku.

“Why is it taking so goddamn long?”

A thirteen-year-old player complains over the mic, the members of his party chuckling at his impatience.

“There’s not a lot of players in this server, King-kun,”

It’s a voice that belonged to a male, a teenager, or a young adult but definitely older than Katsuki. His avatar – *Nano* – is dressed in a mage’s garb and alongside him are two more players. They’re currently in Musutafu Square waiting for others to accept their request. They need five players to enter the Blue Mist Forest. Katsuki has worked with this party a few times before so he has no problem tagging along. He’s a newbie as well – a LVL. 16 who wants to gain EXP the fastest way possible. Raids and entering dungeons are one of the best ways to do that.

Ping!

Someone wants to join your party!
[Leader: Nano permission needed]

“Ahh, they’re here,”

Katsuki scowls, tapping his fingers on his desk.

***Izuku* has joined your party!**

“Deku?” the blonde narrows his eyes at the screen, readjusting his headset. “What kinda name is that?”

He’s seen worse but *Deku?* Who the fuck names their avatar *useless?*

“Uhh… It’s actually pronounced as *Izuku,”*

A new voice connects, soft and a bit shy.

“Hi, nice to meet you.”

Izuku sent you a friend request!

[ACCEPT] or [DECLINE] ?

“You scream like a girl!”

“I did not scream like a girl!”

“Well, you sure did a high-pitched scream!”

“I did not scream!”

***Izuku* sent you x100 angry emotes.**

You sent *Izuku* x100 angry emotes.

Ping!

> **Dungeon Cleared by**
> Atisse, Bukukuchagama, Izuku, King Explosion Murder and Nano.
> Time: 00:48:12:32

“Where’s the idiot, anyway?”

“I’m right here, Kacchan…”

“Stop calling me that!”

“But your username is too long!”

Izuku sent you a friend request!

> **[ACCEPT] or [DECLINE] ?**

And their first *crisis.*

“Hand it over, King,”

Right after their sixth raid, their teammates directing their weapons at them. In this scenario, the word *them* is used but their aggression is mostly focused on King Explosion Murder, Izuku nervously standing at the edge of the dungeon. He’s included on the victim list because technically, he’s not in on this situation. Whatever this farce is, he’s just as clueless as Katsuki. Apparently, their teammates have no intention of splitting the loot, some sort of consensus the

three older players agreed on.

I mean, yeah, it's a Rainbow Gem and it's very valuable but…

"You and your shitty luck," a thirteen-year-old's very colorful language. "You had a 15% chance and you still got none? Even when there's three of you!?" a condescending, prideful tone followed by a scoff.

The chances are low yes, he *knows.* It's not his fault he has good luck nevertheless. The distribution is different per player and he just happened to receive the best. His only mistake was that he opened his mouth and revealed the fact that he received a rainbow gem.

These jealous fuckers…

"TRY IT BITCH. YOU KNOW WHAT THEY DO TO PLAYERS WHO PK – "

Ping!

You have suffered 2,470 damage.

"Kacchan!"

Izuku sent you a friend request!

[ACCEPT] or [DECLINE] ?

Katsuki *hates* parties.

"We will get it back. Calm down, Kacchan!"

He *hates* parties.

"We will get it back!"

12:48 A.M.

"The fuck are you doing still on at this time?"

Referring to that one pesky avatar running around King Explosion Murder.

The other is doing a show out of stickers and emotes, universal bubbles popping up on top of his head to communicate. They're still not friends so this will have to do for now. You can only

communicate with others by pinging them on the live server chat, using bubbles, or befriending them. Katsuki has still yet to accept Izuku's friend request.

Ping!

Deku: I changed my username!!

***Deku* sent you a gift.**

Click. Click.

You received a *Rainbow Gem* from *Deku!*

"No parties,"

"No parties,"

"I'll kill you if you mess this up,"

And that's how it started.

Deku sent you a friend request!

[<u>ACCEPT</u>] or [DECLINE] ?

Click! Click! Click!

"Pay attention— *KEEP YOUR EYES ON ME DEKU YOU DWEEB –"*

They can't really do many high-level raids because there are just the two of them. Partying up would have been faster but Katsuki had expressed his extreme hatred on said idea. It looks like they'd be taking the long route – leveling up by killing monsters. Now, there's nothing wrong with that method. It's a good way to hone quirks and enhance skills but it's difficult and very time-consuming. Although monsters are the main enemies in the game, ultimately, everyone is racing each other to level up.

You have gained 4,200 EXP.

"You killed it again, Kacchan!" Izuku complains, half-crying over the mic. *"I didn't receive any!"*

Experience points he means.

First come first serve, you see. The one who kills the monster is the one who gains EXP.

Although Izuku helped a lot he didn't gain any because Katsuki landed the last hit.

"You're too fucking slow!" he doesn't even feel bad about kill stealing.

They've been trying to level up for a while now. Technically, Deku can go and join other parties but he doesn't want to. Perhaps he also hates parties in a way. It's more fun to play with players he knows and although Katsuki's kind of rough around the edges, it's enjoyable and he likes gaming with him. In summary, Izuku is playing for the *experience.* He's not competitive at all. Katsuki was baffled and shocked when he heard that exclaiming, *what are you? A fucking nerd!?* This is not a shonen manga where love and friendship take over, you know!

"You should've used your ULT!"

"But it wasn't up, Kacchaaaan—"

"You need to time it with mine. Pay fucking attention!"

"But I did time it!"

Sniffle.

The blonde owlishly blinks.

Sniffle. Sniffle.

"You're already on 32 and I'm still on 25," a difference of seven levels. It's not a lot but to a thirteen-year-old who wants to keep up with his friend, it's vast. Enough to make him cry, at least. On the other side of the screen, Katsuki's eyebrow is twitching, unprepared for what is happening. *"We can't duo at this rate,"* a small whine, referring to the dungeon they agreed to challenge.

Katsuki's face contorts into a peculiar expression before he groans saying, "Fine."

His avatar then turns as he grumbles,

"You can have the next kill. Whatever."

Ping!

> New Record Set by
> **King Explosion Murder and Deku.**
> Time: 00:58:11:46

Ping!

> New Record Set by
> **King Explosion Murder and Deku.**
> Time: 00:50:10:23

Ping!

New Record Set by
King Explosion Murder and Deku.
Time: 00:44:12:10

Ping!

New Record Set by
King Explosion Murder and Deku.
Time: 00:36:19:027

"Fuck! Screw it!"

Katsuki exclaims as he sends an explosion towards the Goblin Riders chasing them.

"LET'S JUST BLOW EVERYTHING UP AND CALL IT A DAY!"

"K-Kacchan!" he ought to scold Izuku for having his mic that close to his mouth but the battle comes first for now.

"IS YOUR ULT FUCKING UP!?"

"It's up!"

"WHAT ARE YOU WAITING FOR THEN!? STUN GUN!"

"Smaaaaash!"

Bakugo Katsuki is not a friendly person.

He has a group he surrounds himself with but they're not friends. They think they're friends but they're just acquaintances. He goes to school with his acquaintances, he sits with them during lunch and he'd sometimes go with them somewhere after school but they're not his friends. They don't last long – his acquaintances are always different, changing every year the class is shuffled, when their seats are re-arranged, depending on the time and place.

He doesn't have friends.

And that's not fucking sad, that's just the way he is. He's comfortable with it.

They're not friends because friends are people you want to hang out with during weekends.

People who want to see you even when there's no meeting set.

People who are actually excited to see you.

Your friend *Deku* is online.

Ping!

Deku:

>> Kacchan!!
>> Raid?

There's this one person for Katsuki.

He's a bit messy, a little bit clumsy and they're complete opposites but there's this one person.

Your friend *Deku* is requesting a call.

There's this one person who fits the bill.

"Maybe the real treasure was the memories we made along the way!?"

Izuku exclaims, trying to appease his partner's bad mood. He's learned to read his habits by now. Katsuki's silence basically meant that he was about to explode from anger. This time it's because of a bad reward. It was a very difficult dungeon and although they gained tons of experience, what matters in the end is the loot! *Where is the goddamn loot!?* They heard that it was good so they came here but it's all shitty items, oi!

"I ALMOST DIED!"

"Ah yes, that was my fondest memory – Kacchan! Wait!"

"Small fire!"

It's shitty Deku again!

Seriously… he takes his eye off him for a bit and this happens!

"I said to set a small fire *AND THIS IS NOT A SMALL FIRE!"*

[Cooking Skill LVL. 2 to LVL. 3]

"Come here!"

"No!"

"FUCKING COME HERE!"

"You're going to PK me, Kacchan!"

“That was fun – let’s do it again sometime!”

He’s never met this person before but is it bad that he can already imagine what he’s like?

“Mou, that’s pretty rude of you to say!”

Deku in real life is definitely just as bright and kind. He’s sure of it.

“A new patch? We should get married to share EXP?”

He’s sure of it.

You have registered *Deku* as your husband.

Set a new nickname?

[YES] or [NO] ?

“I can’t believe we have our own house, Kacchaaaaan,”

Izuku sounds like he’s cooing on the other side of the line, his avatar hugging their land deed. World Execute’s been getting more and more realistic. It was already good at first but they’ve added these tiny details. Houses are not necessary for players but it’s good to have your own place and spawning point. Also… your treasure chests won’t be looted by random players! It’s basically your own little territory inside the game and the two were elated when the update dropped.

“Now we’re fucking broke,”

“It was worth it!”

“Hell yeah, it was worth it,”

Even Katsuki agrees. He and Deku spent four weeks doing missions to gain money you know!

Realistic is good but isn’t the price a bit too realistic!?

Consider the children playing the game, oi!

“Maybe when we get a bit richer we can buy that one – “ Deku pointing towards the empty plot next to theirs. The Japanese server is big but there are not a lot of players in Musutafu. They’re mostly in Hosu, somewhere near the center because that’s where all the hot spots like shopping districts and commissions are. *“I want a second floor.”*

But they don’t have any gold left so this will have to do for now.

“You have your equipment with you?”

“Nn! I have it!” Izuku cheerfully nods, trailing after King Explosion Murder. *“Sky Forest? Are we going to farm?”* for materials so that they can start crafting and building. Labor costs are expensive after all! They’ve already planned the entire thing out. Katsuki even asked his father for advice! As expected of someone born in a very artistic family! Designing a house is quite easy for them it looks like.

“You don’t have class tomorrow, right?”

“Yep!”

“Get ready to grind then, shitty Deku!”

Izuku’s laughter rings from the other side of the line.

“You can text me anytime you want,”

A forgotten chain of numbers in a chatbox unopened for eight years.

“Next time, tell me when you can’t play. Got that?”

“Nice to meet you, Katsuki-kun,”

A woman’s voice greets from Izuku’s mic.

“It’s my mom, Kacchan! I was just showing her the game for a bit,”

Katsuki, fourteen, red-faced and nervous replies, “Hi auntie.”

It’s the first time he’s ever cared about first impressions his entire life.

“I saved up three months’ worth of allowance for that skin!”

“I also fucking saved up you know!”

Ping!

You received a gift from *Deku*.

You sent *Deku* a gift.

This feels right.

“You and me. Summer festival this upcoming August, you got that!?”

That’s it. It’s this person.

“Nice kill!” Deku’s avatar smiling at him from the screen. “We broke another record, Kacchan.”

This feels about right.

Year XXXX, July 24.

Click. Click. Click.

Fifteen-year-old Bakugo Katsuki silently scrolls down his friend list with a tired expression on his face. There’s not a lot on that list, only two accounts. One belongs to that WE assistant everyone has by default and Deku.

Click. Click.

Your husband *Deku* was online sixteen days ago.

Katsuki stares at the words on his screen before he plops his head against his desk.

Three years later while waiting he’s asked to join Team UA.

“IS THAT EVEN FUCKING POSSIBLE – “

Twenty-three-year-old Katsuki’s blood is *boiling.*

“You took a nap when you arrived,”

This isn’t making any sense so let’s line it up.

Yesterday, Izuku arrived from Osaka at around five in the afternoon. He woke up at seven and they talked for a while. The packing was postponed until eleven because the officer hasn’t eaten dinner yet. He had to go out of his apartment to buy food since he didn’t have any in his fridge – *not that strange because he just came back from his internships* – but after buying ingredients, he cooked, ate, took a bath, and fell asleep which caused him to completely forget about his agenda.

His agenda to pack his things.

His things for Tokyo.

His flight is at ten am.

It's eight.

They barely have two hours left.

"IF YOU MESS THIS UP I'M GONNA KILL YOU," and quite literally on top of that. Then again, it's not really possible to kill someone who lives far away. The intent is present but the threat itself cannot be accomplished. Also… is that a proper thing to say to a police officer? *"WHAT ARE YOU DOING!?"* because this guy seems like he's just running around his bedroom looking for random things.

"I just remembered…" a panting Izuku pauses in front of his desk where his phone is propped up, "*I haven't done my laundry – "*

"JUST BRING WHATEVER. IT'S YOUR UNIFORM THAT'S IN THE LAUNDRY – "

This guy seems to have forgotten that he doesn't wear casual clothes while working.

He's worrying about useless things.

I can't believe this is happening, Katsuki groans as he covers his face with both hands, *Is this really fucking happening!?*

Are they not about to meet because Izuku overslept?

"Don't worry about it!" the other's voice snaps him out of his stupor, that handsome face on the center of his screen. "*The airport is just fifteen minutes by cab and I can take a shower really, really fast! All that's left to pack is my coat, see? I don't even need to put it in here! I can just wear it to save space!"* fabric that's messily folded is peeking through the other's duffel bag.

"I won't be late. Calm down, Kacchan!"

"We will get it back. Calm down, Kacchan!"

The voices overlap.

Ahh… that's right.

"What the hell…" Katsuki groans, Izuku's smile faltering. "Aren't you way too lenient for someone that's running late? Everyone knows you're supposed to be an hour early for flights! Why the fuck are you just standing still!? You're wasting your goddamn time!"

That seems to effectively set the other in motion again.

"Midoriya Izuku, I swear to God if you miss this shit…"

Izuku's panicking in the background and Katsuki only calms down when he sees the other disappear into the bathroom with a bunch of clothes in hand. Six minutes later he comes out fully dressed with his hair dripping wet. *You'll catch a cold,* since it's winter and all, *How'd you manage to live when you're this inattentive and shit?*

"I'll be waiting for you at gate 3 you got that!?"

Katsuki tells Izuku who’s in the midst of pulling a sweater over his head.

“Nn! Got it Kacchan!”

Ping!

Deku:

> >> I’m not at the airport yet
> >> I came back because I forgot my ticket

Katsuki wants to fucking scream into the void.

"You're moving away from Tokyo, Midoriya?"

A classmate asks, trailing beside the other in the hallway.

"Nn, we're moving to Fukuoka,"

"Your mom got promoted, right? A private school then?"

Izuku awkwardly laughs because, "I don't think so. She said my school will be like Aldera."

Their conversation continues while in the background someone exclaims,

"Bakugo!"

A blonde student frowns when his name gets called out, scowling as he asks, "What!?"

"Nothing, nothing~" his classmate sing-songs, "Let's go to the cafeteria together!"

Their shoulders do not brush as they pass.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained

(1) PK - player kill. this was mentioned in the earlier chapters but in case you're confused.
(2) ULT - ultimate skill.
(3) Aldera - middle school where both izuku and katsuki went to.

i didn't mention that izuku used to live in tokyo for this purpose.
they were in the same school in canon so it's also included here i guess.
also... this chapter includes a lot of flashbacks in katsuki's pov.
it's a bit long but i needed to get it out of the way.
it felt like katsuki's experience needed to be written or else their meeting would be shallow.

see you in the next update!

in the same place at the same time

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Ping!

Deku:

>> I got in!
>> There's still thirty minutes left
>> I'm early Kacchan www

Katsuki is about to *explode.*

It's both from anger, impatience, happiness, nervousness – it's so complex he wonders if this shit is even normal. He's been lying down on his bed for a while now and yet his heartbeat is showing no signs of slowing down. It's so loud he can hear it in his ears, humming against his neck and chest. Perhaps this is a case of tachycardia… an *extreme* one. Or maybe he just can't fucking calm down because Deku is less than thirty minutes away from boarding that plane and approximately three hours before they meet.

It's not like he's coming from a different country or something…

It's just Fukuoka. It's still in Japan.

It's just a two-hour plane ride. It's not like there are thousands of miles in between them.

Fuck.

The past few months are starting to sink in and all of a sudden everything feels a bit too overwhelming.

A part of him is saying *this is too good to be true* while the other is rejoicing because –

"You've been waiting for this,"

They were doing this.

"You've been waiting for this for so long,"

There were going to fucking do this.

It's not like he has any plans of backing out but he has no idea how to act in front of the other. Izuku doesn't even seem that nervous. The guy has the gall to forget his plane ticket, that's how nonchalant and carefree he is. The bitch had the nerve to oversleep while he was up in his bed contemplating on what he should say when they meet. He even brought new clothes for this day and *fucking hell, why?* He's not a high schooler. Do you know how long he's been scrolling down pages?

Thinking and formulating plans because fuck –

Don't make him feel bored.

That's the last thing you should do.

Don't make Deku feel bored.

He's come all the way from Fukuoka just to see you.

Then again, if Izuku says that he's bored Katsuki will just leave and tell him to *fuck off I don't need you in my life you're not worth it* and then maybe go cry in his bed or something. Admittedly, he has very high pride. Another thing about Katsuki is that he doesn't care about meeting new people. He can introduce himself, be respectful and all but that's surface level and shallow. He's the type that doesn't exert much effort into things like socializing. 99% of the time, the people that surround him are those that willingly attach themselves.

Deku is *different.*

He's nice, he follows him around and all but that's *inside* the game.

He hardly knows what he's like in person.

Will he even –

Bang! Bang! Bang!

Katsuki frowns, slowly looking up from his spot on the pillow.

Bang! Bang! Bang!

"WHAT!?"

He was having an inner monologue damn it!

"Open the door Baku! We have something to give you!"

The team captain grimaces, grumpily getting off his bed to walk towards the door.

I swear to God I'm going to move out of this place soon…

"STOP BANGING ON THE DOOR SO GODDAMN MUCH," it's not like he's deaf or something. He can hear clear enough. "The fuck do you need – " he blinks, scowling when he opens the door and sees the thing that Mina is holding up, Kaminari brightly smiling beside her. "The fuck is that?" he's a bit taken aback, obvious because he's not even shouting.

"It's a banner!"

A big red banner with the words *Welcome, Deku!*

There's silence for a while and Kaminari breaks it by asking, "Well?"

Red eyes shift from the banner and towards the pair.

"Do… Do you like it?"

A scream too odd to belong to a human being echoes inside Team UA's shared house.

A meeting is held.

“How the fuck did you guys know that I was meeting up with Deku!?”

Cellphones are confiscated.

“NO NOT MINE ARGHHHHHHH – “

Ping!

Katsuki narrows his eyes at the screen because *these bitches have a fucking group chat.*

Sedun Dnes:

>> **Deku**: I’M NERVOUS
>> **Mina:** BBY YOU CAN DO IT
>> **Sero:** Update us on how it goes later
>> **Kaminari:** It’s fine if he doesn’t come home tonight
>> **Kaminari:** If you know what I mean
>> **Mina:** I mean we were supposed to have Team UA stream
>> **Mina:** But it’s fine if you extend your plans or smth
>> **Kirishima:** HAHAHAHAHAHA
>> *Sero is currently typing…*

He turns his head towards the stairwell, aware that the other two are in the living room downstairs.

>> **Sero:** I think they made a banner HAHAHAHA

“Our phones have passwords – “

Kaminari laughs, leaning against the wall.

He’s laughing now but he definitely wasn’t earlier. They almost leaked Deku’s plans, phew.

“He was just asking us for advice!” Mina defends, pouting with her arms crossed above her chest. It’s not like they were doing something embarrassing or shameful. They were helping out with their love life actually. “Geez, Baku! You overreact too much,” well it’s always been like that when it came to Deku at least.

“What advice?”

Mina flinches and the boys awkwardly laugh.

Katsuki is not mad.

He talks to Yummycat, asking for photos behind Izuku's back so it's a bit similar but –

FUCK.

Deku: I hope Kacchan likes it

Isn't this guy a bit too unfair!?

Deku: I'll tell him when we meet

Katsuki can feel his chest constrict.

One last phone call.

"Hey,"

"Hey,"

In the background, there's an intercom, a voice calling passengers for a certain flight. Katsuki knows that it's the one Deku's supposed to board because he's been looking at that plane ticket photo a bit more frequently than he would've liked. It's come to the point where he remembers that very specific chain of letters and numbers, the time, the place, and even what seat it is. Oddly enough, he's very observant about this. Maybe it's because he was anxiously looking forward to it…

Strange.

"Say something,"

It's unfair how he's the only one like this.

Izuku hums because, *"Nn…"*

This guy is oddly calm.

"I don't know what to say," there's that awkward laughter and if Katsuki knew any better he'd realize that it's not just him fretting over this. That Izuku overslept because he was worried and couldn't rest well that night or the day prior to that. That he left his ticket behind because he was way too nervous and jittery. His clumsy side often comes out when he's tense you see. *"Which gate was it again?"*

"Fuck – It's gate three!"

"Okay, got it, gate three," and Izuku chuckles slightly humming, *"I'll see you at gate three…"*

Silence.

And it's not really uncomfortable at this point. It's just Katsuki grumpily staring at the wall, Izuku with a fond smile on his face.

All he can hear on the other side of the line is the muffled noise of people talking to each other before –

“I have something to tell Kacchan when we meet,”

Katsuki grimaces, cheeks flushed. Deep inside he knows where this is going.

“Just say it now.”

“Nope,”

“WHY!?”

“Hmm… It’s not really proper to say it over the phone,” Katsuki groans, feeling the need to sit down on his bed because *what’s not proper to say over the phone!?* So he’s fine with doing lewd things but *this* is where he crosses the line!? This guy is really good with testing his patience. It's almost torturous in a way and the blonde reminds himself to seek some sort of revenge.*“It’s something that Kacchan probably already knows.”*

He has a hunch but, “Haa—ah?”

That came out a bit more unstable than he would’ve liked.

“What you’re thinking right now…”

A *confession.*

That’s unfair.

“What you’re thinking right now is probably right, Kacchan…”

Midoriya Izuku is unfair.

“Hmm… I don’t think I can lie anymore,”

A pause.

“I really, really miss you,”

And Katsuki’s expression softens because, “We haven’t met yet, stupid!”

GROUND ZERO @bkgkatsuki_official • 10 min ago
no stream for today and for the next following days.

“You really told him about the goddamn banner…”

Katsuki grumbles under his breath, returning Kaminari’s phone.

“Sorry,” the other sniffles, starting to contemplate a bit. “We got too excited.”

It was just for fun anyway. They weren’t planning on doing it because it’s not like they’d be accompanying Katsuki to the airport anyway. He doubts their team captain would allow them to go. This wasn’t about friend groups, you see. Also, they might have miscalculated earlier because they forgot that they were supposed to be oblivious regarding their meeting.

“Deku was the one who asked!” Mina points out, Kirishima nodding because *that’s right, that’s right! He was asking me for a favor! He told me during the convention!* “You…” there’s this sinister smile on her face, “Be prepared for the date of a lifetime!”

“Wha – “

“That’s right! This guy has no freaking idea – “

“What the – “

“Give the guy a big warm hug when you see him!” Mina says and the boys behind her nod in agreement. “Have fun, Bakugo!”

Katsuki grimaces because, “I know that already!”

He then starts to grumble against his scarf as he makes his way out of the house.

Deku:

>> Kacchan
>> Are you in gate 3 already?
>> I just landed
>> I think
<< *what do you mean i think!?*

There’s a click.

“Yeah, that’s the new patch. Getting married, I mean…”

Fifteen-year-old Katsuki musters, red-faced behind his screen at eleven pm.

“You won’t have to work as hard and – “ what did it say on the update page again, “and… the skin you like won’t be as expensive. We can go to the exclusive events together and because we get

to share the points we can level up at the same time."

Proposing takes a lot of courage for a fifteen-year-old, Bakugo Katsuki most especially. Deku might have thought that he was just doing it for the benefits but admittedly, some part of it involved something personal.

Katsuki at the age of fifteen makes his first confession. Unexpectedly, the person he confesses to is male – something he's lamented over the past two years. It's a big deal for a teenager like him. It's also someone whom he's never met before. A bit risky, he knows, but it's Deku… He's warry to everyone on the internet except for Deku.

Katsuki then pouts when he hears the other laugh.

"Geez…" he starts to grumble, "AND I WAS TRYING REALLY HARD TO SAY IT!"

"What happens when we reach 100 then? Do we get divorced?"

The maximum level at that time.

"Hah!?" Katsuki exclaims, scandalized. "As if I'll let you divorce me after leaching off!"

As well as, "You're indebted to me for life!"

It's been a while since he'd last been here.

His purpose is different because unlike before, he's not here to board a flight and represent Japan for an overseas gaming event. It's not for a convention either. If you told him five years ago that he'd be standing in front of Gate 3F waiting for his *friend, lover, pseudo* – it's *confusing.* He doesn't know what to call the thing happening between them but he likes it. It feels warm, carefree, and good. It used to feel like waiting for something that isn't going to happen but Deku is well…

Even without seeing his face, Katsuki would've already agreed to anything.

Eight years ago this would've been just something temporary but –

This isn't even a phase anymore.

Katsuki sighs, staring at the area right in front of him. It's a few minutes past twelve and he got a text from the other confirming his arrival. There are scarf-wearing businessmen walking past right in front of him, foreigners, and even children. There are also a few sitting around waiting just like him, noise everywhere – rolling luggage on wheels, phone calls, the intercom repeating phrases like *JAL102 – Kyoto,* and *SF27 – Okinawa*. It's in the middle of winter and the airport's AC is blasting on high.

It's not making him feel better, fuck.

Ding – Dong – Diiiing!

"Calling all passengers of flight JAX327 please proceed to Terminal 2, calling all passengers –"

Ah it's just the intercom. He got surprised for a moment there.

There's a second of relief before he owlishly blinks, noticing a small crowd start to emerge into the baggage claiming area. There's a glass that divides the two spaces and Katsuki can see everyone head towards the belts to claim their suitcases. He then remembers *ahh, Deku doesn't have a suitcase*. He knows what his flight number is but there's no guarantee that it's this one.

For all he knows it might be a different batch.

Where is he!?

Katsuki is impatiently tapping his foot on the floor, arms crossed above his chest all the while scowling.

Ba-thump. Ba-thump. Ba-thump.

FUCK.

He kind of feels the need to take his heart out and scream *FUCKING CALM DOWN* to it or something.

It's not good…

A moment later, a familiar figure emerges from the back of the crowd. He's tall so he stands out quite a bit. He has this nervous expression on his face that's enough to make a few people look back and ask if he's alright, only to be dismissed with the kindest words of assurance ever. If Katsuki didn't know any better he'd never assume that this guy was one scary cop. He looked like he was lost.

Also, there's *that.*

Freckles, green hair, green eyes looking around – *searching.*

He's fucking looking for me, and his heart starts to swell, *his eyesight probably sucks.*

He knows that his Deku is good-looking but *fuck.*

It's the kind of face that stops you in your tracks. His friends might be used to that, the sudden pause in his natural expression when he looks at something that catches his eye followed by a nonchalant gaze. Like the one he's giving the flight attendant right now. It's probably the same modest personality that made others fall of him. He was handsome alright, fucking gorgeous if he'd have to add and all Katsuki ought to say to that woman is *stop bothering him, he's looking for me –*

She must have been giving him directions because she points a hand towards the area he's in and Izuku's attention follows. The other scans and takes in the sight for a moment before their eyes meet and all it takes is one smile for Katsuki's breath to hitch.

His breath fucking *hitches.*

Admittedly, his face is flushed and he's a bit irritated because *what are you standing around there for!?*

Hurry up and get over here, stupid!

The other looks frantic, wanting to get out but awkwardly laughing because his path is being blocked by children and the elderly. He lets them pass first and patiently waits, irises flickering back and forth to the blonde. *Wait a sec,* he mouths, and the blonde's heart clenches. *I'll be there in a bit, Kacchan.* Katsuki feels like he's on the verge of losing his strength when that familiar figure finally passes by the doors with eyes just as glazed as his, warmly and brightly smiling at him.

Nn, that's Deku.

"Kacchan!"

FUCK THAT'S DEKU.

Katsuki hesitantly takes one, *two* steps forward before his legs immediately shift into a sprint.

There were people looking but he didn't care.

"Took you long enough!"

Katsuki ran to him anyway.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Banner - there is no banner.
(2) Airport Meeting - i said there will be no airport meeting but look at this now.
(3) Five Days and Four Nights - i miscalculated. it's supposed to be this one and not four days three nights.

anyway, they've met now... kinda? it'll be a proper one next chap.
there's a hella load of pinning, worth 30 chaps, and there's finally development.
i can't believe we managed to go this far without the mcs even meeting hahaha.

also, yeah... they were in the same school.
a few open-world games do that. wait lemme explain.
in order to avoid lags and make the connection faster, it's more efficient if people on the same server are grouped together during parties. that's because the closer you are, the more stable the connection is.
izuku and katsuki were in the same party because they lived in the same neighborhood and went to the same school.
it makes sense if you look at how the game mechanic servers work. it's not the same for every game though just to be clear.

see you guys next week or after the 28th! i have my final exams...
it just had to happen before chapter 34 but ughh... it couldn't be helped.

that's my player two

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"You're here,"

"I'm here,"

"Fuck…" Katsuki mumbles against the other's chest, arms tightly wrapped around Izuku's torso. He's never been one to initiate hugs before but this one couldn't be helped. He's been waiting for so goddamn long so this much should be allowed at least. Also, he wasn't hearing any objections. "Deku… *Deku,"* spoken with a tone that seemed a bit too desperate.

Izuku who is reciprocating the embrace laughs because, "Nn, hi Kacchan."

Katsuki grimaces, his heart skipping a beat.

He takes note of the height difference – Izuku is tall enough to somehow rest his chin on top of his head. He's annoying tall but he already knows that after seeing the photos of him and Kirishima. What he didn't expect is *this.* This rock-hard chest he's pressed against right now. After a while, the nervousness starts to turn into embarrassment because *fuck, Deku's pecs.* His nose is pressed against it. The same one he's seen on photos and –

Okay, calm down. Calm down for now!

"We're falling over, Kacchan,"

And the officer holds him tighter, dropping on the floor to get a better hold of Katsuki.

The blonde squirms and Izuku laughs, the low rumble humming on his chest. Katsuki is grumbling something incoherent, his face flushed because it's *unfair.* This guy is definitely wearing cologne and shit. If he isn't then doesn't he smell way too good!? It's absolutely not the sweater he's wearing, he can tell that much at least. *This is annoying,* all of a sudden the embarrassment shifts into petty anger. *This guy is prepared.*

"How was your flight?" he turns his head, one cheek squashed against Izuku's chest.

"It was alright. There was snow yesterday so I was a bit worried…"

Katsuki nods, gaze focused somewhere else.

His heartbeat is loud.

At least he's not the only one losing his mind over this.

They just stand there in the same position for a while, Izuku laughing when he realizes that no one is willing to continue the conversation. It should've felt awkward but it doesn't. As expected, both of them are comfortable with each other whether it is online or in real life. It's a warm, fuzzy feeling – something intense enough to make Katsuki stubbornly not want to let go.

"Ghnn…"

The officer owlishly blinks, panicking because, "Kacchan, are you crying!?"

He wasn't!

Izuku gently caresses Katsuki's cheeks with his hands, noticing the glassy eyes but no tears. It's a face he's imagined in his mind various times before. As expected though, a pouting Kacchan is much cuter in person. The sight makes his heart clench and he softly brushes his thumb against the other's skin.

"Fuck, your hands are cold," is what Katsuki says, scowling a bit. Izuku just nods because *I didn't think I'd need gloves,* and he was in a rush this morning, *it was freezing on the plane.* "Let's go somewhere warmer…" tugging on the other's sleeve, moving back for a bit.

Izuku fondly smiles at the sentiment replying, "Nn…"

Cute.

"Let's go somewhere warmer, Kacchan."

"Is it alright?"

Katsuki is scowling, glaring at the road in front of them.

Even with the weather like this, cold with a bit of snowfall, he feels a bit too hot for his liking. Maybe it has something to do with the hand that's holding his right now. It makes him nervous and stiff because *fuck that's Deku's hand.* He can also feel the other's gaze on his face definitely looking at him.

"What do you mean?"

Leaving his car that far from the place they're heading to or the hand-holding?

"This I mean…" slightly swinging their hands, intertwining their fingers. "You're not uncomfortable?"

Hah!? Who would be uncomfortable – are you kidding me right now!?

"It's fine," Katsuki grumbles, his frown deepening.

It's the face he makes when he feels butterflies in his stomach. Some sort of defense mechanism to hide the giddiness he feels because he's Bakugo Katsuki and he has an image to uphold. He's prepared himself for this but the real thing is different after all. At some point he has surrendered, letting Izuku tuck their fingers in the pocket of his coat. He's an adult so he can do this, this is basic.

Katsuki feels like he wants to escape from reality in various ways…

He's usually not this inattentive but today he's staggered at least twice. It's like he's some sort of distressed shojou manga character that really needs to get a grip. *You're twenty-three years old,* mentally slapping his own cheek, *PAY ATTENTION TO THE FUCKING ROAD*! It felt like he'd bump into one of the people passing by so he tries to let go, only for Izuku to tighten his hold instead.

Hmm… Is this a new form of torture perhaps?

Maybe God is testing the power of his heart…

At least it feels warm but ehh… We're already inside!

"How long are you going to do this!?" even the one taking their order is blushing.

It better be from seeing them two though, not from Izuku's face!

She looks a bit disoriented all the while taking their order, looking like she's almost fawning. Katsuki slightly regrets wearing a mask to hide his face. He put one on after they exited the car to somehow hide his identity but *oi!* It feels like a mistake for some reason!

Katsuki pinches the other's hand on top of the table.

Red eyes focus on the sight in front of him.

"Is there something on my face?"

Izuku blinks, in the middle of eating.

It's nearly one pm and they both haven't had lunch so they've both decided to do that first. There are a lot of good places in this area of Tokyo, you see. Izuku said something about getting katsudon but no way in hell was Katsuki going to allow them to spend their first time eating together in some run-down place. The other looked a bit disappointed but ultimately agreed to it, in no position to argue because he did have Katsudon for lunch yesterday and last night for dinner as well.

They've been texting so no doubt, Katsuki definitely knew.

"No," the blonde huffs, shifting his attention back to his plate. "You're just imagining it."

Izuku forces a smile.

"Hmm… Okay, let's eat fast," now that catches the streamer's attention.

"Why?"

"Weren't you worried about *that?"* the very main reason why they chose a seat that was at the far end of the restaurant. It wasn't crowded but it wasn't deserted either so Izuku figured that the other was keeping things in check. "People recognizing you, I mean…"

"Hah!?" personally, he doesn't care if people recognize him and they can stare all they want. When he's alone he doesn't try to deliberately hide his identity. Izuku's not wrong but the context is different. "If they see me they'll figure out that you're Deku, won't they? It's worse if they take a picture and post it online on a thread or some shit."

Izuku remains silent because *ahh, it's a Deku issue then.*

Well, Katsuki's already pulled down his mask to eat so…

“It’s fine,” the officer starts off, “I don’t really mind if they find out that I’m Deku.”

Izuku’s never told him this, has he?

“If you’re worried about pictures they can’t do that,” he knows his stuff, familiar with the law and all. Technically, although it’s alright to take pictures, posting them online without permission is not allowed. It doesn’t matter if it’s a civilian or a celebrity. “You’ve been worried about it for a while but I don’t think they’d do that… leak my identity I mean.”

“Hah?” is this guy oblivious to the dark side of the internet or something. They definitely had this conversation on the phone before. “As I said, there are fucked up individuals out there who won’t stop even if you tell them to. What makes you think they’d ask for your permission?”

Izuku blinks because, “Well… true, but I mean…”

Technically speaking –

“You can always sue them and they’ll have to take it down,”

Sue!?

Katsuki feels a shiver run down his spine.

Police officers are *scary.*

“Japan’s privacy laws are very strict, Kacchan…”

He did know that but –

“You can always settle it legally if you want,”

He’s been worrying over nothing then!?

Maybe he should’ve told Deku instead of worrying about it by himself.

“It’s fucking snowing!”

“It’s fine!” Izuku laughs, pulling him along the white streets of Tokyo. “They’re too busy to look at us!”

And Katsuki just stares as he lets himself get dragged by the arm, his entire attention focused on those snowflakes on the other’s lashes.

Perhaps this isn't the first time they've met.

People who have only been introduced aren't this comfortable with each other.

It wasn't love at first sight either.

"I haven't been in Tokyo for a while!"

It was something that was formed gradually.

Izuku's personality – his hair, his eyes, the way he smiles and those goddamn freckles on his face. Although everything about this person makes him stand out from others Katsuki is not the type to fall for just a pretty face. He wasn't a shallow person. He had high fucking standards, you see. He might have been longing before they reunited that time but he wasn't in love. It was the countless conversations that made him –

"We used to live near this area before we moved, "

– fall for Izuku *excuse me what?*

"We used to live near this area," Izuku repeats, pointing towards the street. "It was an apartment complex in Aldera park and uhh… it's not near, never mind. Maybe I thought it was near because the bus –"

Hah?

And he chatters on and on, Katsuki's monologue cut off again.

HAAAAH!?

"We were thirteen at that time!"

"Still should've fucking told me!"

"I was very wary of everyone on the internet – "

"We lived in the same neighborhood –"

"My mom was a lawyer and… Kacchan? *Kacchan!?"*

"It really wasn't my intention to hide it from you,"

Izuku says, bumping his shoulder against Katsuki.

They're currently riding the lift heading to the fourth four after it had been decided that the officer should check in since it's already past six in the evening. A normal person wouldn't check in a reservation this late but hmm… it couldn't be helped since they got caught up talking and walking

around. Katsuki wasn't as upset during the latter half but Izuku can't help but be nervous when he's this silent.

"It's our first day," meeting and being together he means, "I don't like seeing you upset."

"I'm not fucking upset,"

"You were sulking,"

"I wasn't – " Katsuki grits his teeth, groaning because, *"Fuck."*

He's right.

He just ruined it huh? Even when this was supposed to be their long-awaited day.

He can't really help it. Call it a tantrum if you will but he just found out that they lived in the same area for approximately fifteen years. Judging from what the other said they might've gone to the same school as well. There is only one institution in Aldera, you see. There are tons in Tokyo but in where they lived it was the only one close in terms of distance. Katsuki doesn't dare to ask and Izuku seems to have understood that as well.

Ding!

Ah, they're here.

Room 102, room 102, room 102 –

"Sorry for getting upset," and Izuku pauses, about to swipe his key card.

That's right. Better apologize while you still can, Bakugo Katsuki.

Deku didn't come here all the way from Fukuoka just to argue with you.

The blonde presses his lips into a thin line while the other's face softens.

"It's fine, Kacchan. I understand," it's a bit surprising to see the other acting like this, and Izuku wonders if he's being considerate. He knows that it takes a lot to receive an apology from Katsuki. This kind of makes him feel happy for some reason. "I was also at fault. If I had told you more about myself back then maybe we would've met earlier."

A statement that makes the blonde frown, Izuku awkwardly smiling.

"From now on let's get to know each other more,"

That's right. It's in the past so they can't do anything about it now.

Izuku extends a hand to pat Katsuki's head once, *twice,* "So that we can avoid issues like these in the future, Kacchan."

Click. Clack!

The officer enters the room first, slightly puzzled when he sees the other just standing idly by the door.

"What's wrong?"

“Let’s meet again tomorrow,” Katsuki says, sounding like he’s struggling to speak. His face is contorted into a weird expression. A mix between irritated and impatient – agitated maybe. “In the morning…”

The officer tilts his head to the side because, “Aren’t you coming in?”

“Hah?”

“Nn?”

“That’s *your* hotel room, Deku,” and he feels like he’ll just embarrass himself again if he agrees. They’ve only spent a few hours so far and he’s already having a hard time allowing himself to leave. If he agrees to hang out more, let himself enter that room… “Go get some rest, geez. You overslept this morning, didn’t you?” an unrelated excuse, Izuku staring at him.

Silence.

“I still think you should come in,” Izuku tries to convince as he opens the door a bit wider, the lights still off. “You’ve come all this way and I still have to make up for making you upset.”

And Katsuki’s face turns red, his entire body freezing under those eyes.

“What make up!?”

“Hmm?”

“Wha –” even his voice sounds unstable, “What do you mean by *fucking make up!?”*

“Well…” Izuku delays, not quite sure about it himself. Would it be selfish to say that he doesn’t want him to leave yet? It’s a bit embarrassing to admit but he assumed that they’d be together for the entire duration of this trip. “That’s for Kacchan to decide…”

He’s never been the type to ignore Katsuki’s wishes anyway.

“Spit it out you coward!”

Izuku sheepishly laughs.

“I will tell you,” he defends himself, pouting a bit, “If you come in…”

If that isn’t an obvious invitation then he doesn’t know what is.

Katsuki looks like the wind has been knocked out of his chest because, “Fuck.”

His hands are sweaty, goddamnit!

“Move out of the way!”

And the door behind him clicks shut.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Japanese Privacy Laws - basically the right to not have private affairs made public without due cause. if you look it up well... in summary it's very strict and protects even celebrities. posting candid photos of other people online is not allowed in japan. you need their consent or you'll be in deep trouble.
(2) i kinda miss chat.

not a lot of action in this chap. just a lot of hand-holding and panic.
try to guess what happens next tho. i love your wild guesses lol.
also, here i am again, updating fast... even though i said it'll take a week.
everyone, please give me ideas for a 100k hits celebration or something.
what prompts do you want to see.

deducing from the face

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Katsuki watches as the other drops his bag on the floor.

Izuku is saying something about the weather in Tokyo being colder than Fukuoka and Osaka. His previous winters have always been rather mild but in this city, everyone is wrapped up in scarves and he's wondering if he came underdressed. On second thought, he should've brought a thicker coat. All that information doesn't process in Katsuki's brain nevertheless because he's just staring, *grimacing,* and standing like a statue a few meters away from the other.

The officer is in the middle of taking off his coat when he notices.

"Kacchan," ever so slightly amused as he sits down on the bed, "What are you doing over there, Kacchan?"

No reply.

Izuku smiles, extending his arms out for the other and hmm… *it's working.*

Not even a few seconds later and he gets Katsuki's entire weight leaning against his body, grumbling.

"Ah, we fell over," he laughs when his eyes meet the ceiling, arms wrapped around the blonde's waist. It's a comfortable position but he really should've taken his shoes off. "Are you cold?" because he is and that would kind of explain Katsuki's clinginess. *Nn, as expected Kacchan is the cutest,* all the while lightly patting his back. *Clingy Kacchan beats sleepy Kacchan.*

Izuku owlishly blinks when a shadow looms over his face, the other grimacing and slightly red.

"WELL!?"

Huh?

"Didn't…" Katsuki starts off, both hands resting on the sides of Izuku's head. "Didn't you have something to say to me!?" ah, he was referring to the phone call they had yesterday. Izuku did have something to say – a confession to be more exact, but that can wait for a later time. It's… It's a bit embarrassing to say it right now. He hasn't prepared his heart as well.

"Later, Kacchan,"

"No. Fucking say it now,"

"It's a bit difficult," when he feels him tightly grip the collar of his sweater, demanding an answer. "We have to consider TPO," some sort of excuse that only makes the other even more infuriated for some reason. Katsuki is ranting about it and Izuku just lets his head sway back and forth, too relaxed and used to being scolded.

Nn, my heart is not prepared. You can tell me off all you want.

"You don't get my point. What I want to say is – " slightly humming, tightening his hold around the other's waist, "Wouldn't it be better to say it once you get to know me better, Kacchan?" since

it's just their first day and all. They might have been talking every day for more than half a year but this is different, yes? In case Katsuki decides that he prefers the Deku he sees online…

"I'm saying that I *want* to hear it," he's been waiting for so goddamn long, "Give me my fucking confession, shitty Deku."

So he does know what it is… *Now I feel pressured…*

Izuku presses his lips into a thin line.

"Kacchan can confess first then… If you're so adamant about it,"

"HAH!? Why would I!?"

See? He knew that this was going to happen.

"If you don't want to then be patient," Izuku hums, extending his arms out again – an invitation for a hug. The streamer complains, a bit tempted but adamant about being stubborn and standing his ground. He has his pride to defend you see. He would be his if this guy just asks…

"Even if you appeal with your face I won't. Not until you say it,"

So the officer attempts a little bit harder and begs, "It's cold. Please come back."

Katsuki grimaces but leans in nevertheless.

"So you like my face?"

"Shut up,"

"You said that even if I appeal with my face you won't – "

"Shut the fuck up,"

He then proceeds to pinch Izuku's stomach under his sweater.

That kind of backfired, to be honest.

"I feel sad,"

Izuku says, watching the other straighten out his coat.

"I don't want Kacchan to leave yet,"

Katsuki freezes because *stop touching me, goddamit!*

He's also a bit guilty because he was in on it earlier but *this?* He's about to leave now. He knows

that there are different kinds of hugs – front hugs, side hugs but *back hugs?*

FUCK.

It feels like he's about to commit some sort of crime or something.

It doesn't help how this guy has a nice scent – something he's noticed even back at the airport. It's etched in his memory now since they did spend about an hour and a half just rolling around on that bed, talking about trivial things and making plans for tomorrow. It's not that hard to notice. Katsuki has never willingly allowed himself to like hugs but this…

This guy is scary.

Izuku's really good at hugs or something because Katsuki's supposed to *hate* it.

Or maybe the streamer's just biased, it's a mystery.

Katsuki purses his lips when the other gets dangerously close to his neck, hot breath fanning against his skin.

"Tomorrow," he says, the tips of his ears flushed red, "I'll stay over tomorrow."

Izuku hums because, "Nn, don't forget about our date tomorrow too."

"I know,"

"And I'll be waiting for Kacchan," for some reason he can't really say anything when the other speaks like that. Usually, he'd be triggered if someone speaks that softly but he likes it. *He fucking likes it.* He was used to it because they frequently talk on the phone but that voice is fucking unfair. It sends shivers down his spine so better get away now. *Quick.* "Am I still allowed to call later?"

"Fuck yes,"

"Okay," Izuku fondly laughs, pleased. "Okay."

"SO HOW WAS IT!?"

Kaminari exclaims as he stumbles, appearing at the entryway when he hears their team captain arrive and come in. Behind him, Mina is also brightly smiling – excited for answers. He checked his phone on the way here and saw the number of texts they've sent so he knows that they're pressed for answers. They're probably not going to let him go until he says something that satiates their curiosity.

"BRO – " and here comes Kirishima with a controller in one hand followed by Sero. "Well!?"

Katsuki doesn't reply, glaring and not moving from his position.

Mina laughs because, "YOUR FACE HAHAHA—"

“Isn’t that it?”

Sero says and everyone turns to him, wondering what he means.

“Maybe he’ll confess to you when he gives you his gift?”

Katsuki blinks because, “What gift?”

“I mean it’s Christmas and all…” as if he’s talking about something obvious, “You give gifts during Christmas.”

And Katsuki’s brain short circuits.

There should be a class for this, a seminar of some sort.

Katsuki prides himself as someone who gives good gifts. Many individuals wanted him to be their Secret Santa during Christmas parties when he was still studying because *one,* he had good taste – he follows what’s written on their wish list. And *two,* he’s rich so he can basically afford anything. Well, back then his parents would give him money for it but that doesn’t make that much of a difference. Even now he can probably afford anything with his salary and all.

There is only one problem.

“WHY IS IT SOLD OUT EVERYWHERE – “

It’s because it’s the holiday season and all. People usually buy gifts a week or two before said event.

The thing he wants to give is either not available or would take too long to arrive. Christmas is in three days goddamit. He really doesn’t have time for this. There are a few good things on various websites but he feels like Deku wouldn’t like them or they’re just too fucking basic. It’s their long-awaited meeting; this guy doesn’t visit Tokyo often and *ARGHHHHHHHHH* –

FUCK.

Maybe he should just get up and go to a mall and look for something by himself.

Nn, let’s do that. They might have something on hand that fits the bill –

“Eh? But malls close at ten pm, don’t they?”

FUCK.

Tomorrow morning then –

“Nn, don’t forget about our date tomorrow too,”

FUCK.

Katsuki wants to scream.

FUCCCCCCKKKKKKKKK –

“What’s wrong?”

Izuku asks all of a sudden and the blonde curses himself.

“Nothing,” he was definitely distracted on what to give Izuku – not that he was willing to admit that. He’s been thinking about it constantly since last night and has failed to come up with an appropriate solution. “I was just distracted by something,“ green eyes owlishly blink at his reply, a bit puzzled.

“Did Kacchan want that?”

Pointing towards the claw machine where a bunch of big Shiba plush toys were. He must have seen Katsuki look at them for a while and thought that he wanted one or something.

“Hah – “

“I’ll get it for you,” not even waiting for an answer, immediately inserting four tokens into the machine. Katsuki dumbfoundedly watches everything unfold in front of his eyes, the officer moving around the box to check different angles. “I’m good when it comes to things like this.”

He’s forgotten why they were in an arcade in the first place – *Ah.*

They were walking around town and stumbled into one, right.

“You don’t have to, shitty Deku,” grabbing the other’s arm in an attempt to stop him. He doesn’t even want it in the first place; he was just staring at it! “Come on, let’s just go – “ and the machine makes this happy-go-lucky sound as the claw descends, Izuku looking back and his face brightening when it looks like it’s about to succeed.

They spend the next twelve seconds looking at it before the prize plops down.

“I got it!” and he’s snapped out of his daze when Izuku’s all but bending down to get it. “I told you I was good at it!”

Katsuki frowns, the toy in his arms feeling foreign, “I’m not twelve. I don’t need this.”

What the fuck is this softness!?

It’s quite a big one as well, about the same length as his arm – no wonder this required four tokens!

“Ohh… Did I have the wrong idea then?”

Katsuki’s expression morphs into a grimace and he groans when he sees the look on Izuku’s face.

Well… I guess it’s a bit cute.

That was embarrassing though.

Izuku just smiles; contented when he sees the streamer ever so slightly pouting and looking at his

prize.

“Shiba-chan looks a bit like you, Kacchan,”

“Hah? Who the fuck is Shiba-chan?” Katsuki exclaims, not taking his eyes off the road.

“This little guy,” Izuku holds up the plush toy that’s been sitting on his lap for the entire ride. “You two have the same color scheme and all.”

The streamer is confused because, “Shiba Inus are not blonde, dumbass!”

“Bubble tea!? IN FUCKING WINTER?”

“Come on, let’s go try it Kacchan!”

Katsuki taps his fingers on the table as he sits around waiting for Izuku to return.

He ended up giving in to the bubble tea request.

Ping!

Eighteen unread messages from Sedun Dnes.

The blonde frowns because he remembers that cursed group chat. Those guys really have the gall to text Deku while he’s in the middle of something. Well, not that it’s prohibited or anything but he knows that it’s definitely them asking for updates. They’re being sneaky behind his back again. At least Izuku hasn’t responded to them yet – if the number of messages is of any indication. Those guys – *Mina most especially* – are probably getting impatient right now because he deliberately ignores their group chat as well.

They don’t get any information, *hah.*

It kind of makes him feel smug or something.

He looks at the device on the table, waiting to see if another notification would pop up but what he notices instead is the wallpaper.

“Kacchan here – “

Izuku immediately turns red, Katsuki looking up at him with a grin.

“Ghnn…” he places their drinks on the table. “Your fans are extremely talented, okay?”

Katsuki feels a bit accomplished when he sees that look on the other's face.

"Let's ask someone to take it for us next time,"

"Yummycat?"

"Yeah, let's ask Shinsou-ku –" Izuku pauses, narrowing his eyes at the streamer. "I was expecting Kacchan to say Ashido-san or one of team UA," why *his* friends? It's not like –

"Obviously it'll be my turn to visit you next,"

It's just right, correct?

"Since you came here this time and all… It would be better to take turns,"

Izuku tries to hold back a smile but ultimately fails, "Nn, Kacchan can visit me next."

"You haven't confessed and you think you're allowed to kiss me?"

He has his palm pressed against Izuku's lips, grinning and all.

"You're contradicting yourself, Deku," the taller male slightly groans, sighing before he opts for a hug.

Katsuki can help but grin; pleased that he has the upper hand for once.

Red eyes stare at the ceiling, unable to sleep.

Who said that it was a fucking good idea to stay over!?

Well, they both agreed on that but now that he thinks about it again it's such a bad idea. I mean… there's just the two of them! And it's a hotel! The bath is big as hell and… and… Have you seen the guy he's staying with? It seemed like such a good idea yesterday but yup, he's regretting it now. It doesn't help how Izuku's sleeping in a motherfucking robe – *the garment slightly slipping on the front area* – because he forgot to pack his pajamas.

Yeah, he should've expected that.

Or maybe he's doing it on purpose; Katsuki doesn't know anything at this point.

Fuck.

And Izuku's clinging unto him. It's too hot, both the person and the room.

Where's the goddamn remote for the AC!?

"Kacchan?" the officer wakes up when he hears rustling, Katsuki standing near the vanity table with a small remote in one hand. A lamp is dimly on, the streamer having figured that he wouldn't be able to find it without light. He didn't want to wake Deku up as well so he figured that this was an alternative. It seems like he was wrong. "It's cold Kacchaaaaan," the officer complains, slightly sitting up on the bed.

Katsuki gulps because *fuck, who's the cute one when sleepy now?*

It's making things worse. Bakugo Katsuki stop thinking about that!

Beep! Beep! Beep!

Turn that AC down a lot!

"Kacchan it's winter," yeah outside but not in this room. "It's cold. I'm freezing to death."

And I'm overheating over here so shut up, shitty Deku.

There's a small argument, the two of them bickering back and forth before they compromise. The room's more on the colder side nevertheless because Katsuki's holding the remote, not the other way around. He was being generous with that conversation. He turns the lamp off, returning back to bed and Izuku plops down the same time as he does.

"Are you uncomfortable?"

"Stop asking me that. I'm not,"

So considerate, geez.

Izuku hums, silently nodding before he says, "Nn… I'm glad."

And Katsuki's heart squeezes again, the same feeling he feels when the other looks and smiles at him for absolutely no reason.

"Good night again, Kacchan,"

"Good night, Deku,"

He'll deal with this in the morning.

It's *worse.*

Katsuki is sitting on the bed, staring as Izuku changes his clothes.

He gets a good glimpse of that bare chest, all those marks and scars as well.

"No kissing before I confess,"

He just remains silent for a moment before groans, plopping back down on the mattress.

God fucking dammit.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) TPO - time, place and occasion.
(1) Shiba Inu - a type of dog breed.

okay, okay, OKAY I'M WORKING ON IT -
there will be some sort of action in the next chapter! i swear!
this fic will finally live up to that m rating.
*i'm not sure if it will be full on smut... *gulps*... please give me 2 more chapters to build this up.*
it's been 9999 years since they've done anything and 27 years since i've written smut.
all because of this slowburn (yes blame the slowburn). i'm getting rusty now.

showing, not telling love

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

There's one thing Katsuki had discovered about Midoriya Izuku.

This guy has a savior complex.

He feels the need to help every lost child there is and it doesn't matter if they're in the middle of their date or not. He feels this responsibility to lend a hand and the blonde wonders if he does it out of obligation as an officer or if he's naturally good-willed. It's probably both. It's the same guy who got his arm broken because he fought a criminal who was trying to hold children hostage. Helping a lost brat is rather mild than that, so Katsuki just grumbles as he leads them to the nearest desk in Tokyo Sea Life Park.

"Keep a better eye on your sister, geez!"

He wouldn't be saying that if he was talking to a parent but it was a teenager so yeah… that's fine.

Izuku awkwardly laughs at his companion before he owlishly blinks, noticing the young girl staring up at him. The officer's demeanor then softens and he bends down, gently patting her head.

"Try not to lose your nii-san next time,"

"H-Hai – "

A smile that makes both the girl and Katsuki's heart squeeze.

Nn, men who are good with kids are different.

Katsuki's really not good with children. It took him quite a while to gain affection points from Eri and Kota. He wasn't mistreating them but yeah… It's a bit hard to deal with – individuals below twelve, he means. It's more so a personal problem for him. He doesn't like lowering his mental age and pretending to be nice. Eri and Kota seem to be the only individuals below twelve who understand that.

"You too," Izuku turns to him when the pair walks away, "Thank you for being patient, Kacchan."

Katsuki grimaces; a bit torn on how to react when the officer pats his head.

It feels like he's being treated like a child but at the same time he likes being given attention.

Wow, such a big dilemma…

"Let's go back?"

Again with the hand holding!

"Doesn't he like holding my hand a bit too much?" a question he's been thinking these past two days. He also likes it so he doesn't complain but Midoriya Izuku is really brazen and thick-skinned. People are staring, you know! *"Whatever,"* before he gives up, deciding to just go with it.

"Aren't you going in the wrong direction?"

“Ehh? Ahh… Really? Sorry – “

Izuku has a grin on his face.

“Edible,” Katsuki lists, his eyes following the fish that swim in front of them. “Edible, edible, not edible.”

“Oh?” the officer curiously asks, bumping their shoulders together. “Sunfish is also edible?”

He’s glad that the streamer has gotten used to him already, comfortable enough to drag him around and bring him to places he wants to see. Izuku might make plans and all but ultimately, the goal is to please the other. He’d prepare it just in case but prefers if Katsuki sounds out the things that he likes and dislikes. Perhaps Izuku is a people pleaser in a way. He’s always been like that, more so towards this person. All he wants to do is stack good impressions.

As for his own preferences well… he’s never thought of that.

Anything is fine as long as it’s with Kacchan, I think.

“Yeah they eat it raw and stuff,” the sunfish he means. “It’s an endangered species though so that’s not allowed anymore. Not surprising since it’s a fucking stupid animal.”

“Stupid?”

“Yeah, it’s so fucking useless. It’s a complete failure of evolution,” Izuku can’t help but laugh because *you know an awful lot about them, Kacchan.* It’s a bit surprising to be honest – in a good way of course. Adorable even. “Imagine being more than two thousand kilos and only being able to swim sideways. They basically just drift. Like a fucking dinner plate in the ocean or something.”

What makes it funnier is that Katsuki sounds a bit angry, said fish in the enclosure in front of them.

“Everything they eat basically has zero nutritional value. They don’t have goddamn teeth and hardly any animal uses them as a food source. They’re so fucking useless – “

And at this point Izuku just *laughs,* on the verge of falling over.

Apparently, it’s something Katsuki learned while scouring the internet. It’s one of those times he clicks a random link out of curiosity and ends up reading those weird articles about the North Pole or something. Perhaps *rabbit hole* would be a more familiar term. He finds those quite frequently because of his fan base.

“Mou –” Izuku complains, wiping the tears off his eyes. “You made me want fish for dinner, Kacchan.”

Would that be weird? Since going to the aquarium means that they’re supposed to appreciate marine life and all.

Katsuki doesn’t seem to mind because, “I know a good sushi place.”

There are quite a lot in Tokyo. It’s one of the perks of being friends with socially active influencers.

“Nn,” Izuku nods, laughter bubbling up in his chest again. “Let’s go get sushi.”

“So you became an officer because you wanted to help people?” Katsuki has seen it coming, really. It’s only been two days but he can tell that this individual is a genuinely good person. Perhaps the kindest he’s ever met. He *knows*. “That’s such a bland answer. Very normal,” and cliché but see? Izuku’s not even mad that his career and dream are being ridiculed. That’s some saint-like patience right there.

Ridicule is also such a bad term. Perhaps *tease* is more appropriate.

He noticed how most people who wanted to become an officer wanted to save others, but not many are brave to act during moments that count. Izuku is not one of those people; he’s real and honest in a way – a very trustworthy person. Somewhat like a hero.

“It’s something that I want to do, Kacchan,” he just shrugs his shoulders and laughs. “My mother is a lawyer so perhaps she influenced me somehow,” Katsuki remembers talking to her a few times before when they were still teens. He called her *auntie* and he recalls her having the same demeanor as her son – soft-spoken and gentle, her voice soothing even through the mic. Perhaps it runs in the family or something.

Maybe the Midoriyas are secretly angels, I dunno.

“I’ll introduce you next time, Kacchan,”

“Hah!?” and he almost fucking chokes on his food. *“STOP TEASING GODDAMIT!”*

He listens as Izuku explains his course, how most cops don’t need to go to university to become police officers. It’s usually just one year of police school and two years of specialized training – a total of three years, and then an exam to get a license. Izuku took a special curriculum so it’s much longer but it does give the same results.

The only difference is he gets more credit, knowledge, and maybe a higher rank when he gets hired. It’s basically a course leading to a Master of Law degree as well if he chooses to proceed.

One day maybe…

“And Kacchan?”

Katsuki doesn’t even turn to look, knowing that Izuku will continue his sentence soon anyway.

“Why did you want to become a streamer?”

Ahh… It feels a bit embarrassing to say it after Izuku said his part somehow.

“They gave me an offer so I just went on with it,” he was waiting around, true, but Deku never played a part in what he wanted to be in life. Back then he decided that he wouldn’t let anything or anyone influence how he lived, *never*. Sounds a bit angsty but it really isn’t that deep. “I like it,” and he thinks that it should be a reason good enough for anyone. It would very exhausting to do an occupation that you don’t love and it shouldn’t be that way.

Izuku can’t help but smile, “That’s very cool. Kind of like following your dreams?”

“Hah!? It’s not that cheezy, geez…”

Katsuki frowns, staring down at his plate and contemplating for a moment.

“Wait – I know what you’re thinking. Being a streamer only works well if you’re young and I fucking know that so I’ve been saving up a shit ton of money. I have more than enough to last for the next ten goddamn years – “

Oddly enough, Katsuki is also very realistic.

“What I’m trying to say is that I’m stable,” proceeding to make as much eye contact as possible. “I’m fucking stable, Midoriya Izuku.”

Izuku grins, realizing what the other is trying to imply, “Oh? Good job Kacchan.”

The blonde’s face morphs into something that resembles irritation before he lightly punches the officer’s arm.

Dammit!

It happens again.

He took a bath first to avoid this very situation but waiting around is very nerve-wracking – *wait*. Coming out second after taking a bath is *worse*. He can already imagine Izuku sitting on the bed, the two of them making eye contact before *oh?* HELL NO. It’s like he’s impatient but at the same time, he’s not? At least he can control his reaction this way, keep his eyes focused on the television or something because he already stayed up so late last night and –

“Kacchan,”

Here comes Izuku with droplets of water dripping down his hair, the robe he’s wearing slipping ever so slightly on the front area. Katsuki gets a good view of his chest from where he’s sitting, defined muscles in full display, and fuck he’s seen that scar before. What would it take for him to trace his fingers and – *no, no, nononono.* Don’t fall for it, Bakugo Katsuki! This also happened yesterday!

Shitty Deku is doing it on purpose!

“Kacchan, help me dry my hair,” the blonde growls like a Pomeranian when the larger male sits down beside him, slightly leaning in. When a few seconds pass and he doesn’t reply, Izuku tries again calling, “Kacchan…”

Don’t look, don’t look, don’t look –

He’s probably using his face again or something.

“Is that a no?”

Fucking hell.

Katsuki ends up sitting up on his knees behind the other, grumpily complying with said request.

It feels like he's drying a big dog or something. Deku's hair is just as soft as it looks and he'd never admit it out loud but he kind of wants to run his hands through it or something. He won't though because that's blatantly obvious and there's no way the other isn't going to notice. Speaking of notice, his eyes have been focused on those specks littered on the officer's skin. Freckles are peaking through the collar of his robe and Katsuki has this urge to pull it down to see or something.

He doubts Izuku would get mad but yeah… he's not going to do that.

"Are you done already?"

Izuku tilts his head back, red meeting green.

Katsuki frowns, pinching Deku's nose before he sits down, tossing the towel on the larger male's lap.

"Thanks Kacchan…"

"Sure,"

That wasn't as bad as he thought it would be.

Izuku is *upset.*

He's been trying his best to seduce Katsuki, you see.

It's not his forte but he really is trying. He's been wearing that robe for the past two nights and that's a very big effort on his behalf because he can't stand the AC. He's been complaining about it since the first day and all of a sudden he's sleeping half-naked? Katsuki is not dense. Izuku knows that so he's definitely noticed that something's been going on for a while now. There's *that no confession, no kiss rule* and he wants to be respectful but nn…

Even he is at his limit.

On second thought maybe he should just – *no.*

You've come all the way from Fukuoka, Izuku! You decided on Christmas Eve!

Now, he did consider how cheesy it would be but it's the only event where he can give Katsuki a present without seeming too pushy. It's a strategy in a way. It's better to offer something all the while confessing, it's more effective – or at least that's what Mina said. Also, they'll be spending Christmas together so why not? It'll be a good excuse! Kinda… He wonders why he's so nervous though.

It's not like he's proposing or something.

“What time was your reservation?” Katsuki asks, already sitting up and going through his phone.

Izuku groans, groggily replying *five* before he wraps his arms around the blonde’s waist.

No complaints. I guess it’s allowed.

He then freezes when he feels those fingers run through his hair, realizing *ahh* –

“Don’t stop, keep going Kacchan,” since the other seemed to hesitate and pull back when he froze. “I like it,” he mumbles, snuggling a bit closer. Wearing a robe is really not for him – he’s cold. At least he has that thick blanket and Katsuki to make up for lost heat.

“We were supposed to get breakfast together, get up,”

Ah right, Katsuki said that he knew a good place.

Still though…

“Just a little bit more,” he tries to negotiate, not bothering to open his eyes. “Breakfast can wait.”

Ping!

Sedun Dnes:

>> **Mina:** It’s tonight right?? Send update!
>> **Kirishima:** GOOD LUCK BRO
>> **Kaminari:** Why are we even worrying? We know Baku’s gonna say yes!
>> **Sero:** Tell us how it goes after!

The officer awkwardly laughs.

Like I said, it’s really not a proposal…

Izuku is *nervous.*

He knows he has to confess, knows that Katsuki deserves it and is planning to, but it really is nerve-inducing. It feels like he’s in high school or something. He’s never done something like this before. Admittedly, he’s been interested in other people when he was younger but it was never this bad – never this stressful and frightening. As Kaminari said, they all know that Katsuki was going to say yes so what was he being tense for?

Again, this is not a proposal. He’s just confessing.

Even the other was impatient and declared that he was waiting for it.

Geez… He’s really going to go crazy with worry at this point.

“You’re going to say it tonight, right?”

See? Even Katsuki’s like this.

Izuku whimpers when the other squeezes both of his cheeks, soft hands playing with his face. It kind of hurts but he’s not going to complain. It wakes him up a bit and makes him less anxious. Katsuki definitely thinks he’s this cool, tough figure so hopefully, it doesn’t show up on his face too much. Or maybe it already is… He can’t tell.

“Nn, I’ll say it tonight Kacchan…. Sorry for making you wait,”

Why are they even talking about this beforehand!?

Also… *why are you grinning!?*

Please don’t… Izuku feels like he’s about to cry or something.

His feelings… how does he say it? It’s a bit difficult to explain.

Although they never really said it to each other, I think they both already knew.

Confessing is just for formality in a way.

It’s important but at the same time, it’s not really necessary because this was not going to end. Not now. Not *ever.* Then again, he really should just take this chance. It’s better than saying it over the phone. Izuku knows that both their patience is running thin and he’s just dragging it out at this point so now…

Better do it now.

How do you even convey how you feel using words?

What he’s feeling is a bit too extreme, geez.

Are words even needed? It probably is.

“I’ll make up for it,” Izuku says, grasping both of Katsuki’s wrists. “The eight years I was gone, I mean.”

Katsuki just grins because, “You better fucking do, dumbass.”

Scrolling up –

Ground Zero:

> >> are u mad or something deku?
> >> where are you
> >> i thought we were going to the festival together

To make up for those messages you sent, at least.

>> Your husband *King Explosion Murder* changed his name to *Ground Zero*
>> i'm joining team ua today

Just a little bit more, Kacchan.

"Oi,"

Izuku snaps out of his daze, staring at Katsuki's figure in front of him.

The other had his hands tucked inside his coat, scarf keeping his neck warm. It's just five in the afternoon but the sky is already dim, clouded with snowfall. Izuku on the other hand felt oddly warm. Katsuki was right there, in front of him, his eyes ringed with gold – drop dead gorgeous. Even under the cold weather the man was alluring. Like wildfire, or a storm – red like summer.

Izuku couldn't help but stare.

How does he say it?

He can't even explain how good it feels to look up across a room and see Katsuki standing there.

How do I say it?

"Are you going to just stand there and gawk?" the blonde looks unimpressed, scowling per usual.

"Ah… Nn… Sorry," the officer mumbles, catching up to the other, "I got distracted."

Katsuki grimaces saying, "Stop it. You look stupid."

"Sorry Kacchan," Izuku awkwardly smiles, clumsily trying to cover up his blunder.

He then takes the other's hand, the two of them walking down the street.

"Are you sure we aren't late, Deku?"

You can do it, Midoriya Izuku!

"Nn! Even if we are, they said that they don't mind as long as we show up for the night,"

You can do it!

Katsuki frowns unimpressed because, "You reserved it so show up on time, dumbass!"

Izuku just laughs, swinging their intertwined fingers back and forth.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Sunfish - inspired by that one facebook rant i read years ago. this one guy made a post explaining why he hates mola mola so much. there are various articles about it but i can't find the actual post he did.
(2) Inspired - speaking of inspired, the plot last chapter was given by popular twitter kiddos. thank you for manifesting. it was cute. shiba chan will be re-appearing soon.

anyway, we're done with thirty-six. no smut again, i failed to keep my word.
i hope izuku's sincerity was conveyed nevertheless. ima go trigger myself with love songs now.
i have to write a long confession essay by yours truly, midoriya izuku.

relationship status unlocked!

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

There was something that Mina told Izuku that stood out.

Do not tell him during dinner!

The boys complained in the group chat that time, Kaminari most especially because *ehh, isn't that supposed to be good? That's the best time to confess!* They were all under the impression that confessing during dinner would be the perfect moment but no, Mina-sensei had to explain TPO in a very elaborate manner. Apparently, confessing during dinner can come off as a little bit too much. It's too formal and too proper. Also, it wasn't a fancy five-star hotel slash restaurant! It was quite expensive but it wasn't on the *you can tell your loved one your feelings now* range.

This is just a confession, not a proposal!

I mean… wouldn't it be better to say it in a more casual manner?

Nn… so difficult.

The more Mina spoke, the more they got convinced. Oddly enough it made a lot of sense because the team captain would probably agree that confessing in such a place is a bit too strange and heavy. Also, probably cringey or sappy – somewhere along those lines.

It seemed like a bad idea but *huh?* Katsuki seems a bit pissed off now.

"Here's your card, sir,"

"Ahh – thank you,"

He keeps scowling – *almost pouting* – as they make their way out of the restaurant and unto the streets of Ginza. Izuku kind of regrets not confessing now because clearly Katsuki had been waiting for it, obvious by the expression he's currently showing. The officer also noticed the frequent glances, the other impatiently tapping his foot on the floor, and his silence as they ate dinner.

Sorry Kacchan!

Ghkk – Restaurants are reserved for proposals!

Izuku reflects on himself, tightly squeezing the blonde's hand.

Isn't this too nerve-wracking!?

Hopefully his hand is not sweating or anything. It's winter so it should be fine but his body feels way too hot all of a sudden. It feels like everything's happening way too quickly but at the same time, it isn't. Maybe he should just say it before he leaves tomorrow – *no, no, no!*

It has to be *today!*

He hopes that Katsuki doesn't tease his confession too much. He can already see it coming though; getting bullied because he took so long. Well, it's definitely his fault but still – *ah.* He doesn't need to defend himself during moments like these. He needs to admit that he's slower than a turtle so

that he can reflect on it and maybe next time something as important comes up he can –

Katsuki glances in his direction, glaring almost. He still has that scowl on his lips – unimpressed and a bit upset. Kind of like a small puppy or something… Like shiba-chan, maybe. They walk down the road, slightly past the main street and Izuku doesn't even know where they're going at this point. He just lets himself get dragged, contemplating and contemplating.

Nn, I have the gift in my coat right now. I'll just say it later when we get to the car.

They go past the plaza wIzuku owlishly blinking and only looking up from his feet when they reach the bay area.

"Huh!?" completely surprised and taken aback. "What's this place, Kacchan!?" as he rushes towards the railing, amazed by the view. The buildings and skyscrapers illuminate off the water and far off into the distance there are boats.

The weather's a bit cold but the snow has stopped for a while now and –

"It's pretty!"

All Katsuki can see when he turns around is that big smile on his face, hair tousled because of the wind.

"It's very pretty, Kacchan!"

And his heart starts to race again.

Katsuki has been waiting since this morning.

He's been nervously sitting around in that hotel room as the other took a shower, pretending like he's not bothered by anything as they went out and ate breakfast. They dropped by a few places – since it's Christmas and all, but the rest of the day is a blur because all he could think of is that confession… That goddamn confession that didn't come even after they finished eating dinner. What adds more frustration is that this guy doesn't seem all that bothered.

He keeps talking and talking like nothing's amiss and Katsuki's *frustrated.*

Ba-thump. Ba-thump.

Fuck it all.

The night is about to end.

"Deku, come here,"

"Ehh? The wind is nice over here, Kacchan!"

See? He looks relaxed, smiling and all.

"Come here,"

Perhaps it was his tone but Izuku's expression immediately changes asking, "Why?"

"Just come here," was it showing up on his face? Maybe, "I said come here."

The officer nervously gulps because, "No, you're mad."

Ah, so he does get it.

"Kacchan, why are you – *wait.* I know why you're mad. It's because I haven't said anything, right? You're probably thinking that I'm a coward and all of that. I'll say it now so wait a sec – *Ack* – which pocket did I put it in again – "

Still rambling on and on like a goddamn loser so Katsuki decides to take matters into his own hands cutting down the chase, saying, "I like you."

And Izuku pauses, wide eyes staring at Katsuki.

"I like you," he repeats, noticing how the other slightly gulps, both hands falling to his sides. "I like you."

"Wait – "

"I like you – "

"Kacchan, wait!" the officer's face is flushed; his eyes watery and lashes slightly damp. He has this expression on his face like he's about to cry, completely torn and troubled over something. "Wasn't I supposed to be the one to say it!? Kacchan you didn't have to, I'm sorry you – "

"Stop… Just stop," and now he can hear sniffling. Why is this guy so embarrassing, geez. "How much courage do you think it took me to say that!?" he crosses his arms in front of his chest.

You know how difficult it is, don't you?

"Nn," Izuku nods, lips pressed into a thin line. "Still, it was supposed to be my turn to –"

"You were taking too goddamn long,"

"Ah yes. I'm sorry – "

And Izuku nervously heads over to comfort the other, noticing the expression on his face.

"Even though you said that you couldn't wait over the phone…"

A slightly muffled voice, arms tightly wrapped around his figure.

"You were taking too goddamn long!"

Katsuki finds himself pressed against the other's chest again, hands tightly gripping Izuku's coat.

Midoriya Izuku is convinced that he is a loser.

No, he's not even a loser. He's *scum,* the lowest of the low.

He's the dust – no, the dirt on the ground and he doesn't deserve to thread upon this world.

This is what you get for hesitating,

What's worse is that is although he feels bad he also feels good because *ahhh Kacchan confessed to me.*

Stop that! Look at his face, you filth!

The officer gulps, gently cupping Katsuki's face and making eye contact. Although the blonde looks upset his face is a bit flushed, the slightest pout marring his lips. Izuku has this urge to smile but he doesn't because that'll just put the streamer into a worse mood. Also, he already feels guilty enough. Comforting the other would be the best choice in this event.

"I'm stupid,"

"We've already established that,"

"I'm indecisive and thick-headed,"

"As if that's anything new,"

Izuku smiles, brushing his thumb against Katsuki's cheeks.

He then leans in ever so slightly, closing the distance between the two of them.

"Nn, I'm sorry,"

Foreheads pressed together.

The first kiss is nothing more than a short brush of lips. When they part they're close, *so close* that they're pressed against each other's mouths – not that it matters anymore. No one is saying anything and Izuku notices how Katsuki's looking at the ground but not complaining so he does it again once, twice, *thrice.* Soft and chase, gentle enough so that he can be pushed back and denied if needed.

When nothing of the sort comes, Izuku fondly smiles against Katsuki's lips.

"You beat me into it but I was waiting because – " the glare he receives makes him awkwardly laugh. He's being kissed again so he hums, reciprocating for a few seconds before he speaks again, "Let me talk for a bit, Kacchan – " But it's useless because he's drawn in and he lets Katsuki do whatever he wants for a while, comfortably wrapping his arms around the other's waist.

"I really wasn't making an excuse," Izuku says, about to let go for a moment before he receives another look. *Ah, not allowed to huh.* "Left pocket, Kacchan – " in his coat, the one he's been looking for earlier. "I was planning on saying it when we reach the car," he rests his chin against the other's head; letting those hands fumble through said garment. "But I guess it couldn't wait."

Katsuki opens his mouth once, twice *before* he asks, "What is it?"

As if that would make the other spill the contents.

It's a red box that's neatly wrapped, a white ribbon tied around and decorated on top.

"Open it up and see,"

So he does and in the background Izuku is explaining, saying, “I was troubled on what to give Kacchan at first but as I was thinking of a gift I figured that it has to be this. I asked the lady at the store to wrap it up and – ” He then goes on to list a description on how it wasn’t that expensive and how Kacchan can probably afford it but – “Well…Uhh… How do I say this? Our relationship… The timing is a bit messed up – “

Meeting, letting go, and then meeting each other again…

Katsuki just continues to undo the ribbon and wrapping, silently listening to the other speak.

“ – it’s the one thing we have in common and it’s more of my problem but – “

Being too slow, being too fast, never meeting each other in between…

“With this I hope I’ll be on the same time Kacchan is. Even if I’m far away in Fukuoka or you’re in Tokyo – anywhere,”

Katsuki notices the logo, taking off the cover before his eyes land on the wristwatch neatly kept in the box. He feels his breath stop because *have you ever craved someone so much that you literally fucking ache?* That’s what it feels like, honestly.

“And uhh… The color slightly different but it’s the same kind as the one I’m wearing,” Izuku flushes, hiding his face against Katsuki’s neck. “It’s a pair watch… It’s a bit embarrassing to say, Kacchan.”

The blonde can feel the spot next to his ear heat up, most likely from the other blushing.

“I don’t have good fashion sense so I asked Todoroki-kun to help me. We spent more than an hour at the store,”

“At Osaka?”

“Nn… I only had one day at Fukuoka remember?”

Because he had to board his flight the day after…

“Well?” Izuku peeks, trying to see what Katsuki’s reaction is. “Kacchan?”

“Isn’t this brand expensive?”

“It’s more on the high-end side but you can afford something more expensive right – “

“I like it,” he says, watching the hand tick, grinning before he hugs Izuku tighter. “I like it, shitty Deku!”

And their feet intertwine, the officer catching the both of them so that they don’t fall.

Izuku sighs out of relief before he presses a kiss against Katsuki’s cheek all the while saying,

“Nn, I’m glad you do, Kacchan.”

They remain in that position for a while.

“And I didn’t say it earlier but I like you too, Kacchan,”

Izuku says, humming against Katsuki’s lips.

“I like you so much…”

Another one – tilting his head to the side, kissing him a little bit deeper this time.

“By the way, how did you manage to keep this box in your coat?”

“I don’t know,” Izuku laughs, swinging their hands back and forth. “It fit and well… It’s more convenient to put it in my pocket rather than holding it, right?”

Katsuki narrows his eyes at the other’s coat.

The door behind them shuts close.

“What!?” Katsuki exclaims, noticing how the other turned red when he pressed his lips against his jaw. “Am I not supposed to kiss you there or some shit!?” he’s just a bit flustered. The officer hasn’t said anything about it either. Rather than that, the response itself is quite positive. Katsuki himself should know that he could get away with anything he likes at this point.

It’s blatantly obvious, isn’t it?

“No,” Izuku replies with a small smile, “Feel free to grab me and kiss me whenever you want, Kacchan.”

And Katsuki just grimaces against those lips, a bit too embarrassed for his own liking.

“Fuck –“ he mumbles, struggling to catch his breath when his back meets the mattress. “Careful with the coat, Deku. My present – “

Another kiss to cut him off, the other slightly whimpering when he bites his lip to retaliate for not listening.

“My present,” Katsuki frowns and Izuku pouts. “You’ll ruin my present.”

I guess the present is more important…

“Sorry,”

Izuku apologizes, taking off his coat to comply. He was the one who kept it since it couldn’t possibly fit in Katsuki’s fashion-forward coat. Slowly undressing his outer layer, Izuku remains oblivious to the blonde eyeing him. With a position as provocative as the one they’re currently in it

really couldn't be helped.

He places the box on the bedside table and not even a split second later he gets grabbed by the collar, pulled in for a lip lock. In the midst of it all, green eyes peer slightly open because *ahh… Kacchan put his tongue in. Cute.* There's this urge to tease him about it but that would be mean. He doesn't want to risk getting scolded right now. *Maybe next time,* he tells himself. *Kacchan really likes kissing.*

Look, even that face he's making just because Izuku leaned back and pulled off.

Slightly panting and all…

"Hah… What am I supposed to do when you're this cute, Kacchan?"

There's no complaint even when he trails both his hands under that shirt, slowly caressing until everything's exposed. All he gets is the other glaring at him, red-faced and ever so slightly shivering under his touch. Izuku unconsciously gulps at the sight, scarred fingers dangerously close to fondling Katsuki's chest.

"Kacchan?" and the blonde forces his eyes closed. "Kacchan? Are you alright?"

He's so red…

"I fucking told you before," Katsuki's eyelashes are slightly damp. "I said I wasn't going to do anything…"

And Izuku's breath hitches, brain somewhat circuiting.

No way…

I'm just gonna sit still and let you do all the work, he was referring to *that* time!?

Ahhhhhhhhhh –

Izuku is starting to sweat, geez. This is unfair… This is *so, so, so* unfair.

Someone… Someone *please* grant him patience.

"Is it too much?" is what he asks, fighting the urge to just lean over and use his mouth. The blonde's hands are empty, the sheets not enough so when he reaches for Shiba-chan as support Izuku feels his heart squeeze. *Ahhhh cute.* "Don't cover your face…" he asks and the other complies ever so slightly, squirming when those hands start to rub down and pinch, Izuku leaning over to kiss.

"Tell me if you want to stop, Kacchan," foreheads pressed together.

And Katsuki just glares through teary eyes because, "Hah!? No you fucking won't."

Izuku impatiently groans, not bothering to complain when he gets grabbed by the collar again because,

"Finish what you started, shitty Deku!"

He can't say no to that, can he?

Scrolling up –

Ground Zero:

>> i like you
>> i’m sorry if i made you mad
>> it’s not as fun now
>> come back shitty deku

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Ginza - popular district in tokyo.
(2) Gift - katsuki will give his gift in the future chapters.
(3) Wrist Watch - i couldn't resist. forgive me because it's not a ring.
(4) Coat - can a box fit in a coat? i tried, yes... but it depends on the size.
what is this author trying to say? i also don't know.

anyway, it's going to be quite descriptive in the next chap.
those who are here for the fluff can skip and you don't hafta read it. the update may take a while tho... i don't know.
i think i'll get distracted by genshin again. i keep getting distracted.
also, say goodbye to izuku. he has to go back to fukuoka.

anyway, go listen to mr. loverman by ricky montgomery.
it's the artist that inspired this chap. made me write faster
thanks to emi/nana (?) who was it that suggested that song (?)
even i am confused.

no such thing as goodbye

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Izuku is a people pleaser and that applies even in bed.

He's the type to pin his lover down, letting his mouth do all the work as he slowly, ever so slowly unravels what's in front of him. The type to peer through dark lashes looking daunting and all but would actually listen to each and every request. He's careful and attentive, green eyes hazy with lust as he lets go with a plop, letting those thighs squeeze around his head. It doesn't bother him, not even the least. He knows that the other's doing it out of reflex anyway, it can't be helped.

"Try not to rub your legs together, Kacchan," as he opens his mouth, letting the pre-cum drip. They've been at it for quite a while now and the blonde's been speaking less. "Here – " substituting his tongue with his fingers, gently rubbing the slit until he has the other squirming and flinching, trailing kisses down the base. "I can't touch you properly in this position…"

That seems to do the trick because although Katsuki sends him a glare, he parts his legs ever so slightly.

Cute.

Izuku takes him in his mouth again, noticing how those hands extend to tug on his hair.

Cute.

"Deku, sta—*ah*— hkk—"

Cute.

The officer lightly hums as Katsuki spasms, releasing into his mouth. It's not as bad as he thought it would be but maybe he's biased. The other is grumbling, trying to push him off as he gulps down, opening his mouth to lick those long slim fingers.

"What the… hell?"

Is it really that strange, Kacchan?

Izuku slowly shifts unto his elbows to trail his lips on Katsuki's abdomen, chest, jaw – pausing on the juncture of his neck. There's a soft creak, the bed dipping under his knees. "Help me with this Kacchan," as he guides the blonde's hands towards his shirt, letting those fingers fumble through the buttons. There's a grumble and the officer notices how Katsuki's way too red, feverish almost.

Cute.

He likes it, is what he thinks when he leans back and Katsuki reaches over to touch his stomach. *Way too obvious,* but he can't really say anything because he also likes the current view. The officer expected this much but the destructive power is no joke. He himself is already threading on edge, patience running thin. Katsuki looks nice lying down in front of him like that – slick between his thighs and all.

They'll probably be fine with just that but still…

“It’s in my bag,” the lube he means. “It’s way across the room,” and then he sighs.

Katsuki frowns, squeezing shiba tighter because, “Aren’t you way too prepared for this?”

Nn… when you point it out like that it’s a bit embarrassing…

“Well… I would be lying if I said that I wasn’t expecting something…”

Izuku awkwardly smiles and Katsuki just huffs, looking off to the side in embarrassment, “Whatever.”

Nonchalant as ever, as expected of Kacchan…

He then makes a move to get off the bed, saying, “I won’t take too long. Please be patient for a bit – *eh?”* Katsuki’s legs wrap around his waist. “Kacchan?” *What is it? Did he not want him to leave or something?* This is making him nervous for some reason.

“There’s no need for that,” Izuku owlishly blinks, noticing the flushed face and small pout. “I prepared myself so…”

Hmm!?

The officer tilts his head to the side, confused.

Umm… Kacchan I think I just heard you say something extraordinary?

“You weren’t the only one expecting something to happen, shitty Deku…”

WAIT A SECOND –

In the midst of panicking, Izuku gets pulled in for a kiss.

He did it.

Izuku gulps, a low groan in the back of his throat. Every small, pleading noise from the other sets his skin on fire. It’s a bit unbelievable, really. He had expected Katsuki to be a bit reluctant about this but here he is – two fingers deep, faced with no complaints whatsoever. At this point, he’d probably be able to fit a third one because – *he really fucking did it.*

When did he even… *this morning or* – goddammit his mind is blue screening.

Izuku pushes Katsuki’s knee back to get a better view, sinking in until he’s buried up to his knuckles. He hears him let out soft moans, fingers rubbing against tight walls and stretching them out. *Ahh here it is,* when he sees him arch his back, covering his face. *He likes it here,* and not even a few moments later he gets scolded, only stopping when Katsuki tells him to stop because *I already came once you fucker.*

“Sorry,” he mumbles apologetically, pulling out. “I’ll make it up to you.”

Izuku softly smiles before he sits up on his knees.

Nn, should be good now.

He then starts to unbuckle his belt, zipping down his pants to undress.

Now that he thinks about it, the other has never seen him fully naked, has he?

Izuku's eyes drift up to meet Katsuki, only to see how flushed the other is.

He then hears him grumble a curse.

Katsuki is *prepared.*

He's been waiting around since April and has already thrown his pride out of the window. Normally, as a man, he doesn't want to be on the receiving end. It's only natural. He's never even fantasized about it – not until Deku, at least. There's the fact that he doesn't want to argue as well, just get this over with already. It's been established since their first session on-call so he's learned to accept it but still – isn't *that*… isn't that a bit *too much?*

"Ghhhk— ghnn…"

Tears stream down his face, the other holding him by the back of his knees. He can't help the spasms that run down his body, his dick leaking and twitching as Izuku slowly sinks in. *Relax, Kacchan,* is what he hears him say but he's already out of it, a complete puddle on the bed. *You're drooling how cute,* is another and all he can feel is *hot, hot, hot* – Deku's hands on his chest kneading and fondling. There's a bit of pain but he's way too overwhelmed, his legs easily parting when Izuku touches his skin.

"Does it… hurt?"

Katsuki blinks, peering through damp lashes to see the other flushed and sweating.

"Kacchan?" he looks like he's about to snap or something.

Good. At least I'm not the only one suffering.

It doesn't hurt that much since he already came once but –

"Hurry up…" one hand pressed against the abdomen right in front of him. Katsuki bites his lips when he feels the few remaining inches sink in, his legs losing strength. "Hahh…Nn –" Izuku gently rocking back and forth, flinching as he gets kissed and slowly fucked at the same time.

Too much, he thinks as he opens his mouth, barely able to reciprocate the kiss. *Too fucking much,* when one hand wraps around his exposed cock to jerk him off.

"Nn, you look like you're feeling good Kacchan…"

He's not even holding unto shiba at this point. His hands are wandering everywhere, extending out to Izuku but he's way too far – out of his reach, so he has no choice but to cling unto the sheets. It doesn't take long before a lewd slick sound fills the room, Izuku having emptied Katsuki's grasp so that he can lean closer with nothing in between them.

“Give it back – “ shiba he means, that guy’s been contributing a lot, you know. He can cover his face with it since this is much more embarrassing than he expected. “Deku – “ with no choice but to cling unto him, arms wrapped around the officer’s shoulders.

“Nn— ghnn.. ahh – *hah*—“

Katsuki can’t even move at this point. All he can do is lie down and take it, too dazed and overstimulated. He can’t rub his thighs together because of that hand touching him. His legs spread impossibly wide, one foot curling on the mattress with hips tilted up to give the other better access to fuck freely and as hard as he wished. Has he always been like this before? He tries to tell himself to keep it down but a few still manage to slip out.

“Fuck – “ he mewls against Izuku’s shoulder. “Fuh—ghhnn—“

It doesn’t hurt. Unlike earlier, heat had started to pool in the pit of his stomach and he’s starting to panic – wanting to say something but too fucked to even mumble coherent words. He’s getting praised over and over again but Katsuki can’t hear anything. Other than the feeling between his legs he has no idea what on earth is happening. His hands are wandering everywhere from Deku’s shoulders to his arms and even up to his chest.

“Don’t touch – “ he shakes his head, tears dripping down his face as he gets cut off by his own whine, Izuku’s hand playing with his cock. “Deku –“ no choice but to hold unto the sheets, body shifting up and down on the bed as the larger male picks up the pace. It’s a bit hard and rough, a rhythm that feels a bit too much and he’s nothing but a mess at this point.

He did say that he’d just lie down and let the other do everything but still…

After a while Katsuki starts to squirm, Izuku’s hands on his knees making sure that he keeps them wide open. He lets out a rather long incoherent complaint, walls tightening up and clamping down on the other – a warning that’s good enough because the officer manages to comprehend. All it takes is one hard thrust against his prostate and he’s spasming, arching his back as he lets out a slutty mewl because –

“Ghnn… Kacchan you came,” soft strokes on his inner thighs, the officer’s mouth trailing along his jaw and chin.

Fortunately Izuku’s considerate enough to slow down for now, raking his body with long hard thrusts, thick cock dragging against his walls and over that sweet, sensitive spot inside of him. Katsuki’s moans are effectively muffled by a kiss, his tongue being caressed. A moment later and he throws his head back in an attempt to catch his breath, still twitching from the aftermath.

“Are you alright, Kacchan?”

Katsuki tries to glare but it doesn’t work and the pout on his lips is quickly erased by another kiss.

“We ended up doing it more than once…”

The streamer is in a daze, staring at the ceiling with Izuku clinging to his side.

They ended up having sex not once, not twice – definitely multiple times. Katsuki was the first to

give in because surprising, *not surprising,* Izuku has unlimited stamina. He's athletic as well but people who work on the field are just *different.* He remembers them doing it in various positions – sitting up, from the back; until they both exhausted each other at least. There's this feeling that Izuku was being considerate as well and it pisses him off for some reason.

Next time I'll take the lead, is what he reminds himself, red-cheeked and all. *He won't know what'll hit him.*

Katsuki managed to get a few hours of sleep, maybe three or four before he woke up fully energized at five in the morning. It's winter so the sun is not even up and he's just sitting there in silence, the events earlier still slowly sinking in. Beside him the officer is peacefully sleeping, latching unto his hip like some sort of snail or something.

He then grimaces because *this guy is naked* and *I'm wearing his shirt, he gave me his fucking shirt.*

What kind of shoujo manga is this!? He's not a girl, you know!

It makes him feel warm and all but ultimately it's annoying!

He's so fucking handsome it's annoying!

Katsuki frowns, turning and gently pinching the officer's nose. He's aware that he shouldn't be doing this to a sleeping person but he feels a bit petty. Also, he's the one who got fucked so technically he's the one who is more exhausted. He's allowed this much at least. Izuku grimaces, thick lashes fluttering open before he lets out a groan, pulling the other close to his chest.

"Aren't you cold?" the streamer sighs, tugging the blanket higher. "Should've fucking worn something."

"Nn… But I didn't want to leave the bed," he nuzzles closer. "Go to sleep, Kacchan…"

Yeah, he probably should.

Still…

"What time are you leaving?" since it's the twenty-fifth now, the day Izuku's supposed to leave.

"After check out, Kacchan…" Izuku's tired, groggy response. "My train leaves at one-thirty," he could've chosen to leave in the evening but then he would've arrived late at Fukuoka. He had something to do on the twenty-sixth, you see. Some sort of task at the university that he needs to finish. "We can still have lunch together before I leave."

Katsuki grimaces, pinching the other's stomach, "Too soon."

The officer mumbles a short *ow* before he fondly laughs saying, "Next time I visit I'll stay longer."

Since Katsuki seems a bit upset about it.

"No, I'll visit next time," the blonde shakes his head, hugging back and looking up. "Since it's my turn next..."

"Oh?"

"I told you last time, didn't I?"

"Ahh… Yes you did," Izuku seems to be forgetting a lot of things nowadays. "Come by whenever

you're free, Kacchan," since he has an apartment of his own anyway. Technically, it would be less expensive since all they have to pay for are just tickets. He could've stayed at team UA's place during this week, but he didn't want to impose on the other members. "I'll give you a tour around Fukuoka," and then he hums, pressing a kiss against the other's cheek.

"I'll miss you," another kiss. "Stay safe and don't overwork yourself with streaming while I'm gone, okay?"

A pause.

"Like before, I'll try to call Kacchan as often as I can…"

Katsuki just remains silent, grimacing with his cheek squashed against the officer's bare chest.

As Izuku lines up to buy his ticket he notices something amiss.

"Uhh… Kacchan?"

Confused as to why the blonde is also here, right in front of him in the queue.

After they packed up and checked out the hotel they stopped by somewhere to eat lunch. After that Katsuki drove to the train station to drop him off – that was the expected agenda at least. There are no issue buying tickets on the actual date of departure because they're always available but uhh… Aren't non-passengers *not* allowed here? Izuku had already said his dramatic teary goodbye earlier only for the streamer to trail after him. Not answering questions as well.

"What!?" Katsuki asks with the usual snappy tone, looking back. "I can't buy a ticket or something?"

Well… it's not that you can't but…

"Ahh, no… Go ahead," still respectful as ever.

Katsuki sends him the side-eye before he returns his attention back to the machine, tapping in the details and inserting a few bills. Izuku standing beside him is just going by the flow because *Nn, Kacchan is always a bit unpredictable* and *maybe he just wants to stay together for a little longer.* It's been a long time since he's been in Tokyo after all, maybe non-passengers are allowed inside. He has this carefree expression on his face, waiting for the other to finish before –

"Deku here," green eyes blink, staring at the two tickets being waved in front of his face. "You hold it."

His expression then morphs with confusion because *hmm? Two?*

A *round trip?* Is this Kacchan's way of telling him to come back after the twenty-sixth?

As if knowing what the other's thinking Katsuki grimaces and says, "That's not it, shitty nerd."

Well, Izuku had also considered the other option but that would be a bit impossible yes? I mean… they haven't planned out anything yet. Katsuki has his own job to do and as much as he would like to stay together it's just all too sudden. The possibility is present but the chances are low – that's

what he thinks at least. He doesn't want to get his hopes up. It's also the reason why he looks so lost on what is happening.

"I'm coming with you to Fukuoka," Katsuki announces, raising a brow at the other. "You got a problem with that?"

Izuku blinks once, *twice* before he tilts his head and asks, "Eh?"

Today?

Even shiba-chan looks confused.

Izuku awkwardly smiles when he notices the two women next to their seat glancing in their direction.

They're both slightly flushed, probably taken aback by the sight. It couldn't be helped since it's not every day you see same-sex couple in Japan – in the shinkansen, on top of that. With Katsuki looking tired, dozing off against his shoulder, their fingers intertwined and all – anyone would assume that they're in a relationship. It's a bit debatable if this counts as PDA but hopefully, they don't think too much about it. The workers that pass by seem a bit curious as well, he can tell.

"Stop squirming," Katsuki complains, not bothering to open his eyes. "It's cold."

"Sorry Kacchan…" Izuku says, thinking about how ironic it is because usually, he's the one who's cold.

It's probably that coat… It looks pretty but it doesn't seem warm…

Compared to his thick fluffy coat it doesn't look that comfortable as well.

Katsuki sits up and grimaces when the officer moves back, his peaceful sleep disturbed. His irritation doesn't last that long nevertheless because Izuku is slightly smiling, in the middle of taking off his outer garment as he mumbles a soft *the AC is a bit too cold, right Kacchan?* He swears he can hear someone squealing at some point but he doesn't really care. He's way too tired and his body is way too freaking sore. This guy is probably trying to make up for last night…

Good because he better be.

"I don't want your coat," *what I want is your arm.* "Give it back," *the arm he means.*

Katsuki really likes Izuku's arms…

"But you said you were cold…"

"I'm twenty-three years old I can take the cold," now this is just getting out of hand.

Izuku knows how to deal with it though because he says, "I just want to take care of Kacchan…"

With that puppy-dog eye thing he does and Katsuki is *weak.* He's so weak he *gulps.*

Stop using your face, goddammit!

“It’s a five-hour ride so make yourself comfortable, Kacchan…” the smile he shows when Katsuki accepts the coat is also dazzling. He even helps him settle into a more comfortable position than before, the blonde using the garment like a thick heated blanket. “I’ll wake you up when we arrive,” a kiss on the side of his head.

Katsuki scowls at that because he can feel his heart squeeze.

Whatever.

“If you’re giving me your coat then give me shiba as well,” referring to the item on Izuku’s lap.

Ahh, that’s right… They brought this guy along.

The officer laughs before he complies, his side of the seat completely empty.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Ticket - both of them are going, yes.
(2) Puppy-dog - katsuki thinks izuku is doing that face on purpose.

anyway, here's the smut. the rating has been fulfilled.
this would probably be the only descriptive one in the entire series.
the following ones will be rather tame and not as long.
back to fluff! next up kacchan finally meets inko-san!

inko-san and shinsou-kun

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Fukuoka is completely different compared to Tokyo.

It's the biggest city in Kyushu and because it's a harbor city, although there are skyscrapers and buildings, the infrastructure is not as advanced or as tall as the capital. Then again, it's a bit unfair to compare it to Tokyo because their cores are different. Fukuoka seems slower – *in a good way* – and because of its location, it's not as cold. Katsuki definitely got used to his hometown's fast pace and busy bustling streets. It's mild and cloudy; everyone dressed in coats but no gloves or scarves.

Fukuoka is *pretty.*

During evenings in winter, most especially.

"Yumachi, please,"

While Izuku is talking to the cab driver Katsuki is too busy looking out of the window. They're passing by a large bridge, the sea very close. Now that he thinks about it, it's his first time being in this city. He's never willingly spent his long breaks outside of Tokyo as well.

"Does your team know that you're here, Kacchan?"

"Yeah, I told Kirishima," and that guy will definitely inform the others. It's just how team UA worked – almost no privacy when it comes to romantic relationships and events. "Aizawa-sensei will probably know soon because I left the car near the station," a smug grin on his face, Izuku nervously gulping.

"So that's why you wanted to drop by the lost and found!"

"How else would he get the key?"

The officer groans, wringing out his hands because of worry, "You're going to get scolded, Kacchan!"

"I'm the number one streamer in UA. I won't get scolded,"

"Still! Isn't this a bit too impulsive? You said that you were doing a stream with your – "

"I can just use your computer," since Izuku told him that he'd be out for the entire morning tomorrow anyway. He can just borrow it and install whatever he needs tonight. "It's Pikachu's stream. I don't need a webcam and I can just use whatever for a mic," connect through discord and join the call, the thing they do per usual. "The quality will be crappy but they just have to deal with it," he has nothing aside from earphones to use anyway.

Seriously, I really need to buy this guy a proper mic…

A headset at the very least. Chat is used to Deku's audio but it definitely needs to be improved.

They earn a lot in super chat for goodness sake.

"Maybe later," when they go out or something. *"I should've just gotten him that for Christmas."*

Then again, a mic would be a rather shitty gift. Well… actually, it's not a shitty gift because it's quite decent in a way. It's just that it would pale in comparison to what he received. Thank goodness he didn't buy anything for now. It would've been embarrassing to give something easy when the other has sentimental meaning in his. Better late than ever. Deku better prepare himself for his gift.

After a while, the car pauses in front of a building.

"Ahh… Thank you very much,"

Izuku slightly bows after he pays, Katsuki trailing after him when they exit the vehicle.

Red eyes look up and he realizes *it's a pretty nice place for a college student*. The building looks new and it seems expensive. When he asks the officer about it all he gets is *rent here is pretty cheap compared to Tokyo, Kacchan* and *my mom helped me look for it*. Apparently, apartments cost twice more expensive in Tokyo. One expensive studio would probably equal to a big apartment unit in Fukuoka. Izuku's rent is not too high but he also has a student discount because of Kyushu University.

"What the fuck?" Katsuki exclaims as they ride the lift to the seventh floor. "Tokyo is such a scam."

No wonder people like to live outside of it or near the provinces.

"I'm in a share house with those guys and I've been planning on moving out soon but – "

"Izuku?"

Katsuki owlishly blinks, following the other's line of view because *who's that?* The question only lasts a few seconds in his head nevertheless because he realizes *ohh.* The resemblance is uncanny. The woman doesn't have freckles but they have the same shade of hair, the same eye shape, the same eye color… She's definitely a relative or something. That much is easily distinguishable and.

"Ehh!?" the officer's face brightens up, the streamer trailing after him. "What are you – *ahkk!* Dinner! Wasn't it supposed to be at six? Too early –" Izuku continues to rattle on and on, in the midst of trying to find his keys. No one seems to be paying attention to him though because both Katsuki and the woman are curiously looking at each other.

"Good evening," Katsuki says, slightly bowing his head.

That seems to snap Izuku out of his stupor because, "Ahh, right! Mom, this is Kacchan. The guy I've been telling you."

Katsuki's confusion gets replaced with something worse – *nervousness* – because *mom!?*

YOUR MOM IS IN FRONT OF ME RIGHT NOW!? ARE YOU FUCKING KIDDING ME SHITTY DEKU!?

The blonde tugs at the other's sleeve urgently once, *twice* before Izuku finally realizes.

"Uhmm… He's the person I'm dating, mom," he sheepishly says, shyly rubbing the back of his nape.

"Bakugo Katsuki," the streamer continues, another slight bow for formality. "Nice to meet you…"

“Ahh… yes! Midoriya Inko! Nice to meet you Bakugo-kun,” she’s definitely Deku’s mom with that soft demeanor. He can’t help but stare for a bit while the officer struggles with the lock, noticing the small smile she sends his way. “Thank you for looking after my son,” *polite, way too polite!* Midoriyas and their good manners are starting to overwhelm him a bit.

Anyway –

“No, he’s been looking after me as well – “

Hmm? *Inko?*

“I heard about you from Izuku. Did you both have fun in Tokyo?”

INKO!?

“Yes… It was very fun,” while Izuku just gulps because *why are you glaring at me like that, Kacchan!?*

Inko owlishly blinks, pausing for a moment before she realizes something, “Ahh! That’s right! Would you like to have a chat, Bakugo-kun?”

“Of course, ma’am. Sorry for dropping by unannounced,”

Ma’am!?

“It’s fine! Izuku stay here for a moment, will you?”

The officer tilts his head to the side because, “Hmm? Here? Outside?” In front of his apartment? Before he can even continue his question the two are already heading in, Inko not allowing him to enter. “What’s happening? Why am I – “ and the door shuts, the lock clicking. It seems like his mother had taken his key as well…

Ehh? Wait a minute.

“Last time I checked I was the son of this household though?”

His duffel bag then slides from his shoulder and drops on the floor.

It takes thirty minutes before the door finally opens.

Click.

“Deku,” Izuku looks up from the floor to meet Katsuki’s gaze through the small gap. “You can come in now.”

The officer almost tears up because, “Wha – What did you two talk about, Kacchan?”

Much to his dismay the streamer just remains silent, his eyes cast to the side with his cheeks tinted red.

Ehh!? Now he’s even more curious! What is it!?

“I’ll be leaving now, Izuku,” and then his mom appears next to Katsuki, the blonde opening the door for her to pass. They seem to have had a good conversation with how friendly they’re acting with each other. It’s almost a bit strange to see Katsuki that… submissive? Well, not really. He’s just about ninety percent nicer than usual. “Take care, both of you and ahh… Izuku I brought cake. It’s on the table.”

“Mom, you’re leaving already!? What about dinner!?”

“Mou, I can’t stay for dinner when you have a guest over, Izuku!” she scolds him and he visibly deflates, Katsuki grinning at the sight. It’s way too tame to even use the word *scold.* Then again, reserved people like this are probably scarier compared to outspoken ones; based on the way they calmly hold their anger. “Make sure to look after Katsuki-kun while he’s here, okay?”

“Ehh? Nn, okay mom!”

“Stay safe, Inko-san,”

Katsuki-kun!? Inko-san!?

“It’s fine, don’t worry about it,” she sends her son a soft smile as she adjusts her coat. “You spend Christmas with me every year. It’s about time you spend it with someone else,” to which he flushes, a bit embarrassed. He doesn’t want to seem like he has a mother complex but yeah, it probably is. It was worse during his teenage years and it’s lessened now that he’s older but he’s still quite protective and attentive of her.

“Sorry…”

Inko just laughs before she nods towards Katsuki’s direction, “He’s like that. Please bear with him, Katsuki-kun…”

“Nn, leave it up to me Inko-san,”

Izuku’s face scrunches because, “What did you two talk about!?”

Inko and Katsuki glance at each other before they smile.

“Wha –“

The officer is starting to tear up a bit.

“What did you talk about!?”

In the end, he doesn’t get any answers.

Izuku has no time to feel dejected because the moment the door shuts close again he’s faced with a menacing look from the other. Nn, this was starting to feel like a real relationship. Kind of like he

did something wrong but at the same time, he didn't? Kacchan can be very vague sometimes and his brain is already reeling in – thinking of any mistake that he could've done previously.

"You didn't tell me that Inko-san was your mother,"

"Hmm? Did you know her before this, Kacchan?" the way he said it seemed so.

"Haaaaahh!?" okay that was a bit dramatic even for him. "Of course not, this was our first time meeting each other," which makes the other a bit confused. If it's not that then *what?* The officer silently takes off his shoes at the genkan, dropping his bag and coat on the couch. "What I mean is that I didn't know that *Inko* was your mother's name," Katsuki has his arms crossed above his chest, a rather hmm… *pouty? Slightly upset? Irritated?* It's a mixed expression, really.

"I haven't… told you about her before?" *is that the issue?*

"No," Katsuki's scowl deepens because, "You didn't tell me her name was *Inko."*

Nn… I still don't know what's wrong. You're just repeating it Kacchan.

Anyway –

"Sorry…" this is the best course of action. "I won't do it again."

The apology seems to have sufficed because Katsuki just turns red and says, "I thought Inko was your side chick or something." *Hmm!?* "I was fucking ready to throw hands and get into a fight."

Umm… Sir!? Bakugo Katsuki had just said something extraordinary again!?

He doesn't know what's scarier… Katsuki thinking he has a side chick or the other getting into a relationship with him all the while thinking he has a side chick. Both are pretty bad. Also… *fight!?* What fight!? That seems pretty bad! Immoral as well! He would never cheat! Where did this even come from!? Izuku gulps, feeling his hands start to sweat.

"You made me worry over nothing," the blonde groans, remembering the nights he spent awake. "Give me back my sleep, fuck!"

Ehh… This seems a bit too complicated so Izuku's brain just summarizes it down to –

"Kacchan, were you jealous? Is that it?" because he thought Inko was another girl and not his mom or something along those lines. That's cute but, "I… I really should've clarified myself, huh." Truth to be told it's not really his fault. It's Todoroki's but he doesn't even remember that time at the headquarters. What they had was just a casual passing conversation.

"HAH!?" Katsuki flushes, red up to the tips of his ears. *"I WASN'T – YOU GOT A PROBLEM WITH THAT!?"*

He's not denying it!? CUTE!

Izuku just shakes his head, attempting to keep his expression neutral because,

"Hmm? Of course not," he feels his body shake with laughter, "Thank… Thank you for your jealousy, Kacchan," feeling the need to bow or something. Makes him feel fuzzy and all. So much he can just peacefully ascend at this rate.

Nn… I really appreciate it. It's very cute.

Izuku then approaches for a hug, Katsuki grumbling as he gets pulled in to reconcile.

"So how was it?"

"Hah?"

"How does it feel to get jealous of your boyfriend's mom – *ghhk* –"

"There's nothing here,"

Katsuki is frowning at the empty fridge, closing it with a frown. Izuku had surrendered at this point, calmly explaining *Kacchan I was at internships, remember?* and *I didn't have time to stock up.* If he knew that the blonde would be coming here with him then would've been a different story. All they have right now is that cake on the table. As a solution, Izuku suggests that they go out for dinner today and buy groceries tomorrow only to be shut down because –

"Let's just get this over with. I don't wanna fucking wait for tomorrow,"

And then what? Starve for breakfast? Hell no!

For someone who has a great built this guy's diet is really non-existent.

He probably eats katsudon every single day.

"Is there a grocery store nearby?"

"Hehe kinda feels like we're newlyweds, Kacchan,"

"Stop lagging and push the fucking cart!"

Shinsou is in the middle of buying groceries when he encounters a familiar face.

"Midoriya,"

The guy looks troubled, unable to decide which tub of ice cream is better – vanilla or chocolate. If you ask Shinsou he'd say none because he thinks those are pretty basic. Now, encountering colleagues at the supermarket is pretty common. They all live in the same city and the good

apartments are located in this area. He's even met Uraraka once or twice before and she lives in the student dorm. What's uncommon on the other hand is for him to see his friend like *that.* Dressed up to the tens because *hah? you're just here to buy food, aren't you?*

No need to look that handsome, geez.

Apparently, Shinsou is unaware that the two have already met up.

In their friend group Todoroki is the only one who knows.

The irony…

"Hmm?" he watches Izuku lift his gaze from what he's holding, turn and then brightly smile. "Shinsou-kun!"

Ahh… he's getting reminded how ugly he is again. Should've worn something better other than pajamas.

Anyway –

"You just got back?" from whatever he went to, that much he could tell. They didn't question Todoroki because everyone sort of assumed that Izuku was with his mother. Their friend group also had their own Christmas party yesterday. "Praline is better," he points towards the freezer, the larger male blinking before he follows the advice.

"Thank you, Shinsou-kun!"

"Nn…" he then suspiciously narrows his eyes at Izuku because, "Ice-cream in winter?"

What a strange kid…

The officer awkwardly laughs saying, "Well Kacchan wanted it so…"

Kacchan?

Pirirririririri! Pirirririririri!

"Hello? Kacchan I'm – "

"FUCK. HOW LONG DOES IT TAKE TO GET ICE CREAM, SHITTY DEKU!?"

Shinsou just watches everything unfold in front of his eyes, confused. Even if it's not his intention to listen in, he has to – he has no choice. The streamer's voice is so loud and the call is not even on speaker mode. His friend is slightly panicking, defending himself by saying that there were too many choices and that he was torn as to what to pick. It's a long explanation per usual and at this point, the other is just not having any of it.

"I DON'T HAVE MY WALLET WITH ME! "

"Sorry, Kacchan! I just have to grab one more thing and – "

"I'M NEXT IN THE FUCKING LINE – "

His friend looks guilty, awkwardly laughing and all.

"WHERE THE FUCK ARE YOU!?"

Izuku gulps, immediately replying, “On my way! I’m on my way!” Along with an apology as he hangs up. After his conversation on the phone, he sends Shinsou one last smile, saying, “I’ll meet you tomorrow at university, Shinsou-kun!” before he turns and runs past aisle four.

Ehhh?

Shinsou remains standing in the same position for the next minute and a half, dumbfounded.

What the hell just happened?

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Genkan - entryway for a house, apartment or building.
(2) Midoriya Inko - izuku's biological mother. a lawyer.
(3) Boyfriend - i get hmm... kinda excited everytime i write this term.

early update! it's a bit fluffy this time!
katsuki's dilemma is finally cleared and they're back to being cute. shinsou's confused though.
also, as an individual who is always told to line up and wait... the last part is based on real experience.
there is no greater fear than it being your turn and not having money to pay lol.
izuku hurry up and get back geez! chat returns next chap!
someone help me with fukuoka facts! my knowledge is google level hahaha.

where is bakugo katsuki?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

People on social media are a bit confused.

The Light In Your Eyes @tiredizuku • 3h
Does anyone know when @*bkgkatsuki_official* is returning?

GO CATBOY GO! @garou_inazuma • 3h
replying to @*tiredizuku*
Idk. He hasn't said anything, just that there wouldn't be any streams for the following days.

Lipstick Chateau Wine Color @lotttttto • 3h
replying to @*tiredizuku*
it's already been four days and still no content.

mei-chan is in gacha hell @reimeimei • 3h
replying to @*tiredizuku*
It's fine! Baku's like that! He's a really private dude.

107 DAYS WITHOUT BAKUGO @bakugoswife • 3h
replying to @*tiredizuku*
Idk. He didn't do a Christmas stream yesterday.

His sudden disappearance is a complete mystery to the internet. They've been informed about it beforehand but it was very vague. Many have been speculating a hiatus and some say that it's only a short break but it's all just guesswork. No one actually knows. Team UA hasn't commented on it as well and before his fans get started, yes, Ground Zero disappearing for four straight days is a bit worrisome because it's Christmas! They've been waiting for this event all year round!

What about the World Boss on WE? Christmas skins on League? Mario Cart Winter Cup?

There are so many good things they're skipping on and other content creators are streaming about it!

In summary, his fans are jealous. They have to survive on crumbs even though it's Christmas.

Red super chat won't activate by itself you know! Come back, Ground Zero!

Then again, they'll probably forgive him when they learn the truth because –

"Can we?"

WHAT? CAN WE WHAT!?

Katsuki gulps, eyes focused on the ceiling as the other's hands trail up his shirt because *calm down, calm down, calm down. You also did this yesterday, you'll be fine*. It still feels nerve-wracking though. It doesn't help how they're doing this in Izuku's apartment, on Izuku's bed with Izuku's scent everywhere. It's a triple kill and his irises are shaking, his lover pressed against his ear. He's going to faint at this point.

“Kacchan?” when he doesn’t receive a reply, Izuku sitting up so that their eyes meet. “No?”

What the actual fuck is wrong with this guy!?

“WHY… WHY THE FUCK DO YOU KEEP ASKING ME SHIT!? JUST GET ON WITH IT – “

Make this less embarrassing!

“But consent – “ ah, so it was about that. It sounded a bit too lewd for Katsuki’s liking though. “I need your consent – “ struggling as he gets continuously hit by a pillow. “I don’t want to do anything that Kacchan doesn’t want to do. I was just asking you a question, ghnn…” he sobs, rubbing his eye. The blonde feels a bit guilty because he can see droopy puppy ears on the other all of a sudden.

What the… So now it’s my fault!?

“Nn…” Izuku sniffles, leaning in on his elbows. “Sorry if I made you upset.”

And then Katsuki receives a kiss.

“I feel like I’m getting spoiled or something,” the streamer grimaces, glaring at the ceiling with his cheeks flushed. He can feel the other nuzzle against his neck, trying to find a comfortable position. “What the… What are you? A dog?” an overgrown one on top of that. Does this guy have any idea how heavy he is?

“Come on, get up,” Katsuki sighs, patting Izuku’s back. “We can’t do anything in this position.”

“Hmm? But we don’t have to if you don’t want to, Kacchan…“

The officer complies nevertheless, owlishly blinking when Katsuki also sits up to straddle his lap. “Eh?” is all he could say as a shadow looms over, the blonde’s hand on his chest making him lean back against the headboard of the bed.

“You did it last time so…”

Izuku gulps, frozen stiff as Katsuki’s hands tug on his pants.

“It’s my turn, shitty Deku…”

And then he melts.

Ping!

Team UA:

>> **Mina:** Don’t forget about the stream tomorrow Bakugo!
>> **Sero:** Discord at 8:30 am

Izuku's breath hitches as the blonde softly rocks back and forth.

If he had it his way they wouldn't be going this slow but –

Nn, Kacchan looks like he's feeling good…

It didn't matter for now, I guess.

Izuku lets him lean against his chest, Katsuki gasping at every shift.

He then flinches because *teeth* – on his collarbone and shoulder. It doesn't hurt too much since Katsuki makes up for it with those soft brushes of his tongue but that's definitely bound to leave a trace. Izuku can only silently tilt his head back, his hands wrapped around the other's waist. *I want to move,* he thinks, looking at where they're connected. It would be quite easy to lift Katsuki and make a bit of space but *he'll get mad… This is torture.* Izuku already had his fun last time.

"Try not to leave it in any noticeable places, Kacchan…"

It would be quite awkward to explain.

"Don't put one near my neck," but Katsuki just sends him a moment's glance, his lips trailing up Izuku's neck.

It was useless after all.

Confused seems to be Shinsou's default emotion nowadays.

"Wow," Uraraka blinks, her eyes falling on her friend's neck. "That's a very big bug bite, Deku-kun."

Said Deku flinches for a moment, tugging his collar higher and nodding because, "Yeah, bug bite."

Iida looks puzzled, Shinsou grimacing while Todoroki stops midst chomp on his burger because *wait.*

Wait a second…

"Are there bugs in winter?" Shinsou facepalms.

"I believe there are," and here comes Iida, just as trusting because there's no way Midoriya out of all people would have a hickey on his neck. It's either he's in denial or he just trusts the other way too much. Personality-wise, Izuku isn't the type to do something that risky as well – except he actually is. "Perhaps it came from a spider because mosquitoes are cold-blooded and it's unlikely for them to be active during winter."

"A spider?" Uraraka turns to Izuku's neck again and exclaims, "A very big spider then!"

Shinsou, in hopes of giving them enlightenment says, "I don't think spiders bite…"

But Todoroki just shakes his head because, “No, my brother was bitten by one before.”

Again with your brother!

Shinsou glances at the food tray next to their table thinking, *“I want to hit my head with that.”*

Izuku just awkwardly laughs, noticing his friend’s distress.

Nn… it might be good to tell Shinsou-kun later…

“I can’t believe you told Todoroki before me,”

“You were in another city! I couldn’t have possibly – “

“You even took him with you to buy a gift. I found out at the grocery store – ”

“Shinsou-kun!” Izuku panics, not liking where this is going. “I’m sorry!”

Oddly enough, Shinsou gets upset quite easily.

It’s a nine to twelve stream on Kaminari’s channel.

They’re playing League because their team had received sponsorship from the gaming company itself. Apparently, they wanted them to promote their new Christmas skins and what better way than to have team UA try it out? It also helps how Kirishima and Sero had been hooked on the game for quite a while now. Even Mina is excited because *cat girl!? How cute!* Katsuki just wants to get this over with. The skin runs until the last week of January so their sponsor is fine with them streaming even after Christmas.

Ping!

Stream Chat:

>> Bakugooooooooooooo!!!!
>> WE MISSED YOU AHHHHHHHHH
>> he’s really here omg!!! welcome back!!!
>> Kaminari I like your new head set so cute wwww
>> RIP those who are not watching right now

Katsuki is using Izuku’s computer so he installed a few things yesterday and changed a bunch of settings. The officer said that he didn’t mind so he made himself comfortable, updating the drivers because *that’s what you’re supposed to do, shitty Deku.* It’s a bit upsetting that he doesn’t have any of his gear though. All he has are regular earphones. The quality is not bad but it’s definitely mediocre compared to his teammate’s gear. It makes him feel annoyed for some reason.

I’ll definitely buy a mic, he reminds himself. *I should’ve just gotten that for his present.*

Now that he thinks about it Izuku also uses earphones when they stream.

Chat is used to it but it could be improved. With the amount of super chat they receive it *should* be improved.

“Bakugo your rank is too low for ranked!”

“I don’t play this often!” as he clicks away, trying to navigate. “What’s wrong with a normal game!?”

“Ehhhh, it’s no fun but ohh well… No ranked for today everyone!”

>> Hmm? Phone call?
>> what’s wrong with his audio??
>> Maybe he’s not with Team UA rn
>> AHHHHHHHHHHH I GET IT
>> Baku are you on vacation wwwww

It’s a bit difficult to keep up with chat using a single monitor. He’s connected through discord and he’s playing League on it at the same time. It’s impossible to look at chat like that so he uses his phone, the device on the desk in front of him. It’s tolerable but the text is too fucking small and they type way too fast. He can’t see anything goddammit!

“Bakugo doesn’t have his usual set up right now,” at least Sero is decent enough to assist.

Mina on the other hand is giggling, triggering chat to have suspicions.

“Oh!? They’re asking if you spent Christmas with us, captain!”

This girl…

“I didn’t because I have fucking work to do!”

Which prompts a bunch of *ahh, business trip* comments. It’s not usual for Katsuki to go somewhere for promotions or events. It’s probably for a new release again or something, similar to how Kirishima went to Osaka for a convention. The red-head was also absent from streaming during that short period of time but unlike Katsuki, he properly informs his audience. For now, that reason seems to prompt chat to calm down, the comments cheering them on for their match.

“Ohh!? You missed your ult!?”

“SHUT UP! I’M NOT USED TO THIS SET-UP!”

>> what set-up?
>> ????
>> Computer café set-up probably
>> Sounds like Deku so computer café
>> they should’ve lent him a proper mic

It’s only a matter of time.

It’s really not Izuku’s fault.

It’s a nine to twelve stream, right?

“Tadaima,” he unconsciously says as he enters his apartment, dropping his things on the couch.

It’s past twelve! Actually, it’s already two in the afternoon.

Crash!

Izuku owlishly blinks as he heads to his bedroom.

Katsuki’s champion just died.

“We’re already fucking losing! It doesn’t matter!”

Is what he replies to Kirishima when he suggests changing his build. His build is not the problem here, you see. It’s his fucking teammates – that’s what he thinks at least. Kaminari is way too slow with the back-up and Mina just keeps roaming around. Good for them because they have moderate defense but since he’s all DPS he can’t stand getting ambushed or crowd-controlled. It’s a bit stupid to be honest. *Where’s the shitty support!?* or so he would say every time he’s the only one left defending their tower.

Right now he has nothing to do for the next minute, grumpily complaining about the gameplay.

“MINA STOP RUNNING AWAY – “ Kaminari’s pained scream as he gets pulled in the crowd.

“Nah, we can’t win against that without tank – “

“Tadaima – “ Katsuki blinks, turning around to look at the door. He takes one of his earphones out before his eyebrows furrow, glancing at his phone to check the time.

2:47 P.M.

The chair drags against the floor as he stands up, tipping over and falling down.

>> !?
>> what was that??
>> ?????
>> ??
>> !!!!!!!!!!

Even chat is confused and thankfully his teammates are too busy with the game to even look at it. He should really mute himself on discord but that would mean he has to exit the game since it’s on full screen. That’ll take a while. It’s such a pain to play on a single monitor goddammit –

Creak.

He turns around and thankfully the other has some sense. Deku is peeking through the door, seemingly getting the clue when he receives a *look* from Katsuki.

>> why is everyone sending question marks
>> Baku what was that
>> Maybe it was his mom???? Christmas right?
>> Deku??
>> I didn't hear it

Katsuki sighs out of relief.

Four games and two more losses later the stream finally ends.

"Deku,"

He bends down, tapping Izuku's shoulder. The officer is asleep on the couch with his jacket zipped all the way up. It was snowing so it was a bit cold outside today. He got the clue and didn't enter the bedroom, opting to stay in the living area instead. Katsuki doesn't know if he should feel good about what happened earlier or feel bad. Maybe he should've muted once and allowed him to come in for a bit. Screw him and his own dilemmas.

"You can go in now," green eyes sleepily blink; the larger male sitting up. "Go change your clothes."

It's not usual for streams to extend and last longer than expected but nn… Even that annoyed him for a bit.

Katsuki groans when the other doesn't move but gives him a hug instead.

"What the hell are you doing?" *You feel cold, go get a blanket or something.*

Izuku just gives him this awkward laugh and says, "You were streaming."

Well yeah. Obviously.

"You haven't eaten lunch yet," which makes Katsuki grimace, heat pooling up in his chest. "I asked you what you wanted through text but you didn't reply so I just brought Katsudon," that part is a bit expected but *you should stop eating that all the time, shitty Deku*. The officer lightly whimpers, going on a long rant to defend himself but everything falls deaf to Katsuki's ears.

I'm way too bad at this, pouting with his chin propped against Izuku's shoulder. *What the fuck is this?*

"But I guess it doesn't matter? It's already five so we have to go get dinner anyway,"

This guy has been waiting for the stream to finish since two. It makes Katsuki feel bad for some reason.

"Kacchan?" Izuku asks, noticing how silent the other is. "Kacchan, are you alright?" he tries again.

"Dinner can wait," yeah, well they can always eat later – "Pay attention to me."

Nn, he should pay atten – *Hmm?*

KACCHAN, I THINK I JUST HEARD SOMETHING AMAZING!?

"Yes, I am paying attention," the streamer is a bit clingier than he expected. Then again, he really should've seen this coming the moment they boarded the train together. Katsuki is frowning, tugging at Izuku's tie because *I tied it for you this morning, the fuck is this ugly knot!?* "How was your stream?"

"Bad. They almost heard you and I don't have a decent mic,"

Ahh… as expected. The audio was the problem, huh?

Anyway… Why are you playing with my uniform, Kacchan? Maybe he likes it? It's his first time seeing it in person after all. Izuku is not saying anything but he notices those hands roaming all over, you know!

"Let's go buy a mic tomorrow,"

"Hmm? You still have work even though you're on a break?"

"I can't just skip out on collabs," he huffs, grumbling against Izuku's chest. "I had those scheduled before we even met. It's all your fault," because he really had no intention of leaving Tokyo. Katsuki thought that four days with Izuku would be enough but no… All his plans after Christmas had been scrapped due to this person. Their first meeting went better than expected and he didn't want to part – not when they did it just the night before. This isn't a one-night stand, you know!

"I don't think the malls here are as big as the ones in Tokyo, Kacchan…"

"We'll see about that."

"What's that?"

Izuku asks when he sees Katsuki carrying another bag from a store they didn't enter.

"Did you go somewhere while I was in the bathroom?"

It should've ended at that but, "None of your business."

WHA –

"That was not nice," Izuku complains with a pout, following the other. "What is it, Kacchan!?"

There's a new set-up on Izuku's desk.

Aside from a mic, there's also a new monitor. Katsuki was quite adamant about it. He wasn't going to spend the rest of his streams like last time. It was uncomfortable and he didn't like it. He has a reputation to uphold, you know! Even if there is no camera for now the audio needs to be good at

least. Katsuki won't be doing solo streams – it's just for the collabs that he wasn't excused for and the ones he couldn't remove from his schedule. Aizawa also insisted on it because *work* and *you should be glad they allowed your sudden leave.*

Just tell them, since Izuku will be at home for the entire duration of his break. *It's not that hard.*

It would be stupid to make the other be cautious about every single thing. This was his apartment for goodness sake!

"DON'T GO YET! WE'RE ABOUT TO WIN!"

"What am I supposed to do!? Hold it in!?"

Kirishima screams in pain on the other side of the line, Katsuki exclaiming, *"DEKU!"*

>> !?
>> Deku??
>> What
>> !!??
>> ????

A few seconds later a confused Izuku appears at the door, looking just as lost as the audience.

"Take over for a bit," Katsuki removes his headphones, getting off the chair to head to the bathroom.

>> I WAS RIGHT
>> !?
>> YOOOOO
>> ????
>> the fuck?

A bit dazed, Izuku sits in front of the computer innocently asking,

"Ehh? But weren't we supposed to hide it, Kacchan?"

It doesn't take long for both Team UA and chat to explode.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Chomp - todoroki soft bite.
(2) Brother - todoroki is very close with natsuo in this fic.
(3) Collabs - katsuki has a few scheduled which he can't cancel.

as you can see, kacchan is being considerate with izuku.
he chose to reveal rather than making him tip-toe around the apartment.
after careful consideration, katsuki finally realizes that it's actually not that big of a deal.

sorry for the late update btw. i was in genshin event hell.
also, i made a new fic! i wanna die before thirty.
do give it a try if you like angst. it was such a pain to proof-read.

fanservice for chat

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"DEKUUUUUUUU!"

The voices of five people overlap at the same time.

Izuku then nervously laughs when he sees their champions roam around Katsuki's because *aren't we supposed to be defending the tower, everyone!? Kacchan will get mad if we lose, you know!* The blonde was very snappy about it yesterday. League wasn't his favorite game but he didn't like it when he had a low winning streak – any gamer would understand. Katsuki is very prideful and competitive. The officer doesn't realize that this is just a normal game and not a ranked one as well.

"Uhh… I don't know how to use this champion,"

It's a fighter with a polearm and he's only used to support characters.

Ping!

Stream Chat:

>> OMFG IT'S REALLY DEKU! HI DEKU!
>> ----- DEKU! WE MISSED YOU WELCOME BACK
>> THEY'RE COHABITATING!? EHHHHHHHHHHHHH
>> AHHHHHHHHHH OMG OMG OMG OMG BEST CHRISTMAS EVER
>> HE'S ALIVE!? BRUH… AND PEOPLE SAY HE'S FAKE WHAT

"Deku! Hey Deku!" Kaminari's excited voice. "Come with me! Let's do mid together!"

Reluctantly he follows.

"KAMINARI THAT'S NOT FAIR!" Mina exclaims, having no choice but to return to bot. *"There are three enemies here! KIRI! SERO! COME HERE I WANNA MID WITH DEKU TOO – "*

>> boys team
>> BOYYYYSSS TEAAAAMMM
>> Three people mid WAHAHAHAHA POOR PINKY
>> a lot of people are gonna regret not watching todays stream lol
>> Ahhh Deku you missed ult! Don't mind!

Usually, whenever someone makes a mistake like that they'd be bashed and teased to no end but because it's Deku it's fine. It also triggers an endless stream of *don't mind* on chat, everyone cheering him on. Since it's not Bakugo's live he can't see the super chat notifications but it's definitely filling up. Kaminari is also laughing endlessly about it since he knows.

"Deku! They said they miss you," Sero snickers, trying to support their new fighter. Their viewers have so many questions and the chatbox is basically overflowing with it. "Does Bakugo have chat pulled up?"

"Nn, he has it but it's on the other screen,"

Since the new set-up has a new monitor and all.

“I can’t play and read at the same time… I’m sorry chat,”

>> SIMP
>> TAKE MY MONEY
>> BABY -----
>> IT’S FINE! IT’S FINE! IT’S THE MONITOR’S FAULT!
>> I WANT HIM TO TALK SO BAD HNGHH

“Maybe when Kacchan gets back – *ahh, he’s here* – “

“SO FAST!” Kirishima laughs, chat nodding along as well.

“I just went to the bathroom. It won’t take ten years, shitty hair!” Katsuki exclaims, leaning over Izuku’s shoulder so that the mic gets his voice loud and clear. He then blinks when he sees the officer’s state – clicking his tongue because, “Stop being a slob. You don’t know how to put on headphones properly?” Izuku wore it lopsided that’s why he could hear the audio even though he wasn’t the one wearing it.

>> HNGHHGHGH AHHHHHHH I CAN’T
>> IT’S BKDK IN REAL LIFE ARGHHHHHHHHHH
>> This is starting to physically hurt me
>> IS HE FIXING IT FOR HIM. WHY IS THERE NO CAMERA
>> BAKUGO!!! BAKUGO MAKE THE FUCKING TEXT BIGGER FOR DEKU

“It keeps slipping off, Kacchan,” Izuku complains, ending up with his bangs pulled back and his forehead exposed. It’s quite a cute look. Looks like a dog or something. “I don’t know how to use this champion Kacch— *Kacchan?* Where’d you go?” it seems like he exited the room to do something.

“Ehh? Did Bakugo leave, Deku!?”

“Nn, I don’t know where he went,”

“It’s fine! Let’s just play without him!”

“You’re the new team captain! LET’S GO!”

>> LET’S GOOOOOOOOOO!!!!!!
>> GO DEKU GO!!!!!
>> I have so many questions to ask
>> IS NO ONE GOING TO EXPLAIN ABOUT THIS!?
>> KAMINARI ASKKKK HIM!!!!!

“Ahh… Kacchan’s here,” Izuku glances to his side, noticing how Katsuki brought another chair from the kitchen as well as, “We were supposed to eat that for lunch, Kacchan!” referring to the take-out sushi they got earlier, the blonde already settling down next to him.

“Shut up! I can do whatever I want. It’s already twelve,”

“But this is your stream! You’re the one who’s supposed to play!”

“You’re good at it,” Katsuki says, seeing the two kills and two support that Izuku garnered over the past few minutes. It’s more than his previous score so he has no problem letting the officer

play. “Do your best,” casually separating his chopsticks and turning his attention elsewhere.

Izuku’s heart skips a bit before he pouts because, “Kacchan’s just trying to use me!”

Someone makes a choking sound in the background, Mina screeching.

>> WHAT IS HAPPENING!? WHAT ON EARTH IS HAPPENING!?
>> PLS PLS PLS EXPLAIN. I THINK I JUST HEARD BAKU SAY SOMETHING ENCOURAGING
>> THIS WAS THE VACATION!??? WINTER GETAWAY WITH THE HUSBAND???
>> TEAM UA SAY SOMETHING!!!!!!! DEKU!!! BAKU!!!!! LOOK AT CHATT!!!!
>> THEY’RE HAVING SUSHI OMG I CAN’T DO THIS RN I’M SO SINGLE

“Deku!” Kaminari sounds like he’s on the verge of dying from laughter. “Say hi to chat!”

Ping!

Team UA:

>> **Sero:** Crazy bastard HAHAHA
>> **Mina:** That was so fun Baku LOL
>> **Kaminari:** Bring him again!!
>> **You:** i know what you’re doing Pikachu
>> **You:** stop using deku to earn sc!!
>> **Kaminari:** NOOOOO!!! It’s because they love him WWW
>> **Kirishima:** We have to do ranked!

Plus Ultra Scans:

This stream was the best HAHAHA. It’s such a good way to wrap up the year! I’m so glad I was watching it because I was about to skip out on it. I was too lenient! I know that Kaminari uses archive but seeing it live is just different. I was so goddamn nervous the entire time. Also, we finally get to see where Baku actually is. I thought he was doing PR again but it turns out he’s with Deku! I hope he didn’t feel pressured to reveal it? Hopefully not! Baku said he won’t do a solo stream but we managed to convince him! Save your SC for New Year’s Eve everyone! Link is here per usual: *@herotube.Kn/9bnjU*

08:12 – Deciding on champions.

14:10 – Mina flexing her new Lux skin so cute HAHAHA

22:24 – Bakugo can’t do ranked because his rank is still a bit low. Just a few more to

go! You can do it!

29:02 – Talking about plans for New Year's Eve. It looks like everyone will be streaming except for Baku.

33:56 – Second match start. They're finally rotating roles HAHAHA.

45:30 – Sero said that he wants to do a WE stream again because of the World Boss. I also want to see the World Boss! The event won't end until the second week of January so we still have a lot of time left. It'll be very fitting if they do the stream in December though.

50:09 – Complaining about the losing streak.

01:07:22 – Bakugo going to the bathroom and calling for Deku. I love how Baku just winged it and dearest father is just sitting there confused. Also, he fixed his headset for him! It's a bit past twelve so Baku got hungry. Please take care of yourselves and don't skip meals everyone! It was a nine to twelve stream and only Bakugo was eating.

01:48:57 – Someone asks 'Have you ever been to Team UA's house, Deku?' to which he answers no. Mina seems very excited about it though! They promised not to show his face if they do collab but it's also alright if they just hang out. Deku sounds cool about it as well but Bakugo has second thoughts. He's probably just embarrassed LOL

02:19:02 – Date plans. They have date plans. *"If it's New Year's Eve we have to visit a shrine, Kacchan"*.

03:02:15 – Finally managed to convince Bakugo to stream on New Year's! Thank you for the help, Deku! It won't be a regular stream though. It'll be a radio type of thing since they don't have a camera yet. I wonder if this was done on purpose? Deku doesn't have to reveal his face if he doesn't want to! I'm still looking forward to it though! They're going to do a Free Chat type of thing like the one Camie always does. Ready your SCs and questions! Baku said that he'll take questions from twitter!

03:44:37 – Literally why is Deku carrying this entire team LOL. He has twelve kills! Go Deku go!

Anyway, I'm so excited for New Year's Eve! It's in a few days! A lot of people went off on Kaminari's stream with red super chat but I'll do mine on Bakugo's stream. I've been waiting for this, my OTP! Use it for your date or something! Make sure to attend the stream, everyone. Remember to be respectful because it's Deku's first time seeing chat live though. Stay tuned for more updates! Plus Ultra!

Ping!

Good Luck With The Internships!

>> **Uraraka:** YES! He can come with us Deku-kun!

>> **Todoroki:** Which shrine were we supposed to go again
>> **Iida:** Kushida! Todoroki-kun! Hakozaki seems to be too crowded.
>> **Shinsou:** I wanna see him. Bring him Midoriya.

“Ehh? You’ve never been to a shrine before, Kacchan!?”

Izuku gasps, in the middle of finding another coat from his closet.

“Hmm… It won’t take that long, don’t worry,”

It depends on how many people are lining up but they’d definitely be finished by seven in the morning. Fukuoka isn’t as crowded as Tokyo so the queues aren’t as long. They’ll also be going with other people so it’ll be fun. Shinsou most especially has been insisting on it ever since he found out that the streamer was in the same city.

“Everyone is excited to see you, Kacchan!”

Katsuki wants the ground to open up and swallow him whole.

“PHOTO? WHAT PHOTO?”

“Uhh… I just happened to find out, Kacchan – “

“He poses for the photos I send you. My fault, I wasn’t being discreet,”

Not really that convincible with how monotone Shinsou’s tone is.

“WHAT THE FUCK – “

That means Deku knows he has a stash then!?

Katsuki stares at the image on his phone.

It was him and Deku standing next to each other at the shrine.

Aside from the selfie they took at that bubble tea shop this might be the first proper photo they have together. He’d have to thank Shinsou for that.

“My brother also likes taking photos,”

Nowadays Todoroki seems to be talking about his elder brother quite a lot.

“That one’s strange,” or so Katsuki would tell Izuku.

Ping!

Stream Chat:

>> IT’S STARTING
>> AHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHH
>> [**Mielle_038 donated ¥10,000:** Happy New Year Ground Zero and Deku! Thank you for all the content that you’ve been giving us!]
>> [**OkamiShoujo112 donated ¥15,000:** LET’S GOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOO!]
>> [**PRETTY SNIPER donated ¥8,000:** I missed you both a lot! Happy New Year!]

Since it’s a Free Chat they won’t be playing games.

It would also only last for about an hour and a half because realistically, it’s difficult to do nothing but talk for a very long time – it’s better this way. Many streamers do this on their channel during special events like birthdays but it’s a first for Baku. He has a BKDK photo pulled up on the screen with chat on the side so that everyone can see. It looks like a few well-known people like Jirou Kyouka and his teammate Mina are also watching. He can see their donations pop up.

Seriously… Twitter was already a mess and now he can barely see the comments.

Even Deku is shivering in his seat because, “Ehh? Isn’t 182k viewers a bit too much, Kacchan?”

This isn’t a K-Pop group’s live stream, you know!

>> SO CUTEEEEE HNGGHHHHHH
>> [**Synchro_KSR donated ¥12,000:** DEKU HI! CAN YOU SEE CHAT NOW?]
>> [**Kyun-Kyun donated ¥15,000:** i’m a very big fan of you guys! happy new year!]
>> [**Nanuuuuu donated ¥15,000:** The husband is nervous SO CUTE AHHHHHHHHHHH]
>> [**Carlama_Storm donated ¥10,000:** Congrats on hitting 15 million Bakugo!]

That’s right 15 million – *Eh?*

Ehhhhhhhhhhhhh!?

Katsuki grits his teeth, starting to panic, *“TOO MANY FUCKING THINGS GOING ON AT ONCE!”*

The relaxing World Execute OST that plays in the background is a big contrast to the chaotic atmosphere.

“IT’S NOT A FUCKING BOYFRIEND TAG!”

>> [**kiwiBee donated ¥5,000:** Deku what is the color of the underwear you’re wearing rn?]
>> [**Juniper donated ¥12,000:** HUSBAND TAG!!!]
>> the contents are a bit similar i guess but if you say so baku!
>> It’s definitely a boyfriend tag what is this guy talking about…
>> [**akemi donated ¥10,000:** THIS IS MY FOURTH RED SC PLS ANSWER READ MY LETTER NEXT OMG.]

“From BakugoxDeku_Lover4Ever-san. Bakugo-kun, Deku-kun Happy New Year,”

>> [**Happy BKDK Day!! donated ¥15,000:** WILD ASS NAME HAHAHAHAHA]
>> [**Tofu is tired donated ¥7,000:** SO OBVIOUS LOL]
>> [**I’m not a simp donated ¥5,000:** THEY REALLY DIDN’T HIDE IT WWWWW]
>> Deku your voice is so relaxing and pretty!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!
>> [**Lu_Lu_Luchiiiii donated ¥10,000:** GUYS STOP BEING EMBARASSING OMG]

“The fuck is that name?”

Katsuki grimaces, watching as Izuku reads through the letter the viewer sent, scrolling down the other monitor.

“Happy New Year,” he greets back, trying to be polite at least.

The blonde posted the entry box on Twitter yesterday and a few people from UA management helped them sort the ones they’d be answering. It needs to be appropriate after all. There were quite a lot so it took them a while but they finally managed to narrow it down to ten. Katsuki has his doubts nevertheless because as time goes on he slowly realizes that everything Izuku’s read so far is weird.

Maybe everyone in his audience is weird… He doesn’t know.

“I have a concern! I am currently in High School and I think the girl I like likes me back but I’m not sure. She’s the manager of the club I’m in and I can’t help but think that she’s cute. We go home together every now and then and she even lends me her notes. She also asked me if we could go to the shrine on New Year but I refused because BKDK is holding a radio!”

“THE FUCK IS WRONG WITH YOU, OI!?”

Izuku also pauses to laugh for a bit, chat cooing at his voice.

“I told her that I liked ponytails so she put her hair up. Anyway, she is being very confusing. Do you think I should confess now, Bakugo-kun? Deku-kun? Also… I always watch your streams! Thank you for the amazing content as always. I will be waiting for my letter to be answered so please help this troubled high school boy!”

There’s silence for a moment, the mouse clicking before Izuku hums and says, “So it’s a boy?”

>> THERE ARE MALE BKDK FANS???

>> Of course there are! Bakugo's fans are mostly men, you know!
>> [**LVL 20 donated ¥15,000:** I watch them for… educational purposes.]
>> [**irem donated ¥15,000:** I'm also a male fan!]
>> THERE ARE MEN IN CHAT RN

"Hmm… I think it's good? Listener-san can confess, why not?"

"Yeah. She was probably going to tell you but you went ahead and rejected her to watch the stream,"

"Ponytail… Ponytail, huh? Ponytails are nice,"

"Hah?" comes Katsuki's side glare and sharp tone. "What's that supposed to mean?"

To be followed by another stream of super chat, Izuku trying to appease his lover's anger.

"Favorite facial feature, they said,"

Izuku reads out one of the comments, turning to get a better view of Katsuki's face.

"Hmm… I like everything,"

Hah? That made his heart skip of a bit. *What a bleak answer.*

Katsuki grimaces, staring at the officer's face for a moment before he answers, "Nose."

"Ehhhh?" Izuku complains, touching his nose. "Why nose though? That's a bit surprising."

The streamer does not reply.

Ping!

Stream Chat:

>> **Mina:** IT WAS SO FUN HAHAHA. Meme and fan art review next!
>> **Kaminari:** Make it longer next time dude!

>> **Sero:** Yeah, I don't think two hours is enough. Look at Twitter!
>> **Kirishima:** Treat Deku to something nice! You got a lot of SC!!

"Kacchan?"

Izuku owlishly blinks, noticing the item on the kitchen table. It was a red gift bag and he remembers seeing it last time they went to the mall. He asked the blonde about it but he didn't get an answer. It wouldn't have been nice to continue asking so he just left it at that. It also didn't matter much at that time, wasn't that big of a deal.

"Why did you take that out from the drawer? Are you going to use it?"

Katsuki who is facing the counter just remains silent and does not bother to look back. He seems busy, in the midst of cooking and all. Izuku wouldn't have been curious if it weren't for the fact that the other's ears were red.

"It's your present," is the reply he gets after a while, "It's a bit late. It's for Christmas."

The officer stares, pursing his lips into a thin line before he flushes.

"Ahh…" he nods, nervously sitting down to open it. "Thank you…"

"I wasn't quite sure on what to give you. A watch or a bracelet is out of the question because it'll get in the way of your work. Rings as well," Izuku is an officer who frequently uses his hands to fight after all. "You don't have any piercings so there's that. A necklace won't be as troublesome to wear."

It's a dog tag necklace in silver. It's good that Katsuki has good sense when it comes to these things.

Izuku's eyes glisten when he opens the box, excitedly asking, "Is… Is it really alright!?"

"Hah?" the blonde turns around, frowning. "You gave me one so it's only proper, right?"

The officer stares, feeling giddy all of a sudden.

"Nn! You're right…" Izuku laughs and Katsuki flushes. "Thank you again, Kacchan."

He then gets up to head to the other.

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Mid/Bot - middle and bottom lane.

(2) Champion - the hero/character you are using.
(3) Dog Tag - it is a type of necklace design. posessive kacchan alert.

anyway, here's another update!
it's a bit sad but kacchan will be going home now!
say goodbye everyone! it's back to LDR!

it's goodbye for now

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Izuku's pupils are shaking.

"Umm… Kacchan?"

He slowly turns his head to the blonde, one hand holding his phone.

"Aren't there way too many zeroes, Kacchan?"

It's safe to say that he's stunned – completely taken aback. He knows that streamers make a lot of money but this much in one go? It's not even sinking in yet. He's seen the numbers before but perhaps he failed to comprehend that those numbers are *actual* numbers. There were even people donating in dollars and foreign currency. The total amount makes him gulp while Katsuki looks unfazed because *it's the holidays, shitty Deku.* Of course the fans were saving up for it! It still doesn't make sense though. A hundred thousand is already amazing but millions!?

Millions!?

No wonder Shinsou always looks up to these guys.

They earn a lot, his friend frequently says. *They're rich, Midoriya.*

Nn, I understand you now Shinsou-kun.

Rich is a rather unfitting term. Millionaires, these people are millionaires!

"That's just half of what we earned in total," Katsuki grins, referring to how they divided the sum between the two of them. If they add it up it's definitely bigger. "It's my highest record so far," that doesn't make him feel any better! Shouldn't they uhh… write the fans a letter or something? A message? This is way too much – "Stop fucking worrying about it. Most of my fans are functioning adults."

Still!

"Also…" a vein pops on Katsuki's head, arms crossed in front of his chest. "It's been twenty minutes! Stop wasting your time and go change!" Unlike Izuku he's already fully dressed, neat and tidy with the watch he was gifted on his right wrist. The officer on the other hand had just gotten out of the bathroom, distracted by the notification he received from his account.

Ahh, right! They had some business to attend to!

The streamer frowns when he sees Izuku pull out a t-shirt from the closet because, "Wear something nicer!"

"Ehh? But we're just meeting my mom, Kacchan – "

"Exactly," a look that says *don't fucking embarrass me.* "It's dinner with your mom, shitty Deku."

Izuku gulps before he nervously scans through his wardrobe again.

It looks like even Kacchan can be nice.

“Ehh? Which part of Tokyo did you grow up in, Katsuki-kun?”

Well, he’s nice in his own way but he seems *really, really* nice today.

“I lived in Musutafu until I was eighteen before I moved out – “

Nn, the actual son feels left out.

Ping!

Aizawa Shouta:

> >> This is your schedule starting Tuesday
> >> [**File attached:** UA_Bkg.docx]

Ping!

Team UA:

> >> **Mina:** Bring us souvenirs when you get back!
> >> **Kirishima:** Tsukushi mochi!!!
> >> **Sero:** If it’s Fukuoka isn’t it mentaiko?
> >> **Kaminari:** I’m fine with anything!

“I still have internships, Kacchan,”

Izuku awkwardly laughs, plopping down on his bed.

“I can play during weekends… I think. If I don’t have errands to run or if I’m not tired then I’ll definitely go to the PC café but I’m not sure,” since internships will start in a few days and Katsuki has to go back to Tokyo tomorrow. His break isn’t that long. It’s only for about ten days. He’s in no place to complain nevertheless because his decision was very impulsive. UA management was being quite generous actually.

“You don’t have to force yourself to do that,” going to PC cafes, he means. “Just rest since it’s your day off.”

Izuku obediently nods, cheek pressed against his pillow.

Katsuki's gotten to know the other quite a bit. He expected at least one drastic difference between Deku's online and offline persona but *no,* this guy is exactly what he seems. His personality and what he looks like in pictures – it's the same, better actually. There are a few questions he has yet to ask like the origin of those scars but that's reserved for another time.

Ten days is way too short.

"Hey,"

Izuku hums at Katsuki's call, opening one eye.

There's this strange look on the streamer's face, a mix between a frown and something else.

Is he *mad? Worried?* Kacchan is very difficult to read.

Katsuki is sitting on the bed, grimacing at the officer before he says, "Nothing is going to change."

Hmm…

"I guess even Kacchan gets worried?" Izuku laughs, lying on his back so that he can face the other.

"Hah?"

Cute.

"Come here," the officer grins, extending out his arms. It takes a bit of coercing but the blonde finally complies, face buried against the larger male's shoulder. Izuku can't see Katsuki's expression in this position since he can only comfortably stare at the ceiling but this is definitely better. He has a feeling he'll just get scolded anyway. "Of course nothing will change, Kacchan. I'll miss you a lot but like before… we can always call each other, right?"

They managed last time, didn't they?

Well, Izuku has a point but –

"I'll visit next month,"

"Ehh? But like I said internships – "

"I said I'll visit," Katsuki insists, glaring at the officer. "I'll visit you in Osaka next month."

Izuku can't help but press his lips into a thin line, cheeks flushed because,

"Is it for valentines?"

Katsuki hastily sits up, a horrified look on his face.

"IT'S A REGULAR VISIT, DUMBASS!"

He then proceeds to hit his lover with a pillow.

Ping!

Osaka Headquarters:

> **>> Chief:** Midoriya-kun and Todoroki-kun, please take note that internships resume on the sixth of January.
> You've probably been informed by the university already so this is just to double-check.

Ping!

"Stop – "

Katsuki grumbles against the other's lips, feeling his legs being spread wider. Izuku presses deeper into him and he throws his head back, mewling as his body shifts up and down on the bed. The blonde hates how there's background noise hurting his ears. It's distracting and troublesome, too many things going on at once. He can't help but painfully close his eyes at the ringing, Izuku hands touching him between his thighs.

"Your phone is ringing,"

Ignoring the mouth trailing on his jaw and chin.

Ping!

"Ghnn – ahh… *hah* – " the streamer huffs, gritting his teeth as his legs shiver and twitch.

"Kacchan you came,"

"Fucking turn it off," Katsuki complains again, tears dripping down his face as Izuku gives him open-mouthed kisses. "It's annoying," he bites the other's lip to retaliate, Izuku whimpering like a scolded dog before he reaches over to grab his phone.

"Ow…"

Izuku sobs, staring at the cut on his lower lip in the mirror the next morning.

"You didn't have to bite me that hard, Kacchan…"

Ping!

Mom:

>> Tell Katsuki-kun to have a safe trip!

Katsuki is scowling.

“Hmm… Your train is about to arrive, Kacchan,”

Izuku fondly laughs, not minding the arms tightly wrapped around his torso. He responds to the gesture just as affectionately, softly patting the streamer’s back with his eyes fixated on the station’s clock. Katsuki booked his ticket online and Fukuoka is not as crowded as Tokyo so it’s alright not to rush. He still needs to be at least five minutes early nevertheless.

“Come on,” a rather mediocre attempt on removing those arms. “People are staring.”

It doesn’t really matter because Katsuki has a mask on.

He always has one whenever they go out. It was the same in Tokyo and here in Fukuoka.

“You sound like you want me to leave, the fuck?”

“Ehh? Ahh, no – it’s just that your train – “ the officer panics for a moment, pouting when he sees the mischievous sparkle behind those eyes. “That’s mean, Kacchan…”

Katsuki just grins, tugging his mask lower as he leans in for a kiss.

It’s a bit soft – softer compared to the previous ones they shared. It also lingers way too long, the both of them tucked in a corner of the station away from wandering eyes. They only separate when they hear the radio announce an arriving train, Izuku’s eyes a bit glazed before the blonde leans in for one, two, *three* short pecks. It’s short and brief, the officer sniffling a bit.

“I’ll see you again soon,”

“Nn, soon,” Izuku nods, lips curling into a smile. “In Osaka.”

“In Osaka…”

At least he’s not that worried or conscious about money anymore.

The fans would probably also rejoice when they know what their donations are being used for.

“It’s goodbye for now,”

“Yeah, goodbye for now,” Katsuki brightly laughs before he pulls his mask up, teasing, “Crybaby.”

And Izuku lets their fingers touch a bit longer, the streamer waving one last time as he walks away.

Katsuki is not worried.

He had placed a precautionary measure before he left – a dog tag with his name written on it.

He's not worried.

He is worried.

"Wha – "

It's only been thirty minutes since he arrived at the share house – *his teammates unpacking their souvenirs in the background* – and he gets *this* news. Apparently, Izuku has been playing World Execute during the five hours Katsuki was on the train to cope with sadness and guess what.

"I made a friend!"

Hah?

"What friend?"

"Hmm… They helped me unlock a new part of One for All," he can hear the clicking of the mouse on the other side of the line and Katsuki grimaces at how the image's so vivid. He's seen Izuku's desk so of course he knows. "Danger Sense is what it's called. Like a sonar of some sort, Kacchan."

Usually, he would be interested in anything related to quirks but anyway –

"Which friend helped you?" *Yummycat, chouto, pink cheeks, glasses or –*

"Uhh… Shigaraki Tomura-san is his username I think,"

Red eyes widen because *who the fuck is that dude!? A new internet friend!?*

Anyway, calm down. It's just the first day.

"It was really fun. He was also maxed out but he liked doing the slime challenge hahaha – "

It only takes approximately twenty seconds of listening to Izuku's ramble for Katsuki to go, "Deku…"

"Yes, Kacchan?"

"If it turns out to be a side chick…"

Izuku shrieks because, "*Kacchan!? Again with the side chick! There's no side chick!"*

It's safe to say that it took two hours of playing WE together for Katsuki's mood to improve.

---

kamiiiinari @chargeboltt • 4 min ago
Bakugo's finally back!
[**Photo attached:** Team UA sprawled out in the living room with their souvenirs.]

The Secret Plotter @scrtpltr • 3 min ago
replying to @*chargeboltt*
Are those from Fukuoka www

Chapter End Notes

terminology explained.

(1) Rich - streamers earn a lot. a million yen is about nine thousand us dollars.
(2) Internships - it won't be elaborated that much now since we're nearing the ending kinda.

tomorrow is d-day. wish me luck and pray that i get kazuha.
this genshin event is really taking a toll on my regular update dates hahaha
also! comment the extras you want me to write for the extras after chapter 44!

february, march and april

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Ehh!? You already finished, Midoriya!?"

One of the policemen stares at the desk in awe, Izuku awkwardly laughing.

"And you're leaving!?" he continues when he sees his underclassman grab his jacket. "What about the company dinner? Aren't you going to attend!?" they had those every two weeks. It's a treat they get from the HQ higher-ups themselves. A lot of people were looking forward to it because word got around and apparently they were going to some high-end restaurant today.

"Ahh… Sorry senpai. I have other matters to attend to,"

A panicking Izuku apologizes before he bows, heading towards the door.

Their upperclassman scowls because, "What's up with him?"

"He has a date," it's Todoroki who speaks up, his desk next to Izuku's.

"Ehh!? Date!?"

"Nn," he then nods, explaining, "It's Valentine's day."

Ping!

Kacchan:

>> where are you
<< On my way!
>> stop making me wait!!!
<< I just got out! I'm sorry!

Katsuki is *pissed.*

He's been waiting at the station for thirty minutes already.

If this was a business meeting he wouldn't be signing any contract because who on earth makes an important client wait? That's just rude. Then again, it can't be helped since the other has urgent matters to attend to. It's not a holiday so everyone still has to go to work. He's just exempted because he's a streamer and his schedule is not really fixed unlike most people. It's been more than a month since they've seen each other as well so maybe that's why he's so impatient.

“Kacchan!”

A voice calls out, a familiar figure approaching from the distance.

Great, you better fucking run! the blonde scowls under his mask, glaring at the other. *Took you long enough!*

Seeing the other pant and sweat lessens his anger a bit. It means that Izuku rushed to get here – as he should be because if he was dilly-dallying it would be very bad. He’s still dressed in his uniform minus the jacket, red eyes unconsciously staring when the officer stops in front of him.

He looks good, at least the nerd seems to be taking care of himself. *Just how much muscle are you going to gain!?* when he gets pulled in for a hug, cheek squished against that hard chest.

Also… He’s wearing the necklace.

Everything’s going well so far.

“I’m sorry I’m late!” Katsuki has to look away for a bit, scowling because he had forgotten how sunny this guy is. That smile is probably bright enough to provide power for the city for an entire week. It’s dazzling, similar to how they first met back in Tokyo. “There was more work than I expected. I finished early but I still had to print something out and send it to the – “ ahh, he’s babbling again.

The streamer doesn’t really want to hear a long explanation so he cuts him off saying,

“You’re here now. Stop nagging about it.”

Now he feels guilty. He had planned on scolding Izuku for his tardiness but that look on his face is making him have second thoughts. It’s troublesome, really.

“Nn…” the officer dejectedly nods before he perks up, remembering, “Have you eaten yet?”

Katsuki grimaces again, replying, “Hah? That’s the plan, right? We were supposed to get dinner.”

I skipped out on the eki-bento for this, you dumbass!

“Ah yes! Crab!” since it’s Osaka and all. “Kani doraku is very famous, Kacchan!”

They’ve talked about it over the phone before and it’s a must in this city so of course, they’ll be giving it a try! It’s Izuku’s first time going to that restaurant as well because *don’t fucking go there without me, shitty Deku!* They planned to meet today so might as well reserve it for this occasion. Couples would usually eat something sweet for Valentine’s Day but the streamer is not really fond of sweets so there’s that.

Seafood it is then, Izuku mentally notes, grabbing Katsuki’s hand as they walk down the street.

Again with the hand holding…

People are sending them glances but they don’t seem as judgmental as the ones they received in Tokyo. They seem curious and amused by it actually, as expected of people from Kansai. They’re

not as stiff as the workaholics that live in the main city.

“Stop feeding me before dinner. You’re going to spoil my appetite!”

Izuku just laughs, telling Katsuki to open his mouth for another piece of Takoyaki.

Since they passed by a stall they can’t just ignore it, you know.

It’s Osaka after all!

The blonde glares at the officer, grumbling because it tastes better than expected.

Ping!

Team UA:

>> **Kaminari:** IT LOOKS GOOD SO UNFAIR
>> **Mina:** I WANNA GO THERE AND EAT TOO AHHHHHHH
>> **Kirishima:** Meshi-tero! Stop sending food pics!
>> **Sero:** [**Photo attached:** Take-out that team UA ordered for dinner.]
>> **Kaminari:** CRABBBBBBBBB

Katsuki stares at the table in front of him.

He was a bit worried before because who on earth eats seafood during Valentine’s date!?

That dilemma is now gone nevertheless because there seem to be quite a few couples in the restaurant they were at today. It’s not a very fancy place but it’s still popular in Osaka. No doubt you’d find it in every travel plan and brochure out there as well. Since they’re here they decided to get the most expensive set and Katsuki can basically see the officer’s eyes sparkle when the waiter lays it out on their table. It’s snow crab, you know! There’s no way Izuku can contain himself!

This is not fucking romantic at all, is Katsuki’s only complaint but, *What the – I guess it’s fine.*

Even he fell for the temptation they call crab.

It can’t be helped.

He’s frequently stuck with take-out and repetitive dishes in the shared house so this is new.

“Itadakimasu,”

“Itadakimasu,”

They both take one bite before their eyes widen and they look at each other.

“Should…” Izuku gulps, glancing at the menu. “Should we order drinks too, Kacchan?”

A few minutes later, the sake is served.

It’s a bad idea that Katsuki shouldn’t have agreed to.

“Have you found an apartment that’s good, Kacchan? You’re supposed to move out during May, right?”

The officer is completely flushed from his cheeks up to his ears. He has two of his buttons open as well because apparently it’s too hot. The number of times female workers approached them to give him water is starting to get annoying. Can’t they see that he’s with someone!? Also, what’s with that? That coquettish look Izuku’s giving him while playing with their fingers on top of the table.

WHAT’S UP WITH THAT!?

Are you the protagonist of a BL manga or something? Snap out of it, oi!

“I’ll start looking for one in April,” it’s a good thing Katsuki can hold his alcohol well.

Regarding the apartment thing… Everyone in team UA decided to move out because they’ve been staying together for almost five years. At first, it was to lessen financial costs since they were just starting out but there’s no need for that now. The main office also got a new upgrade so if they needed to record team content they could just go there to film. It’s something they all saw coming. They’ve been discussing it for quite a while actually.

Izuku softly nods, glancing at the other, “I also have to go in for a formal interview in April.”

It seems like he’ll really end up accepting TMPD’s offer.

“Let’s find an apartment together…”

Katsuki opens his mouth to speak once, *twice* before he presses his lips into a thin line.

“Are you talking about moving in together or going together because you also need yours?“

“Hehehe,”

The streamer grimaces as he pinches the other’s hand.

Izuku had a great time and since it’s late they decided that it was time to end it and go back.

“That’s a very expensive hotel, Kacchan~” referring to the place Katsuki booked a room in.

The officer was feeling great and he felt like skipping as he waved their connected hands back and forth. It’s a good thing that he wasn’t a bad drunk. He looks cute, actually. The only troublesome

thing is his fixation for hands – something that the streamer finds a bit embarrassing because they're walking down the street. Thankfully no one seems to be paying attention, too occupied with their own plans.

"Are you staying over?"

"Hmm? Of course I am!" Izuku seems baffled almost. "I'm the boyfriend! It's my job to stay over!"

Katsuki sends him this confused expression before he laughs exclaiming,

"The fuck does that mean!?"

Izuku owlishly blinks, his lips curl up into a fond smile.

Nn, Kacchan's laugh sounds nice.

"Nghhh – "

Katsuki whimpers, tears streaming down his face as Izuku slowly sinks in.

"Wai… Wai—" he closes his eyes when it reaches the hilt, exposed cock twitching as he cums. It's a bit embarrassing but as expected… it can't be helped because it's been more than a month since they've last had sex. Doing it together on call and video chat just isn't enough. The real thing is a bit too overwhelming as well. "Slow down –" he tells the officer who is leaning in for another kiss, pressing one hand against his abdomen so that he can't move just yet.

Both of their hair is wet since they just got out of the bath.

One would expect Izuku to sober up after a long soak but no, he's still drunk.

That's going to fucking leave bruises, referring to the tight grip the other has on his thighs. *This jerk… Just how drunk are you!?*

Katsuki takes in the sight in front of him, his lover flushed red and looking like he's suffering.

That's good, at least he's not the only one. *I should stop spoiling him so much.*

"Move closer," and the larger male complies, looking like some sort of overgrown puppy. Even in this state, he's still obedient which is nice. Wouldn't want him to do whatever he wants. "Don't you have something to say to me first, shitty Deku?"

Green eyes blink, contemplating for a moment before he nods replying, "Nn, I missed you Kacchan."

"Damn right, you did," the blonde shows a smug smile, arms wrapping around the other's neck. "Come here."

Izuku then slowly leans in for a kiss.

Katsuki had forgotten how good the other was with this, seriously.

All he could do while his lover moved was lie down and take it – drool dripping down his chin. There's a slick sound that fills the room, Izuku's free hand working with his exposed cock. How long have they been at it again? He can't tell. It's a good thing that it's the officer's day off it tomorrow because they can sleep in as much as they want after this. Katsuki is surely going to need it. His throat hurts from moaning a bit too much and he grimaces when those hands caress his chest.

"M'not…" he pants, glaring though watery eyes. "M'not a girl."

Keep those hands off my chest, is what he means.

Izuku just hums, slowing down for a while before he pinches down *hard.*

"Hkkk –" the streamer's eyes widen as he cums again, cock twitching all the while Izuku grinds into him. "Bastard… *Hah* – " he throws his head back, complaining as his lover kneads the soft fat underneath. He's already feeling it so much from his lower half so as much as possible not the top as well.

"You like it…" Izuku says, noticing how the blonde tightens up every time he rubs down.

A twitch, Katsuki squirming and rubbing his legs together.

"See?"

"You're annoying,"

The streamer mumbles half-incoherently against the lips pressed unto his.

"Good morning, Kacchan," a shy greeting from the other, Katsuki not wanting to wake up.

Judging by how his body felt Izuku must have cleaned him up. It's only proper with how he was acting last night – this much is expected.

"Goddamit," when Izuku makes him throw his arms around the curve of his neck. "It's too fucking early for this," he sinks on his pillow, grumbling all the while being kissed.

"Mina-chan, why aren't you guys streaming on the fourteenth – *HAHAHA,"*

The streamer laughs at the question, brightly grinning.

"Team UA has someone important to meet," she reveals, stream chat starting to become a bit more

curious. It also doesn't take long for the guesses to start rolling in. "I'll tell you guys how it went after… After lunch with Deku, I mean…" a teasing grin, amused and excited when her viewers' comments shift from intrigue to alarm.

Ping!

Stream Chat:

>> EHHH!?
>> BIG NEWS!!!
>> deku meets team ua arc!? omg!!
>> Baku might get mad that you're announcing it Mina!
>> Meeting brother-in-law… I also want to go!

Word got around quite fast.

"Shut up, they're here – "

Sero points out, elbowing Kaminari on the side when he sees Katsuki and Izuku walk in.

They all stand up from their seats to greet the other, Mina forgetting to say something because she's just staring.

"Wow, you're very handsome in person," she announces, the officer owlishly blinking before he sheepishly laughs and responds with a *thank you*. "Baku what did you do to get so lucky?"

Katsuki frowns, completely unimpressed because *what on earth is this girl saying?*

"Ahh that's right, Shinsou-kun asked me to pass this to Kaminari-kun,"

Izuku all of a sudden declares in the middle of eating before he takes out something from his pocket – a gift card for World Execute. Perhaps it's some sort of inside joke. No one knows.

Kaminari chokes on his water while his teammates do a double-take because *hmm?*

HMMMM!?

What is this development!?

And then April –

Which way is Kyushu University again?

He doesn't want to make Inko-san mad by being late.

Katsuki is dressed in semi-formal attire. He's not a staff member nor is he a relative so this much is enough. He's just there to attend and watch. He also doesn't have his usual mask on, a few students glancing at him when he passes by them near the gate. They agreed to meet up at the Centennial hall but he doesn't know where that is so he's just roaming around, a bouquet of flowers slung against his shoulder.

Izuku doesn't know that he's here.

"Katsuki-kun!" he's heard that voice a few times before.

It was Inko who asked if he could come. She said that it'll definitely make Izuku happy since it's his long-awaited graduation day. Trying to hide it was troublesome but it was all worth it after seeing that look on the other's face.

You look like you swallowed a bug or something, Katsuki owlishly blinks before he laughs.

"Ka-Kacchan!?"

Izuku is dressed in his academic regalia – black cap and gown with hints of red.

Nn, he looks good. Makes his heart flutter a bit.

Inko-san told him that graduating students were supposed to wear a suit and tie so under that is definitely – "What are you doing here!?"

Blink. Blink.

"Hah!?" this guy… shouting at him when there's quite a distance between them. Other people are looking! Izuku's face is red, his eyebrows knitted together. He looks surprised but definitely happy. I mean why wouldn't he be? Katsuki went all the way from Tokyo just for this event, you know! "Am I not allowed to be here or something!?"

Yup. There's a hint of tie, definitely a suit.

"No, not that but… But… This is too sudden! It's embarrassing!"

It's embarrassing!? Seriously!? This guy…

"Hah… What the hell!?" Katsuki sighs, looking unimpressed. "I came all the way here for you, you dweeb!" he needs some sort of cute response or something! A praise! *Usually you get so excited to see me so what's this!?*

"I DON'T LIKE SURPRISES KACCHAN!" he's not prepared for this at all, his heart is pounding against his chest and his blood is rushing because – "I'm… I'm about to die – " *why didn't you warn me beforehand mom!?* Even the person he trusts the most betrayed him! Katsuki doesn't have his mask on, he's dressed up and… and… And this is his graduating ceremony, you know!

"DROP DEAD!"

Katsuki screams back, approaching the other with a grin on his face.

"STOP! DON'T COME HERE! I'M NOT PREPARED!"

“It’s fine!” the streamer assures, Izuku panicking when the distance is closed. “What more are you supposed to prepare for!?”

“My face! I’m… I’m sure I’m making an ugly expression right now – “

Katsuki pauses in front of the other, slightly tilting his chin up. He really doesn’t get what this fuss is all about. Is it really surprising that he’s here? Izuku is looking off to the side, red up to his ears but as per usual –

“You look gorgeous, is that what you want me to say?”

Much to his surprise, the officer’s face becomes even redder.

“Congratulations on graduating, shitty Deku,”

Izuku pouts, glancing at the blonde before he grumbles something under his breath.

“Nn…” when his cheeks get squished by the blonde’s hands, being pulled down for a kiss. He can’t help but reciprocate for a moment, their foreheads pressed together before he says, “Thank you, Kacchan…”

Katsuki then grins, Izuku fondly smiling.

---

midoriiiiiiii • 6 min ago

> Thank you for the support!
>
> [**Photos attached**: (1) Izuku and Katsuki, (2) Izuku and Inko, (3) Izuku and his friends.]

↳ Liked by chouto and 92 others.

“Tokyo?”

“Nn!” Izuku nods, adjusting the strap on his shoulder. “Let’s go to Tokyo!”

They board the shinkansen together for the first time during the month of April.

Chapter End Notes

> ***terminology explained.***

(1) Kani doraku - popular restaurant at osaka.
(2) Valentine's day - february 14.
(3) White day - march 14.
(4) Izuku's graduation - april 14
(5) Meshi tero - literally means food terrorist. someone who sends tons of food pictures.

no, the title did not come from the last part. it's a coincidence.
i realized it the moment i was proof reading but it's fine though. ima just leave it there.
it's... ehh? i guess it does relate to the title but oh well...
also, i'm allergic to crab. i've never tasted crab but everyone says it tastes good so i'm curious.
osaka is really known for seafood! that's what my research said at least.
next update will be the last chapter then omake or extra.

deku's face reveal!?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

At first team UA was trying to hide it but it got to the point where it became way too tedious that they manage to slip sometimes.

“Kaminari, a shadow just passed by – *pfft,”*

They’re all in the living room with their portable set up, everyone sitting on the couch and a few on the floor. It’s game night for their group. Team UA usually does streams like this at least twice a month. Today they’re playing some sort of card game due to popular demand. Last time it was *Code Names* and this one, *Mafia* or so it’s called, is trendy nowadays so they’re giving it a go. So far so good, chat seems to like it as well. It’s a bit nerve-wracking to play but yeah…

“What shadow?” at least Kirishima is trying to pass it off, looking behind his back. “There’s no shadow.”

“They’re asking what shadow – *pftt –“*

Meanwhile, Katsuki is silent and leaning back on his seat, red eyes glaring at the others because *don’t you fucking dare.* Mina most especially. She looks like she’s about to explode with her lips pursed and entire body shaking. The fact that she’s holding in her laughter just makes it seem more suspicious. Also, Sero… *SERO STOP FUCKING LOOKING AT THE GUY STANDING BEHIND THE CAMERA!* Maybe it’s because of the lighting but yes, a shadow did pass by from the front.

Ping!

Stream Chat:

>> ghost sighting?
>> Share house is haunted confirmed!!!??
>> Tokoyami-kun?
>> Why does Pinky look red wwww
>> I didn’t see a shadow????

The best course of action would’ve been not to address the passing comment but this is team UA, what do you expect? Their eyes always somehow manage to catch the most ridiculous comments. Kaminari is not sure what went through his head at that time but their leader is not amused. Katsuki looks *pissed.* He’s holding up that card like it’s his middle finger, aura so dark Mina has to hide her face with a pillow.

“DENKI YOU’RE THE MAFIA AREN’T YOU!?”

“I SAID I’M NOT! I’M THE DOCTOR – “

>> Vote Kaminari out!!!!
>> LYNCH LYNCH LYNCH LYNCH LYNCH
>> i’m still confused, why are they acting like that?
>> SOMEONE EXPLAIN OMG
>> why does baku look like that?????

Behind the scenes Izuku just awkwardly laughs. He wanted to stand up and go to the bathroom but it looks like that wouldn't be happening anytime soon – not with his figure overshadowing team UA. Nn, he should just remain seated until the stream ends. Katsuki doesn't seem too fond of answering questions. He's glaring and glaring. The blonde has become less uptight about his identity nowadays but perhaps revealing it still a bit too much.

Izuku himself doesn't mind but yeah…

"Gambatte," the officer mouths when their eyes meet, Katsuki grimacing before he huffs and looks away.

Cute.

> >> Ehhhhhhhhhhhh
> >> baku????
> >> *confused fish noises*
> >> why is captain acting like a tsudere kareshi?
> >> What the – Why is everybody laughing?

And then –

> >> Is Deku standing behind the camera?

No one comments and it sends the entire internet spiraling.

PROOF WHY DEKU IS REAL (with evidence)
[Video uploaded to HeroTube]
1,729,950 views 212k 10k Share
bkdkloverrr
Uploaded – July 18, 20XX • 2:19
Description
go watch the original stream and check for yourself: *herotube.bkDKml*

pretty stranger • 2 days ago
I SAW THAT SHADOW ON 00:32 TOOO!!!! AHHHH! I'm so glad that Deku is with them. It must be really fun hngghhh. It's sad that we don't get to see his face but it's totally fine! I'm surprised that you actually managed to spot the other times he made his presence well known on stream. Baku was really panicking www. Thanks for the disclaimer at the end too! It's totally their choice!
15k REPLY
View 248 replies

> **The Coconut Is A Giant Nut** • 2 days ago
> i'm squirming because i respect them but i'm very nosy so i also want to know.
> 6k REPLY
>
> **Juuden_27** • 2 days ago

Bakugo made it totally obvious with the heart eyes wwww
3k REPLY

MILKYYY CHOCO • 2 days ago
I CAN HEAR CAPTAIN'S MONOGUE THROUGH THE SCREEN WWW
3k REPLY

Go Barbara Go! • 2 days ago
super chat was going insane. too bad they didn't fold.
2k REPLY

paiwillin • 2 days ago
AHHHHHH I'M SO CURIOUS I'M GONNA RIP MY HAIR OUT
1k REPLY

"Dad! I've leveled up!"

Eri is running around Ground Zero's avatar, excited because she's almost maxed.

Kota seems to be upset because she's higher than him now but it can't be helped. That quirk of his is mostly only efficient in combat unlike Eri's which can be used for both support and damage. Watering plants don't give that much EXP as well. Truth to be told Izuku and Katsuki tried to balance out the children's levels to avoid issues like this but nn, they really should go on a raid soon. Kota looks like he's about to summon a storm at this rate. They've never dealt with tantrums but it seems plausible.

"When's papa getting back!?"

Again with this –

Kota always looks for Deku whenever he's upset. Maybe it's because his relationship level is higher with the other.

"He has work to do," Katsuki's casual reply as he clicks away. He's done this multiple times already. It was worse during Izuku's internship days. "He can't play all the time because he has his job in the real world," one would assume that mobs won't know what the real world is but Kota and Eri seem to be aware. Maybe it's because of their programming, no one knows.

"Tell him to log in!"

"He doesn't have his PC with him!"

Team UA would be more than happy to lend him one but the guy is always out. In the first place, he came to Tokyo because of an invitation from TMPD. Imagine Katsuki's surprise when he found out that Izuku was going to work in Tokyo. He was shocked at first before he became a bit pissed because *it's been almost half a year since you received the offer and you didn't fucking tell me!?* Now he feels embarrassed for being emotional back in December, what the hell. They were both overreacting for nothing.

Ping!

Stream Chat:

>> Just let them talk to Deku!!!!
>> Does it work if you use the same mic?
>> maybe they'll recognize him?? www
>> AHHHHH KOTA DON'T CRY
>> BAKUUUU GIVE US CRUMBSSSSS

"No," the streamer emphasizes. "You won't be seeing him ever."

There's no way in hell he's allowing Deku to do any sort of reveal.

Actually, fuck that.

He didn't allow it, it occurred by itself.

Due to various reasons, Izuku and Katsuki did not share a room. One, it would be embarrassing with the blonde's teammates around due to their teasing, and two, Izuku's here for work. He has to wake up early and leave early – he can't possibly trouble Katsuki more. There's also the fact that his schedule is not fixed. He comes back at random times in the evenings and it would be bad to just barge in while the other is streaming. It's convenient enough that the house is big and there's an extra room – the one Aizawa uses when he has to stay over for an extended period of time, so it's not that big of a deal.

That is until Izuku oversleeps during his free day.

"Kacchan," he calls out, one hand on the door's handle. "Kacchan, have you seen my uniform?"

He remembers being in the other's room all night last night before he returned to his room.

It's probably on the floor or something.

He really needs to find it because he only brought three sets of uniform shirts.

Ping!

Stream Chat:

>> WASHBORD!!!!!!!!!??
>> HMMMMMMMMMMM!????
>> DEKU!!!!???? DEKU!!!!!!!???
>> OMG OMG OMG OMG
>> WHAT IS HE SAYING HE'S TOO FAR

"Laundry," Katsuki monotonously replies as he clicks away, too focused on WE. "Go get it later."

The officer just sleepily nods, using the back of his palm to rub his eyes before he leaves saying,

"Nn, thanks…"

Click. Click.

Ping!

Stream Chat:

>> !!!!!!!!!??????
>> WHO WAS THAT TOPLESS GUY???
>> UHHHHHHHHH DEKU??????
>> ----- CONFIRMED
>> I'M GONNA FUCKING FAINT IS THIS REAL

The blonde pauses when his eyes land on chat, head slowly turning around before he glares to the camera.

"Don't clip this shit," he warns, eyebrows twitching. *"DON'T FUCKING CLIP THIS SHIT!"*

They do.

Thankfully they didn't see Deku's face.

Because of the angle, they were only able to see from chin down.

Katsuki is not sure if that's a blessing or a curse.

---

cocoa-chan @cocobuns • 54m
why everyone should simp for deku; a thread –
[**Photo attached:** BKDK fanart in a World Execute setting.]

DENISAUR @denysaurrrr • 53m
replying to @*cocobuns*
ALPHA VIBES

jade @dekusgf • 53m
replying to @*cocobuns*
we didn't get a face reveal but we got something better

Kiwiiiiii @kims_art • 52m
replying to @*cocobuns*
HAVE U SEEN HIS ARMS OMG

Drawing_naho @nahooomi_92 • 52m
replying to @*cocobuns*
The biggest question is why does he have a lot of scars

LAVENDER @violetlilac • 51m
replying to @*alienqueen*

DEKU YAKUZA CONFIRMED???
[**GIF attached:** Shocked anime girl.]

“What the hell!?”

Katsuki exclaims when chat asks about Izuku during one particular stream.

“He isn’t part of any shit. He’s far from that!”

That must have been the turning point because he immediately reveals, “Deku’s a fucking cop.”

And perhaps that was the better choice, the false rumors immediately trashed.

Izuku is confused.

“I think the bedroom’s big enough?”

They’re currently in a café sitting next to each other, a bunch of fliers and brochures on the table along with their drinks. Katsuki also has his phone out, scrolling down a website all the while grimacing. Other people wouldn’t be able to tell what expression he has on because of the mask covering his face but Izuku is way too familiar with this. It’s obvious with how the blonde’s eyebrows knit together and how his eyes narrow ever so sharply.

Did I do something wrong? the officer asks himself. *What did I do wrong?*

And then he starts to recall what happened throughout the day attempting to figure it out.

It’s not the *flashing chat* issue because they’ve already settled that last week. It was a whirlwind, a thunderstorm – thankfully Izuku has a lot of patience and self-control for the both of them. A few assuring words here and there and Katsuki seemed to recover fast. He did bring it up from time to time though, always pissed whenever someone tags him on Izuku’s shirtless photo on Twitter. At least now he wouldn’t have to sneak around the blonde’s room whenever he needs something.

Other than that hmm… They ate breakfast then went out to look for apartments. Katsuki insisted that they should just find one online but Izuku thinks that those are way too expensive. His salary is not that low but he wants to save up during his first year. A bunch of people told him that agencies have cheaper options for a one-bedroom apartment as well.

“What about my streaming gear?”

“Ehh? You’re bringing your streaming gear?” the PC, monitor, mic, lights, and all of that?

“Hah? I’m a streamer! Of course I will!”

And Izuku at this point is just way too lost so he asks, “Ehh? But why? Are you going to stream in my apartment?”

Silence.

Hmm? he tilts his head to the side because Katsuki seems to be shaking in anger.

It's the Pomeranian look again.

Clang.

"Kacchan?" Izuku exclaims, panicking when the blonde stands up and heads to the door. "Where are you going – Kacchan!?" as he tidies up, immediately following the other out of the café.

What is it!?

"The bedroom is not big enough!"

"It's fine if it's over your budget. We have super chat!"

"What an ugly kitchen,"

"Not that one. There's no security,"

Ahhhhhhhhhhhhhh.

"Of course I was just joking!"

No, he totally forgot.

Izuku is trying to smile as he pats Katsuki's head, pulling him in closer for a hug. He can practically feel the other pouting against his shoulder, the both of them standing at the bus stop. After thinking about it for a while the officer realized what he missed and yes, it's a pretty big mistake on his part. There's also the fact that the blonde has been hinting about it since January so nn… he'd rather not think about that. Izuku's usually not this dense and inattentive but he really doesn't have any excuse.

He can feel himself sweating.

Sorry.

"You weren't fucking joking. Stop lying,"

"It… It really was just a joke!" Izuku gulps when he looks down and sees Katsuki's glare.

Red is pretty but it's very scary sometimes…

"Really?" the streamer asks again, his grip on the officer's arm tightening. For some reason, Izuku can feel some sort of pressure sink in, much worse compared to the times he was faced with a bunch of criminals. Katsuki would probably do well with interrogation. That look he has on his

face is no joke. Izuku is a trained combat specialist, you know! “You swear on your mother? You’re sure it was just a joke?”

If you say it like that… Kuhh!

“What... How? How should I make it up to you?”

Yeah, let’s just do that. No entirely admitting the mistake and just jumping straight to the consequences.

It’s better this way.

Katsuki remains silent for a moment, staring up at the other before he grins.

“Kacchan, what are you planning?”

He looks smug, a bit too pleased for Izuku’s liking.

“Kacchan!?”

A few days later they sign their new apartment’s lease.

↳ **GROUND ZERO @bkgkatsuki_official Retweeted**
Deku ʕ•ᴥ•ʔ @officialdekiru • 12m
i finally have a twitter account!!

Uraraka Ochako @uravity • 12m
replying to @*bkgkatsuki_official*
AHHHHHHHHHHHHHH NO WAYYYYYYYYY

BKDK #1 Supporter @bkdklove • 11m
replying to @*bkgkatsuki_official*
I AM NOT PREPARED FOR THIS WAIITTTTTTTTT

i want to sleep @_toshii • 10m
replying to @*bkgkatsuki_official*
??????????

Namikawa Haru @syznnaa •10m
replying to @*bkgkatsuki_official*
immediately heads to deku’s account to follow

The Secret Plotter @scrtpltr • 9m
Deku’s real identity @*reddit.Nl/IOknak*

“Kacchan,” Izuku frowns, not liking what he was hearing from Aizawa.

“What’s this Reddit post about?”

Ahh… the thing that’s been going around since last year?

“You see…”

Ping!

Katsuki grimaces, watching the other pick up the phone.

“An unknown number?”

That’s a story for another day.

Chapter End Notes

drop dead, gorgeous has officially ended! ✺◟(• ω •)◞✺
cue party noises it's been such a long journey. thank you to everyone who's been there since chapter one.
i can recognize almost half of the reviews. you're all regular commenters! pachi pachi pachi!

anyway, author-san is happy now that this is finished.
i purposely left out a bunch of scenarios because there's a sequel. (´。• ω •。`)
as for when the sequel is... hmm... after i get a break from university! it's way too hectic right now!
i'm in internships and i didn't want to leave this on a hiatus so i cut it off at this point.
it's a cliffhanger... kinda... secret plotter will be on the sequel.

it might turn into a crime/thriller fic idk.
originally this was just a fluff fic but for some reason, it's progressing with plot.
anyway, thank you for the support! i'm currently writing the 100k special __φ(. .)
it's team ua cooking with deku on the side.

again, thank you for reading! have a nice day!
it was fun everyone! see you in the sequel! (シ_ _)シ
also... please look up *where does vanilla flavoring come from?*

goodbye

Hello, long time no see.

About half a year ago I joined Twitter in order to make friends and talk to people who also read fics.

As intended, I encountered individuals who share the same interests and those who do not. It was quite fun at first and I learned a lot during that duration but I don't think I'll ever be the same again. I should have expected this from happening. I should have been prepared because when I decided to post my work on a public website, criticism was bound to show up. That is a fact.

What I did not expect was for people to trash talk and trample on my work in a private group chat. There were a lot of members so I was not able to speak. I was merely observing and perhaps that was my fault. I just sat there staring at the screen as they tore down my work into pieces. Admittedly, they were not aware that the author of DDG is also a member of that space. Perhaps that was even more shocking to me because I joined that group chat in order to make friends. Not to discover that people hate my fic to the point that it makes them react violently.

It's been a few months since then and I tried to get over it but I don't think I can. I feel like I'm going mad and I don't have anything to write even though I used to be so excited for the sequel. I'm not the type to be sad or depressed but I don't feel like I'll ever get over that. Is it alright to say that my experience was traumatic? I'm not sure but it definitely made me stay up countless nights. I can't concentrate and every time I see a BKDK fic I just want to rip my skin out. It makes me wonder how many more are talking about my work like that. I only see the good comments in the comment section so it was definitely an eye-opener. Perhaps it would've been different if it was a public comment, not a private one.

I was writing this for fun. They were picking a fight with people who liked DDG and well… I don't. I really don't know. I just hoped that they would be kinder with their words. I hoped that over time I would feel better but no. I have reached a breaking point. It's been months since then but I'm still upset. I don't think I would be able to write ever again. Thank you for all the fanart and for those who commented. Your words really made my day better. You were all so patient with me and nothing but good.

It's a bit dramatic and cliche but yeah, I don't think I can go on spoiling your lives any longer.

There will be no sequel.

Goodbye,
thewunderkind

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!